# David (Chapter 1)

Wednesday, 26 January 2022 9:19 PM

The roar of the crowd was becoming louder as I approach to the gate leading to the coliseum field. With every foot I take, the cheers of every person is getting louder. There excitement is even more effusive since no one knows who the other opponent is. I myself am confused who the Citradels elders have been hiding all this time. Kafar says this person is a hidden weapon of Citradel and supposedly formidable enough to have kept the Hive commander away from their home for years. It's difficult to imagine anyone tougher than Marina among all the Citradels people. It's unbelievable that someone stronger than him or the Hive commander has gone unnoticed all these years. Who is it? Why have they been kept secrete for so long? As I reach in front of the gate, I mumble to myself, Its time.

Ahead me, I can see a glimmer of golden radiating in the air. Hmm. Weird. I focused a bit more and allowed my eyes to fill up more radiations. The golden slimmer was not filled up in front of me, but it was shaped in a silhouette of a person. I immediately stopped. What's this now. Someone trying to stop me ? No. Whoever is here isn't moving, instead they are just waiting. Perhaps for me. Are they a spy. Do I ignore and move on. That would be best. I walked a little closer and saw a new smaller glimmer coming out. This one however, I knew. In fact, we had just clashed recently. I stopped and called out, what's this Blake.

Ahead me a voice responds, Huh damn. You can see me. The golden glimmer started to dissipate and Blake remined behind. He was waiting beside the gate. He was wearing his casuals jeans and a jacket on top. He was leaning against the wall, arms folded and a leg pulled up resting against the wall. It looked like he was waiting for me. I say, You have almost completely hidden your Kuret and everything around you. Blake smiles a little and says, its because of this. He pulls out a small glowing item from his jacket pockets. He opens his palm to reveal a white stone shining not too bright, but enough to catch attention of an eye. I had never seen this before, but I its no brainer to guess that it's a something Marina created. Blake continues, it's a Kuritine to hide the wielders smell, noise and temperature. Yet you managed to see me here. Impressive as ever. It took you what, 5 seconds to figure it out. He scoffs. He raises his hand which held the Kuritine, Marina gave me this to cover my Kuret and other physical presence for a while if I consciously keep my Kuret down.

I ask why?, he says, I wanted to sneak into the Citradels side of rooms and find who you were going to fight. As soon as I heard him walked towards him in shock. I faced him closer, I said, you did what! Blake are you serious? Tell me you didn't spy on them. Blake pulls him palm on the air saying, calm down David. I didn't want to spy on them. But you understand how unsettling this is right? They still haven't revealed their so called prized champion. I replied, That's not a good reason for you to spy on them, dude. If you get caught and they feel violated, they might just pull the plug out of this tournament. We have worked a lot to reach here. I don't want to them to leave for any reason and waste this opportunity. I quickly recalled all the agreements and compromises we had to make just to make this tournament happen so out in the open.

Blake continues, I know. I don't want to risk this also. But it's unfair that they know you and tell nothing about their champion. I know that you also understand how much at a disadvantage they have kept you. Not knowing who your opponent is the worst. Citradel knows how you fight, your style and your power. Others told me that Kafar didn't even bat his eyes when we duked it out on the field. I don't want to sound boastful, but people find you, me and Marina objectively stronger. Kafar wasn't much bothered by my defeat. He scoffs, and it's someone claimed to be stronger than Marina or the Hive Commander. Where were they when we were fighting a year back. Someone who Kafar thinks is stronger than me and you, why they have kept it a secrete and are ready to reveal now. I couldn't possibly just idly sit by and let them have that advantage.

Even when I am angry at him, I knew there was truth in what he said. Not knowing who my opponent is the biggest challenge. Most of my battles are dependent on knowing who I am fighting against. My shadow leader training was all about knowing how my enemy would think, their strategy and how to out maneuver them. It was a vital part for all my missions. I took a moment before asking, you said we. Who all colluded behind my back?

Blake smirks saying, Everyone. I replied, excuse me? When you said everyone you mean. He continues, dude, everyone in the war room decided it was worth the risk. Vanessa, Nathanial, Cass, Matt, Catherine. Hell, even Sierra agreed. I was taken aback when I heard her name. She was supposed to be the voice of reason. I can't believe she didn't stop this. He goes on, and I wouldn't say we did it behind your back. We knew if we told you before you would throw a fit. We didn't want to worry you while you were preparing. We needed your head in the game. So I volunteered to do a little spy on them. I shook my head in disbelief. I said, you are damn right. I would have stopped you guys from pulling a stunt like this. Jeopardizing everything we worked for?. He didn't reply immediately. He says after a moment, believe me. We all discussed at great length. But we agreed, not knowing is much worst. I was about to rebuke him but I held myself. I didn't want to be mad at him and others when they were just looking out for me.

Before I could say anything, he closed his eyes and sighs, well, it doesn't matter now. I already checked their war room about two hours back, I didn't find any person who hasn't participated in the matches. Can you believe it? I risked infiltrating the other side of the coliseum for naught. I looked everywhere, but I couldn't find anyone who was powerful than Derek. I could feel only his Kuret the strongest amongst all. I know this person has to be inside the coliseum, but they also like me has found a way to hide myself. After about 10 minutes, I gave up and went back to others. Told them I couldn't find that person. Others thought it would be wise to not tell you about this. They told me not to tell you.

But you have, I said. He nods, yes. I wanted to let you know that whoever this person is, he or she is very skilled at hiding his Kuret. And that's a bad match for you. Your powers react on others Kuret. And if that person can hide it so well, who knows what other tricks will be shown in the actual battle. I looked over to the gate. The crowds noise were slowly diminishing. It's almost time. I faced Blake again, Look. I appreciate you guys doing this for me. But you shouldn't have. Or maybe you should told me sooner. Blake sighs, I know. Believe me. We wanted you to be in on it. Our search would have been more efficient. Especially when I am not very the expert in infiltrating places. I usually just kick the main door, you know. He laughs, you have no idea how we managed to snuck in their room. We had to bribe one of the engineers who laid out the Kuretine and the circuits underground. With those layout plans, we found a secrete passage on-

I cut him off, on the 3 level where we are running the Kuritine stones to hide and protect this place. He looked shocked. I continue, that passage was small enough for only one person to fit. Let me guess, you had to crawl all the way in that passage to the other side right? Because we running so many detection system in this place, you didn't use any Kuret and crawled with your bare hands and legs. You reached to the sewer crossing, used that path to cross the other side. I closed my eyes, about 300 meters left, then 100 meters to right and finally 200 meters straight you found the upper basement manhole that opens to the room adjacent to war room.

Blake had his mouth hanging out, how the hell did you know. His eyebrows pushed together, dude. What, how?. I open my eyes and sigh, I told you. I wish you would have told me sooner about this. I know all this because I just used the same route just half an hour back. Blake pulled himself away from the wall and walked towards me, you did what! You have got to be kidding me. It was now my turn to feel a little guilty, yeah. I did. And like you guys, I wasn't planning on telling anyone about this.

Blake was in shock now, Damn. You gave me so much crap about taking too much risk when you did the same. I raise my hand. I was more prepared. Unlike you, I wouldn't be caught using my Kuret. I didn't need any layout of the underground passages. So I have much better chance of not getting detected. You on the other hand took a lot more risk than I did. I could see Blake was ticked off. I thought he would still be angry, but he chortles, I can't believe you also did something stupid, man. I rebuked, hey it was not stupid. It was a calculated risk. I wanted to know who I will be fighting. I know Kafar doesn't think me as a problem. He believes whoever the person is, they must be so powerful that not even my Kuret can stop. I thought about the risks, but I decided if I can get even a hint like which house this person belongs to or what his Kuret is, its worth it.

Blake nodded, yeah I guess, if I were in your position I would also do the same. I mean, I know I did it anyway, but I wouldn't have told others. In case I get caught, there is always plausible deniability. Yeah, exactly, I replied. I knew If I got caught, I could somehow persuade them saying it was a rash move and blame it on adrenaline. I shrug my shoulders, but like you I couldn't find anyone who seemed like the next opponent. Blake replies, really. You also couldn't find him?. I said, yeah. In fact, I think that contestants also don't know this mystery wild card entry is supposed to be. I suspect apart from Kafar and his circle, only Derek would know who it is.

Blake says, will he? We already asked him, he didn't give a straight answer, just said that it will be revealed soon enough. I think he just trying to be mysterious and actually doesn't know who it is. I shook my head, no. He definitely knows who it is. After our match was over on the field, he said to me privately to be very careful against the Citradels champion. I got the feeling that he knows how strong this person is. Derek is very smart guy and he knows my strength. And yet he warns me about this mystery person. No way he warns me about someone he never met. I bet he knows, but I think he was promised not to tell anyone who it is.

Blake faces the gate now where the stadium is almost silent, I don't know. He could be just saying that scare you off. Get you to rattle before the match. After thinking over a moment I said, a mind game before the fight ? maybe. I don't think he was lying or manipulating me. I face towards the gate and walked closer. I could now see strands of red and orange flowing around. It's the scent of all the suspense and excitement in the air. Even with the barrier erected, people's presence are still reaching me. I close my eyes for a second to tune out the lights in front of me. I can't afford to have any distractions now. I have a big disadvantage of having no clue who my opponent is.

Blake says anxiously, if this person is not in the war room half hour back, then where the hell are they hiding him. He walks behind me, don't tell me that he will be brought from outside the barrier now. I replied, no. The barrier will remain unchanged until our match is over. We made an agreement with Citradel that we will not risk people's safety. The barrier will not be tampered for the next 3 hours. Blakes says, I know. Then where is this person. I walk towards the gap of the gate to peep. I could see few people on the ground running around with Kuretines in their hand. They were using it to even out the grounds. Some patches of land lay bare. The grass on those spots were uprooted when me and Blakes fought last week. They must be growing those grass back to make the field even again. Only 3 people were on the whole field. They are almost done.

I said, there's only one place where he or she is hiding out now. Blake says, where ? I said, isn't it obvious, in the crowd. I point my finger up. He shook his head, no. Not possible, all the people sitting out there have been vetted rigorously. Everyone's Id and Kuret have been logged to make sure no uninvited guest is here. And they are not allowed to interfere with this match. There is a protective barrier added. Marina doesn't want a repeat of last time, so she has added physical charms to the barrier. Whoever it is, they can't just force themselves on the field now. I have seen the charms casted by Marina. I don't care how strong this person is, they can't break it easily.

I move my eyes towards the crowd now. Oh, I think this person thinks it can be broken. There are 85,000 people gathered here. I bet Kafar somehow managed to hide this person in the crowd. Kafar has been blatantly vague in answering everyone's question. And he has a flare for being mysterious. So its not a stretch to think he will reveal his champion in a dramatic way. I take a breadth, he will most definitely will want to demonstrate this persons strength before the match starts. He wants to dominate this match by making me afraid. Blake replies to my theory, it sounds like something Kafar would do. But Marina's charms are not only strong, it heals on its own also. And at a fast rate. You may be able to break it easily with your black Kuret, and so could I, but I would waste a lot of Kuret in that process. Not a good strategy when there you have a match. If this person does it, they would be wasting a lot of Kuret for just trying to show off.

Or they have a lot of Kuret to use, I said. I have some theories on which the house bloodline this person might belong to. If its one of them, then I know ways to fight them. But something tells me its someone totally unexpected. I face back to Blake, its good that barrier is self healing. I think we are going to need it when this person drops into the field and creates a whole. This person, whoever it is, if they are willing to go along with Kafars theatrics, must also want to show that they will dominate the match. What best way to do that by showing something only I could do.

Blake ponders a while hearing me, yeah. It make senses. It's twisted and arrogant, but that's just right by Kafar's alley. All these months we have known him, still can't figure that guy. I said, you got that right. The only good thing is that no matter who wins this match, our both cities will finally merge. And others outside will join along with us. Blake pauses for a second, yeah. I hope so. But are you sure you are okay with loosing. Winning all the matches up until now, defeating me, Derek, Catherine and Jess. I doubt you would want to stop so close to being the strongest person on this planet.

I guffawed, this again. I told you. I am not interested in gaining any title like that. Blake says, you say that, but you could have then let yourself defeated in our match. I was about to interject, but he didn't let me, I am sure you could have given up without showing that and let everyone believe I won. I remained silent on his remark. Its true, there was a moment near the end where I thought it would be better to just give up. But couldn't do it. I replied, I don't know why I didn't do that. But its definitely not because I want to be the strongest. Blake shook his head, denials not a good look on dude. You need to own it. Blake prodded me with his eyes focused on me. I couldn't find a response to those piercing eyes. He continues, it takes more than just power to win. I should know better than anyone. If anyone other than you had defeated me, I would have not forgiven myself. I am glad that it was you. You should, no, need to win this match. Do you understand?

I felt his bruised ego hearing about his defeat. I told repeatedly that our match could have gone either way. Its easy to know that he doesn't want me to lose now. His expectations on me is causing me to feel such nervousness not felt since our war with Hive Commander. Do I really want to win this match so badly that I would let not let my pride go. I looked at Blake who was waiting for me, I won't deny that my actions have been quite contradictory to what I had initially planned. My plan was to just clear to a certain matches and clear out as much as many powerful Citradel warriors. It would have been actually efficient for me to give up our match and let you fight in this match. I sighed, I guess I am wrangled between my head and my emotions. No matter the outcome of the match, our cities will be joining now. I look at him, I am not saying that I won't fight seriously, but if I am at a big disadvantage, I might forfeit the match. He almost glared at me now, I continued, I am just managing expectations here. You know I don't fight battles going just with wits alone.

Blake looked like he was about to go on a rant, but he held back and then a moment later says, yeah. I can't argue now can I. I lost, you won. You get to decide what you want to do now. He showed a little understanding of my thoughts, and continues. But also you decided to continue our match to the bitter end. We both really went out you know, no punches pulled back, right? It looked like he was probing something from me. I ignored his intent though, I know. As I said, if decide to fight, you don't have to worry about me not begin serious. As frustrating it is, even if I know that its best to give up, I don't think I will be doing that when the moment comes.

He nods after hearing my reassuring words, and remember, you are a Shadow strategist. Never in the history of entire Shadows has a strategist even beaten an attacker. He makes a fist in his hand and punches me in the shoulder, I bet there is no one you cannot defeat with that big brain of yours. I smirk on his comment, Ah, you do know your position was meant to be strongest right? He pulls his hand, yeah well I guess the shadow council didn't realize your potential, otherwise my predecessor would have given you my title.

This made my smile disappear. I didn't want to recall the person who preceded Blake. Even after all the therapies, I still haven't gotten him out of my mind. I can't even get to talk with Vanessa about him. Even if wanted to I don't know where to begin. Blake caught my sullen expression, hey snap out of it. I looked at him. He continues, you have to eventually tell me why you refuse to talk about other Shadows. I don't want to push you much because whenever we talk about our past, you become distant and moody. But one of these days, you will have to tell me what is bothering you so much.

I didn't know what to say. I want to tell him, but I can't show him the other petty side. The part of me who still resents that person. I reply, I am working on that, believe me. Trust me, you will be the first person I tell when I am ready. I turn towards the gap from the gate. Lets pick this conversation up later. Those people have cleared out. Soon there's a big siren and all the people in the crowd became silent. I took a long breadth and said, its show time. Blake walks behind me and keeps him hand on my shoulder, finally. We get to see who this person is and why all the secrecy. What's so damn important that they couldn't have a fair match.

I almost lost my footing when I heard him, I turned to face him and shouted, wait, how do you know about that. Who told you about this. Blake was laughing, its fine, no one told me. During the last moment in our match, I saw you doing something weird. I wasn't conscious enough to understand what you were doing. I thought I was imagining it at the time, but later I recalled that you were truing to pull off one more trick. I wasn't even sure till now. Your reaction says I was right. He made a disapproving sound now, I can't believe after all we did in our battle, you still kept something hidden. I guess, you wanted to save it till now right?

I turn to the open field. Blakes words kept lingering in my mind, the strongest person on the planet. Do I even want this tittle. I never thought I would have the chance to be the strongest. Considering how I started in Medrine and on earth, this feels unreal. I clenched my teeth and made a fist from my hands. Can't let anything distract me. With these thoughts, I stepped outside into the field for the final time.

# Vanessa (Chapter 2)

Thursday, 27 January 2022 11:46 AM

I was sitting in the VIP room with everyone waiting for the big reveal. Among us only Kafar wasn't worrying about the match. He had a gleeful smile all the time he sat on his chair. I couldn't possibly understand why he was so content with the thought that this champion of Citradel is the strongest. Derek was also here, placed beside Kafar. He kept a much better composure than Kafar. He was watching the ground, checking the progress of the last minute clean up of the field.

In front of our room, there were eight screens put up against the wall. Each screen covering different angles of the field. Josh said it was essential that they record every moment of this fight. He claimed that no matter the victor, the whole battle recording will make people believe in our strength. Personally, I didn't understand why sending out the battle recording is necessary. It's a great risk if these recordings somehow reached the hands of HIVE or ECHO. It may even end up over the internet for Humans to see. Ned, however, thought it was a great idea. He told people can make up their own stories when recounting the battle to others. Its important that the real battle to be shown if we need others trust. He explained this many times to me, but I am still wary of this idea. We are basically depending on this Movie to persuade people all over the world to join us.

Ned shifted uneasily beside me and asks, how much longer Kafar? I think people are beginning to become restless. You need to tell who your secrete contestant is now. Ned was a little impatient, I couldn't blame him. Everyone here was eager to who this person was and why didn't they had to participate in the previous matches like we did. Kafar turns his head to Ned and says, he is not a contestant. He is the ultimate warrior. Ned moved his lips to scorn, clearly not amused by Kafar response.

Derek pitches in, just give it couple of more minutes. We are almost finished up fixing the ground. He faces Kafar, you can proceed to the podium. I will ask the guys to sound the siren when we are ready. We also need to tell him to get ready now. Everyone eyes caught Derek's attention. I knew it. He does knew who this person was. I said out loud, so it's a He. Who is it? Its almost time now. There is no point in hiding his identity now. Kafar clicks his mouth in defiance, you all have been waiting for a week, I think you can manage for a couple of few more minutes. He smiles as he stands up, all right Derek. I will prepare for the announcement. I don't think he needs to be told anything, he has been anticipating this fight since David and Blakes battle. I worry he might not be able to contain himself. I gave strict instructions not to show himself until the right time. He starts walking towards the back door. And remember, you cannot tell everyone who he is until I do. You understand? Kafar held the door open and was waiting for Derek's reply.

Derek let out a big sigh, yes. I understand. Leave now. Kafar took a moment as he glares at Derek and a moment later exits. Derek faces to the window glass overseeing the grass. Matt behind me says, what a douche. Man, isn't he doing a little overkill with this whole mystery guy. I don't see what's the big deal is. Marina who had been continuously casting a charm repeatably on the barrier stops for a moment, and what's this request of adding additional charms on top of this barrier. Its already fortified with 4 different properties of charm. I know David's Kuret cancels out others, but this barrier is specially made for him. It will reseal any holes David makes during the battle instantaneously.

Derek didn't respond immediately. In front of us, the royals were sitting. Nathan who has been silent all this time says, well ? I don't know how, but I still can't read your aura. You and Kafar have been very secretive. Maybe now you can tell us what this is all about. Derek faces all of us, Ah. Sorry. I want to tell you guys, but you heard Kafar right? He made it clear. I have my reasons why I can't go behind his back. He pauses to gather this words. He then looks over Marina, It's not David I am worried about breaking the barrier, Marina, it's the other guy. Believe me when I say this, if we don't have a strong enough barrier, he could break it during the battle. He could unintentionally harm the spectators. I don't want to risk it.

I took a moment before asking, if you can't tell who it is then can you at least tell if this person stronger than Blake or David ? Derek draws his eyes to me. He replied, if we talk in terms of Kuret, then Blake is the strongest. If we compare skills, then I say David is leagues above other two. He takes a short breath, but this particular persons enormous strength trumps others by a huge margin. I have seen it my from own eyes. I have never met another person that can match his strength.

I was a little shocked to hear this from Derek. I have came to realize Derek can easily be a Medrine commander after his battle with David. He may be even at a generals level. For him to say this makes me a worry a lot. Cassandra sitting beside Matt said, don't count out David yet. He has beaten people before who were thought they were stronger than him. She kept her eyes focusing on Nathans back. Nathan immediately turns to face her, ouch. That was a little rude. But I won't deny it. He has surprised me many times before. Jess besides Nathan agrees, yeah. And don't forget about what we all agreed to do. I am sure that David knows who he will be fighting by now.

Derek chortles a little hearing Jess, you mean your little convolution of spying on the Citradels side of the rooms? My eyes widen and I put my hands on the chair rest in uneasiness. Everyone grew anxious as soon as he said it. I can't believe that Derek already knew. Ned spoke first with a stern voice, what you are taking about Derek. He was trying to deny this. But Derek remained unconvinced. We will never do something so underhanded. Derek raises his palm in the air, don't worry. I have not told Kafar about it. Fortunately, I run the security of this coliseum and I kept it under wraps. He became a little serious, but what were you all thinking. If Blake was caught by someone else, Kafar would have leveraged it against you all. He turns to Catherine, if you all really wanted to do it without getting caught, why didn't you go instead?

Catherine has said much for the last couple of hours. Not just today, she has been a distant ever since her battle with David. I wanted to ask her if something is bothering her, but it felt personnel. Maybe she and Robb have a couples quarrel. But I didn't want to intrude so I kept to myself. She speaks, Ah. There has been some complications. I can't use my Kuret for longer than a minute. I, she took a long breadth before continuing, I think it's a side effect of my battle with David. I ask her, really ? But that match was weeks ago. Are you sure its not something else. Catherine vehemently shook her head, no. I am sure, Brain told me that it could take some more days for me to recover my Kuret. I just need some rest. That's all.

She is usually better at lying. But even I can tell she is speaking evasively. She did look tired. There were small dark circles under her eyes, has she not been sleeping much? There was clearly something going on she didn't want to talk about. Derek also wasn't satisfied with her answer but didn't ask her further, Okay, I hope you get well soon. We can't have an Omega commander on the sidelines if we run into another war. Catherine nods and mumbles, thanks. She quietly leans back to her chair. I wanted to ask her right away what's going on with her, but we already had enough drama going on here. Derek says, look, you guys need to be careful from now on around Kafar. Not just during this tournament, but also when our cities join. I know you guys run your city in your own way, but he has been running Citradel over a decade in secrete. He will do absolutely anything, and I mean anything to keep people safe. Be very careful next time. If you are going to do something, do it in a way he doesn't find out.

Derek warning about Kafar shows he is very serious. I could hear it in his voice. Marina spoke, yeah. Derek's right. I have known him almost as long as Derek has. He may be a little extreme, but he has done that to keep us safe. You guys shouldn't have done something behind his back. I said to her, you are just annoyed that we didn't tell you what we were planning, right. She shouts, you damn right. When Derek just asked for a single Kuritine to hide his presence, I didn't thought it was for this. Brain asks, that's on you know. What do you think he would use something to hide especially today?. Marina was a little frustrated, well I, I thought it was for..she stopped and then shook her head, forget that. You guys should have told me what you guys were planning, I would have prepared a better Kuretine, I have a bunch of charms to hide someone. Derek stops her, I told you Marina. As long as Kafar is here, we need to make sure you and I don't get caught doing something he thinks is a betrayal.

Tess spoke, hold on, if you already know that Blake went to spy on your people, so does that mean Blake found him? Derek says, no. By the time Blake made it the other side, he was already moved away from our side of the coliseum. You guys just have bad luck. I thought you might do something like this and so I told Kafar beforehand. He told me he would take care of it. I said, wait then where is he? Derek shook his head, no clue. Derek looks over the field. A moment later he pulls out his radio device and says, okay Grover. The field is now ready, sound the siren now. The person on the other end replies, you sure. David is at his gate, but we still haven't found our champion. Derek says, that's fine. Go ahead. Kafar orders. There was a long pause and then the voice replied, Ah okay boss.

A moment later a loud siren filled the air around us. 10 seconds later the siren slowed and so did the noise from the crowd. Everyone gathered here stood up from their seat. Everyone is looking on their right gate, anticipating who will emerge. Derek says, Marina I think its enough. You can stop now. Marina makes one last movement of her hands and pulls away. She let a big sigh, fhew, I think this is my strongest charm I have casted ever. It may be even stronger than one we have in both the cities. And with so many caster near the field borders, it is robust enough that even an army of tanks can't break it. Derek says, that's great. Thanks for doing this. He scoffs a little, you don't know how close you are with tanks as an analogy. He raises his hand and pours out Kuret on it. I thought he was about to do something but he kept staring at it and deeply in thought.

I ask him, you have fought him before. Derek puts out the Kuret in his hand and looks to me. He says, Yes. Only once. But it was enough to know the monstrous gap in our strength. Matt asks, really. He is that much powerful above you?. Derek nods, oh yes. No disrespect to you guys, but he can defeat all of us on one on one. No matter how much Kuret you can control or how skilled you are, there is no defense against his attacks. This might be the worst compatibility for David as an opponent. David's biggest weakness is his stamina. On the other hand. He stops himself. He pauses and says, I guess you will all find out in a minute.

Nathan asks, he must have left quite the impression on you from just one fight. Derek had a somber voice as he replied, yeah. Do you how long our fight lasted? Everyone faces to him at him in eagerness. He left a loud noise as he breathes heavily. Our fight was over in 2 minutes. I said, what. You are joking right. I found my jaw hanging a little open. He kept his same expression, I am not exaggerating it. Before even I could think of a way to beat him, he was all over me in an instant. He raised his palm and points two fingers, 2 punches. That's all it took to knock me out cold. And trust me, I went all in with my Kuret from the start unlike my battles here. But none of it mattered, I woke up an hour later with 5 broken ribs and a concussion to my head. I never asked for a rematch because I realized it won't matter. He could have even killed me if he went beyond kept attacking.

Everyone were silent hearing this. Derek decided to talk about him now, he could have told this long time back. David would have benefited from knowing this. Kafar must have something on him. He is letting us know so much about him just before the match. I kept hoping David would find some way to beat this guy. But someone who could beat Derek so easily, can David hold his ground. David struggled against Derek at the beginning. Although that's because David was wary of Derek and hiding his trump card till the end. But will it work against this person. I hear a door opening and jarring me out from my thoughts. It was Blake who entered in.

He looked at all our expressions and then said, why do I feel a wired vibe here. Derek raises his finger to him, you should know I already know you tried to spy to find who Citradels champion is. Blake was taken aback, say what. I would never do that. He tries to smile his way out of this. I said, he already knows Blake. He guessed we would do something like this and Kafar moved him somewhere else.

Blake was surprised, really. Blake and Derek had a staring contest for a while. Blake then says, okay. Then you guys already know that this was a bust. He then chuckles a little, well since we are all in mood of telling secretes, I told David about what we planned just now. And guess what, turns out David already had a plan of his own. He went over the Citradels rooms to find his person just 30 minutes ago on his own. I was the least surprised to hear this than others. I smiled in my mind. That's so like David. I knew it, David also didn't want to fight without knowing who it was. Matt snickers and mumbles, classic. Derek shouts, what. Seriously. He pushed his hand in his pocket and pulled out his tablet. He was furiously tapping and scrolling on it. Wait, he says, I don't see any alarm tripped or anything in the censor. There nothing unusual in the cameras we installed. How in the world did he moved in and out without no one noticing?

Blake shrugs his shoulders, no idea. I didn't ask. We were more worried about where our other finalist would be now. David thinks his person will be making a bold statement of power and blast his way through the barrier from somewhere in the crowd. I say, what. That's crazy. David really thinks someone will jump out of the crowd ?. Derek lets out a small shriek, damn it. Why didn't I thought about it too. He turns towards the whispering people, he has done something like this before. He wanted to show his crazy strength in a manner that will woo all the Medrines here and instill fear to his opponent at the same time. He turns to Marina, I hope your barrier holds strong.

Marina who usually is outspoken kept mumbling to herself. Blake says, sounds like you know the person. Derek says, yes. I know him, I fought him once and he beat me in an instant. Blake was surprised, for real. That's not good. David did say you might have much him battled him before. Blake looks over to the ground. Everyone follow his suit and we see David walking out to the middle of the ground. The crowd went berserk and starting calling out his name in excitement. The other gate was already opened, but no one came out.

Blake starts walking slowly from behind us and stands next to Derek, tell me honestly. Can David win? Derek didn't move is gaze away from the middle of the field where David stands, if there is a chance of beating this guy, then David's the only one who could figure out. Everyone had a silent agreement amongst ourselves. Soon we heard a voice over the speakers. It was Kafar.

Welcome everyone to the final match of this tournament. I am Kafar, the council leader of Citradel. The crowd grew silent as he started talking. I turn towards the middle screen over the wall. He was standing on the podium specially requested by him to be made for this match. Kafar had done a wardrobe change and was now wearing something ceremonial. It was a radiant gown of gold color and lines of threads beaded with shining stones. Likely a Kuritine. He continues as he speaks over his microphone attached to his neck as he steps forward, I am very grateful to have been given this opportunity to host this match. I have been witnessing all the matches and I am beyond impressed with the so many talented people participating from both the cities. The number of Kurets we have seen over this month is the most ever since we arrived on Earth. Please give a big round of applause to all those contestants who worked hard and gave their best. He paused as the coliseum was filled with claps and cries of excitement.

Kafar raises his hands in air, the crowd settles down. Now, you all have seen so many people showing their strength. I believe that once our cities merge, with such powerful individuals, we will be on a path to gain what we lost all those years back on Medrine. There was a roar of approval from the crowd. We will not be anymore cowering from HIVE or the Humans anymore. We will have a society that can finally stand and fight back our oppressors. His comment made another roar of cheers from the crowd. He takes a second, then says, Now. I don't want to delay any longer. I know people have been waiting for this match for a long time. I want you all to remember, that no matter who the victory goes to today, we all are one people and this match will show that we have people that can keep you safe in our city. The crowd gives another round of cheers.

Blake says ahead me, wow. He already thinks that we will be moving to Citradel. Look at that confidence. Matt says, dude. That’s overconfidence. I say, maybe. All I can tell is that I haven't seen David this worried before, I said looking over the left screen which showed David in the middle. He was standing and looking up to Kafar. His body posture remained confident, but we could see he had some doubt in his face. Cassandra says, well that’s to be expected. David always had a plan before he enters a battle. Derek says, This will be a tough fight for him.

Kafar then waves his hand towards the middle of the field, and without wasting more time. Let me introduce to our champions. First champion, you all already know him. The champion of the new Medrine city and the one who defeated the Hive leader, David. The crowed lets out a huge cry of excitement in response. They have seen him before in the stadium, but I guess being introduced by someone has more effect. David pulls out a smile on his face and waves around to the people. Kafar continues, like many I found the last match exhilarating. So many twists and turns. Both Blake and David are tremendous Medrines. Both have Kurets that defies our natural understanding. Perhaps the most unexpected result was that someone from a royal bloodline and a mythical true alpha was defeated by someone who remained in the dark until few years back.

Blake smirks, that guy really knows how to add salt to my wounds. He could have skipped this. Catherine broke silence after a while, ignore him Blake. He is just trying to add more flare. Nathan says, this ways he is setting a much more flare when David looses. Their champion would then be considered unrivaled. He chuckles on that thought. Blakes says, although what he is saying is the truth. In the end, David won. I could hear a frustration in his voice. It’s the same when I lost to Marina. I really wanted to fight David in the stadium. I guess it was never meant to be.

Kafar says, but that’s just the nature of how these battles work. There can only be one victor. And today will not be any different. Its safe to say that whoever wins today will be considered the strongest among all Medrines. The crowed went wild hearing this. This is what all of them have been waiting for. Kafar continues, and now its time to reveal our champion. He pauses until the crowd becomes silent. Everyone here become still and quite. We could only hear faint noises of our breathing as we starred at the screen.

He says, I know you all have questions why we didn't have him participate in the match like how others did. Well, there is good reason for that. You see our champion comes from a bloodline that is so ancient that many believe they are a myth. In fact at one point in our Medrine history, they were worshiped as deities. But during the destruction of our planet, they were forced to come out of hiding to save others and themselves. Every member of this house is very strong. But alas, with such great strength comes with a bigger weakness. You see, they can't use Kuret for a certain period of time. During this Kuret blackout, they are very weak. They need a lot of rest and time to recover. Their bodies goes through alternating cycles like sun and moon over weeks. That’s why our champion couldn't join the matches until today, he couldn't use his Kuret till today.

At this revelation the people starting to whispers. I said out loud, an ancient house? I don't know any bloodline that has goes through a Kuret blackout. I looked over others, they were just as clueless as me. Kafar says, I couldn't let him reveal himself to others because there was risk. Kafar sighs a little, although he is our important guardian who has kept Citradel safe for years, he doesn't want any help from me and refuses to have bodyguards. So we made a deal that he would remain hidden until his Kuret returns. Kafar then raises his fist over his head, but do not make the mistake of thinking that this makes him weak. Once he recovers, our believed champion is undefeatable. Not even the Hive leader could defeat him. His overwhelming strength has kept Hives out of our city for years. The Hives even gave a nickname to him, hivanukes, which means killer of hives in their language.

I immediately stirred up when I heard the name. I turned to Blake, Tessa and Nathan. Didn't that Hive leader say this name when we fought him last year. Blakes ponders on this a while and says, yeah. I remember. When we had him in our trap, he kept spouting nonsense things. I never imagined hivanukes was this guys nickname. Tessa says, this explains why he didn't help us that time. He couldn't use his Kuret. Isn't that right Derek. Derek nods, yeah. When were fighting that day, his was still in recovery. It takes him months to recover once he uses his Kuret. He was frustrated that he couldn't help us that day. Nathan cries, did you just say months. Oh man, that is one hell of a drawback of such power. Derek says, yeah. That’s why even the people of Citradel don't know who he is. Almost all the time, he is a fragile guy. But when his Kuret recovers, he is a monster.

I had been praying silently for David's win all this time. I have now serious doubts. When a Kuret has a big weakness, the trade off is that much bigger. Kafar continues, please welcome our champion now. I become still as I listened to him, the protector of Citradel, Charles of the house Heraknus.

# David (Chapter 3)

Thursday, 27 January 2022 5:18 PM

As soon as I heard the name of the house my legs felt like giving up. My mind automatically tuned out the noise from the crowd. I couldn't think for a moment, my whole mind went blank for few seconds. The name of that house gave me chills that ran from the back of my head to by legs. My brain went deep to recall I conversation I had with Zakerine on Medrine when we were working on our secrete book. We ran so many hypotheticals and how we would fight them. We covered so many different houses, listing their weakness and strengths. One time we would talked about houses who we didn't think were real.

Hey, how about Heraknus people, how do we fight them, I recall asking her. She looked at me funny and said, we are not fighting a imaginary bloodline you idiot. I replied, hey, what if they are real. We need to have some contingency if one day we have to fight them. Zakerine thought I had lost my mind, seriously? I nodded my head with seriousness. She laughs, okay our shadow strategist. What do you think we should do when we have to fight someone. I was thinking hard, well if I have believe the legends about Heraknus house, there is some rumors that they are the ones that eradicated the giant Kuret monsters that reeked havoc some centuries back. Those Kuret monsters were some science experiments gone wrong and no one could stop them. So Heraknus house took the responsibilities of killing them.

She says, really. Do tell me where you found this piece of information. I was a little hesitant to say, I heard it from her. She laughs more loudly now, haha, so you now believe that crackpot. Listen to me David, trust me when I say she is crazy. I reply to her, but she is one of us. She replies, exactly. You haven't spent much time with her as I have. She has a very morbid way of looking at life. She pushes her lips together, So she now believes in Heraknus. Then she shook her head, doesn't matter. Look don't you think that if they ever existed we would have known by now. We are the most secrete organization in the world, if there was evidence of their existence, we would have known.

I kept pondering for some time, you know what. I don't think they are imaginary. The way she told me, described them, its almost as if she has met one. Zakerine says, yeah well, she must be very good in telling stories, enough to have convinced others to allow such a creepy person in Shadow. She leans towards me, if you are serious about writing this house down, then we would have to make a new category for this. I was relieved that she finally agreed. I ask, so what should we put them under, mythical ? She looked like she was thinking one very intently, then she says, how about get the hell away when you meet one. She starts laughing. I let out a sigh. Its enough for today, we are not going anywhere. I close the book and throw it towards her. She catches it immediately, hey don't be so mad. I am serious, we don't have a clue what they can do if they are real. The only thing I know is that they are were though to be powerful than alphas. But besides that, we don't know what their Kurets do, what shapes it takes or what effect they have. We should better focus on houses we do know about. Thinking about a house we don't know anything is just waste of time.

So you really think we should run away if we meet one. She nods, yes. You know better than anyone, there's nothing more dangerous than an enemy we know nothing about. She had a point. If I ever meet one, I should just run away and get backup. Why waste time on something we don't think is real. She keeps the book on the table beside our bed. She says, now. Will we keep discussing about some imaginary stuff or do something real. She brings a big smile. I laughed, what do you have in mind ? She leans forwards, well we could visit the place you said we would go. I start to lean forward as well, nah, it will take time. How about we do something that is much closer. We both were close enough to hear our heartbeats. She snickers, yeah, I was just thinking the same. I closed my eyes and leaned in forward to bring my lips on her.

Before I get sucked further into my memory, I dragged myself out. I can't let her divert my focus anymore. Not when the house she scoffed as imaginary is what I will be fighting now. The moment Kafar said his name, there was a muffled explosion. I immediately looked to my right. A small part of the stadium was covered in white smoke. My first thought was that it was an attack, but I saw only glimmer of white strands. There is no fire, just smoke. A camouflage for their champion. Really, they are pulling out all the stops to make this match like a movie. I began to move towards that smoke, there was a huge silhouette figure under that cloud of smoke. The smoke then flew inwards towards the field, crashing to the barrier. There was a large thumb sound, like something heavy hit a wall, then there was another sound that rocked the whole barrier. Finally, on the third sound the barrier gave up and there was a crash sound like a big thick glass shattered into pieces. The smoke and its occupant crossed the barrier and was about to land on the field in front of me. The hole left on the barrier already started to reseal.

I was too stunned to move. My guess was right that this champion would do something like this. Honestly, I hoped that I would see the glimmers of Charles Kuret. But nothing, I see only the white strands of smoke flowing. I was shocked to see that he broke the barrier without his Kuret. He punched it only 3 times. That is an insane amount of power. The second he landed the ground beneath my feet shook a little. I unconsciously, took a step back. My instincts was going wild, perhaps telling me to run away. The smoke starts to clear out. At the same time, it starts to move towards me. I could still see the figure inside, but somehow it was becoming smaller in size as it approached to me.

Everyone in the crowd were silent, waiting to see his him properly. I took a heavy gulp as I took another step back to the middle of the field. Then a voice came from the smoke, greetings friend. You have no idea how long I have been waiting to meet you. The last of the smoke clears. What left remaining is a man who looks like he is in his forties. He was about 6 feet tall and had few scars on his right side of his face. He had silver hair and cut short to give a military look. He was grinning like a child given candy, he was probably excited to be out in the open after all this time. He was wearing something weird. It was too baggy for his size. He had simple black trousers and jacket on top. If he was wearing a correct size one, it would like he was out for jogging in his sports clothes. He says, sorry for the theatrics, but I couldn't break my promise to Kafar to give an entrance that will surprise everyone.

Well, mission accomplished I said in my mind. He then raises his fist in the air, hello everyone. He shouts so loud that I am sure the whole stadium can hear him. I am Charles of house Heraknus. After his declaration there was silence in the crowd. It could have been due to utter shock or confusion. A second later there are whispers everywhere. We are meeting someone who is considered to be a legend, not real. Kafar continues, I understand the confusion. But let me assure you all, the house of Heraknus is not a myth. They are very real. They have hid themselves for centuries in Medrine. And were forced out in the open when Hive attached Medrine. They were invaluable during the rescue of people from cities. I was shocked to hear this. Somewhere back in my mind I was also trying to figure out a plan. But none came to me. I have no clue what Heraknus can do. Only thing I know for certain is that they are ridiculously strong.

Kafar continues, they have been with Citradel all this time on Earth. But as I have already told you, their Kuret is not consistent. So we made sure they remained well protected until it was safe to reveal their existence. Citradel gave them sanctuary and in return Heraknus Medrines have been protecting our cities by being part of our main and a secrete troop. I looked over to Charles, he has been smiling and gazing all around to the people in the crowd. Kafar says, when the news of Hive leaders death reached Citradel, we realized that the Hive forces have been trimmed down and finally Heraknus had an opportunity to finally come out of shadows of Medrine history. The house of Heraknus have been patiently waiting for everyone to know about them. And the opportunity came in the form of a tournament. However, the timings didn't align to Charles Kuret return and so we had to arranged for him to fight directly with the winner of the regular matches. I apologies to everyone here, but I had to do this to protect Charles and his house.

At his last statement a cold sweat ran through my neck. I cleared my throat before approaching the myth standing in front of me, Ah excuse me. Charles suddenly became excited to hear me and walked towards me. Kafar also stopped his speech when he heard me call out to Charles. Charles walked closer to me and raised his hand to me, please, call me Charles. As I look at this hand, I thought about how we never had any formal introduction in the matches till now, so I was little hesitant to take his hand, if he is really powerful he could crush my hand like a toothpick. He didn't seem to have any sinister intentions. And Kafar is still at the podium, he has more to speak. So the match hasn't started yet. I didn't want to take any chances, so I pulled a small amount of Kuret on my right hand. It was thin enough to be invisible to the eye.

I shook his hand with a little uneasiness, Ah, okay Charles. As soon as we shook hands, he said, wow, so this is what your famous Kuret can do huh. Impossible. I poured very less amount of Kuret in my hand, no one should have been able to detect it. I immediately pulled away my hand way from him. I didn't want to come across as rude, but I have know no clue what he might do. He just laughs, don't worry kid. I don't believe in deception. I prefer to strike my enemy looking in the eye. I just thought I know you a little before we start our match.

He showed me a smile that had no malice or trick. He was just wanting to meet. I felt a little relieved, Ah. Sorry. I am a little nervous. I don't usually meet some myths everyday. Much alone fight one, I thought. He replies, don't sweat it kid. As you can see we not myths. He waves his arms gesturing his body, we are just a well hidden house who have remained a secrete over centuries.

I was completely enthralled as he recounted his story. I never imagined Kafar had managed to kept Heraknus a secrete all this time. I brought myself to speak a second later, Kafar said you have battled the Hive leader. Is that true? This brought his smile back, Yes. I fought him three times. I am surprised he never mentioned me all the times you battled him. I guess he didn't want others to how I close he came to death. He managed to wriggle his way out from our grasp every time. When I heard from Derek last year about your plan to take him down. I wanted to be there, but my Kuret was not yet recovered. I sent the rest of my house members to your aid, but by the time they reached, the war was already over. I was surprised to know you killed him. A feat that I never accomplished. He then looks over to the VIP room and says, I am very grateful that you all defeated him. Earth is better off without him. Hive are in a state of chaos, they don't have a leader to mobilize. And from this state of confusion we have been able to eradicate a lot of Hives headquarters.

The people now didn't just whisper, they were talking amongst themselves. They were finally able to raise their voices after such a shocking revelation of Heraknus. Charles faces back to me, I have been wanting to meet you for a long time. And not just you, Derek has told me great things about the true alpha Blake, the omegas Catherine, Vanessa, Jess and Nathan, they are all powerful. I wish I could have fought them before. But my stupid body hadn't recovered yet.

I can only imagine what others might be feeling up there in the room after being praised by a legendary person. I ask, speaking of Derek. I guess he is not the strongest person in whole Citradel right? That was another lie right? I mean, if I believe the stories I have about you guys, every member of Heraknus house is as strong as an alpha. He laughs at my question, I am humbled that you think we are so great. But the truth is that Derek is indeed the strongest person from Citradel. As I said earlier, my house members have erratic control over Kuret on Earth. I am sure Derek could have win against me if he gets more powerful. He is already skilled enough that he didn’t go down the first punch with my full power. The only other person I had to fight seriously other than the Hive leader. As expected of the son of the great savior of Medrine.

My throat went dry. Did he just imply that he had to punch Derek one more than others to defeat him. Derek, the same guy who gave me trouble. And I am to fight him? This is crazy. There was a silence between the two of us. There was so much tension in the air around me, I began to see my own yellow glimmer from my body. Fear. Kafar took the moment to continue his speech, there you have it people. Our two champions have finally met each other and exchanged their greetings. Huh, what is he taking about, I thought. There was no greet. I am trying best to hide my fear. I know I should be glad that we have such a powerful house to fight against Hive and Echo. But first I have to somehow get through this match. The crowd suddenly cheered in ecstasy. They must have finally came to the realization that they will see something hidden for over a decade on Earth and centuries on Medrine.

Kafar says, I know people still have many questions for us and Charles, but for now keep them aside and pay attention to their fight. Charles has been dying to show us the most glorious fight for some time now. A lot of people started to jump from their seat unable to control their excitement. I was almost envious of the people sitting there. They get to watch safely from a distance, while I have to fight. I shook my head trying get my head straight. Enough with the distracting thoughts, I knew the other person would be someone stronger. I was hoping that it was a house which I know about. Heraknus bloodline never occurred to me as a possibility. That means I have to improvise as we battle and learn about his fighting style.

Charles walks back to the other end of the circle drawn in the middle of the field, hey kid. Don't let the myth about our house get to you. He spoke as he starts walking, do not let yourself be concerned about our house being different than others. Remember this while we fight. I don't want you to worry about anything else. Just keep your attention on me. Its like he felt my worries. And giving advice to your opponent, he sounds like a wise person. He doesn't have any ulterior motive other than just to fight me. Charles reached his spot and looked up to Kafar. He then raises his fist to him and gives him a thumbs up. Kafar says, okay. Charles has told he is ready. Best of luck to both the champions. I hope the powers you two will show reaches to all the people here. He waves to the crowd and then walks back getting down from the podium.

Me and Charles where intensely staring each other. It was like we were waiting for a signal to start. A sign which was never going to come. Charles now donned a serious face. He has now fully composed himself for a serious battle. I on the other hand am just trying to keep it together. Formulating a plan of attack. I know his punches packs a great deal, so avoiding that them be my primary concern. There were other things popping up in my mind, like what was that huge shadow I saw when he entered. And how is he hiding his Kuret. I can only glimmers coming out his flesh and bones, no hint of any Kuret hidden beneath. But I had a question that was much more pressing.

I think Charles picked on that. I can see you are dying to ask me a question. If that's what is stopping you, then I will gladly answer. He must have incredible six sense to figure it out. I replied, sorry. Its just you have been taking about your house like someone who is a leader. I paused thinking he might correct me. But he didn't. I began to worry as I continue, and you said that your house is not different than others. So does that mean that there is an alpha in the house of Heraknus and, I swallow hard, that alpha is you?

Charles broke his expression to give a small smirk, you think that house of Heraknus would just let anyone fight you. No. I have seen your matches. You have a strange power, yet you have brought down many powerful foes with that power. It would not be justice if the person to fight you is not the strongest in the house. He closes his eyes and opens it a second later. His Kuret tattoos over his necks start to shine. Shit. His eyes start to brighten with a brown Kuret, you guessed right. I am indeed an alpha of house Heraknus. And I, will be you challenging you as the leader of my house. So lets have some fun.

My freaking bad luck. I not only have to fight a bloodline we know nothing about, it had to be their boss.

# Vanessa (Chapter 4)

Thursday, 27 January 2022 10:59 PM

Something incredible is going on. I was completely in shock when Kafar announced who their champion was. What's more is that David has to fight the alpha of Heraknus. We were all standing in awe watching the screen on the right as Charles shows his brown Kuret. It was a dense Kuret, meaning he intends to fight David with his full power from the start. His Kuret then starts to warp around his torso. The more he pulled out his Kuret the more his Kuret started to wrap around him completely. He is doing something. I looked over David on the other screen. He now kept both his hands in a defensive form in front of his face. I could tell he is nervous and a little frightened. But I know he must be strategizing already.

Marina said, holy shit. My Barrier. She had a hand on her mouth, I added so many layers. One person should have not been able to break it. Even David would find it difficult to go through with his Kuret. All it took was 3 hits by him to break through. She looked over to Derek with an astonished expression, he was living in Citradel with us? Impossible. I have used a scouring spell many, how did it not pick his Kuret? Derek replies, your charms would only pick people who had access to Kuret. Heraknus people would usually stay in Citradel when they are going through their blackout. When they have access, Charles mobilizes his people outside the city. There are two reasons for that. Kafar had promised to keep them hidden even from people living inside. And if Hive found us and any Heraknus has to fight, they can't fight in a crowded city. He pauses a little and says, they are messy when it comes to fighting.

Nathan was the first to speak, what in the world. Derek, you are one hell of a secrete keeper. I can't believe this is the champion that Citradel has been hiding for so many years. He gives a little nervous laugh, I am almost glad that its David and not me down there who is fighting. I was taken back from his comment, is this the same Nathan who does not fear anyone else. Nathan smirks, well if I also have to fear someone, don't I? Vanessa, we know house Heraknus was always real. We have stories about them in books about them in the royal family. There are no other evidence, these stories are the only source left.

Blake cuts in, yeah. He is right, but we were also told they died out. No one has seen them in centuries. It was easy to rule them as dead. Tessa says, I can't believe I am watching a living Heraknus alpha. That would mean that there are others also alive. She gazes over others, do you know what that means ? I said, it means we have now the single most powerful house ever with us. She nodded, yeah. I heard stories that if a group of them ever got together to fight, they can reshape the landscapes. I am not even joking, out of all the Medrine houses, they are clearly the strongest.

Derek says, they were once but now. He ponders over a somnolent voice, you guys heard what Kafar talked about Heraknus right? I know few of them. On a good day, they can manage to use their Kurets consistently for a scant few minutes. But it can just comes and goes on a whim. That’s dangerous in a battle. If even for couple of seconds their form reverts, they are vulnerable. They have been trying to adapt to their new limitations. And those who have somehow able to maintain it for long time, once their Kuret runs out, they have to wait for weeks to recover. Imagine how frustrating it is that they are once considered to be the strongest Medrines and now Earth has stripped their power considerably.

Blake hesitantly asks, then Charles is also not as powerful as before right? Then maybe David has a chance of winning. Derek didn't responds immediately. Charles, he is different. He is an alpha. While I don't know how powerful he was at Medrine, he claims that his strength hasn't deterred, only the amount of time to recover has gone up. I ask Derek, how much time does he needs to recover? Derek responds, he told me that back on Medrine it would take about a month equivalent of Earth time. But here, he now needs about 6 months. Holy crap. I can't believe that his body was so much effected by Earths atmosphere. Cassandra asks, then how long can he fight without losing his Kuret interrupting ? If even if its for a second, David might use that window to beat him.

Derek shook his head, well I can't say its not a possibility but Charles can use his Kuret constantly for more than few hours. His alpha powers gives him an incredible stamina and endurance. The more this battle is stretched out, the more his odds of winning will increase. I remembered what Derek was taking about earlier, you said that Davis one weakness is his stamina and makes this the worst match up. He nods. Blake agrees, I agree David doesn't have the stamina as we do. But his Kuret tips the odds to him too. If David keeps hitting him with his black Kuret, Charles will start to loose more and more Kuret. He might have stamina, but no one has been able to defend against David's Kuret.

I think it might not be completely one sided battle, yeah that’s right. David can still win. Everyone was waiting for Derek to say something. But he kept silent and watched as Charles was now covered completely from head to toe with his Kuret. Derek finally answers, I honestly don't know what will happen in the battle. I don't want to pick sides here, I have great respect for Charles. I also want David to win. However, the odds doesn't look good. It would have been different story if any of you guys were fighting Charles. Physical attacks are key for victory against. David has only one Kuret attack that will allow him to attack materialistically. But he can pull that off couple of times. And I don't think that would be enough to defeat Charles.

He turns towards us and sits back on his chair, well now its up to David to figure out a way to survive and defeat him. As for Charles, he might take the battle initially a little slow. He fights simple but he is not stupid. He will keep his some distance from David at first to judge how his Kuret will react to him. David's Kuret is unlike ever seen, he will be cautious in the beginning. He then looks over us, you all should also take a seat. This battle will not be over like mine. At least I hope so.

He was right, we shouldn't lose our hope just yet. Everyone went back to their seat. My eyes were glued to the screen where Charles Kuret was now slowly taking the shape of his body. Its been almost a minute since he started to wrap his Kuret around him. Is this a delaying tactics, Derek what is Charles doing. Its been a minute. Does it take this much long every time he uses his Kuret. Derek says no, its very quick, but the time to transform becomes tougher next turn and takes more time due to that. He already transformed once when he broke the barrier, so its taking a little longer this time.

Catherine asked, there's the word transform again. What do you mean he will transform, is it similar to how I do it? Derek thinks for a moment, not entirely. You can shapeshift into any person or an extension of it. Heraknus, they can't turn into anyone. Their forms are determined at birth. Jess says, I don't understand. What will he transform into then. Blake says, hold on. Then what I was told in the stories wasn't an exaggeration? They really turn into massive beasts.

His words made everyone gasps a little. Matt says, don't be ridiculous, they don't turn really into beasts, right Derek. Matt small laugh broke into shock when Derek was a little wary of replying, you will soon get to see his form, he said in the end. Everyone was kept their thoughts for a little longer as we watched Charles brown Kuret take shape of something tall and humanoid. The door behind us opened. A voice came, oh I am just in time. So glad I didn't miss it. It was Kafar. He was in the same clothes he wore when he was giving his speech. He walked to us and took his place beside Marina and Derek, so what do you all think about Charles. I hope Derek didn't tell you guys after I left.

Marina says, no he didn't tell us. I understand why you wanted to keep it a secrete from everyone until today. But why did you ask him to keep it a secrete from us just when you were going to tell everyone anyway in a minute. Kafar brings up a smile, oh that was for just fun. I could only imagine your faces when I was the one who told you all. Derek doesn't have a flare for drama, he would have left something important out. Derek faces him, and what would that be? He replied its emotion boy. I created a build up that made his reveal even more astounding.

I looked at David. He now has wrapped a little bit of his Kuret from the elbows up to this fist in order to cancel out some of the Charles Kuret reaching to him. He didn't use much Kuret like he usually does, and I understand why. Charles was barely letting his Kuret run rampant like ours do. He was somehow keeping it close to his body. His Kuret control is unbelievable. Nor Marina or Blake have such fine control over our Kuret. I have never seen such a massive swirl of dense Kuret from a single Medrine.

Soon Charles form start to grow. Its happening now. I see the brown Kuret dwindling into thinner threads and falling into Charles new form. I gulped as I ask, how big will he become ?. Derek turned his head to me and was about to answer me, but Kafar beat him to it, oh its not done yet. I say he has a few more inches left. Seriously, I replied. He really turns to a beast then. Derek continues, the actual height is actually never a constant. Their form remains the same but If they have more control over their Kuret, a Heraknus can grow bigger. Alphas naturally have more control, so Charles is visibly bigger than others. He has been waiting for this day for quite some time. I think we are about to witness his biggest form yet.

Kafar pats his hand on Derek, well said my boy. Now that I think about it, he did say he had been preparing from yesterday night. So who knows how big he might become. Charles form become less humanoid now. He had longer and broader legs which were more bent towards the knees. His waist become wider along with his torso. His chest had the most growth and was buffed to point that a grown person could fit into it. His arms now reached his knees, each having muscles shaped like a chucks of big rocks aligned from his shoulders to his wrists. Behind me Matt cries out, holy shit. Is that a tail growing behind?

I turned towards a different monitor which showed a different angle. The brown Kuret was still swirling around his body and he skin was still hidden. And there it was, clearly visible a tail protruding out behind his back. My god, what is he turning into. Blake leaned towards the monitor and said, hold on to something folks, I think its not just a tail, its tails. His words became reality when the tail we were watching split into two. A moment later, those two tails splits further and now he has four tails. I hold Ned's hand more tightly as I saw the tails grow longer than his actual body. This is insane, he already has an unbelievable control over Kuret, now his body is becoming beast like.

The first feature we get to see of Charles complete form are his legs. His feet has big feet, he was covered in brown fur, there was also big round muscles around his calves and thighs. As I look closer I realize there were some shinny things attached all over his muscles and mixed in those furs. Kuretines. I gasp at that thought. His body has condensed so much Kuret formed into solid forms and attached to his skin. Slowly the upper body also started to show. The over sized pants he was wearing made sense now. The pants had become very small shorts, just enough to cover his upper thighs. It looked like someone would wear in a marathon. I couldn't tell where his waist started in all those muscles and fur, but his torso was visible. He has fur covered most of it, but I could see perfect abs formed up there. Blake let out a whistle, dude. That man is ripped.

Behind Charles, his tails were less covered in fur. They were much neater than rest of his body. There was sharp edge at the end of his tail. Shit, each tail had grown a Kuritine and was shaped like a spere. I don't know if Charles was doing it unconsciously or not, his tails were not at all still. They kept moving and wagging in different directions. Even with four tails, they moved with such synchronization that they didn't entangle themselves. His upper back looked like mountain slope with boulders of muscles in shape of rocks stacked on top of each other. He arms are long and big. They look very similar to his legs. This biceps was bulging out like someone attached it from outside. His arm were also covered with Kuretines. His hands, no I couldn’t them hands anymore. They were more like claws. He had no nails, which he didn't need because his fingers were covered in Kuritine. Those fingers looked like it could tear up metal.

Finally we get to see his form above neck. His neck was relatively shorter to his body proportion and his neck muscles were large, but all that didn't matter once his face was revealed. His entire head was covered in pieces of Kuretines. His ears were pointed and I could swear the tips were shining with Kuritine. His nose was big and we could see his nostrils, but they were also covered with stones. He opened his eyes, that the only part of this body that resembled human. His eyes remained the same, they must have grown to his head size, but they retained his iris features. His mouth was shaped like a like a wolfs, his jaws was more square shaped and protruding. I have no doubt that those teethes shown whenever he breathes out are also having Kuretines. The top of his head was more flat than a persons and he had less fur there. He had no extra hair on the back of this head.

Looking at this complete form, he was easily 10 feet tall. He was so massive and tall that would make any warrior afraid of him. Marina cries out, what the hell did he transform into. He is like some cross between a large Gorilla and a Lion. Marina paints quite the picture. Charles is looking like a true beast. Kafar argues, don't match his features to animals, girl. His form is what he was born with. He has no control over it. He chastised to her. He continues, their form are mostly reflected where they were born. Instead of animals, the terrains plays a lot more role into their forms. Charles told me he was born near a mountain cliff on a winters night. So he had developed fur and body shape in response.

And the Kuretines all over his body ?, I ask. Derek says, that’s common among all Heraknus. Their bodies contain large amount of Kuret. Large enough that they only allow little outlets to pour out. So some of it grows out of their body. This also depends on the persons control over Kuret, the more control he has, the more he will keep Kuret inside and more Kuretines will be formed. Nathan asks, he is practically bathed in that stuff. So does that mean he is at the top of his game today? Derek says, you can say that. I have never seen these many Kuretines on Charles before. Today he has really gone far out.

Kafar claps his hands in joy and chortles, okay. The match starts now. He looks over to us, anyone care for drinks and snacks? He pulled out a box and a bottle besides his chair and waved it to us. None of us were in a mood to drink or eat. I can't believe Kafar is treating this like a game. But then again, he thinks Charles already won. No ? Okay fine, you guys are in shock, so give it some time. He puts away those item, how about a wager then?

We were shocked by his blatant disregard. Cassandra asks, you want to gamble on the winner? He nods, why not. You can worry about David all you want, but that will not change the outcome of this battle. Blake leans over towards him, you sure are full of confidence that Charles will be the victor. Maybe you need to consider that David could win. Kafar smirks, of course I know there is a certainty, boy. But I find it hard to believe he will come up with a way to defeat our champion. David fights more with brains than brawns. He needs both to win against someone as powerful as Heraknus alpha. You have seen him only transform now. Wait till you see him in action. Tell him Derek, what do you think.

Derek looked like he didn't want to say anything. He manages to put his thoughts to words, think of him like a walking disaster. He can cause earthquake under his feet, his punches can tear apart metals, his jaws can crush rocks into powder and those tails can strangle up people in four different ways. Right now what you have is a Medrine who is a lethal killing machine. When we fought, I was barely able to block his first attack. His second one was even more powerful. I thought he killed me for a second. With me he choose to just use his fist, he has other limbs to use for attack. Charles will definitely prepare to use all his limbs. He wants everyone to show what Heraknus are capable, now that they have come out of hiding after centuries. It must be what is driving him to focus and control Kuret much better.

Kafar says, see. Derek understands what David is facing. So how about it, lets make this match more interesting by betting. I am not being immoral you see, its just we can't do anything but watch our champions fight. He might not be immoral, but he was really getting on my nerves. Nathan speaks first, I am in. Everyone looks at him, what ? He is right, no point worrying about David. He can't see us. He most definitely doesn't know us wagering, so what's the harm. Kafar says, excellent. So who do you think will win. Nathan responds, maybe I hold a personal grudge or something, I am betting on Charles. Kafar smile got bigger.

I was not surprised, that was no brainer for Nathan to bet on. Beside him Jess sat thinking for a moment, I thought for sure she would side with her husband, but she surprised everyone. I bet on David. Nathan glanced to her, She says what. You have your reasons, I have mine. He has a plan. He always does. Blake beside her speaks, I know for a fact that he still has one ace on his hand which he hasn't reveled during mine or Derek match. I am betting on David.

Derek said, really. He said that? He was surprised to hear as was everyone. Blake nods, yup. I don't know what it is, but he must have it kept hidden so that Charles wouldn't know about it. Derek then faces towards David. In many ways he and David share many similar characteristics. He looked at Kafar who was waiting for his response. Really, you want me to pick one?. Kafar says, of course. Derek sighs, fine. I pick Charles then. I don't think David would go down easily but I have never seen Charles defeated.

I could tell it was a tough decision for him. He must have wanted to say David, but felt some pressure from Kafar. Marina said, well I am betting on David. Mark my words, he will be knocking him to ground. Well, that was obvious, I thought. Me too, Matt says. David will be the winner. I know it. Beside her Cassandra said, I am with David too. I don't care if Charles is some war god or something, David will beat him. Everyone knew they both would pick David. Catherine took some thought before saying, I think David is going to hate me for saying it, but I am betting on Charles.

Now that was a surprise. She has been friends with David for long time. Why she didn't bet on him? I thought I ask her about it, but Ned beside me said, I am also betting on Charles. I was shocked to hear him. I let go of his hand, what why? He says looking at me apologetically, keeping my personal feeling about our city aside, objectively, David odds are not looking good. Just look at that Charles. He looks like he wanted he could eat David in one go. I pity David, but I think he will lose.

Hearing those words felt like betrayal to me. He is speaking honestly, and I can understand why he thinks this. It still was shocking to know he gave up on David. I was the remaining one, but I didn't had to give any thoughts. I am betting on David. I don't know how, but he will win this. Hearing my claim Kafar laughed, that’s the spirit. You need to enjoy this. So we have 6 bets for David and 5 bets for Charles. But remember, once the match starts, you guys can always change your bets. This is getting exciting.

Nathan nonchalantly says, hold on we made the bets but haven't put up anything. Don't tell me we are gambling on money. Kafar says, of course its not money. That would too cheap. Lets see what will the winner get. He began thinking about it. I immediately said, how about the winners get a no objection favor from each of the losers team. Nathan says, whow, that’s a good one. It could be any favor then? He smiles. I say, obviously something reasonable. Jess poked him on his stomach to stop his immature behavior.

Kafar agrees, yes. That would do nicely. What do you others think. Everyone murmured in agreement. I know what I want from Ned. I want him to apologies to me and to David once he wins. Ned kept his eyes away from mine. Derek says, if all the frivolity is done, then lets see the match. Charles is now ready to make his first move. Everyone shifted with uneasiness on their chair and face the screen as the final match started.

# David (Chapter 5)

Sunday, 30 January 2022 10:36 PM

What in the world is going on here. A scrawny man is turning into some type of beast. His form is unlike any animal I have ever seen. Either on Medrine or Earth. His Kuret was so dense and controlled, hardly anything is getting wasted. I was defending myself with Kuret in my arms, but I expelled it after few seconds. There was no extra Kuret for me to block in the air. Their was only one glimmer coming out of Charles, strands of blue and violet. He is totally clam and composed. No hint of doubt or fear. Meanwhile, my body was oozing with doubt, fear and anxiety. I tried to clam my mind, but my body wasn't listening. My instincts was at odds with what I want. It was telling me to run.

When Charles dispelled his brown Kuret. I saw his full form. Shit. His is around 10 feet tall. He has 4 tails, long legs and arms, big jaws and claws. I could have never guessed that their Kuret allows them to transform into beasts. As Charles breathes, he exhales so much so that I could hear the sound of the wind even from such distance. His eyes was glued to me like its hunting its prey. Oh no, don't tell me he becomes more animalistic in this form. Charles opens his massive jaws, this is what it means to be a Heraknus. He says while raising both his arms to his torse, like a showman presenting to an audience. His voice is so much deeper now. It felt like his voice travelled great deal of muscles. He continues, David, you could have attacked me during my transformation, but you didn't. Why?

I gulped as I thought about it. He had a point, why was I just standing when I could have attacked. Even if I didn't know that he would take this form, I knew he would be becoming something dangerous. And yet I let him. Sure I was stuck with fear, but I wasn't completely frozen. I have been so many situations where I felt fear and still fought. One attack. Maybe that would be the end of it. As I keep asking these question to myself I realized my true feeling. I not going to lie, I reply, I was completely in shock seeing so much visible Kuret. But that’s not why I couldn't attack you. I choose not to. I can see you have been waiting for this moment for a long time. Even if I had win when you were not ready, its not really a win. Till now I wasn't sure, but I don't think I want to win like that.

Hearing my response Charles took his right leg and stomped on the ground hard. I felt the vibrations of that even here from the ground. What did I say that made him mad? There was a small glimmer of red coming out from him now. He says, you would show such compassion to your enemy? He shouts at me. I took a moment to say, we are not enemies. We are not fighting for our lives here. I don't know how people from Heraknus fight, but I have my own way of fighting. I get to choose my own battles and how I do it. So don't think that I made a mistake of letting you turn into this form. If I am to win, I need to do defeat you completely. Even when that means to let you become something that was a mistake.

Charles was now growling. Or was he breathing in from his mouth, it was difficult to know. He kept staring at me like I had given him a wrong answer. I saw the red glimmer around him fade, he then laughs. I was a little shocked at this reaction. Compared to his normal laugh, when he laughs now with his deep voice its still frightening. He says, that was a good answer. That was me testing you. And just like how have your way of fighting, so do I. I wanted to know if you are honest to yourself. You didn't deny you were scared of my Kuret form. People can say a lot of things before, but their true character comes out only when they are actually faced with something they fear. While we have remained in secrete for centuries, that doesn't mean we haven't fought other people and their houses. I have fought many people in my life too. I am sure your heart and mind are telling you to not fight me. Even though you are trying to hide your fear, I can see it as plain as day in your voice. But, not many stand their ground when facing me. I don't know what reasons you still have for fighting me even after you seen my Kuret. Whatever they are, it makes you a worthy opponent.

Wow, this guy. Either he is childish, or he is wise beyond his years. I can't figure out which one he is. But he is now becoming more of a person than a myth in my mind. He then takes a step forward. This time he doesn't uses much force on his steps. He starting walking slowly to me, I will give you one more chance. If you want to surrender, now's your chance. There will be no chance once we battle. Or to be clear, I will not give you a chance. His presence become even more intimidating as he came closer towards me as think about his offer. I began to weigh my choices. He has the worst compatibility for my Kuret. Like Vanessa, his Kurets effect are physical in nature. My usual Kuret attack cannot cancel the force behind his raw strength. There is chance that if I get close enough and wrap my Kuret around him completely, it might disrupt his Kuret. Maybe enough to revert to his normal state. He said himself that their access to Kuret is not consistent. So there is a chance.

He came close enough to see his claws and tails clearly. My strategy seemed impossible now after I saw Kuretines attached to it. No way I can get close to him without risking getting shredded by those claws or pierced by his tails. I have to fight him from distance. It would work more efficiently against someone who uses Kuret attacks. I am sure Charles uses his body to attack.

I began to run out of ideas. Only if I had time and had known more about Heraknus weakness beforehand, I would have more chances. Maybe I should give up. There is no harm in backing out now. No one will be question me if I surrender now. That would mean we will live in Citradel. Kafar has somehow managed to operate with Humans living in his city. More people can live similarly. Catherine can raise her baby with Robb in a city with both Humans and Medrines. It would be perfect for the baby to have such an environment. Maybe we can figure out a way to live with Humans.

My thoughts were interrupted by a conversation I had with James on the day he died. We were talking about how Medrones will live with Humans. He said, it’s a good dream kid. Humans and Medrone living together in one place. Maybe it will happen in future, but not now. Its impossible. You haven't seen what I have seen. Our species have many similarities, but there many glaring differences. Its like you are asking a Chimpanzee to live with King Kong. I asked him which species is what in his reference. He laughs a says, doesn't matter. My point is this planet is not ready to hold two sentient beings. Medrones will eventually have to find a new home. Earth human history is still dwarf compared to Medrines. We need to grow, both technologically and humanity. We are neither ready to know existence of aliens nor ready to handle the other wordily powers you guys have.

I prefer Medrones and Humans stay separate for the time being. Humans are aliens for Medrones also you know. They need to work on getting their bearings. It will take years, but it will happen with a Medrine society isolated from humans. Trust me kid, our species are not yet ready to live together. Your leaders made a wise decision to not let all humans know about your existence. Maybe one day, probably decades or even centuries, humans will be ready. But right now, it would only bring destructions to both species.

I remembers our talks. Even though it was in my memories, it just sat there. When we decided to rebuild our home on the Island, it makes sense why he believed we should remain separate. Its not bigotry or discrimination, its just that Medrines has a different society, just like humans. That means the way forward has to be from our own hands. Our previous generation, this generation and the next generation are already caught in the struggle. I can't let our future generation be dependent on humans and humans on us. We have to move forward. The first step is to build ourselves a home on Earth separate from humans. I can't throw away the match now. If I loose, then we will not make real progress.

With this reasoning, I decided to not to give up. All the while feeling that I am not being honest with my reasoning. Blakes words kept bothering me. Do I really have such a big ego that I can't through away this match. How badly does this match's result matter to me. I can't understand my own feeling. I stop my thoughts going crazy and took a breadth. Well, whatever my reasons. I have already decided what I want to do. I should now focus on the upcoming hurdle and nothing else.

I resolved myself for the fight I have to win. I need to win this match even if my opponent is from a house long hidden from history. Charles was now 5 steps away from me, I completely tuned away everything around me. I have zero strategies. I don’t know any of his Kuret weakness. I felt my resolve weaking. Before I had any more thought of doubts, I did something unexpected. I never done battles without knowing about my enemy or without a plan. But I have to now.

Immediately I draw my Kuret out into my right fist. Charles saw me doing it but did nothing. I blast a large amount of Kuret onto him. I was being foolish, but I know what I was doing. I am didn't want to cower back in anxiety so I did something ridiculous to make sure I can't go back now. I ran backwards to keep some distance between us and I kept increasing the intensity of my attack. My Kuret wraps around his entire body. I don’t know why but Charles didn't move a muscle, he kept still. Between all that facial fur and Kuretines, it was impossible to tell what his expression was like. But the glimmer around him was still blue. What a guy, even when I attack him suddenly he remains calm. I finally made a stand about 50 metes away from him and then shouted, thanks for the offer Charles. But I think you have my answer.

Oddly, it was a little satisfying. I done something totally random, without any plan. I have to improvise until I figure out a plan. I thought for sure Charles would have at least tried to escape from my Kuret prison. But he was allowing himself being covered with my Kuret. A moment later he says, This actually surprised me. For a second I thought you were about to give up. He then starts to laugh, all right, you wish to battle me, then I will give you one that will be will go down as one of the best in the history of Medrine. He then faces his jaws towards the sky and shouts so loudly that my eardrums were about to torn off. That was no Kuret assisted scream, that was a cry of excitement from the glimmer of violet around him now. What the hell is that. Is he trying me behave like an animal now. His voice has probably filled the entire coliseum. From the basements to the top floors, and every Medrine must have felt the intense passion in his voice.

He finishes his cry of declaration and then faces me. He barks at me, David! From this point on, we will not be talking anymore. We will let our fight do all the talking. Do you understand me. I got shivers down my spine as he made his point. But that's to be expected. He is an alpha. He is representing his house who have emerged after so long. He wants to make the best impression in front of all these Medrines. I already resolved myself to fight against his dominating presence. I have to win this for all our future. I shout back in response, I understand Charles. And know this, I am going to win this battle. I somehow find myself grinning. Maybe I have finally lost my mind in the face of overwhelming odds.

Charles made his move. His tails started to curl around his waist. The tails made few laps around his big gut and then he starts to bend forward on his arms to the ground. What is he planning? My Kuret should be effecting him. He was now on all 4 limbs with his tails now curled up on his waist. Suddenly he starts dashing towards me completely ignoring the Kuret wall I put up to confine him. What is happening, shouldn't he be at least weakened by my Kuret. I was already flabbergasted when I first attacked him and his form remained unchanged. And now even after passing through my Kuret, he doesn't appear to have lost Kuret. Impossible.

I wanted to understand how he is impervious to me Kuret, however, I have no time to deal with that. In front of me is a massive beast charging at me a speed which contradicts his body. He ran like a Cheetah covering the distance between us in seconds. I planned to dodge out of his way but suddenly the tails he had wrapped around himself earlier opened up and now covered his sides and blocked my escape routes. What the hell. Those tails were long, he was covering his left and right each side with two. Shit. He was cornering me. The only way is backwards now, but there's no time to use my Kuret to whisk away. I realize I was still maintaining my Kuret on the empty ground behind him. Charles has been running along side the line of my Kuret flow.

Suddenly I had a dangerous thought, there is a way out. I can use this Kuret to draw me in. This means I have to run towards Charles and not away from him. I really have lost my mind if this is my best chance. I didn't have time to think about it. Charles was just 5 meter away from me. I take my left hand and join the Kuret from my right. I wrap my Kuret around my arms like two ropes and let myself be dragged towards Charles.

I don't know if he was surprised to see me do this or not, but he kept going. I had only one chance of getting out of his trap, before he could attack, slide away from underneath him. Its risky, but the space beneath is the only place not guarded. I was dragged by my Kuret head first. I recalled that he had raised his left hand when he was declaring himself to the people, he must be lefty. That means there's a good chance he will use his left claw to attack. I keep me eyes on of his left arm. Charles was now close enough to attack. He let our a war cry from his mouth. His jaw was wide open and baring his teeth's. I didn't even want to know what those jaws and teeth's could do. I didn't let myself distract from this and kept my focus on that arm. He will attack me with his arm and not with his jaws. His arms have more range and was much quicker.

My guess was right as I saw him raising his left arm with claws going in for the kill. I used the force from my Kuret to turn my myself on my left. His claw misses me by few inches and get dragged under him. I willed my Kuret to drag me faster. I become faster as my arms and chest are being dragged on the field. In a second, I came out and felt him getting away from him. I could still see a violet glimmer around me. His tails. I saw from the corner of my eyes, 4 shadows in form of snakes on the grass. He doesn't want me to leave. This is bad, I can't dodge against 4 of those spear ends.

I did the only thing that came into my mind, I released a giant wave of Kuret from my whole body. This tail was the only part of him that was less covered in Kuritine. That means it should not be as robust as the rest of him. I saw the violet glimmers now just above me. I close my eyes bracing myself for the 4 spears coming at me. I felt a small prick on my back, my mind instantly went wild. Shit. What if his tails were also impervious, I am literally screwed then.

I kept waiting for the sharp prick on my back to create holes in me, but I didn't feel them come. All I felt was something more like toothpicks on my back. Holy shit. It worked. I wanted to see what happened to his tail, but not right now. I have to get away from him first. I open my eyes and saw the wall of Kuret that I had thrown earlier getting closer. The Kuret around me also started to subside back into me. Soon I slowed down and reached the place where I thought I had trapped Charles. I hastily gather myself up and turn back to Charles. I was still worried about that attack, so I use my arms to check for any damage in my back. Fortunately, there were no holes. There were only 4 pointed impression my clothes. I managed to save myself from being skewered. Relieved I survived this first attack unscathed, I focus my attention to Charles now.

He was still on his four limbs standing on the ground. His tails behind had become thinner and smaller. The Kuritine on the end of those tails were gone. Now that am a little calmed, I see some of the places were I saw the Kuretines on his body have also been effected. Few have shrunken, other smaller ones have been disintegrated. So my Kuret does work on him. I just need to be closer to him so that my Kuret doesn't thin out as the farther away from I am from him. His Kuret is different from others. My Kuret effects others the same away if I am close or farther away. I can cancel their Kuret from any distance. But to fight him I need to be closer. Great, how the hell am I going to manage that.

I get into my combat position. I will not myself be taken off guard again. I got away this time. I thought he would be slow for his size. But he is fast. Not fast as Blake, but fast enough that I can't use my Kuret Sphere. I need to somehow create some time for me to prepare. It needs to be big enough to hold at least fifteen to twenty attacks. I have never gone that far. But anything less will not give me enough variety and strength of those attacks. I have to also be careful when to use my Kuret dome. I can't use both of them together frequently. I have to choose the timing carefully, otherwise I would be wasting my stamina.

I take a deep breath now. I have multiple glimmers floating around me. I can't fight with so much anxiety and conflicts. There has to be a way to defeat him. I recall back on Medrine, Hanson teaching me that everyone enemy can be defeated. It can take time and patience. But if you gather your wits, a path will be revealed. He was right. For a long time we thought the hive leader was unbeatable. We killed him. And now he have to worry about the Hive King. Someday I will be fighting him. I need to become stronger if we have to survive.

I face Charles who hasn't moved from his spot now. He then pulls himself up and stands on his legs. My eyes widen as I see is chest. There damage to his chest. A portion of his fur was gone. His brown colored skin was bare and no Kuretines was present there. However, there was no blood. Did I do that ? When did that happen. He wasn't effected when he crossed the wall I conjured. And I only wrapped my Kuret around me after I slide away under him and was being attacked by his tail. I tried recalling if I did something before then. Nothing, I was only thinking about my Kuret pulling me faster. I am sure I didn't attack him. Then how did he receive damage. Hold on, it doesn't matter how. I bought some time. Now I should be able to do it.

I bring my arms and extend them with my palms out keeping them equidistant from my chest. I need to make this one big. I take in a short breath before I start to push my Kuret into both palms. I slowly start to bring my arms forward. The Kuret around my arms becomes denser gradually. I will my Kuret to shape in form of a sphere. The edges start to become slightly visible. I have never attempted to make such a big one before. But if the my theory is correct, as long at the ratio remains the same, I will get the same result. It means more of my Kuret has to be condensed. I began to pull out more Kuret into the sphere.

Suddenly I hear Charles shouting. I saw red glimmers coming from him. My focus broke a little as I turn to him. His was facing his jaws towards the sky as he was shouting and he kept his body in place. I gaze upon his chest. His fur was growing back. What. Behind him, his tails were gradually becoming bigger to their normal state. I saw his condensed brown Kuret floating around his body, like shades of winds wrapping over his chest and tails. The pointed end of the tails began to grow another Kuritine. He can heal himself? Few seconds later his chest was now covered in fur and Kuretines. Somehow it looked like there were more of those Kuretines on than before. You have got to be kidding me.

Charles said their bodies have weak compositions. So his Kuret has increased it drastically to this much extent. The Kuret floating on him slowly fall backs into skin after he finishes his recovery. As I see his Kuret being absorbed into him body, I realize his skin and furs all over his body is made of Kuret. It's not his real flesh. I recalled the time he was transforming. His Kuret flow is different from Catherine's when she changes. Her Kuret flows from inside, changing the bones and organs from the inside. Charles was almost opposite. His Kuret came from outside and he bathed in it. All the Kuret was absorbed, I thought he undergo transformation like Catherine did. Instead, he is actually wrapped in a cocoon of Kuret and made this form. His real body is inside all that skin and muscles. So no matter how much I destroy the outer shell, as long he is safe inside, he can heal this Kuret body endlessly.

I was marveled at this revelation. I can't believe such a bloodline exists where the Kuret becomes so dense around the user, it not only becomes physical, it has shapes, colors and strength. Those muscles make a lot more sense now, a Medrine can't have body structure like that. No matter how much buff you get. Then to make some serious damage to him, I need my attacks to go much deeper on his Kuret skin and cut his actual skin. I don't know if those injuries can heal or not, at least now I know superficial surface attacks are meaningless.

A fully healed Charles now faces me and same as last time, he began dashing at me with all four limbs. Dammit. I thought I had time. I dispel my sphere around my arms and my Kuret pulls back into my body. I quickly gather Kuret behind me back and throw it far enough behind me. Until I have found a way to cut through all that Kuret, I have to keep dodging him, try to understand his fighting pattern and come up with a plan. In an instant he was in front of me with his jaws opened, he wants to take a bite out of me now. I wasn't as much scared as before and it helped me to remain calm. I have fought Blake, who was much more faster then Charles. I learned how to move faster from our battle. I need to dodge it the precise moment so that he doesn't get a chance to attack me twice.

As soon as my Kuret was now far enough to pull me back and he leaned forward with his jaws, I pulled myself on my Kuret and flew away as his bites together on spot where my shoulder was. All he chomped was empty air. I brought my elbows up to guard myself in case he tries to attach me with his tails. But it never came. I was able to dodge his assault a second time. Once I covered some distance, I stopped. I started beathing a little faster as my Kuret gets falls back into me.

Around the field there was a glimmer of orange now. Frustration. I saw Charles coming charging towards me again. I may not be as scared as the beginning, but I still am nervous to proceed. I have no choice for now but to keep dodging his attacks until I find a way.

# David (Chapter 6)

Monday, 31 January 2022 12:12 PM

Charles is getting a little agitated after the seventh time I was whisked away to safely. There were small strands of red and orange now mixed within the blue glimmers around him. I was under the impression that he is calm always. But with every attack, he was becoming less and less mindful. Must be that he hasn't fought for this long other than the Hive leader. I wonder how long did he manage to keep with Charles attack. I still haven't figured out a way to attack under that dense Kuret. I had to keep my focus on running away for now.

Charles was now charging at me for the eight time. This time he leapt into the air as he came close to me. His kept his jaws close this time, instead he raised both his arms at me. I don't understand what he was planning, but jumping in air will not give him any advantage. I had my Kuret ready in my left arm to pull me away. Before his claws could reach me, I slide away to my left. I thought that was the end of this attack but then I hear a big whooshing sound, like a big rope was being waved in air. I turn my eyes towards him. He was still in mid air, yet he was able to change his direction by striking his tails on the ground. His tails had grouped together and hit the ground with enough force to propel him towards me.

How in the hell. His tails shouldn't have this much strength. His body weight is possibly 10 times the weight of all his tails. I couldn't understand how he did what he did. There was no time to figure it out. He was now above me one more time with both his claws aimed to my head. His large body was flying above my head and I was covered completely by his shadow. I tugged on my Kuret to go faster, but it would be pointless. He caught me by surprise again. I can't let those claws hit me. Even after getting blocked by my Kuret, one of those punches are deadly.

My mind went blank. I couldn't see a way out. Somehow my instincts kicked in, refusing to let him attack me. I have am not that good at acrobatics and what my I thought of evading seemed impossible. With no other choice I raised my legs above my torso and swing them over towards Charles. I was aiming to place my foot on each side of Charles shoulder. I stopped my pull on the Kuret from my arm and started to recede back. I clenched my jaw preparing to pull myself above with my legs using Charles as support. It was tenuous effort, even on ground it would be difficult. I put all my strength over my calves to push myself above. With tremendous effort I pulled myself above just his claws nearly misses me behind my back. I was now floating above Charles head. I somehow found my footing on his back and kicked myself forward to leave Charles behind. I raises both my arms out and poured Kuret to it.

His tails which were grouped together below me started to unravel, he must be planning to hit me with his tail again. Not this time, I mumbled as I threw my Kuret towards his tails. I blasted those tails with a dense Kuret. In the back of my mind, I knew I was wasting my Kuret. But I had no choice. My Kuret overpowered his tails and they start to disintegrate in front of me. By the time those tail came swinging in front of me, they had lost mass and strength. They were thin threads as it strikes me. I started to descend safely down behind Charles. I didn't waste my time to check on what he planned to do next. I blasted a big amount of Kuret from my chest aimed straight to the other side. My feet land on the grass and I crouch down on my knees as my weight pulls me down. I felt my Kuret had reached a safe distance. I allowed my Kuret to drag me by the torso.

In a few seconds, I landed about 20 meters away from Charles. My breathing had become a little ragged now. Damn. I used too much Kuret in pulling of this stunt. I starting breathing from my mouth to take in more air. I sweating now from the cheeks. I use the black of my palm to wipe them off. This is nuts. I barely managed to save myself. I never expected he would be able to change his direction in mid air. My breathing becomes slower and I clam down a little. Time to face him again.

Charles is standing on the place he landed after he leapt in air. He had his head turned towards his tails and was staring at them. His tails were already healed half way. They began becoming thicker and those Kuretines grew back. Shit. How much Kuret does this guy have. I hit his tails with so much Kuret and yet he is just shrugging it off like it was a just an inconvenience. I grind my teeth a little as I became angrier. What am I supposed to do now. If this goes on, I will run out of my Kuret and stamina before he does. So far both of us has not suffered any injuries, but his endurance is much higher than mine. I have to soon begin attacking instead of defending.

Charles healed his tails. He pushes himself above and stands on two feet. He then lets out another big howl that fills the stadium. I didn't even need to rely on seeing any glimmer to know he was getting mad now. Once he finishes his cry, he faces me. He was baring his teeth in anger. His was breathing now from both his nostrils and mouth. Is he also getting tired or that's just how his animal side shows his anger. I believe it's the latter. He then raises his arms above his hands and extends outs his claws. What's he doing now? Behind him, his tails also followed his arms and stood up straight. With his tails now comparable to his height, they were almost twice his height. He lets out another howl and faces to his hands.

My eyes must be deceiving me, but I swear I see his claws becoming bigger. Both his arms didn't showed any visible change, but his hand and fingers started to grow bigger. What!. I gulped more once I saw his tails. They starting becoming thicker. The Kuritine at the end of those tails starting shrinking. Is he pulling the Kuret out of them and using it to make his tails bigger. I looked over to his right arm, the Kuretines that grew over his arm were shrinking in size. He can use those Kuretines to make adjustments to his Kuret body. While it was impressive, what's he trying to accomplish. Making his tails and hands heavier will make him slow. Soon he was done making those changes. He then kneels down on his feet and thrusts his giant claws into ground. Behind his tails do the same action and strike the ground.

He creates a mini quake with this. I could feel a small tremor under my feet. What is he planning with this. He howls again with his jaws wide open. I could even see is big tongue hanging out from it. The ground starting shaking a little. I was horrified at his strength. His 2 arms and 4 tails could generate so much strength. I bet the he was shaking the whole field. Charles let out another howl. A moment later, the ground around him starts to crack. The grass around those cracks gets uprooted. The loose soils starts to slide away as he began lifting a big chunks of soil.

Holy crap. I was completely frozen as I see him lifting a big size of a piece of Earth and lift it over his head. Behind him, his tails had also pulled pieces of ground and he had wrapped his tails around those pieces firmly. Those pieces were smaller compared to the one he lifted. This claws were giving him support lift the boulder that was almost the size of a car. Suddenly he thrusts his head to the boulder in front of him. His head cracks the big boulder like an egg. The cracks started to seep deeper inside and using his claws he splits the massive boulder into two pieces. Each of them held by each claw. He starts running towards me with his two feet's instead of his usual four limbs. He intends to throw those rocks at me once I start running.

I was enthralled as Charles ran towards me. There are 4 small one and 2 big ones in his arsenal to throw at me. He is considerably slower, but I can't just dodge the usual way. As soon as I pick a direction, he will throw one of the rocks at me in that direction. Even when I dodge that, he has other 5 to block my path. Since he can carry such big boulders of Earth so easily, I am guessing he can throw at any distance them with his humongous strength. There was no running away from this.

I sighed. I was getting a little annoyed with myself for running away each time he attacks. Charles will keep trying out new ways to attack and each time they becomes more ferocious. I can't keep just dodging them. I need to go on the offensive. Maybe now it is time. He is slow and all his limbs are occupied. I think now's the right time to use my Kuret dome. I don't want to make it big, just about a meter big room. I recalled I was able to pull it off for a few seconds when I gave Blake the finishing blow. I was exhausted that time, so I could muster only that little room. I should be able to make one now.

I grip my fist hard. This it, an opportunity I didn't want to lose it. I starting running to him. It was a little suicidal running to a 10 feet tall giant with rock projectiles with him. As I ran I concentrated on covering my body with Kuret. My Kuret kept flowing out from my body. I focused on keeping a small space filled with Kuret. But I wasn't able to hold it much for long. Kuret seeped out from the sphere while I try to add layers of Kuret. I kept trying to keep it steady, but I kept failing. I wasn't surprised I couldn't keep it stable, I have never made a small dome intentionally. My Kuret is not like others. I can't keep it condensed and stable together. Time is running out, with both of charging towards each other, the distance keeps getting shorter. So is my hope.

I gave up on in restricting the dome. I will waste a lot of energy doing this, so I have to keep it for only few seconds instead of a minute. I began yelling and let out a burst of my Kuret from all my body. I kept pulling more and more, the space around me becomes darker. I first focused to wrap my Kuret around my legs and arms. As soon we were close, Charles hurled his right claw boulder at me. The huge chunk of soil and rocks is thrown in the air aimed at me. It was leaving behind a trail of this soil and grass in the air scraped off from the sides. I gather my Kuret around my right hand and conjure up a big sheet of Kuret around my arm. I stopped running and make my stand with my feet planted firmly on the ground. I swing my arm towards the left tugging along the sheet of Kuret. My Kuret makes contact to the boulder. The rock was heavy, I could feel it from my Kuret. But I had created enough force to knock it away from my direction. The boulder makes a whooshing noise as it gets deflected towards my left.

I saw Charles wagging one of his tail in front of me. Round 2 of this attack. I am wasting energy blocking these attacks. I need to get closer. I gather Kuret around my back and legs to propel me forward. I intended to go only a little faster, however, for some reason I was moving much faster towards Charles. I have never flown at this speed inside my dome before. Whatever the reason, I was accelerating faster than those rocks would hit me. I was able to dodge by flanking to my right when the second boulder was launched at me. With this speed, I don't have to block the boulder, I can just circumvent through them.

Charles was now preparing to throw another boulder from his left tail. I didn't want to give him that chance, he has one free arm, but he can't keep the boulders balanced. I join my hands together in front of me and willed to form a spear as I spread my hands apart. The spear was initially thin, but I started to pour Kuret from my hands. It was a little unstable but dense enough to have a physical effect. I took the spear in my right hand and aim it to his right leg. I let out small air from my mouth as I pushed it away from my hand. I kept pouring Kuret behind its trail, making it stronger and faster.

Charles threw his 3rd boulder at it path. It struck at the tip of my Kuret spear. Mine was more powerful, it pierced it from the inside and kept going. Charles was now vulnerable. I thought for sure he would get hit, but at the last moment, he pushed down the boulder he had kept in his right hand to the ground and it used a shield. I didn't have the time to go around the boulder so I pushed it inside that rock. This one was much bigger than the other one. There was too many things to pierce through. By the time it came out from the other end, Charles had jumped to the sky. His jump was high enough that he safety was hovering above while my spear misses him on the ground.

Charles now air borne, plans to use two remains boulders. He doesn't throw them this time, instead he kept the boulders wrapped around his tail and swung them from both his sides. I raised up my elbows in front of my chest and gather the Kuret I had thrown to become a shield now. I kept pulling the Kuret back from the path I had thrown earlier and the shield became bigger. I clench my jaw and tighten my fist to brace of the dual attack. So soon as the boulders touches me, I expand my Kuret gathered in my arms and block them. I was being sandwiched between the two rocks. A moment later the boulder broke apart and fell away into pieces. I was sweating now. My heart starting beating loudly against my ribs.

I haven't made a scratch on him. He doesn't even look tiered. All I am doing is wasting my stamina. Charles is descending in front of me. He had his gigantic claw ready to thrust into my face. Really, does he indent to kill me. I don't have time to get away. There's only one way now. I gather more Kuret on the shield I had made. I made it bigger and thicker to withstand his attack. I gather some Kuret around my feet and back to give me extra support.

Charles let out a huge growl as he slices the air with those five Kuretines. The claws make contact on my shield. I felt an immense pressure. Even if his body is made out of Kuret, the force with which Charles hit me is unreal. I felt like my weight had increased by 10 folds. I saw my feet getting pushed down from his attack and it buried a little on the ground. My whole body was vibrating, trying to hold it together. My heart was now dancing in my chest. Sweat now dripped from the back of my neck. I had my eyes closed all this time to focus on keeping my Kuret shield stable. A second later, I felt another attack on the shield. The force of this was same as the previous one. He must have used his other arm. My mind is almost ready give up the Kuret. I was breathing hard. This attack now pushed me further into the ground. Shit. If I hadn't used my Kuret shield, he would have already killed me once. I felt his attack recede, finally, I felt a little relieved. I have a chance to get away now. His claws must have broken after coming in contact with my Kuret.

A surprise came in another attack. The force of this attack didn't change. He still had that monstrous strength in each punch. It came not from the above, but from straight ahead. Impossible. I thought for sure his claws will break or at least become weaker, but it looked like he wasn't even effected. I continued to struggle as I kept my Kuret up against his attack. I had to now gather some Kuret behind my back to give me support as his onslaught continues. I could see his gimmer of his body punching non stop, like he was a wild animal attacking . His tongue was out the side of his jaw like he was enjoying this. The claws in his hand were shining continuously. Charles was flowing his brown Kuret like water on a stream on his arm. The claws broke when it touched my Kuret. Almost immediately, he was healing them with the brown Kuret flowing around his arm.

He can do this? I assumed that it takes time for him to regenerate. For all my previous attacks, he took few seconds before attacking. This is almost instantaneously. Did he deliberately slowed his recovery as a distraction? No, he said earlier he doesn't like deception. Then how. I couldn't give much thoughts between the barrage of attacks that kept coming. My arms were getting tired. He must have now attacked about a dozen now. He kept attacking with such ferocious intent.

I can't keep this up. I should have fled earlier. A minute must have gone by now. I can't believe I thought I could have managed with just few seconds of my Kuret dome. I have wasted too much of my stamina for just defending. I can't believe the stupid decision I made when I attacked him. I let my emotion take over. I didn't had any real plan, now I am deep trouble. His attacks haven't slow down. How much Kuret does he have. He must have more than Blake, Nathan and Tessa combined. My control was starting to waver. The shield in front of me was becoming thinner and weaker. Another couple of bouts and he would have broken through it. I have to get away now.

I am almost out of time now. I looked for a chance between his attack. Once I got one, I yelled with adrenaline running in me, I blasted the lasts of my Kuret around the shield outwards. The Kuret was enough dense to have physically pushed Charles back before he could attack again. I felt the dome getting smaller now. The Kuret that was floating in air was coming back to me. I need to keep some distance from Charles. He was so massive that he barely moved from his place. I took a big gulp of air as I jumped off the ground. I gathered as much I could from Kuret in the air on my hands and threw it towards Charles. He felt the full blast of my attack. This time, my attack had much more force so was pushed back further away. And because I had leapt into the air, I was also propelled backwards from the attack.

I kept grunting as I flew in opposite direction from Charles. The Kuret kept pouring out from me to the Kuret attack going. I saw Charles had brought his elbows in front of his chest to defend his body against the black Kuret. His feet was being dragged across the field uprooting the grass from the roots leaving a visible path on the ground. My Kuret became weaker. It slowly started to come back to my arms instead of out. Soon it became weak to not have any physical strength.

I fall back to ground when my Kuret dome was gone. My Kuret was still flowing into my chest, but it was now having no strength. My legs suddenly grew weak and I had to crouch down on one knee. I place both my fists, knuckles to the ground to give me support. I was panting hard. My heart was beating loudly, my ear drums beating in sync with it. Sweat now came to my lower back. My whole body was still reeling from the effects of his attacks. I was gasping of air.

My Kuret was back inside me. I raise my head to Charles. Charles still had his arms raised. However, my attack had reduced the size of his arms considerably. The fur and the Kuretines were completely gone. His Kuret muscles and size was also diminished. His arms were deformed compared to the rest of his body. They looks like his normal arms. He slowly pulls them down. Wow, that's a surprise. It was not just his arms that took the brunt of my attack. His jaws was cut down in half. His chin and shoulders looked like they were carved out with a sword. His beefed up chest was no longer bulky. All the brown skin was exposed now.

I let out a sigh, at least I was able to do some damage. Even if it was not physical damage, he must have lost some Kuret. I don't believe he has unlimited Kuret. He must have some limit. Charles stood at his place and wrapped brown Kuret over his body. His Kuret began healing the parts of his body. His Kuret started circling around him. Both his arms were now covered completely and gradually they grew back to its original size. I still haven't landed a single critical attack on him. I have somehow been able to defend from those claws. His Kuret now travel up his body fixing his chest and face.

I disheartened face the ground below me. This fight is crazy. I may have bought a few seconds until he heals. However, its not enough. I try to pull out my Kuret. Only a small amount would come out. My body was coming down from the adrenaline and started to sore a little. My heartbeats slowly subsided. I was taking in deep breathes to calm myself. I was desperately searching for ideas to buy more time. I am in the worst situation. I shouldn't have used Kuret dome without a clear plan. What the hell was I thinking.

I peaked at Charles from the corner of my eye. He was almost done healing himself. His fur and Kuretines had grown back on his chest. He was now healing his face. Not good. I haven't found a way to buy time. There is no place to hide in this big open field. I got angry. I pull my right arm and punch the ground with my fist. So my only option is to surrender now? No. I can't. Not now. Not after so much has happened. Then what should I do. My only hope of defeating Charles is to use the Kuret sphere. I need time to create one. For that I need create distance from Charles and make him slow. I can't find a way for either that to happen.

Charles Kuret was dissipating now. He had fully healed to his former state. Crap. Here we go again. I had calmed a little but the panic to face him without my reduced Kuret was keeping me agitated. As soon as the last of his Kuret went away, he looks up and howls. What's the point of doing this. He should not be feeling pain when its just his Kuret being damaged. Every part of his body was covered by thick Kuret. Wait, that's not true. There is one thing that is still exposed. His eyes. Unlike the rest of his body, his eyes is not covered with any Kuret. What if I manage to slow him down for some time by attacking his eyes. They had grown a little bigger when he transformed, so it makes an easier target.

But how do I attack them. I immediately looked over the ground near me. Of course. Charles has been rampaging all over the field. There are patches of baren land where grass were uprooted and exposed soil. I look over the place where he had thrown that massive boulders to defend himself from my spear attack. I bet there is a rock strong enough to throw. The only problem is that it is about 50 meters away on my right. I have to run to that place before Charles catches to me. It needs to be a very fast run. I couldn't think of any better plan. So I didn't waste another second. I stood up even though my body was weighing me down a little. With a last ditch effort, I dash for the holes in the ground.

# Vanessa (Chapter 7)

Wednesday, 2 February 2022 1:49 PM

I am completely shocked that David made the first move. What made him do that. And it was not just me, everyone here felt it was unlike his usual approach. Charles had offered him a chance to give up, but David's reply came in form of him using his Kuret to trap him. I was the first to say, this is the first time he made the first move. I though he would keep some distance before attacking.

Ned beside me says, what's he thinking? Does he think he can cancel out the Kuret from Charles body. Will that even work with such a massive body? Ned had voted against David. And I was annoyed with him. How can he support a stranger over our friend. Ned has been planning for almost a year for Citradel to join us. It was his dream. He had said many times I will win this tournament and make his dream come true. But ever since my defeat he has become a little sad. Did he really want only me to win. It shouldn't matter who wins amongst us.

Kafar who had starting drinking, took a sip from the glass and says with a smile, dear boy, do you really think that Charles body is made up of real flesh? He lets out a small laugh. Cass asks, what's that supposed to mean? He replies, aren't you from a house that boasts physical abilities when use your Kuret. Does using your Kuret changes you body in any visible way? Cass shook her face, no. My bloodline Kuret strengthens the muscle fibers and organs in our bodies. She looks over to the screen, but this is house Heraknus. The amount of Kuret he just released now is no where near the amount we use. And his Kuret is so much condensed. Her eyes widen and faces him again, are you saying that body is actually made out of Kuret?

What. That’s unbelievable. I can understand Kuret taking physical shape like Jess's bloodline. But its entirely different to have varied sizes, skin and color. Jess asks, that’s not possible. Sure, Kuret can become visible if Kuret is dense enough. But Charles has furs, skin and muscles. A Kuret cannot do that. It can't create complex physical features. She pauses a little to think it over, I mean, at least I have not heard such a Kuret in existence.

Derek pitches in, its true. Kuret cannot do that. But Heraknus bloodline Kuret is a little different. For vast majority of Medrones, Kuret is something pulled in from the atmosphere. The tiny ambient Kuret floating in the air is absorbed by the body. That happens continues during a fight too. However, Heraknus don't do that. They have an uncanny ability that allows them to keep the Kuret they recovered into their body until it runs out. They can't pull in the ambient Kuret from the air. Charles told me that’s a trade off for having high endurance and control over Kuret.

Wow. That’s incredible. Blake asks, but that still doesn't explain this body changes. How does having Kuret stored up inside the body allows the person to become, he couldn't think of a analogy, so he pointed his palm to Charles, well him. Derek nods, yeah. Believe me, I was also skeptical at first about this whole Kuret turned flesh thing. This what Charles told me, he looks over to Blake. Because their Kuret stay inside their bodies all the time, the Kuret has formed a symbiotic relationship with the body. Now there's a give and a gain from this. Heraknus Kuren, you could say its mutated a bit to change form to a physical state. Their Kuret have adopted some of the properties of their physical body. It’s a little difficult to understand, much less accept this, it is how they turn their Kuret into bodies.

I was mesmerized by Derek's explanation. That incredible. Never I imagined a house like this ever existed on Medrine. I then ask, so does that mean that their bodies have same stuff like weight and strength. Derek nods, oh you bet. Those punches he gave me had the real physical power. And not only power, his body is covered in fat skin and big muscles. So his defensive capability is also real.

Matt says, if what you are saying is true. Then David has this match in the bag. His Kuret will easily remove that body if its made of Kuret. Right? It doesn't matter Charles has more endurance, once his Kuren is drained out of his body, he will become weak. Derek looks to him and replies, if only that was true. I told earlier that Kuret becomes physically real right? That means parts of his body are not Kuret anymore. They have become real enough to be immune to David's Kuret. Brain was visibly astounded, are you kidding me? But even if his body had become real, it was still made from Kuret. So it can't be that he is not vulnerable from David's attack?

Derek takes a second to answer, honestly. I have no idea. Parts of his body is still Kuret. Those Kuretines are proof of that. But Heraknus is not only the bloodline with a strange Kuret. David's Kuret is also difficult to comprehend. There is not even a mention of this Kuret in any books I have read. And like Charles, David's Kuret also always reside in his body. When we fought last year against the Hive leaders army, when the anti-Kuret bomb denoted, only David was still able to use his Kuret. So his Kuret is eerily similar to Charles and yet so different because he doesn't change like him. So I am curious to see if his Kuret will even work against Charles.

Derek made some excellent points. I wanted to know more about him, but a sudden shout from Charles changed my focus to him. He was still wrapped inside the Kuret. He was now ready to make his move. I wondered what he would do to get out of David's Kuret cage. He wrapped his tails around him, then crouches down forward to stand on all four limbs. What came next surprising. He just crossed the barrier, ignoring the repercussions. He ran out the other side and ran towards David. He was fast like a Cheetah. Blake says, whoa. What is Charles thinking? Won't running through David's Kuret cause damage to is body? No one had any answer of that. Then we say his body remained unchanged. There was no visible damage anywhere. Nathan said, well we got our answer. David's Kuret doesn't affect Charles.

I can't believe Charles is not even weakened a little. Anyone else would have their Kuret drained out of them for some time. Heraknus are truly extraordinary. We see Charles approaching towards David fast, something that should have been unlikely due to his size. David was visibly panicked seeing Charles running over to him. He must have been terrified. Anyone would be frozen when a beast is running towards you. David made a posture that looked like he was ready to dodge the attack by running sideways. Then Charles expands his tails towards his sides and blocks David's movement. Damn. David was getting cornered now.

Kafar was wooing now, is the match already over with this first attack? I wanted to shout at him but held myself. Charles had almost closed the distance between them. Finally David made his move. He let himself pulled by his Kuret he threw earlier and flew straight. Straight towards Charles. What. I tightened my fist nervously. What is he doing? Is he really thinking for fighting head on. His Kuret didn't work on Charles, so what his plan. I couldn't think anymore when they were close enough to exchange punches. Charles raises his arm and bares his claws at David. Somehow David manages to dodge that attack and hugs the ground. His Kuret kept pulling him as he slides away underneath Charles body.

The whole crowd roared in excitement. I had unconsciously held my breadth when Charles had attacked. I let out my breath in relief. I thought David managed to get away, but Charles tails now were aimed at him. Those Kuretines on the end were sharp and thick. David is immune to Kuret, but not from the force of the attacks. David was probably aware of the danger from the air, but he was still trying to get away first. I almost closed my eyes in hopelessness. At the last second, David let out a big wave of Kuret from his body. Because his Kuret was close to David's body, it was dense. His Kuret blocked the four tails from reaching him. A moment later they even started to slim down in size. David's Kuret does works on Charles.

David's Kuret suddenly did something unexpected. He had radiated Kuret all around his body, but now all that Kuret around him circled around his body. Like a river going around a rock, his Kuret moved to a single point, his back that was facing the sky. All the Kuret collected on his back was released a moment later towards Charles. Charles had turned around to chase David, but he didn't get that chance. He was struck with the Kuret David released behind him. Charles was caught off guard. He couldn't defend himself from this.

The black Kuret pushed him back a little, Charles was able to withstand the force. Few seconds later, David was slowing down at some distance. His Kuret was being pulled back to him. The Kuret David throw earlier left Charles. What remained behind was a damaged body of Charles. Some of his Kuretines on the body were gone. Charles then stands up on his legs. His chest fur was gone. The brown skin was exposed. He didn’t look critically injured, but it proves that David's Kuret works.

Matt sighs, fhew. that was too close. I can't believe David choose to run at Charles. I bet that must of surprised Charles. He laughs and the asks, and what the hell was that attack? I have never seen David do something like this. Jess continues, who by the way is not immune. I don't understand what David did, but look. Charles took damage. His tails have shrunken and his some of the Kuret was removed from his body. Charles may have a real body, but he is still vulnerable.

Derek says, no one in their right mind would charge at Charles in this form. He smirk a little, but that was the right decision. He couldn't retreat, he couldn't run sideways. This was his only choice, wish I had done the same in our battle. He mumbles something to himself. Nathan turns to Kafar and says, so I guess David's Kuret does work on Charles. Is it too late to change my vote? He asks with a little smile. Kafar was still calm. I thought for sure he would be worried as his champion isn't as invulnerable as he claimed, don't worry. Even if that black Kuret works on him, Charles is still standing. As long as Charles doesn't revert to his normal self, the match will never be over. He looks towards David, although, I must admit I didn't expect David to get away safely without getting hit.

When did David learn to do that attack. He never used it in his previous matches. As I wondered over my thoughts, David was doing something weird after noticing Charles taking damage. Ned asks, what is David doing now. It looks like he gathering his Kuret around his hands in a ball shape. Yeah, David had his arms raised in front and was pulling his Kuret in the space between.

Blake shouts, oh hell yeah. He raises his fist to his neck in excitement, this is what I saw him doing in our match. I remember David doing this hand gestures. This is the ace up his sleeves I was talking about. Marina asks, Really. What is he doing? Blake says, no clue. He never told me what is this. All I know for certain is that if he kept it hidden for so long, even during our match, it must be something really powerful. Catherine says, I don't know Blake, it looks a lot like when David creates that dome. He is just gathering his Kuret in one place. How is it different from then.

Derek who had his eyes glued to the screen at David says, this is definitely different. His dome involves using the Kuret he already released. Very much like Blake. But this, I can see he is not just gathering Kuret. He is slowly increasing the amount. Its almost as if he is pushing it inside. I ask, whatever David is doing, I don't think Charles will just stand by watching. He needs to hurry it up. I looked over to Charles who now was gathering Kuret around him. What's he up to now. I was curious about something. I ask Kafar, earlier you said that long as Charles doesn't revert back he will be okay. What do you mean by a that. Surely he will be in trouble if David attacks him like this continuously. Sooner or later, all the Kuret in his body will be chipped away piece by piece.

Kafar responds, you will know what I meant soon. Just watch. I look to Charles on the screen. His chest and tails were wrapped with brown Kuret similar to what happened when he was transforming. Oh no. This can't be good. Few seconds later, the Kuret vanishes and his injures are no longer there. The fur had grown back, the tails have gone back to their original size. Marina says, oh crap. Charles can heal himself so fast ? A second later Charles let out a war cry and starts running again on his limbs towards David.

Derek says, yes. He can heal his body as many times he wants. Even if it is real flesh, it was originally grown from Kuret. Heraknus have incredible amount of Kuret. Their alpha has even more. This was not enough to seriously injure him. I was shocked at that. So even if David's Kuret works, it is not enough to take Charles down. David was probably as shocked as us. He saw Charles running at him. Whatever he was planning, he had no choice but to drop it.

Matt says, damn. David was so close. Now he will probably have to duke it out with Charles. I thought David would attack again. Instead, he choose to run away. He threw his Kuret behind and got pulled back before Charles could land another attack on him. The crowd let out another wave of noise as David narrowly misses his claws. Blake says, ah, why is he running? Can't he just fight like he did earlier? If he does, he can gain some distance and try that Kuret ball thing again.

Charles didn't waste a second as he followed David. Again, instead of fighting David ran away. I ask, what is going on. Why isn't David fighting back. His earlier attack worked. Why does he keep running away. The same thing happened at the fourth attempt. David let his Kuret drag him away from Charles attack path. Whatever be the actual reason, I think David has no choice but to run for now.

Blake says, how long can David keep it up ? Derek shrugs at him, I am not sure. This is not good. David dodges two more times Charles attack. How long will he keep running away. After another few clashes, Kafar says, whoo. That was a close one. I thought for sure Charles would get him this time.

Derek kept silent at that remark. I don't think he should feel bad. Derek is the second strongest person from Citradel. Charles is just too powerful. I look over to the screen where David landed safely away yet another time. He might be under pressure right now, but he always find a way to overcome it. At least I hope. His next assault looked to have the same result. However, this time he jumped into the air and came with both his arms raised. This was a weird choice. David pulled away from this air attack. I wasn't noticing this earlier, Charles had grouped his tails together. As he was floating in air he thrust his clubbed tail to the ground and changed his direction. What.

I held my breath again as I saw Charles now looming above David. David is still pulling away, but Charles is faster. My eyes squint at the thought of those sharp claws heading at David's head. At the last moment, David locked his feet on Charles shoulder and kicked himself upon Charles back. My jaw open little seeing this ridiculous display of acrobatics. David jumped on top of Charles and kicked himself away. Just like last time, those tails were aimed at him again. He blasts a ray of black Kuret to deflect them. Those tails lost lot of Kuret and became thin. David let out another blast of Kuret away from him and flew towards its direction.

I let out a big sigh, this is nuts, I say, this was way to freaking close. At least David can handle those tails. Derek says, yes. Charles tails are indeed having the least amount of Kuret. So a normal bust of Kuret wave up close must be enough to cancel his Kuret. David landed few meters away. What will you do now David, I thought to myself.

Charles took a couple of seconds to heal his and let out another howl. Marina says, what's up with this werewolf act. Why does he keep shouting. Don't tell me he really is part animal when he changes. Kafar says, don't be ridiculous girl. He is not doing it because he wants to. He is letting out the pain he has been receiving.

Blake faced to Kafar, what pain? He is healing himself with Kuret. Why would that cause pain. Derek says, its not just the pain of regrowing limbs. He is also letting out the pain through shouting for all the damages David has been giving him. I was curious now. Why would he feel pain. That’s not his real body. Beside me Ned snapped his fingers, I got it. You said earlier that Kuret and his body are linked. Because of that his Kuret turns to real flesh. But that goes both ways, any damage his Kuret gets, he feels the pain of that attack. Right?

Derek nods in agreement, Yes, that’s correct. The Kuret turned flesh has become just as much as part of his body like his real limbs. He feels pain when the Kuret gets chopped off from him. Usually, the Kuret on his skin is so tough that it can withstand a lot of physical attacks. But David normal attacks are not physical, they rip apart the persons Kurets. If David gets close enough to attack with some more Kuret, he could do some serious damage to Charles.

Kafar says, that’s not a major weakness Derek. Trust me, our champion has extraordinary endurance. Yes, he feels pain. But that amount of pain is superficial. His stamina and strength more than makes up for this. Derek nods, that’s true. It would take a lot of time to completely drain an Heraknus alpha's Kuren. Not even David can match up to that level. Besides, Charles is a veteran. He is used to getting his Kuren blown off by other Medrones. Those howls are just for him to release his mind of the mental pain since his physical pain is no more.

The more I learn about Heraknus, the more incredible they are. Sure they have their own unique weakness, but their strength is more than enough to tip the scale in their favor. Charles, after healing his tails, stood up again on his legs. He raises both his arms above his head and the tails behind him stood up straight too. I have seen enough to know that Charles is always does something shocking when his previous attacks doesn't pan out. A moment later, his hands and claws were wrapped up in Kuret. So were his tails. He was already healed, what he doing this for? I got my answer when is claws and tails started to grow in size. They kept growing gradually and finally the Kuret dispelled. His claws were massive now. The tails were thicker and the Kuretines at the end were gone.

Ned asks, Derek, I thought you said their form doesn't changes. What is this then? Derek says, no. If you see carefully, his basic form hasn't changed. All he did was augment parts of his body. This is something only an alpha of Heraknus can do. Of course, there are limits to what extend he can change their size. This is manageable for him. I ask, okay, but why did he do this. Won't it make him slower with those big hands? Derek says, Charles doesn't fight in a complicated way. He goes by his instincts and whims. Whatever he is doing must have simple reasons. And I think you can see what he is doing.

I looked to the screen. He thrusts his massive claws into the ground. The four tails did the same. Then Charles lets out a big howl. Then came tremors. The wall of our rooms slightly shake. Wait what. I looked outside the window where people sat. The crowd also had grown a little silent and began whispering instead. Did they also feel this mini earthquake? The vibration stopped when Charles pulled out a massive piece of soil rock from the ground. A second later, the tails also dug out pieces of rocks. They were smaller in comparison to what was in his hand. That one was as large as a truck.

Marina jumps on her chair, holy shit. Did I just see a Medrone pull out a massive boulder from the ground just with his strength? Cassandra says, that’s probably twice or thrice the size I can manage. This is insane. I wasn't sure until now whose house had more physical strength, mine or his. This clears up that debate. To think our was considered the strongest physical types till now. She shook her head shocked at this feat. Matt tries to comfort her by patting on her back, whoa, its not a contest you know. She nodded slightly.

I think I had maxed out my capacity to be surprised. I thought Charles would hurl this massive rock towards David. But he headbutts the boulder on his hands instead. The boulder starts to crack and splits into two. Now he had 2 rocks in his hands. A moment later he starts running on his legs to David. He was slower this time. Derek says, what I tell you. He attacks are simple. He just relies on his brute strength. Nathan, says, yeah. Simple but insane. No one would think of doing this. David can't just run away like earlier. I bet he can throw those rocks quite far and with speed.

We were patiently waiting for David to run away. He had no choice but to dodge this. In a completely opposite move, he starts running to Charles. Blakes, what is this now. He asks when we see David pulling out his Kuret in his hands. It looked like he was trying to gather more Kuret but they fell threw. Is he trying that Kuret ball thing again ? Blake asks. No one had any idea. A couple of seconds later released a massive amount of Kuret from his entire body. His Kuret began filling the air around him making it darker. I ask, Hold on, is this what I think it is?

Blake says, yeah. It his Kuret dome.. Derek says, maybe he has a plan? What could it be. He mumbles. David doesn't do something without having a plan of attack. He must have a reason. Soon they both get close enough of each other. Charles make the first move with throwing one of the boulder from his hands. Just as Nathan thought, Charles had thrown it with such power that it flew fast. David didn't have the time dodge this so he creates a big sheet of Kuret and hits the boulder from the side. I thought the boulder would break from the collision, but David managed to throw it off course.

Charles then prepares to throw a boulder from his tails. He dodges this one with his speed. Charles prepares to launch another one from his tails. In response, David creates a spear from his hands made of Kuret and throws it forwards. The spear pierces through the boulder and flies towards Charles. To defend against that, he shields himself with the boulder he had in hand. The spear dugs into the larger boulder, but by the time it came out, Charles had jumped in the air. I am amazed to see that a being of that much height and weight was able to jump so high. He easily crossed the boulder and hovers on top of David and launching two more remaining boulders from his side.

I thought David would now run. He surprised me as he creates a Kuret shield making his stand. The boulders crush David in between, but his Kuret was stronger. The boulder breaks apart. Now he should run away. But he still didn't. He stood there to prepare for Charles punches from those large claws. I felt annoyed. Why is David fighting like this. He is so methodical and calculating. He makes very move with the intend to win. But this is unlike him.

Charles throws a punch on the shield around David. The impact creates a humming shockwave that was felt far away even to us. The dust from the ground around them few away from the shockwave generated. My eyes widen in worry. This was a powerful punch. I have never seen two Medrones stir up this much without Kuret. The wall around us vibrate for the second time. David's shield held up. He was a little pushed to the ground, but he was okay. I let out a sign in relief. Then Charles attacks with his other fist. Another shockwaves is flown from the field.

David managed to defend against that as well. Charles lands in front of David. Now's the chance, run David. I mumble. I don't know what's going on with him, but he has used his dome at the wrong time. He may not even realize what he did the first time they clashed. Whatever he planned to use his Kuret Dome for isn't working. David should have run when he got the chance, but he didn't. He just stood there, his Kuret still wrapped the front side. Charles took this opportunity and started attacking him.

Charles shouldn't have been able to attack consecutive times. Those black Kuret should have declawed him and damaged his hands. But Charles didn't seem to care. He kept punching on the shield. The shockwaves radiated from the field to the entire stadium. The dirt on the ground started to vibrate in a rhythm, shooting into the air at the wave generated from the impact. The vibrations continued to happen on the walls of our room. I could now feel it passing into my chair and trembled my body.

Jess says, what the hell is going on here. Charles punches are so strong, I can feel from so far away. I ask Marina, I thought the barrier would block all physical attributes. That includes shockwaves coming from the inside. Marina nods, it does. It will even bounces back any Kuret induced wave attack launched at it. After another wave from a punch she continues, these shockwaves are not coming from the air. They are coming from the ground. I didn't think it was important to put the barrier inside the ground too.

Matt asks, hold on. Does this mean that without the barrier there would have been even more tremors? Holy crap. Then anyone standing inside the barrier must be blown away from sound pressure. Another wave vibrated the walls. Incredible, to do have such effect from this distance. Its unimaginable. Blake says, its not just Charles. David's also part of the reason for this. That shield he conjured up, to be able to withstand so many attacks, it has to be stronger than any Earth metal.

Kafar says, how long do you think David can keep this up? Soon he will run out of time, and he won't be able to use his Kuret for a few seconds. Then what? He asks Derek. Derek didn't have a reply from him. He was completely focused on the screen that showed David struggling. I am worried about that too. Does he have a plan for that? David had now taken more than a dozen of the Charles punches. Suddenly he blasted a wave of his Kuret from all his body. That pushed Charles a little back. David now jumps up to the air, his Kuret assisting him, and then he gathers Kuret on his hands. He then thrusts all of it towards Charles.

Charles is now being dragged away on the field. David flew backwards. His dome was now getting smaller and Kuret from the air started coming back to him. A few seconds later, they both slow down and stop. David's Kuret was now retreating back. He fell to his knees exhausted from all the punches Charles thew. I turned my gaze to Charles now. Whoa. This is by far the most we have seen him taking damage. His arms had shrunk, his beefed up chest was gone. His jaw was cut down in half. Almost all the Kuretines on his body were gone. His tail was the only part that remained unaffected. But all this damage was still not enough. He brought out his brown Kuret and wrapped it around him once more. He started healing himself.

Sadly, David couldn't recover like that. He wasn't injured in anyway, but he was looking tiered. He used too much of his Kuret and probably used up too much energy and stamina. I gripped the side arm tightly. Thinking about Ned's comment about David earlier made me realize I am a little angry at myself. That could have been me fighting Charles instead of David. Ned had been supporting so much, I somehow convinced myself that I would become the winner. I had to make my peace a week ago when Blake and David fought, but I couldn't help feeling I could have won if I tried a little more. As soon as I thought that, I chided myself. Everyone here has lost their match. Everyone gave their 100% and still lost. I can't be the only one feeling this. Besides, I don't think even I could have done any better than David. Sure, all my attacks are physical and could be fired from a safe distance away from his grasp. But Charles Kuret body is too perfect. He could have easily blocked all my attacks or heal himself. Our match would probably be long, but Charles would have the advantage of endurance.

Nathan says, David's has lost now. He has no way defending Charles now. He doesn't have time to recover enough to use his Kuret. He pauses for a second, He still gave a pretty good fight. I bet fighting someone like Heraknus

can make anyone lose their will. Its time for David to give up. I wanted to refute Nathan, but I couldn't find the words. He was arrogant and presumptuous, but not wrong. David has made some mistakes. He must be really be feeling the pressure of fighting someone doesn't know anything about.

Blake says, I know its looking a little bleak. But I know David can still pull out of this. Don't forgot, at times like this he pulls out some crazy shit. A title like Shadow strategist is the hardest one to obtain amongst the other shadows. Don't count him out yet. Blake was still confident. His faith on David didn't look even a bit shaken. It was admirable that he was loyal to his friend even now. Meanwhile, I almost gave up on David. I don't want to anymore.

Nathan looked like he wanted to say something. But he remained silent. Everyone were on the edge, trying to hold themselves from loosing hope. No one other than Blake offered any hopeful thoughts. We just sat here staring on the screen. Charles was nearly healed. David was now back on his feet and running somewhere right of Charles.

I mumble to myself, come on David. Don't give up. It was almost a silent prayer, which I hoped it would reach him.

# David (Chapter 8)

Monday, 7 February 2022 2:56 PM

Stupid. Stupid. Stupid. I kept saying it to myself as he ran to the debris. I can't believe I had no choice but to come up with this dump plan of throwing rocks at him. I am supposed to be one of the smart peoples in this island. Smart my ass. This whole fight I have been nothing but struggling. I kept attacking without any plan. I kept running away when I should have fought. And because of all my mistakes, I am stuck in such an unbelievable situation. I need to buy at least a minute to recover a some of my Kuret.

I see from the corner of my eyes that Charles was on my tail. He is much faster than me and will be on me in a few seconds. He is not even trying to pull his punch's and keeps attacking at my vital places on my body. He is aiming at my neck and head. He really is trying to kill me. He must know the rules of this tournament. Yet he attacks me with such dangerous intent. I don't even want to know what he might do to me without my Kuret to protect me.

I see that big boulder Charles has unearthed earlier coming closer. I hastily scanned for couple of rocks that were small enough to throw. Behind me Charles was gaining on me. I saw blue and a hint of red glimmers coming from him. He must have been getting agitated. He was totally calm in the beginning. But now he is getting annoyed. I also saw bunch of other glimmers coming out of me. Resentment, anger and pity. I didn't want to focus to much on that, because nothing good will come out now.

I found couple of rocks that could work. They looked like stones and were size that could fit in my palm. Two of them were fallen on the ground and three were stuck to the boulder. I reached the boulder and thrust my both my hands to dug them out. Two of them came out, but one was firmly stuck. I moved one to get the ones lying on the ground. Just as I picked those stones, I felt tremor from the ground. Charles was now close. My heart which had cooled down a bit was back to beating hard. If this doesn't work, I might be waking next in hospital. Or worse, not even wake up.

I have two stones in each hand. And I have only one chance. I need to attack both his eyes at the same time. I am never been an expert in hitting targets with small objects. I can do it with a gun, but never with my hands. Never needed to learn. I can't throw them from far and I definitely can't when he is on top of me. As I kept racking my brain for an answer, I hid behind the boulder obstructing Charles path. Dammit. What do I do. I ran all the probable ways to attack in my mind, but none worked. With the speed Charles is running towards me, the targets are moving constantly. The chances of hitting his eyes is very less. If his reflexes are good, he might even dodge them.

Suddenly the words speed and reflexes rang a bell in my mind. That's it. It was the only idea I thought of so I wasted no time in doing it. Charles was dangerously close. I faced to the boulder and looked for ways to climb up. Fortunately, I have been doing my fair share of mountain climbing. When I found few steps that could hold me, I climbed up. I need to be at least 7 feet above the ground. The tremors and red glimmer increased in the air. He is almost here. I jump a little and catch a spot of protruding rock with my wrists. It was insanely difficult to climb with stones in my hand. The root and loose soil slide as I pull my self up. I felt my elbows scratching from the larger rocks and cuts my skin. I bit my lip to suppress the pain. I can't stop now. I push myself from another spot.

I open my eyes and focus on to the ground. Somehow I made it to about 3 and half feet. That will have to do, because now I can hear Charles breath. He is just opposite to this boulder. Okay, the timing needs to be to the point. If I jump before he would see me coming. If I jump later, he will catch me. I listen to Charles strides and the glimmers slowing becoming larger. I was able to judge where he was coming from and how fast. I have only few seconds before he comes around from the left. This is it.

I waited for another 3 seconds and when then I let my instincts do the rest. I jumped off the boulder to the right side. In a fraction of second as I was hovering on top, my eyes flicker on the body of Charles coming into view slowly. He didn't see me yet. He had slowed down to a halt to turn to his left. I anticipated where his head might come from based on this height. I kept picturing what distance his eyes from the top of his head.

I was running completely on instinct as I pull my hands back in preparation to throw them to the point where his eyes would come in another half a second. His head slowly comes into my view now. This is it. Even with everything happening so fast, I could feel every heartbeat coming from my chest. Once my elbows reached as far as I could, I now pushed them forward. I aimed my fists to the place my instincts told his move to. I didn't have any thought to second guess. I throw those stones and they flew into that direction. Charles eyes now came into my view. His pupils turns to me hovering in air and I could see was about to leap in air. He pushed his legs into the ground to give him boast. He didn't even brought his tails of arms in front of him to defend against the stone. His mind must not have registered it. Or he didn't care. Whatever the reason, the stone flew towards his eyes unobstructed. I held my breath as I see the stone coming in contact to him.

I was only 1% sure this would work. But my eyes couldn't believe when one stone each from my fists hits the bullseye mark. They rocks were quite strong, but his eye socket was stronger. At the moment of contact, it broke into several little pieces and scattered around his eyes. His eye big lids came rushing down to protect, but the damage was done. Tiny pieces lodged into the edges of his eyes. His eyes now was closed.

I was about to crash against him. I put my elbows in front of me in cross shape as I prepared to land of the side of his torso. I hit his skin. It was damn hard. I felt the pressure on my elbows and abdomen. The Kuretines dug into my skins. I couldn't register pain because of all the adrenaline. The Kuretines slowly crushed and began fading after coming into contact. I may not have access to my Kuret, but even in my natural state, my body cancels Kuret.

Charles let out a big howl when I start to roll off from him. I was rolled sideways as his momentum kept him running forward. I tuck my head forward as I brace the impact of hitting the ground. My back lands on the ground first. I kept rolling to my left for few turns before I finally stop rolling and halt on my elbows. I hesitantly turn my head forward to Charles. He was now standing up on his legs and raising his fingers to his head completely forgetting those claws. The claws creates scratch marks he tried removing the dust and rock pieces lodged in his eye and eye lids. Upon realizing that his claws did even more damage, he lets out another big howl.

I almost let a laugh seeing my ridiculous plan worked. And Charles even hurt himself further. But I have no time to do that. I need to get away as far as possible from him. Where? This is an open field. If he opens his eyes for even a fraction of second he could see where I am running to. There is no place to hide. My eyes move to the boulder. Hold on. I do have a place to hide from his broken vision. The large hole in the ground he dug up to attack earlier.

I waste no time in getting up. I could feel that I had bruises all over my body, but the pain was for the moment pushed down for the moment. I ran to the opposite side of the boulder where Charles had thrown. It was a little far but I had become faster, completely taken over by the blood rushing into my legs and hips. Charles kept howling into the sky. So he can't heal his real body. This must buy some time.

I reached halfway to the big hole on the ground when there was another massive cry from Charles. Now I saw only red glimmer coming from his direction. His shout was different than others. I turn my head to check what was going on. His eyes were still closed but he was now on all fours. His tails stood up straight and he kept wagging it in the air. Brown Kuret came out from his body and starting circulating him. They kept swirling in a spiral pattern towards the top his tails. Suddenly those tails started to grow in length. They became longer and longer.

I realize what he was planning to do. I turned my head around and kept running. While I ran, I could see the glimmers of those tails beginning to cover the entire arena. Those glimmers were gaining height even as I get further away. There was another big howl. I am almost there. I didn't bother to check how close the glimmer of those tails were and became of them. All I knew I had to jump into that hole before they reach me. I heard a loud whooshing sound. I risked a little as I turn my eyes hesitantly back.

They were now the size of almost 8 story building and they generated so much sound when they swing in the air. The Kuret around them had dissipated. A moment later, those tail end gradually bend to the ground, in all four different directions. The tail ends began speeding and taggling along the rest of the behind like a snake flying the sky. Now that he was incapacitated for some time, he wants to catch me with those tails.

I was nearly there. I could feel the cracks underneath my feet caused from the epicenter of that massive ground displacement. And I saw a glimmer of one tail forming in behind me on the grass. Its coming right at me from above. Shit. The hold came into my view now. It was bare and damp inside. The hole was not deep, but it was wide and big enough to fit about couple of people easily. The broken roots and loose rocks were covered at the surface. I barely made it in time when I jumped off the edge of the hole and slide down on my back to the bottom. The roots and stones stuck on the uprooted surface bruise me all over my body.

But I managed to save myself from the tail that swept from the right and went to the left covering all the air above my head. I was breathing hard and fast. My mind and body was on overdrive. I had to make a conscious effort to calm down. It takes several seconds to slow down my body.

When I finally cool down enough, I inspect my surrounding. I was surrounded by debris of stones, roots and loose soil. The hole created by Charles was in a shape of nearly a bowl. I was lying near the edge of the bottom. I move my eyes to my body to check for any bleeding. I had cuts and bruises on my leg and arms. I could feel the blood color glimmer coming from my behind. I have few cuts there as well. My face was drenched in sweat. I had a couple of bruises on the sides of my neck. There was cut on the left side of my head. I closed my eyes to help me get over the wave of soreness flowing over my body.

My breathing slows down. When the adrenaline starts to leave, I began feeling the pain of those cuts. Fortunately, none of the them are dangerous enough of losing too much blood. My body felt a little tired now. Above me I heard Charles running around the ground and howling. His footsteps were now much heavier. So were his tails. They kept making loud noised as they swept through the entire field searching me. That means Charles is still blind. For now. I let out a small sigh and open my eyes. My chest started to beat less now after realizing I have bought some time.

Once my mind became a little free, I rejoiced that this actually worked. I can't believe my luck. I wanted to peak to the top and see how far Charles was, but I didn't want to risk it. From his footsteps and glimmer, he is far enough from me. Lets keep it that way for a while. After a moment my bliss crashed down when I realize the people in the coliseum saw my pathetic state. I don't have any style of fighting in any of my matches, but never I had to run and hide. I could imagine everyone reaction in the VIP room. Would they be feeling confused or shocked at me. I am myself ashamed. I should have never charged in with my dome without a plan. I let my anger control me.

I have never been in such a situation where I didn't have some sort of plan ever since I got my memories. At the very least I didn't do so many stupid things in the span of few minutes. From the moment Charles came crashing from the barrier I have been doubting myself and loosing confidence. Because of that I made mistakes. This thought made me recall a talk I had with Hanson back during my Shadow training.

I was with Hanson in a observation room above the training area. There were monitors and control panels for various battle situations and environment creations. We both were looking below from the glass pane where two people were training. One was a young 12 years old right Blake. He was training for his shadow attacker role. He was dressed in the standard shadow uniform, but he wasn't wearing a mask. His opponent was his predecessor. The most brutal shadow member and probably the worst Medrone I have ever met. But I didn't know his real identity at the time. He was wearing his mask. Only the Hanson knew who he really is. A shadow rule forbids revealing their identity to even other members. With the exception of the shadow strategist. Since Hansen choose me, I am having a rare position that allows me to know about others from my generations shadow members.

The training session was in its climax. Blake was fighting a veteran, the outcome was pretty obvious. Blake and I had formulated a plan for this training session. I remember he didn't trust me much since he had to reveal who he was, but I can't tell him about me. Yet after weeks of wariness, we began to develop some trust. We came up with various battle plans to help him prepare for today. In the beginning, was doing great. He kept a safe

distance from which he attacked. His Kuret didn't have the same control as today, so it was mainly bursts of straight Kurets thrown to the other guy. He was making good progress, but as expected, he couldn't match the experience of his opponent. He become slower and his attacks grew weaker. I had expected this, even if he has more stamina than most Medrones, he isn't used to fighting efficiently.

I already told him that it was impossible from him to win. All we could achieve is to make sure he didn't lose straight away. Blake kept attacking with his Kuret at his predecessor. Blake kept dodging the attacks sent back as a response. He was getting tired. But Blake didn't give up. He kept going, trying to at least land one attack on him. Hanson clicked on the microphone on the control panel and said, stop. This training session is now over. Blake completely ignored Hansen and went for another attack. That was a mistake. The next second he was thrown back far into the wall. His body limped as he fell back to the ground. I saw his hands moving as he laid on the ground, he is still conscious.

Then the worst guy in Medrone history spoke, brat. He said the training is over. We don't have a place in Shadows for arrogant kids who think they are above rules. One more shitty act like this and I might just kill you. You understand? Blake didn't respond. He continued, puny kid. He turns his back to him and starts walking to the door, and that performance was pathetic. I bet you and the that worthless kid planned those funny attacks. Let me tell you, if this the best you both came up with, you better run back to your mommies. This is not place for children who think they have a little modicum of talent. He said nothing else as he walked out.

I was furious at him. I wished I could have punched him. But that was impossible. He wouldn't need to raise a finger to kill me. I looked over Blake. He was still lying on the ground face forward. He probably has few ribs broken and a concussion to head. I moved to the stairs leading down to the training area. Hansen stops me, don't. Leave him for a while. I rebuked him, what. He needs help. He is badly injured. Hansen says, good. Then he understands the consequences of not listening. I couldn't believe what he was saying. I reply, that was totally uncalled for. Blake got a little carried away, but he didn't have to suffer so much for that one tiny thing.

Hansen pauses for a moment before saying, I understand kid. Believe me I do. But you need to let Blake understand for himself how his predecessor operates. They will be on missions on the field together. You need to let Blake understand the dynamic of their relationship. If you keep butting in, then Blake will never learn. That’s a not good for the mission. I ask, there is no relationship. That guy is a monster. He treats kids like they are worthless. I can never understand how such a guy became a shadow. If no one stops him, he might just end up killing Blake.

Hansen holds his palm up, that’s enough David. I understand your concerns, but you cannot speak such things out loud. He looks over to where he had exited, and not just because he is your senior. Even I don't know what he might do to you if he heard you say such things about him. Hansen then looks at me, you need to understand that every shadow was selected for a good reason. And its not for their personality. You need to learn that if are to replace me. He then speaks into the microphone, Blake, you did well for your fifth session. But you must learn from your mistakes. You let your emotions dictate your actions in a situation where it was not needed. You made a mistake. Until you realize that, you will not grow. He pauses for a moment, you are hurt. Tell me if you need help.

No response came from Blake. His royal pride didn't want him to accept help. After couple of seconds Hansen said, fine. You can lay there until you find your resolve and walk out to the med bay yourself. He closed the microphone. Blake didn't move a muscle. I could see he was still breathing erratically, he was conscious and listing but choose to lie there for some time.

I was still angry. I never predicted he would do something like this. If I had known maybe I could have warn Blake not to have such outbursts. Hansen saw me and says, its not your fault kid. You can't predict peoples reaction all the time. I reply, but isn't that my job. To understand how an enemy thinks and how to defeat them. I look over to Blake, I knew Blake couldn't beat him. I spent hours convincing him that it was enough to show his progress instead of trying to win. I told him from his previous training sessions it was that its pointless to try to win. So instead we came up with ways to make sure he doesn't get defeated early in match. I asked him to give up once he was out of moves. But he kept going. Why couldn't he just listen to me.

Hansen says, not everyone fight with logic. Your job isn't just to understand the enemy, but to know your allies too. You were convincing something impossible to Blake. He is a kid from royal houses. Surely you understand that having such a status means people are expecting great things from him. Blakes also knows this. People will not know about him being a Shadow. Yet he keeps pushing because he wants to show his strength and show he is worthy to his parents, to others and even to himself.

I say, and because of that attitude he is lying on the ground. He should have stick the plan and just given up when there was no chance of winning. Hansen shook his head, its not that easy. It sounds logically an easy choice to give up in the face of 100% failure. I think even Blake knew he wasn't going to win. But that doesn't matter. His heart defied that logic to continue fighting. I grew irritated, you don't need to quote human philosophy to me. Heart is an organ, it doesn't make decisions for us. Its just a simple metaphor people use it for excuse when they don't want to deal with explaining why they can't be rational. Its all here, I point to my head, all the emotions. Feelings. Logic. Neurons firing and making decisions. Everything can be controlled if their mind is strong. If Blake just had swallowed his pride, he would have not been beaten so many times. He kept doing the same mistakes.

Hansen, that’s where you are wrong. He didn't make the same mistake. That plan you helped him make, while it was complicated and difficult, Blake still learned it and used it. That shows that he understood who is was facing and he needed help from you to overcame it. And in part it worked. His moves were more refined and unpredictable than earlier. Blake lasted longer than any of his previous spars. I say, but that didn't change the outcome. He still got plumed into the ground when I explicitly told not to go overboard against him. I didn't wanted him to bleed out again this time. But look, he is now lying in the ground.

Hansen says, the outcome was never going to change. Blake couldn't let himself be constrained by that outcome. He keeps pushing and pushing his limits. I know what you think, there is no logical reason to do something that ends with the same result over and over. Hansen knew exactly what I was thinking. But that’s how some people live. He then looks at me, this even more true for us. Our actions has massive impacts on nations and other people. So we have to keep learning. Failure and mistakes are the best way to learn. Without knowing about yourself, you stop growing. You become weaker and you can't defeat your enemy. We have to constantly challenge ourselves, accept our mistakes and learn from it. You need to learn about peoples nature to help others do the same. And for that, you need start thinking not just logically, but with emotion.

I was listening to Hansen with great care. He is so much wiser than me, but I still wasn't satisfied, isn't my job to not make a mistake? You said it yourself, we have to do our jobs without any mistakes otherwise it would cause problems for all people. How can we make sure that our mission is successful all the time then? If I tell other Shadows to do something thing this way and instead they disobey me, how will we work together?

Hansen says, I think you have been misconceived what you are supposed to do with what you think you should do. You are not supposed to become someone who doesn't make mistakes. You are here to make sure that even if something goes wrong, you can still can fix it. Let me tell you something. There is no perfect win, no perfect mission, no outcome which is perfect. There will always be regret and second guessing. Not even I have had complete successful missions. There is always something nagging in my mind. Maybe I could have done this, then I wouldn't have to do that. With the impact our actions hold, its not a surprise that completing missions that have great implications are bulletproof.

Listen to me very carefully David, you will make mistakes. Great ones. Small ones. Some will be out of your control. Others will be because of your decisions. One day soon, you will face a big challenge. I don't know what form it will be, but all your strategies and tricks will not aid you. You will make mistakes then. Unless you can accept them and move on, you will be stuck. Doomed to repeat. Blake pushes ahead even after facing obstacles over and over because he wants to become more stronger as Blake, not as a Shadow.

I pondered on this. Becoming stronger as a person. I couldn't relate to that. Because I don't have anything else than being a shadow. I have no Kuret, no family, no bloodline house. I am literally no one. And that’s what drove me to join Shadow. Because I had no goals. No prospective of becoming someone great. Instead I had only one dream. I have only told Hansen about it. It was what I wanted to use for my final wish once I retire from Shadows. Hansen says, I understand its difficult for you to understand this. You will meet other Shadows soon. Their selection is almost done. In few weeks, all five of the next generation of Shadow will be chosen. And you have to lead them.

I was just a kid with no family, what did I know about responsibilities. I ask, why did you choose me. I still haven't gotten a proper reason from you. It can't be just because I am smart. There are plenty of smarter people to choose from. I don’t have even a little bit of Kuret. On the contrary, I cancel out Kurets with my touch. Then why did you choose me. I can't even do my job properly.

Hansen just stares at me as I had a meltdown. He slowly walks towards me, no. You are the best person for this. It doesn't matter you don't have Kuret. Its not what is needed or necessary to get the job done. He then places his hands on me, I choose you because of many reasons. I can't tell all of them now. But I think its time to tell you one of the reasons. I look up eagerly to him, I choose you because you know what it means to be powerless. You can't fight, but you found other ways to do with Kuretines. Only a person with great ingenuity can reach to where you are now. Right now you are inexperienced. But I can know someday you will grow into a person who just doesn't just plain, but will fight to execute it.

I let out a small laugh hearing this, you must be joking. I never thought you have such humor. I can never battle, not like Blake, or like you or other Shadows. I can only stand behind everyone and send them to fight. Hansen was quite for a while, maybe. But one day you will have to face something or someone on your own. I just hope that day you remember my advice. It is okay to stubble down now and then. You need to have confidence in yourself, not in your strategies. I tried my best to understand what he meant. I have never been with same people for long, so naturally I don't know much about peoples behavior. But I realize now that I have to consider people themselves when making a plan.

There was a movement below us. I looked over to the training area. Blake finally got up and starting walking. He was limping a little. He could move his right arm and used his left to hold by the elbows for balance. His left ankle was probably broken too. Even though it would take only few hours for him to heal, its still too excessive to attack on a kid like this. And this is not the first time him doing so despicable too. I resolved myself and made another personnel goal. Someday, I don't know how. I am going to kill that guy.

I open my eyes and I found myself temporarily disoriented. I looked over my surroundings, I was still in the pit. I got my bearing as I realize the predicament I am stuck in. Last year when I got my memories, they were not completely cogent. Since then, I have been able to recall them with clarity. Could Hansen secretly see the future? He was spot on when he said I would face something like this. He was correct, I kept making blunders and wrong choices ever since Charles came crashing in. I have been doubting myself continuously and lost confidence. All my battles were based on the faith I had in my strategies. What a self-reflection realization to know that I didn't have confidence in my own abilities once I am left without any plans.

My thoughts were interrupted with the tremors becoming stronger. Charles is nearby. My body tensed up as his foots step become closer. He couldn't have regained his sight so quickly, could he? About 45 seconds had passed since I hid. And I still haven't recovered my Kuret yet. I need to move out of the pit. I quickly dismissed that idea. What good will that do. If he can see, he will attack me as soon as I come out. I remained inside the pit hoping he is just passing by.

A moment later Charles body came into view. He came from the other side of the pit. His tails were still circulating the whole field. He was walking on all four limbs now. I hesitantly gaze to his forehead. I feel relieved to see he still has kept his eyes shut. He still can't see. Knowing that I immediately hold my breath. He will hear me if I keep breathing loudly instead. He had his head leaned forward and pointing is ears forward. I slowly place my left hand on my mouth. If I remain silent, he might move away.

Charles came closer to the pit slowing after checking the ground with his left hand. Shit. If he continues this path he might fall inside with me. Even if doesn't he will realize there is a perfectly hole in the ground from me to hide. I have to send him away. I turn my eyes around the ground my body is hugging. I found a small rock near to my right. I slowly move my right hand to pick it up. Charles took two more steps towards the pit. I pulled back my arm as slowly and silently I could and throw it to above to my left. I wanted Charles to run a little farther away so I had to throw it with much force.

I waited patiently for the stone to hit the ground. Meanwhile Charles was just a foot away from the edge. If he takes one more step he will sense the hole. Just when he is about to put his left arm forward, we hear a small enough thump in the ground. Charles immediately turns his head towards the noise. A second later he turns and starts running to the source. When he was far enough, I remove my hand and took in a big gulp of air. Too close.

Almost a minute and half now and I still can't use Kuret. Crap. Hansen's voice remained fresh in my mind. He was right, I need to accept my decisions. I have made a fool out of myself. More so, everyone have seen me failing and running away. I can't change that. But I can stop being resentful. I have to remove all doubts if I am going to win now. I have to have faith in me that I will find a way to beat him. I tighten both my fists in anger. I should have kept my distance but also fought him. Running away continuously just made Charles dominate this match further.

I don't have strategies or plans. I don't know any weakness Heraknus Kuret have. But what I can do is keep trying. Its going to be trail and error from here on out. If I can't fight the usual way, then there is only way. I hated myself for recalling that worst guys advice. But I am desperate. He is without a doubt the most despicable Medrone ever to have born, but he was the strongest Medrone when he was alive. I smile a little at that thought, correction, I thought he was the strongest, but clearly Heraknus were alive then. That helped to accept his advice. Fight like your enemy, become your enemy and then destroy your enemy.

If my usual tactics of fighting opposite to my opponents can't beat Charles, then I have on choice to fight like he does. Rely on pure strength completely. That means I need to up my game. The glaring weakness I have is my inability to have physical attacks continuously. I need to learn how to do it. This made me recall James. He used to say that a battle is just like a training. Only different is that if you don't learn quickly and use it to your knowledge in the fight, you will die. That is so true here.

For the first time since the match started, I began to feel a little hope. Hope that I even if I keep failing and have no real plan, I will still have enough confidence to continue fighting.

# David (Chapter 9)

Wednesday, 9 February 2022 1:46 PM

Almost a 2 minute passed since my retreat. I still don't have access to my Kuret. I should have been able to use at least a little bit. I don't know why I can't. I know I used the dome too haphazardly just now, but I didn't keep it up for too long. Just about a minute. My body should have recovered enough now. I raise my arms and try to summon a bit of Kuret. Nothing. Its like I am blocked. What's the hold up?

I look up into the sky. I began feeling a little despair. I know I made a self resolve to not give up, but I couldn't help feeling irritated. How in the hell am I supposed to fight Charles with power that matches his strength. I know I can tip the scales in my favor once I use the Kuret sphere. But I don't have the time to pull that off. I can't pull another premature decision to use that. I have to use it when the time is right. For now, I need way to bring the match and even our odds first.

I gave another try. I close my eyes and focus on my instincts and praying to pull out at least a Kuret size of my palms. I open my eyes. I am staring at vacant air. Dammit. What's going on here. Any second Charles will be able to see again. The same trick work twice again. If he finds me in this state, doesn't matter what I do, I am done. Suddenly I realize something, wait. I start at my arms and then to my legs. What if my body is not the issue. It could be phycological. I understand what's going on. I have the yips !

My last tussle with Charles has made me unconsciously scared of him. I blasted him with so much Kuret, but he just walked it off. He later healed himself, and all that effort I made was for nothing. Not Derek or Blake were came back after that attack. Its no wonder that I am nervous fight him. I never thought I would have to overcome such a mental block. This never happened to me ever since we left from the valley four years ago. In spite of such a set back, a small laugh came out from my lips. My list of problems keeps getting longer. When I finally made my mind to fight however I can, I am too scared to do it.

Technically, I know what I need to do to get over this. I need to confront Charles head on. Buts that’s a stupidity on a whole other level. I need to find a way to make my Kuret physically materialize without having a backlash. With all the research I have done, I still couldn't find away to do it. The main problem remains that my Kuret is a complete mystery. There is no mention of a black Kuret than cancels out Kuret. It makes it harder to develop my powers. That’s why I have been copying others. Except for my combat knowledge, all my Kuret abilities have been a derivative of others. With the exception for the Kuret sphere, I have no fundamentals of my own that I can use regularly.

Two and half minutes passed. Still no sign of Charles. This is getting dangerous now. Any moment he will come looking for me in this hole. He is already scouring the entire field with his tails. I sighed. His tails can be augments to increase size and length. Not just the tails, but the arms too. Its not surprising if he can change his legs too. All he needs to do is pour more Kuret into it. Suddenly I eyes widen and jaw open a little when I realize something about Charles Kuret.

His Kuret is also not like others. His brown Kuret wraps around him like a mini tornado hugging his body and he stays in the eye of it. I began recalling all the time he healed himself. The first time when we clashed, I was somehow able to blow away a portion of his chest. When he started healing himself, he never kept his Kuret still. He kept it moving around his torse in a circular fashion. Every other Medrone I have seen heal or use Kuret for attacking doesn't need to keep their Kuret moving continuously. Their Kuret just sort of takes different shapes and sizes. Once it gains enough Kuret mass it becomes dense. Charles isn't doing that.

It was like my soul had been invigorated. I feel I am on to something very important. I began recalling all the times he healed or used Kuret to change his claws, arms or tails. Every time he used his Kuret, it was never still. I don't know if it’s the nature of his Kuret or if he is control it that way. Whatever the reason, the Kuret never remains still. When he was attacking me with barrage of fists, he was flowing his Kuret from his arms into his hands. Instead of directly wrapping his hands in Kuret, he had to move Kuret from his chest. When he made he arms and tails bigger, the Kuret flowed around his torso in a spiral form to the ends. When he heals, a lot of other parts of his body are wrapped in Kuret, even the parts that were unaffected. Same thing happened when he made his tails the length of a building.

His Kuret doesn't come out of the place he attacks or heals. It flows into from other places. It never remains still. Always moving and coalescing into a stronger form. So strong that it becomes real enough to become physical. I have been basing all my abilities from seeing others. Mainly copying Blake because our Kurets are similar in nature. But now I think its not enough. Blakes can maintain his Kuret in space without further effort. I can't. Neither does Charles.

Okay, now I am getting somewhere. My Kuret dome basically increases the density of my surrounding, but its cost too much energy and stamina. If I can somehow make my Kuret also move constantly, then maybe I don't need to exhort to create much pressure to make my Kuret physical. The problem is I have never be able to move my Kuret in such a tight manner around me. Its too erratic to be controlled so accurately. I can give it shape and direct it wherever I want, but the shape is arbitrary. Its like a fire. I can control the speed, direction and amount. Never its shape.

I need to be able to shape it into spinning Kuret and then group them together to give shape. Such a fine control has been out of my grasp. As I went through my thoughts I kept picturing Charles Kuret. I made another realization, Charles is pulling out Kuret from all his body. The amount depends how far it is from his target, but he definitely pulls out Kuret from entire body. He has to be bringing out small amount of Kuret from all his body, then grouping it together as it swirls around him and finally it becomes strong to become physical to replace the damaged parts.

I stare at the sky above me. This is way too much complicated for me at this moment. Even if this theory is correct, its not like I have the time to practice it. I can release Kuret from my entire body. I can even control the amount I release. But making it move around my body instead out in the air is very difficult. I don't even know where to start. I have always pulled in Kuret back into me before releasing it from the different part of my body. I don't have a clue on how to keep it floating on me. Its became a habit of mine to pull it back in before releasing another blast. There is a push and pull nature of my Kuret. Making it stable was completely unattainable.

My mind went on wild run trying to figure this problem. I was so much engrossed that I didn't realize the ground was shaking little. I was to too late to do anything. The soil was trembling on my left. The roots and rocks starts to get loose and slide down. A moment later the shaking becomes to much and with blast noise, the soil broke with a force. A long brown Kuritine edged rope came out from the ground. Charles tail. I was so much engrossed in my thoughts that I didn't saw the glimmers from his tails coming closer to me. I tried to get away, but the tail already sweeping the whole from the left side and making its way to me.

His tail made contact before I could run away. Upon contact, the tails starts to bend and began twisting around my legs swiftly. It was too long and fast for me to get away. His tail had completely gripped my legs. I wrapped my fingers on the tail trying to pull it out away. But it was too strong. How is he touching me? My body naturally cancels out Kuret. I focus on the back of the tail. I could see brown Kuret flowing from the end where it came out from the ground. He is continuously pouring Kuret into the parts in contact with me.

I kept trying to pull it away, hopping he can't maintain his Kuret on me for long. I need just one second to get away. Unfortunately, I didn't get that. The tail suddenly drags me in the air above me by the legs. I am being dragged out of the ground straight up with my arms dangling beneath my head. I see the world upside down. The ground was up and sky was below me. My hair was falling away from my head. Pretty sure even if I was standing on my feet, they would have stood up straight from the fear I am feeling right now.

I saw Charles standing at some distance on his legs. All his tails were buried into the ground. Huh? It took me second to locate his eyes. They were partially open. He must have realized I was hiding inside the ground and used his tail to search inside now. He kept me locked in the air at some height. He let out a loud howl and the tails that were buried started to pull out from the ground. The tails broke the surface, leaving big scars on the grass. All the soil were uprooted along its length. The ground looks like a spider web. Each crack was deep. How much strength does this guy have to make cause so much destruction.

The other tails fly toward me. I try to wriggle my way out before they attack me. I concentrated to pull out Kuret. Even a little is enough. Nothing happened. God damn yips. How can I fight if I am so scared now. It was too late, the tails were now in front of me. I am like a fish stuck dangling on the rope and 3 sharp harpoons are going to run me through. I close my eyes in response. A moment later I felt the tails reaching me. But they didn't pierce me. I open my eyes. He was wrapping the other tails on me. One tail slither on my arms and wrap them. Then it pulls to up behind my back. One tails began wrapping my torso to bind my arms behind me. The other one wraps me by the chest.

I became completely immobilized after a while. All the tails were pulling in Kuret from Charles continuously to keep it from weakening. The tails began dragging me forward. Charles is pulling me in. I have no chance of dodging this one. Blood is rushing into my brain as I was upside down. Pressure increased inside my ears. The wind now pricked my face as Charles increased the pace. I can't use my Kuret and now I can't run away.

I have about few seconds before he pulls close enough to do whatever he plans to do. My thoughts went on lightening speed. I don't want to give up, I have already accepted the bad choices I made. I don't want to loose after coming so far. I cannot be defeated like this. Think. Think. I have to be missing something. A way. A trick. Anything to gather my Kuret from my body. I saw Charles body becoming bigger now as I flew close. He had his hands raised in front, ready to attack me. No. No. Come on, think David. What am I missing? I moved my eyes away from Charles in nervousness and stared down to the sky. I saw the tails wrapped on me. I haven't seen it this close with his Kuret before. The Kuret was disappearing from being in close proximity to me, but before it did I saw some bits of Kuret were clashing and overlapping each other as they move.

I had assumed Charles Kuret was completely in sync, but looking so closely I saw his Kuret was not always moving together. A huge portion of his Kuret was flowing randomly. Some even broke off the path and vaporized into air. Like sparks of fire from burning a wood. An idea came into my mind. Maybe the extra blood to my head invertedly helped me think. I moved my eyes back to Charles. I didn't focus how many seconds I had. I yelled out a war cry. I don't want to give up now. And I don't need to be scared anymore now that I have found a way.

As soon as my resolve strengthened, I felt the spark of Kuret returning to me. I gave no thought enjoying its return, instead I released a tiny bit of Kuret from my entire body. I focused on releasing it only for a fraction of a second and then will it to be pulled in back. I never tried pushing and pulling it back so tightly, but somehow I was able to manage it. The Kuret begin pulling back, before it touched my skin and force it again out from the same spots. Again I pull it back in before it stretches further. This was so weird. It like I was stretching a rubber band. Somewhere in the back of mind I was hoping that the tails would become loose. But Charles had been pushing incredible amount of Kuret into them. It would take my full blast to remove them. I haven't recovered enough to do that. I have no choice to make this work.

I gave it a couple more rounds. Come on. On the sixth try I finally felt something. My Kuret didn't felt like pushed or pulled. It was vibrating furiously up and down on my body. Its almost as if its dancing on my skin. Its creating spikes when it extends and hollows out at the bottom. This happens too fast and its impossible to see with the eyes or the glimmers. I could only feel it. At last. I put every bit of brain power I could muster and focus on moving it to my face. I imagined how Charles uses his Kuret. I willed it to move the same way. It didn't happen. All it did was made me loose few parts of the stable Kuret on my body. Dammit. I can't use the same way as Charles. I have to figure out what suits my body.

Times up. I was face to face with him now. The only thing of me he hadn't wrapped with his tail was my face. And that’s where he planned to smack his claws with. He really is trying to kill me. In the last second I open my jaw and once again let out a cry. Charles claws was now coming right at my face. My mind went blank in that moment. I didn't know what compelled me to do it, I released the Kuret I have been holding it. In that split second, all the Kuret over my body began running wild. They formed into a thin Kuret threads and were running around my body like electricity. There was no synchronization or pattern. Every Kuret thread moved around a random direction.

What's shocking is that even in that frenzy state, they were actually heading in the same direction. To my face. It was pure instincts, there is no reason or logic on I how am able to do this. The threads were coming from different paths from my body, however, they somehow culminated at the same point at my forehead. The threads combined on my temple and it started to become thicker and darker. In that second my whole face was covered with my Kuret. Charles claws struck my face once I had dawned a Kuret mask.

I thought I was done for. Even with this last minute miracle, the Kuret wouldn't be strong enough to defend from getting my head crushed. I felt incredible pressure when his claws came with in full contact. Somehow the Kuret formed on face was still holding. Not just that, the Kuretines on the claw immediately broke when it touched my Kuret. I may be imagining but I swear I could see his cracks forming on the skin. They spread back further his wrists up above this arm.

Meanwhile, I was being pushed back from the force of the attack. I could feel the pressure on my face. But he never made touched my skin. His hands were definitely on my head. Is this really happening? My Kuret is actually dense enough to protect me from his attacks. And I am not even using my usual Kuret dome. I didn't have the presence of mind to enjoy this momentous victory. I was still wrapped to the tails and now starting to swing backwards into the air. I didn't want to be a punching sandbag for his next attack.

Once I swung back far enough and his claw left my face, I focused to compel the Kuret I gathered to move over the rest of my body and cut those tails. My Kuret complied, but the not way I thought it would. I thought the condensed Kuret would just slide to rest of my body. Instead it split into those sperate threads again. They move in random direction from my head down to my neck. What the hell. Good news, my Kuret didn't fall back inside our away from my body. Bad news, they are swarming in all random frenzied directions. I saw Charles preparing to attack me from his other hand.

No way in hell I let him hit me again. I can probably gather the Kuret again on my face, but I would be stuck here defending myself continuously. Been there, done that. Will not repeat that same mistake again. I came up with a crazy idea. The Kurets running around my body were not strong enough to be dense. They can still work on his tails though. I yelled out once more and willed them to go faster. My Kuret listened to me and the threads sliding on my body ran faster.

My body felt like it was run over by ropes of electricity. Some were twisting around my arms or running in circles on my chest. Soon my legs were wrapped with circular disks too. I start to descend forward after reaching a certain height. Charles was ready to throw his other punch. Come on, hurry. My Kuret ran rampant on my body. Their speed was crazy fast. Even I could only track some of them. The next second I could feel the tails loosening. Hell yeah.

I kept focusing on my Kuret to go faster and wilder. The tails began to shrink. Even with the support they got from Charles continuously pouring Kuret, my Kuret was dominating. I could wiggle my arms a little now. My legs were becoming loose from the grip. I starting flexing my shoulders and clenched my teeth as I push my arms out. I came dangerously close to his other punch. Just before his claws reached my face, I came loose. The momentum of my fall carried me forward and I slip down towards earth. I saved my head, but now his claws were aimed at my chest. Coincidently at my heart.

I mentally force my Kuret running rampant to gather on my chest. This is going to hurt, but its better than having a hole. Because I had been making my Kuret faster, they gather up almost twice as fast earlier. I barely made it in time when the claws came in contact to my chest. I felt my lungs being crushed by a large rod poking on my chest. My skin starting throbbing. But just like before, there was only pressure. No physical contact to my skin. No bruise. No blood. The Kuret formed on my chest was shaped like a shield. Part of an armor. It was wide covering the area of my chest that came in contact with his fist and at the same time it was strong.

Same thing happened to Charles this claw as earlier. The Kuretines didn't get to make a scratch on me before disintegrating. This time, his fingers were broken and cracks went back into his up his arms to elbows. But the force remained unchanged. Without the tails keeping me stable, Charles is pushing me with tremendous force. My arms and legs float ahead of me as I am hurl backwards into the sky. I was knocked at least 15 feet above ground. My back of the face felt the wind kissing as I am fly away. I still am inverted and I see Charles moving higher and smaller from my view.

A few seconds later, the Kuret I had gathered dispelled. I consciously forced them to not come back inside me. So they now keep circulating my body. Their speed had reduced but at least they are still here and stable. I am not out of the woods yet. My body is in a bad position. The wind pressure is making it difficult me to extend my arms and cause resistance to slow down. If this goes when I hit the ground, I might break my spine. I started to descend backwards into the ground now. I roll my eyes above and see the ground approaching fast. I gather the Kuret threads to my back to form a shield. My back instantly gets covered by Kuret.

No. Its not big enough. I was able to only cover my lower back. But the rest of my back is exposed. With this much speed, I can't break my fall with so little Kuret. I see the ground coming closer now. Momentum and gravity tilted my body and rotated me with my back to the ground. My hands and legs were wriggling in air uncontrollably. I had my teeth clenched bracing for an impact. No, I can't let the impact to happen. The fall will break several bones.

I came up with another idea from my bag of miracles. I willed my Kuret strapped on my back to pull me up. I should be able to push my Kuret forward now that it is solid and powerful enough to give me physical support. I close my eyes and focused on that single command. I order my Kuret to push me up. I began feeling a resistance forming behind me. Its working. Its slow and weak, but its working. I don't have enough Kuret yet to give it more boast. I could feel I am about the ground in the next second. I yelled to give one last big push to my Kuret.

With a sudden jerk, my Kuret pushed me up. My arms and legs swing down a little from the upward force. It was enough to counteract the gravity and for a split moment, I was just hovering in the air. I hastily pulled swung my arms forward to momentum to my legs. In the last second, my legs straightened out and I came crashing down to earth. My balance was skewed, so I crouched my head forward and wrap my arms around my face. I summersaulted on my back as I rolled on the ground.

Finally I stop after a turn on my back. I was dragged a little forward from the fall. Soon I came to a complete stop. I let go of my arms and let them fall into the ground. I was facing the sky now. My arms and legs lazily rested. My breath was ragged. I am breathing from my mouth. Adrenaline was pumping my heart to the limit. My mind finally slowed down from the intense minute that I just went through. I know I shouldn't be resting, but I wanted a couple of seconds to myself. A laugh came from my mouth as I finally was able to enjoy my new powered up Kuret.

# David (Chapter 10)

Wednesday, 9 February 2022 10:08 PM

My bliss came to a sudden halt when I heard a howl from Charles at some distance. Come on. Can't I get couple of few more seconds to rest. I turn my head above to see what he was up to. His tails were waving in the air. The parts that I broke free from were healing now. I thought I cut completely them before. I must have instead only made them smaller and light enough to escape. He was also pouring his Kuret onto his hands to heal the broken fingers and cracks.

I push myself above from the ground. I had new bruises and lesions over by body. But none which I can't handle. My Kuret was still running wildly on my body. I finally get to inspect them closely. I raise my palm closer to my eyes. The Kuret threads were like electricity running around my body only a couple milli centimeter above my skin. They were floating in complete random directions. And somehow they never intersected each other at any point. When I focus on one particular thread I could make a circuit. It was not totally random. The total movement are random, but the individual Kuret threads had some pattern.

They were quick like lightening and thick like fire. Both the ends were capped off abruptly. And I could feel that those threads themselves were vibrating. They behaved like the water surface that was ran through a earthquake. They formed irregular spikes with varied size and height. Yet they maintained shape. I felt like a child seeing candy for the first time. I have never seen my Kuret doing this. I somehow have been able to change the nature of my Kuret. That should have been impossible. You can change size, color, shape, type and power of a Kuret. But never its nature. In this regard my Kuret is even much unique and weirder than Heraknus.

But I have notices few limitations with this. First, I can't keep the Kuret together for long. Second, I can't move it together. I still have to break it into threads and gather it in another place. I sigh, I changed the nature of my Kuret, yet I still have movement issue. On the plus side, I can now shape my Kuret into physical entity without taxing too much on my body. I can share the burden with mental effort now. I can also make shape my Kuret incredibly fast.

I turn my hand into fist and try to pull out more Kuret. Nothing changes. Damn. So I can only use this much amount to fight for a while. I look up to check on Charles. He is healed up now and ready to face me. The glimmer around him now had strands of pink. Confusion. I couldn't help stop from laughing a little. I bet he wasn't expecting this. I know I wasn't. Charles uses his tails to attack this time. His large tails were now pointing at me and speed up to me.

I would be sweating to face this ten minutes before. Not anymore. I have to stall for time to recover my Kuret completely. And I have confidence that I can do it. The tails came together in my direction. His tails are a big problem. He can fight from a distance as long he has such long tails. While I can only fight in close proximity temporary. I should cut his tails off first. I raise my arms and brace myself. I will gather my Kuret in my right arm and cut the tails. It will take time for them to grow. I would then use that time to sprint across to Charles and fight hand to hand.

The tails were now speeding up and wrapped with Kuret to boast their durability. When I saw the brown Kuret swirling on those tails I realize something. He is constantly pouring Kuret into the tails. That means he is wasting Kuret. He might have huge amount of Kuret, but its not unlimited. There has to be limit. He already used so much to make his tails longer. Now he is constantly coating them with his Kuret. This is the perfect chance to let him exhaust his Kuret supply as much as possible.

This is the solution to all my problems. I have been a little hesitant to fight him so early after just learning and using my new technique. I have to get some practice before I use it on him. And the more I chip away his tails, the more Kuret he use to heal up. I went into a defensive form for now. The tails come at from above. I waited at the last second to gather my Kuret at my right side of my waist. Kuret gathered there at a lightening speed. I made it push me to my left just as the tails fly by my side. All right, I have more mobility now.

The tails bend and curve back to me a second later. I make my Kuret to gather at my abdomen now. A black cover forms in front of me and I push myself back. I am testing how far and how fast I can make my Kuret move me. Since I had used very little Kuret, I didn't have much speed. However, it was enough to be ahead of the tails. I was counting the seconds in my head when the Kuret broke into pieces and my escape came to a sudden halt. I have a rough estimate how much fast I can move.

The tails were gaining on me. I have tested horizontal movement. How about vertical displacements? I have been wondering for a while ever since I stopped my fall. In theory I should be able use my Kuret as a boost and jump high. I gather Kuret on my back. When the tails were close enough, I bend my knees and swing my arms to jump in the air. My timing was little off with my Kuret and I was thrusted into the air much earlier than I actually wanted to jumped. However, I wasn't to much bothered because I had jumped about 6 feet from the ground and passed over the tails from above. I began my fall down now. This time I focused on my timing. I moved my arms and legs in appropriate position before pulling my Kuret behind me. The result was similar to have created a cushion under my feet as the force slowed me enough to land safely on ground. I stumble a little forward when my legs hit the ground. I need to practice my jumping and landing timings more.

The tails curved again towards my back now. I tried pulling out more Kuret from my body. No dice. Come on. I don't have the yips anymore. Nor am I bothered with the mistakes I made early in the fight. So its definitely not a mental block. So there really was a physical issue also with my Kuret access. Maybe I have blown a short fuse. I kept thinking for reasons, but the four spears heading to me jarred me out of it. The tails now changed positions. Two came from top and other two from below. And now Charles had spread them far apart. He plans to block me if I move or jump out of the way.

Well, since I can't dodge them, I have no choice but to fight them. I pull Kuret into my right hand. This is my first time gathering Kuret into any of my limb. The Kuret throws sparks around my arm, travelling from different paths from my body. I wore my Kuret like a boxing glove now. It was small and only covered till my wrist. But it was strong. Stronger from any previous ones I have shaped my Kuret into. I could feel the vibrations coming off it. I knew it was there, but never felt it with my fingers before. It sort of have a tingly feeling. I was a little curious as to how it feels when I touch it. I don't have time for that.

The tails came close to me. The best place to jump is in the middle. I removed the Kuret in my hand and gathered it on my back me to give a boast. I turned my hands to a fist and dove into the gap of the four tails. I tuck my elbows together and summersaulted forward. I land on my back and roll forward. In a swift posture I stand up and pushed me again to one of the tails moving ahead. I quickly catch up to the one on the right. I raised my right hand forward and gather the Kuret there. I slowed down a bit since I removed my Kuret from by back, but I had enough momentum to reach my fist to the tip of the tail.

The moment my Kuret filled fist struck the Kuritine, it crumbles into pieces. Surprisingly I didn't feel any resistance from the Kuritine. I think it broke even before I could apply any pressure. I stop moving in the next second and stood staring at the Kuret in my hand as it broke into threads and resumed its random circulation. The vibrations, I guessed. They are so minute and fast that the edge of the surface has become like a small version of a saw. That’s why Charles hands started cracking instead of just shrinking in size.

I look above to the Kuritine I destroyed. Charles had already begin healing it. He had that hovering it still for a while. Ahead, the other 3 tails came at me. This time however Charles made them come from different angles on the ground at the same level. He is now limiting my escape options. Well I could just jump away in the air. But Charles has seen me do it. If I jump and the forth tail comes at me when I am floating in air, that will be troublesome. I was anyway not interested in doing that. I wanted to try something after I realized about the vibrations.

I gather Kuret again on my right fist. I join my left palm to the side of the fist making a pose of Karate. I was little tensed thinking that the surface would cut my palm. But I didn't feel any pain. I was mentally relieved knowing I didn't hurt myself. Don't know why I thought my own Kuret would hurt me. Now that I have joined my two hands I focus on moving my Kuret from my right to left hand. If I am correct about this Kuret nature, then any part of my body can allow the Kuret threads to travel as long it is connected physically. So joining my hands should work the same.

I was rewarded when my theory worked. The Kuret from my right started breaking into threads and flowed into my left. There were black sparks as they crossed the small gap between them. Those sparks didn't join other threads and instead gets absorbed back into my skin. I guess even a millimeter of gap is enough for some Kuret to lose their perpetual continuation and fall back inside me. However, most moved successfully moved. Once I saw almost halved moved. I pull apart my hands.

I should have done this when I don't have three spears coming at me. The Kuret in both my hand became unstable. I tried focusing to keep it going. My Kuret refused. The Kuret on both my hands began fluctuating. They broke into pieces and then join back. The sparks from them also began to increase. I am loosing Kuret. But I have to learn to use Kuret from more than just one place. I would be at a serious disadvantage if I only have one area of Kuret gathered when I fight Charles. The tails are closing in on me.

Come on. The Kuret on my hands were in no mood to listen to me. Some of the Kuret at the edge broke away from the rest and ran back into my arms and continued its motion. My eyes widen. I understand now. I am not used to have two different areas covered in Kuret yet. How about I start small then? I release the mental pressure I had kept from breaking apart. The Kuret on the edges of my arm slowly began chipping off and they ran back up my arm. I kept looking for the optimum amount which I could manage. Finally I felt this would be enough.

What remained were just my fingers. All my ten fingers were wrapped in Kuret which were stable. Is this a joke? What the hell can I do just with my fingers. I had no time to think. The tails reached me. Huh, fine. Lets try this. I grouped all my fingers together extending them straight. I raise my arms in opposite directions. Just when the tails came close I twisted my hips as fast as I could. Imagine my hand like a knife. I targeted the closest tail first. My right palm slashed the Kuritine into tiny pieces. I didn't had to apply much force since I already knew my Kuret is stronger. I crouch down as the rest of the tail pass over my head.

The second closest one came from my right. I push my right hand into the ground to support me as I half cartwheeled and swung my left hand from the top. I aimed by palm to smash it from top to bottom. Once I destroyed that, I fall on my right side on the ground. The tail harmlessly flew above my bent knees. The third one changed position as it saw my lying on the ground. It initially went up and gained some height. Then it came down at high speed aimed to my face.

I could dodge it if I gather my Kuret on my back and pull me away. But then I would loose the Kuret in my hands. I need to make my body and mind used to this feeling so later I can fight with more than just one limb. So I extend my arm above my head, prepared to catch it as soon as it comes near. Unnecessary risk, a rational part of me thought. True. But I was confident. I didn't want to waste this resolve. I took in a little breath when the tail came at me.

I caught the tail just in time. My Kuret broke the Kuritine even before I gripped it tight with my hands. After a second the portion of the tail I had caught disintegrated. Charles pulled out his tail back before I could do further damage. I take no time in getting up and looking at the tails positions now. With all the tails Kuretines destroyed, more Kuret was being poured into the ends. The one which I destroyed first was already healed. But Charles didn't use it to attack. He kept it hovering in air while he worked on healing the others.

I have been thinking for a while, why is he choosing to use such a long tail. He used it to drag me out from the pit, but what's the point having such long tails chase me now ? Why doesn't he shorten it back to its original size. Won't that save him so much Kuret and energy. Is there a reason he can't? I realize that must be it. All the time he made parts of his body big, he didn't change back immediately. Or rather he couldn't. I have been blasting Kurets at him that time. So my Kuret had chipped off the excessive Kuret. He then heals them back to their normal size.

But why doesn't he cut those tails himself? He can regrow them to their normal size. The answer came to me when he said earlier that their bodies can't absorb Kuret during battle. If he cuts those tails, he will loose a lot of Kuret that will just turn into ambient Kuret in air. Its much better to use them instead of removing it. He must have thought I would keep trimming it away during the battle. That also explains why he is attacking me with his tails and not directly confronting me. He wants me to cut it off piece by piece. That way his extra Kuret isn't wasted, it would be traded off for wasting my energy.

That means if I keep destroying only his Kuretines he would keep healing it repeatedly. This would definitely be a problem if I was running scared and no idea what to do. But now I feel like my body was rejuvenated with new power, so I didn’t feel as tiered as earlier. As for my stamina, as long as I don't exhaust my body with too much energy, I should be okay. Then all I have to do is keep breaking those Kuretines until I am able to gather more Kuret than just my fingers. I can practice more. I am sure James is laughing from his grave that I took his silly quote to heart.

The Kuret in my fingers were gathered for too long. I didn't even notice when they broke and turned to threads spinning back into my arms. I try to squeeze out some more Kuret from my body. But nothing came. I grew a little worried. What's the deal. Its been almost 3 more minutes since I pulled my Kuret out. I should have recovered and been able to pull some Kuret out. I wonder what's going on with my body. My thoughts were interrupted with loud noise.

Charles let out a big howl now. I saw the glimmers around him. There was no blue anymore. There were shades of violet and red in the mix. He is slowly becoming mad. I turn to see the tails. All of them healed and Charles got ready to attack me again. My mind went into alert when Charles does something different. He wrapped the end of the tails together. The tails wrap each other, turn for a while and then stops. Charles had now clubbed his Kuritines spears together. He intends to give his attacks more effective by combining them.

The tails more forward in unison. They were in complete sync and were identical to the same speed as one tails. Charles was aiming at me from above. What should I do now? Dodge or fight. How about a third option to defend myself. I have already felt Charles punches. Twice. I barely was able to defend then. I need to be able to defend against him later. I conjure my Kuret in front of my chest. The Kuret threads run to my front and joined to form a shield. This shield is smaller in size than others. I did loose some Kuret when I tried to use it on my hands. I just hope this is enough to block the tails.

I tightened my fist and raise them slightly forward ready to take in the blunt of the attack. I stiff my legs in the ground. I take in a deep breath and clench my teeth just before the tails struck me. The Kuretines cracked and shattered almost immediately. But the sheer force was enough to push me back. The tails didn't stop and continued to drag me on the field. I felt the pressure on my chest, like it is poking a big heavy metal rod to me. Yet the Kuret didn't broke. It was blocking the four Kuritines from puncturing wound on my skin. The strength of the collision vibrated to my lungs and I gasp out loud.

I was being dragged much further away now. Charles isn't stopping. He is keeping up the pressure. The end of the tails that was pushing me were cracking on the surface and disappearing. Damn, Charles planned this to shorten his tails. Charles had kept his tails curled up at some places. So I can't tell how much of the tail has been shortened. I to buy some more time. I willed my Kuret on my chest to push me away towards right. I felt the tug from my chest that pulled me out of the tails attack path. I stumble and use my legs to get my bearing as I stop. The tails kept going ahead with its momentum.

The Kuret on my chest lost its stability and it broke into pieces. I sigh, that was close. Any second longer and I would have had to take the blunt of that attack without the Kurets protection. This was good experiment. I now know that once my Kuret is gathered, its insanely strong. As long as it is stable, I can withstand virtually any attack thrown at me. Both physical and Kuret attacks. Although, I still have to feel the force behind those attacks. I think I have a way to take on those crazy attacks without getting pushed back. But I need to be able to use multiple Kurets shaped at the same time. I don't have either the experience or the Kuret to do that right now.

The tails turn back to me. Even though I have shortened the tails a little bit, it was still long. The Kuritines starts to regrow. I raise my left arm and gather the Kuret in my hand. I have to understand this new ability of mine. I have been seriously lucky to have survived this long against a Heraknus alpha. My luck will soon or later run out. I join my right hand to my left fist. Its maybe a good thing I can't pull out more Kuret. I have a tough time maintaining Kuret in both hands with just some Kuret. I probably can't maintain shape will all my Kuret. Perhaps that’s why I can't release more Kuret. I need to first learn and control this much Kuret before going full power.

I still have to figure out Charles weakness. I may have no real plan, but a way to get one has opened up. I am not feeling hopeless now. My Kuret on left hand travel to right hand. I pull it apart once it was halved at each hand. I am able to wrap just my fingers. I need to now focus on keeping it stable for longer time. Once I get my full Kuret back, I should be able to cover more of my arms. With time I should be able to cover my whole body with Kuret.

I turn to Charles. The glimmers around him are now having multiple shades. He is a little impatient too. He must want to fight me directly. I feel the same way. Just wait for a little while Charles. By the time your tails are shortened, I will have enough control to make this an even match.

# Vanessa (Chapter 11)

Thursday, 10 February 2022 1:15 PM

I didn't expect David to do something like this. He must been real desperate to try this. I saw him clinging to the boulder and jump in the air just as Charles come up to him. He had couple of stones on his hand and with some incredible luck, he blinded Charles for some time. I was relived he didn't give up. But I was still not sure what his plan was. Did he even have one ? I kept asking this question for a while now. Charles was writhing in pain. David took that opportunity and ran way. I gazed over to the other screen wondering where is running off to.

I saw the mini crater that Charles created when he pulled out that massive rock. David has to be running over there. I look at Charles who was still howling but also using his Kuret on his tails. In his pain he brought his claws to his face instinctively and scrapped his skin around the eyes. He howled once more in pain. Well, that was silly. His Kuret wrapped around the tails and they started to grow longer. What. Is there no limit to what he can do? The tails gradually became so long, it probably reached halfway to the barrier. Those tails then fall from sky and Charles makes them scatter on the ground in different directions.

The tails began sweeping the whole field. One was almost caught up to David. Just at the last second, he dived into the hole. The tail missed him in the nick of time. David curls up towards the edge of the bowl shaped crater and rests there for a while. Kafar says, damn. He got away again. I can't believe David's luck. He was this close to getting captured. He shows this thumb and index finger and gestures a little gap between them. Blake asks, you are pretty calm. Didn't your champion get hit on the eyes? There are no Kurets to protect them. On top of that he even injured a little bit himself. I bet he can't see now.

Kafar was still gleeful, this is not the first time someone tried to attack him on his eyes you know. When he transforms, his eyes is coated with a thin layer of Kuret to protect him. They are the size of the contact lenses, although a little brittle. He should have been able to protect himself. He sighs, but no one has ever caught him off guard like this. David managed to attack from very close. So yes, I believe for the time being he can't see. David has bought several seconds. Maybe even a minute.

Derek says, Charles is used to people attacking him on his eyes. He has ways to deal with that. He points to the enlarges tails, that is one way. David made a smart move to hide out in that hole. Charles is too much of a straightforward guy. I bet he will scour the field without realizing to check the hole he himself created for some time. Nathan says, yeah, okay. So David has bought some time. Big deal. Once he gets his Kuret back, it will be same old thing.

I said, unless he is working out a different way. He has to be planning something. I look at the different screen which showed David from a different angle. He was bleeding a little from the bruises. He looked more exhausted than beat up. He hasn't landed any significant blow to Charles the entire match. Charles has kept him defensive all the time. On top of that, Heraknus is supposed to have huge amount of Kuret. A long fight is not good for David. Blake asks, I hope you are right. Right now David is in a tight corner.

Catherine asks, how long can Charles make those tails. Doesn't he need to use too much Kuret to make it big and then use a lot of energy to control it? I know from my own experience that it puts too much of strain on the body. Why will he go this far then? Derek took several seconds to answer, like I have been saying. Charles isn't someone to use strategies or tricks. He fighting style is rudimentary. He can't fight smartly, so he has trained to fight by pushing his limits of Kuret consumption. I agree its too much Kuret to use and control at the same time. That’s just the way he fights.

I ask, then how can anyone beat him? He is alpha, so does that mean only his bloodline members can overpower him? I wondered if anyone of us would have had a chance if it was one of us down there. Kafar says, yes. Only other Heraknus can fight him. Even then one is not enough. I have seen couple of times their training sessions. I have seen Charles fighting 10 Heraknus alone. Only then does the battle be even. Matt shouts, did you just say 10 people? Derek told every member is as powerful as regular alphas. So does that make Charles a super alpha?

Cassandra beside her pokes hard on his shoulder, don't say stuff like this. I am already worried about David fighting a beast. Now I have to imagine him fighting 10 of them. Matt says, then maybe Blake would have been a better challenger for Charles right? He faces Blake, I mean a true alpha and a Heraknus alpha would be a good match up. Blake didn't respond immediately. I know what he might be thinking. I am feeling the same resentment of loosing.

I think all of us had been thinking that Blake would have better chance of winning than David. David did beat Blake, but just barely. Both of their Kuret are literally polar opposites. David only won because he caught Blake off guard in the last second. Blake turns to Derek, well? You know a lot about David, Charles and me. What do you think. Would I have a better chance. Kafar was also curious to know as he looked lot interested in this question. Derek looks to him. He looks to all of us and then faces him again.

He sighs, honestly. I don't mean any disrespect to David. But yes, I think Blake would have much better chances. You have speed and power. An abnormal amount of Kuret that affects both the Kuret and physical properties of others. You are an alpha, so you have high regeneration and stamina. In terms of abilities, you have much better compatibility than David. He then looks to David, David's Kuret is unstable and metaphysical. He has stamina equivalent of human. He has no self healing abilities. I say he has half the necessary things to defeat a power house like Charles.

No one said for couple of seconds. I wondered if David just had a bad luck of fighting Charles. David was lying on the dirt with a pained expression. He looks so frustrated. I would be too if I was hiding in the middle of a match. Maybe he is trying to find any weakness Charles has. I ask Derek, do you know any weakness Charles has? Something in his Kuret or his body. Now Derek looks a little frustrated, no. He doesn't have a weakness. I was shocked to hear this. I reply, that’s not possible. Everyone has one. Derek says, believe me. I have thought about it a lot. The only weak point Heraknus have is outside a battle, when they don't have Kuret and are in recovery. Within a battlefield, they are perfect warriors.

I swallowed a little terrified that Charles may not have any weakness. How incredible Heraknus are. No wonder Kafar has kept them a secret for so long. Marina asks, what about thing David did first time they clashed. And that Kuret ball. David still has some plays left. Don't just think he is out of the game. David never does anything he doesn't believe will go his way. If he thought there was not even a 1% chance of winning, he would have given up in the beginning. I still believe in David.

Marina words were more convincing than her voice. Its clear to she was hesitant to give hope. Ned faces Kafar, tell me something. How many Heraknus are alive? Are all of them in Citradel. Ned asks completely ignoring what we were talking about. I was mad at him. He might have completely given up on David. Kafar says, including Charles there are 678 Heraknus still alive. And yes, all of them are in Citradel. They never separated even once after coming to earth. Ned asks, how many of them are fighters? I don't think all of them are keen on fighting.

Kafar nods, yes. Each one of them are powerful, but not all have the mind of a soldier. Last I heard they were about 26 who are in training. Derek says, its 76 now. One left recently. You know, his daughter. I ask, Charles has a daughter? Ned then asks, and she doesn't want to fight anymore. Isn't she in the next line of alpha. Derek didn't say anything. He looked as if he was hiding something. Kafar says, not to worry. Charles has 5 children. His daughter is the second oldest. He has a son who he said will inherit this alpha bloodline.

I wanted to know more about Charles children. But before I could ask Matt says, whoa. Okay, cut the chatter people. I think Charles is about to find David. I turned to the screen. Charles was walking around the field now. He had is tails searching, but he also kept moving in random directions. He is close to the hole. One more step and he will fall below. David was on the other side of the edge of the bottom. There was silence in the room. Everyone were watching in suspense. David had not recovered. I was sure of it. David confirmed me when he threw a stone away from him and Charles. Just at the moment Charles would have stepped inside, the voice of the stone hitting the ground caught his attention. Charles immediately turn his head to that direction and ran. As he ran, he aimed the tails ahead to catch him. Everyone but him knew that all he would catch is air.

Matt says, That was close. I think this is the first match where David had to rely on luck so much. When do you suppose he will get his Kuret back. It's already been over 3 minutes. Nobody had any answer. David had told that it depends on the use, the longer it was used, the more time he would need to recover. He roughly spent about a minute using that Kuret dome. So 3 minutes should have been enough. Yet he is hiding in the hole. Has something gone wrong?

I really wanted some support from Ned on this. He had completely given up on David. I had keeping my anger inside and tried to ignore Ned for a while. But now that match is stuck for a while, I couldn't keep it in anymore. I whisper to him, can you at least try showing a little supportive of David in front of everyone? Ned nonchalantly looked at me and whispered back, how is that fair? Do you want me not have an opinion on something as serious this? I reply, I don't care that you voted against David. I am mad that you are behaving like David has already lost this match. You don't even think he can win this. Others, except for Kafar, are at least having doubts. You could show some consideration.

He looked at me in shock and tilted his head a little, you have to be kidding me. Do you not see what I am seeing. David hasn't even landed one attack on Charles in this entire match. All he has been doing is running around and defending himself. And now, he is hiding in a hole. I don't know if David has a plan or not. But anyone can see that he is loosing. He is basically relying on his luck. Its really hard to believe that he might just turn this around now. He was getting a angry and his voice became loud enough for others to hear. He continues, you have no idea how much I need for us to win this. Its so difficult for me to see David loosing. I feel like I am loosing. I don't know what else you want me to say.

I am so mad at him. I know couples fight, and we have several, but I couldn't let this one slide. My voice also got louder. So say you, I bet other people also believe in David. Every Medrone on Earth knows David. They know David's strength. Just because he is now fighting some god, doesn't mean he is weak. Ned wasn't moderating his voice now. Oh, you really know what others think, do you? Let me tell you something, you need to know that not all people know David like we do. No matter how powerful he is or what he is done, they don't have the same history as us. So don't just single me out from all them and tell me to be open minded. I was about to rebuke him, but others were now looking at us. I don't think Ned was even a little mortified by our fight.

Nathan whispers, trouble in paradise. He makes a smirk as he said. I rolled my eyes at him. Ned then pulls out his phone from his pocket, if you don't believe me. Lets check the poll shall we? He turns to his mobile and starts to type on the screen. I was confused, what poll?. He says, you don't think its just us who made a bet right? Everyone in the stadium has a voting device with them for this match alone. Kafar shouted, Ned. You just ruined the surprise. We agreed not to let others know until the match near the end.

Ned didn't reply to him. He kept typing on the screen. Blake says, wait. So everyone in this stadium making a bet? Why didn't you tell us. Kafar was a little annoyed at Ned. But he turned away, ah fine. It doesn't matter now. I got you all also put a chip in the bet. He turns to Blake, its not just the people here. All the communities we know about were given a encrypted tablet to watch this match live stream. They also are voting regularly. I was really shocked to hear this. This is not a sports match that should be live streamed at home.

Derek asks, you didn't tell me this when you asked my team to deliver those devices to all the Medrones we contacted. You told that was a secure device to contact us in case of emergencies. Kafar nodded, yes. That is absolutely true. They can contact us using that in case they think they were found by Echo or Hive. But John and his people came up with this idea to share this battle with them too. He suggested just showing the match highlights in a video recording will not be much enticing as a live match. People will invest their time when watching the whole match live. Giving their time would mean they would have expectations. When we give choices, those expectations becomes reality. And that can lead to chance for them to realize the potential in reforming our Medrone society. Now obviously, not all will be interested, but most will find enough reasons to join us. That will cause others to join. And slowly we will pull all Medrones on Earth to gather in one place finally after more than 16 years. John's team gave a pretty solid argument why its so much beneficial to broadcast this to all the Medrones scattered over the world.

Tessa shifts uneasily on her seat says, why would you risk this. If Hive or Echo were to find the live stream, doesn't matter how much encrypted it is, they will figure out this location. Right now we have the most Medrones gathered at one place ever on Earth. Kafar raises his palm in air, oh believe me. We have went to great lengths to make sure this is safe. And that’s why I pulled in Ned. I needed his expertise to help us make sure that no one except for a Medrone can see this.

I face to Ned, so you agreed. Let me guess, in return you promised not to tell us? Ned was still working on his mobile. He didn't remove his eyes from his mobile as he says angrily, yes. I was a little against it. But then I realized you all would just freak out if had told you. So I agreed to only tell you all once the match was over. He pauses, but now you accuse me of being inconsiderate. You actually want everyone to what you want to believe. You think everyone one will be with David because he is strong. Right. He finally stops typing and looks up to me and says, so lets see how many people you should be actually be mad at and not just me. Ned was furious now. He turned to screen at the bottom left. He raises his finger at that screen, I asked one my tech guys to project the polls we have been circulating.

The screen that was showing an angle of David resting in the pit went blank. A moment later, a different screen popped up. There was something written on it, but I couldn't read it from my dyslexia. Ned knowing this starts to explain what's shown there. He says, there's a single question writing on it. Who do you think will most likely win? I could make out that below that question, there is a brown, black and white horizontal line grouped together like a train. The length of black was so less that it would be negligible. Ned says, 83 % for Charles. 8% for David. And the rest who didn't vote.

Ned continues, I think its pretty self explanatory. But let me spell it out for you. He eyes me for a short second and reads from the screen. The brown line is Charles. Black is David. And white is people who didn't vote or undecided. So, he turns to face me, what do you know? It looks like I shouldn't be the only one you should be asking to be more considerate of David. You have, he waves his hands to the crowd outside the window, 83% of the people to convince that David can still win. He then leans back to the seat and says, don't get angry at me because David is loosing. If you want to be mad, be mad for all the people here. He faces away from me and looks back to the monitor.

I am shocked seeing at the numbers. Practically none of the people think David can win. Its possible the 8% are the people who knows David personally. Maybe people who met him. But others believe Charles will win. I didn't want to be, but I was now mad at all those people. I know its not fair, they choose the one they think will win. I shouldn't be mad at them. For some reason, I couldn't stop being angry though. It felt like a betrayal somehow. After everything David's gone through, he doesn't have the majority support.

I was furious at Ned. I was also painfully aware that everyone was watching us fight. Ned really is angry with me. He has never shown so much anger before. I wanted to chew more at him but I stopped myself before I make a more drama for others. I look back at the monitor where the percentage kept changing. Does that mean people could change their vote at any time? I guess Kafar wanted only us to be unchangeable on our vote. Matt interrupts my thoughts, okay so if you guys are done with your love quarrel. I have a question, why only this match are you guys doing all this huh? Why not for all our matches. Wouldn't showing all our matches show that David and Charles aren't the only ones strong? He was annoyed. I think everyone was after hearing this.

Kafar for the first time didn't reply immediately. He was silent, trying to come up with some answer. Derek says, its obvious isn't it. Nathan nods, huh. I see. So you only wanted everyone to know about Charles. Its not just enough to let the people here know about him. This match is like some big reveal of Heraknus Medrones to others. You basically advertised to all Medrones that you have a godly weapon. A weapon only present at Citradel. So people would naturally want to move there. He smirks, wow. This was a diabolical but simple plan. I should have thought of this when I was running the valley. Would have saved me a lot of pain. He gripped his knees probably reminiscing the time he was paralyzed for a while.

Blake says, really. Is that true? He waited for Kafar. He finally sighed and replied, I know what you all are thinking. I have never hidden my opinion that no matter who among you all wins, my champion would be victorious. So I did a little monopoly on that. He shrug his shoulder, could we have shown your battles too. Yes. We could have. We couldn't take the risk of showing all the matches. Too much broadcasting and our safety would be jeopardized. The more matches to be shown, the more data to be dispersed around the globe. And we also found that people generally only want to see the last match. So we took all those reasons when making decision to only this match.

I say, bullshit. You can throw all the rehearsed reasoning at us. I am not buying for a second that you did it because of what, logistics issues? You only care about people joining to Citradel. I didn't even care checking Kafars expression. I look at Ned who was kind of sulking, you knew all this and you still agreed? He says, now its not the time to show your hurt ego. That goes for all of you. He turns to face others, all of us have been in the fight for more than 15 years. You guys were already well known and have reputations. I didn't thought that we would need to garner more.

Marina says, not David. He just popped in everyone radars only 3 year back. Ned nods, Yes. This way people will know more about him. But I never expected him to fight a Heraknus alpha. If I had known then maybe. He didn't finish off the sentence. Blake says, wait. Let me understand this correctly. You couldn't do all this in a week after my match. What you are talking would takes weeks, maybe months to prepare. That means you couldn't have possibly known David would be fighting in the final. Yet you went this plan. So it can't be that you did for David's sake too.

Ned stares at Blake. A moment later sighs, fine. I wasn't thinking of David. I had. His sentence softened at the end, I had a different reason. We waited for him to elaborate. He didn't. Cassandra ask, that it. That's all you have to say? Ned says, it’s a good reason. Cassandra says, oh. It’s a good reason. Well that’s clears every thing. She faces me, do you know why? I gave some thought. I couldn't think of any reason why Ned went along with this. All I know is that he worked very hard for this. So why would he not support David. I shook my head.

I could feel the tension high in the air around us. Derek broke that and says, All of you need to calm down. What's done is done. We will have enough time to throw blame and feel guilty later. You all do know that there is a match going on right? So if its not too much trouble, shut it down. Wow, I thought. Derek voice had a sense of authority that was very hard to ignore. He faces me and continues, numbers aren't absolute. You need to focus on the two people fighting down there, not others. So stop getting so angry at anyone who doesn't believe your ideals. He then faces to Kafar, and you. I know that you did this just for showing off Charles to all. But your plan could backfire if Charles looses. Kafar had something to say but Derek raises his palms at him, don't. You have already expressed your views several times about David having no chance winning. I don't want to hear it again. I am just letting you know, even if only 0.3 % people think David will win, its not zero. So you better prepare for that eventuality regardless of what you think.

Derek was pulling out no tolerance bullshit now. He sometimes remind me of David. Derek then turns and faces others, and you all don't need to be worried or angry that people didn't get to see your match. Be glad they didn't, they would see you winning matches, but also the ones you lost. So stop showing your pride is hurt or whatever. We all don't need to show others we are strong. They already know. Stop your whining. Derek then turns back the screen that showed Charles now standing still. He says, I don't know if its fate or luck or something. The two people that needs the most attention are there right now on the field. Using their match to pull in people can go in either ones favor. Right now all we can do is better give these two the respect and watch till the end.

Derek voice had little haughtiness, still, he is right. I have been shamelessly fighting with Ned when its not the appropriate place or time. Ned said he had good reasons, I just hope that's actually a right one. I bet others were surprised to hear Derek be the voice of reason. Matt and Cassandra were whispering to each other. So were Nathan and Tessa. Blake was thinking about something looking at the poll screen. Catherine and Marina had glued their eyes to David. Kafar showed some uneasiness now, like a student scolding his teacher he kept rolling his fingers in palm. Maybe what Derek told rattled him a little.

Derek breaks the silence once more, David's time is up. I think Charles is beginning see now. I turned to the monitor. The camera had zoomed in to Charles face. His eye lids were flickering. A few seconds later, he was able to open his eyes a little. It was enough for him to roll his eyes around the field. After a full 360 view, he howled at the sky frustrated not finding David. He then slowly looks at the direction where he made the hole in ground, possibly realizing where David had been hiding all this time.

# Vanessa (Chapter 12)

Tuesday, 15 February 2022 2:39 PM

Charles commands one of the nearest tails to hover out in the sky above. Then he makes it fall with the pointed edge first into the ground. The tail buried deep into the ground. The tail keeps digging in the ground. I realize what Charles was planning. I looked over to David hoping he would sense the tails approaching to him underground. David didn't move. He was gazing at the other side of the pit. From his face he looked he was lost in thoughts. He wasn't even blinking. Is he okay ?, I thought. I have seen him in immersed in thoughts before. Never he would space out in middle of a fight.

I held my breath when Charles tail came out from the edge of the pit. David finally woke up from his day dream, but it was too late. Charles had him already wrapped him by his legs and pulled him out from the pit feet first. Shit. What were you thinking David? David was held upside down in the air. Charles brought his other tails towards him. David was trying to break free before the other tails attack him. David's naturally cancels all Kuret on contact. Charles has been continuously showering his tail with Kuret to keep his tail from breaking. The other tails were also glowing with brown Kuret. When they got closer to David, he pulled his elbow up to his torso and defend himself.

Charles had a different plan. His tails didn't attack, instead of attacking Charles was wrapping his tails all around his body. He made one tails pull his arms behind and wrapped it with another tail to his waist. David was completely at Charles mercy. Charles made sure David couldn't escape anymore. The tails then move David in the same upside down position to Charles direction. David kept struggling, trying to wriggle out his confinement. He didn't have any luck.

Cassandra spoke softly, come on David. She was nervously shaking her legs. Matt puts his hand on her knees trying to calm her. Then he takes her hand in his. I was turmoiled inside. There was some jealously in me that Ned didn't do the same thing for me. I buried it deep inside my thoughts as David become closer to Charles. Charles had raised his left arm in arm and his claws ready to attack. But the way he aimed, he must he planning to attack his face.

I had big tug in my gut. I shouted, is Charles planning to kill David ? That is a dangerous position he intends to attack David. I looked at Kafar, stop this match now. Charles is going to kill David. I stood up from my chair and faced the screen horrified. Others followed suite when they realize Charles is taking this too far. Then I face Kafar, call off Charles now. This is supposed to be a match without any kill shots. Kafar was visibly worried now, I. He was stammering, I can't. No one can stop Charles when he is in this form. I immediately say, useless. Then tell the other Heraknus to stop him. I don't care if this is against the rule, Charles is breaking one now. We need someone to stop him. I was now shouting orders.

Kafar says, there's no time. We will never reach out to them and break through the barrier in time. I moved my eyes to David now. He is panicking now. Its clear he is also confused and scared. Seeing him I reached the limit of my patience. I immediately call my Kuret. My body is filled with Kuret around me. I summon a gust of wind in my right hand. It was slowly building up pressure. But it wasn't strong enough to blow away the left wall of the room. Dammit. I should have been outside.

I faced the windows and aimed my arms to them. Fine, I say, I will go there myself. Before I could shoot the wind gathered in my hand, Derek shouts over the wind spinning in the room. Stop. You might hurt the people sitting outside. I didn't care, I thought. David is in serious danger. I will not let him die here. Derek was also panicking. He says, I thought Charles would be holding back a little. I was wrong. He really is crazy enough to attack David when he can't defend himself. Vanessa , I will go. Derek summons his Kuret out now, I told Charles to not let his get carried away so much that it cloud his judgement. I don't even know if he even remembers that David can't heal. This is outrageous.

A moment later he phases into the front wall where the monitors were hung. I could see from the windows he was descending down. If he thinks I will just stand here and wait, he is dead wrong. I face Marina, bring down the barrier. Now. Before I asked, Marina was already waving her hand in the air and creating a Charm, shit. No. No. I, she takes a second, I can't bring it down. The barrier has too many layers to break it down in such a short time. I responded, Don't say that. Bring it down, Now.

Blake also had summoned his Kuret and the room was filled with blue Kuret, Vanessa. Lets go. We will break through the barrier. We don't have time to wait. Marina, come with us. Help us make weaken the barrier a little to give us a path. Hurry. Marina nods, you got it. She waved her left fingers and casted a charm. She starting floating in air and moved forward. I face to Cassandra, break the wall above us. The debris will fall only on us, not on the crowd. Cassandra was up on her feet. Her eyes filled with red Kuret, yeah. Got it.

Cassandra was about to jump with her Kuret filled fist. Nathan then shouts, You guys will not reach in time. Charles just made his tails move faster now. My Kuret was rattling in air. I felt sparks of electricity from my fist discharging in air. Nathan was right. David was now just a few steps away. No one can reach him now. Not even Derek. David let a cry as soon as Charles brought down his claws to his approaching face. I froze in my place. My anger quickly turned into horror when the claw was less than a second away from David's head.

I unconsciously closed my eyes and turned my face away. I can't watch this. No. No. David can't die. Don't you dare die. Not yet. I.I couldn't even form thoughts. I heard from the monitors a big thumping sound. No! I forced my eyes open. Please no. When I noticed David still wrapped in Charles tails, my hopes crushed. David was punched back and the tails were swinging him back. I couldn't understand what I was seeing. Charles raised his others arm and prepared to attack once more.

No. I screamed out. But my body was still frozen. I watched helplessly when Charles was about to hit David a second time. Charles had made David loose from this tails for some reason. Charles hit him right on his chest and there's another thumping sound. My heart was beating like crazy. I was seeing things but couldn't understand anything. David was sent flying into the air. His body was limp as he flew in air. His arms and legs just floundered in air. He was attacked twice. One on his face and once on his chest. He must have crushed bones and bleeding all over.

I couldn't do anything as David's body continues to fall down straight to the ground. If he wasn't dead, he will be if he falls from this height. Come on Derek, please save him. Derek never showed up. All I saw was David falling his back facing the ground. My eyes swell up with moist when he was just about to hit the ground. No, he can't die. Then David body did something unbelievable. David was floating in the sky now. I don't know what's going on, but David was hovering in the air for a while.

The next moment he starts falling again. He is now able to crouch down and managed to roll away on the ground. He gets dragged a little further away from his landing spot. When he finally stops, he is idly lying on the ground. Oh god, don't tell me he his dead. I shout to others, get help. David needs paramedics now. We need get him to the nearest human hospital. No one were listening to me. Everyone were watching the screen confused at something. I asked, what the hell are guys doing. I was irritated now. Fine, I said. I will carry him and fly him away. I ran to the window. Again, before I could blast the window away, I felt someone pull on my left arm.

Wait Vanessa. It was Ned. He shouted, look. Just look at David. I shoved his arm away in anger. I asked, what. He is bleeding all over. We don't have time. Matt says, ah. Vanessa, I don't think that’s blood over his body. I started back at the screen, what do you mean?. My mouth stopped moving when I saw black sparks running over his body. I thought that was his blood coming out. It was his Kuret. He was somehow making them run it like sparks, no more like small threads all over his body.

I focus on his face. He wasn't bleeding. There was no blood. He didn't look like any of his bones in his head were broken either. I moved to his stomach. He was breathing and I saw his chest rising up and down. Same like his face, he wasn't bleeding from the impact. What is going on. Blake who was hovering in the air like Marina, starts to level down to his feet. What the hell just happened. Catherine, who had one hand on her mouth and the other one on her stomach. She puts her arms away and asks, is David okay? What just happened.

Cassandra who had her alter ego taken over asks, is that David's Kuret on his body? When did he do that? I was too shocked to remember the details. Tessa says, just before Charles hit him. He got his Kuret back. He was releasing it from all his body, but he didn't blast it right away. The next second I saw the Kuret around him moved to his face and chest at the moment Charles attacked him. Nathan says, its similar to what he did the very first time he got away from Charles. But this, he gulps a little, was so much faster. I almost didn't see it happening. Just like this, he snaps his fingers, those Kuret sparks swarmed from all over his body to his face. And somehow it protected David.

Marina says, this is new. She then sighs, then he is okay. Dammit. David almost gave me a heart attack. She lets go of the charms in her finger and comes down on the floor. Matt says, he looks like he is on fire. I have never seen his Kuret become so thin and small. I let out sigh of relief. I pulled my arm down and released my Kuret. The gust of wind circulating in the room dissipated. I was overjoyed to know he wasn't dead. David actually pulled a new trick at the last second. David was lying on the ground when he starts to smirk. Is he for real? He nearly died and he finds that amusing. I felt a relief wash over my body looking at him smile. I calmed down the sudden adrenaline coursing in me.

Then my anger rose up. I face back to Kafar, stop this match now. Charles just tried to kill David. He failed for now. That will not stop him to try again. Kafar was a lot anxious in the whole ordeal, I told you. We can't. Charles will not listen to anyone now that he is fighting with David. He was too worked up about it months. If someone were to get in his way, he would just blast past them. He might even try to kill them. My anger was boiling, oh you don't need to worry Charles accidently killing you. I might just do it now. I walked towards with the intend of punching his teeth's out.

Blake comes in between us and grabs me by the arms to keep me apart from Kafar. Kafar took steps back scared a little with my hostility. Blake says, don't Vanessa. Control yourself. This is not the place to fight the leader of Citradel. Don't do something you will regret later. He is making his reasoning firm as he tightly gripped my arms to keep me back. I shove him away in anger and take few steps back, you think we just let this slide away? The rules were setup to make the matches realistic. We agreed there will be no murderous intentions or attacks. That is violation of that. He needs to be disqualified now.

Blake kept staring at me. I could see he was angry too. He then turns away to Kafar, well. You have nothing to say? She is right. He should be disqualified now. Charles may be from a legendary bloodline, but he is not above the rules we set here. And If Charles doesn't agree with it, tries to resist, I will personally go down there to put him down. Kafar was visibly shaken with this. I am sure he never thought that Charles would actual try to kill a defenseless David.

Kafar spoke with hesitation, I never thought Charles would go this far. You are right, according to the rules, this should be considered as a violent act and have him disqualified. But you need to understand, this is being live streamed to entire Medrones on Earth. If we have this match end on a technicality, then we wouldn't achieve the very thing we did this for. People may not join us. We need to give them a proper match that ends in a conclusion. I shout, are you serious. You want to continue this match for such a reason? This is not gambling. We are talking about David's life. I took one more step to towards him. Kafar could see my hostility coming out from me and my Kuret.

Nathan spoke, why don't we let David decide? He has to know that Charles broke the rules. It should be up to him to know the risk and still wants to continue the match. Bickering amongst ourselves is just waste of time. I was still angry to hear any rationalization thoughts on continuing this match. Kafar immediately pitches in, precisely. It should be David who wants to end the match right now if he wants. I rebuked him, and what if Charles doesn't like it when David calls for violation? Do you think your crazy over zealous champion would thrown in towel ? I don't think so. We need to get in there and end the match right away before Charles another attempt on David's life.

Ned behind me says, yeah. Vanessa, I agree with Nathan. It should be David's call to pull of plug on this match. I turn to him in anger, what. Are you not seeing what I am? Come on you guys. I turn to face others, are the rest of you all thinking the same then? Am I the only one who sees how crazy it is to let this supposedly friendly match turn into this? Everyone were hesitant to answer me immediately. A moment later Derek phased from the right wall into room. Fhew, he says, that was a close call. Amazing David pulled off something at the last minute. He lets go of his Kuret and then looks at the tense atmosphere. Let me guess, he continues, some of you want to end the match right?

I nod at him, it would be reckless to let Charles continue and keep endangering David. Derek nods slightly in agreement, I know. I feel the same way. Kafar interrupts him, Derek we can't let the match end this way. You know how hard we have worked to make this tournament happen. People will not join Citradel or the Island if we stop the match now. Derek says, we don't know that. Maybe reveling Charles would be enough for people to join us. Not to forget that all of us here also showcased our abilities. Maybe that’s enough for people to join.

But not everyone, Ned says. We need every Medrone on the entire planet to believe in our abilities to keep them safe. He takes a short breath and then looks at me, bottom line, it means David and Charles need to finish this with a proper conclusion. He said that with a straight face. It was troubling to see him not being bothered too much about David nearly dying. Does Ned thought David would make it out safety ? I was getting angrier now. I didn't understand why Ned is prioritizing this above David life.

I faced others hoping to get enough votes to end this match before it gets worse. Everyone were anxious and little confused, but no one came up with any answer. Blake asks, so I guess this silence means we are hoping David to decide, huh ? I mean, its clear to us that Charles took it far, if David wants to he can end the match either forfeiting or calling out Charles. Blake shrugs his shoulders telling us. Kafar was about to say something but instead he just turns to the screen.

We all faced to the screen. Charles was healing his arms. After lying down for few seconds, David was got up. His Kuret was running all over this body like small black sparks. Whatever he did must be a surprising to him because he was starting his arms, legs and chest. I was amazed to see David pulling off a miracle in the middle of the match. He found a way to use his Kuret for offense without the dome. However, the surprising thing was he wasn't ending the match. He was already preparing for the next round.

I was a little taken aback by his behavior. This isn't the first time David risked his life, but this is the first time it was with a friendly. Why isn't he backing down ?, Jess asks, does he plan to continue then. Kafar lets out a small sigh, subtle but enough to notice his burden relieved, then I guess the battle continues. He then looks at everyone, David made his choice, so then there is no objection here. I was almost blurted out Kafar to screw off, Derek cuts in, lets continue with the match for now. David made his decision. Derek then faces me, but if Charles does something like that again, we are calling this whole thing off, agreed. He glares at Kafar and then to Ned.

They both took a moment. A slight nod came from both of them. Everyone got back into their seats. I was the only one remaining standing. After few seconds, I too gave up and sat down. Ned beside me leans forward, but I pull my palm in front of him signaling him to not say whatever he was thinking of saying to me. Ned looks at directly at my eyes and then pulls back. With the anxious atmosphere dissipated, we turn our gazes back to the screen.

Matt says, looks like David's pulling out some crazy trick up his sleeve. David is now running and jumping around the tails instead of running away.

# David (Chapter 13)

Wednesday, January 17, 2024 00:02

I can't catch a break for even a second. Its bad enough that I have four tails to keep track of with their glimmers, I have to even make sure not to cut the tails and mistakenly end this unexpected opportunity. Still, for the first time since our fight started, I am beginning to feel like myself again. I am not fully in control of the situation, but I am not panicking recklessly anymore. I have been dodging and breaking the Kuretines repeatedly dozens of times now. I have almost grasped the patterns of the attacks. I caught early on that Charles wasn't making any complex movements. There were so many chances where he could have strike me and catch my limbs though I would instantly free myself before the tail could catch me- yet the tails just kept coming at me with straightforward attacks. After a few rounds of those attacks, I figured out the simple pattern where he is attacking with the nearest tail near me. Even if the Kuretines were not healed, he would use them to attack me.

A tail was coming dead straight to my face from ahead, the Kuritine at the edge was already cracked and had become brittle, but the speed itself is enough to pierce my face. Is Charles not even bothering to not hide his intent to kill me. Or does he think this is not enough to put me down. Either way, I can't let him keep dominating this fight. I have been slowly improving my Kuret control. I gotten better at this new form of Kuret wrapped around my fingers. I raise my right hand and my fingers to block the tail in front of my eyes. The Kuretine he attacked with wasn't healed fully, so it didn't have the usual sharpness. I braced for the impact as the force with which it came pushed me back a little. I managed to hold my ground.

I saw a glimmer approaching from behind me. I didn't have time to block it using my arms, so instead I moved my Kuret wrapped in my left hand to my back. After so many times, I have now gotten a instinctive feel for moving my Kuret on my body. The Kuret formed moments before the tail attacked me on by lower back. I saw glimmers of the Kuretines breaking apart and I was lunged ahead by the force as I staggered to keep my balance. The attacks kept coming since then.

After another minute, I started to think what Charles plan is. I understand that he doesn't want to loose the tails, but why isn't he attacking me directly and instead only using his tails. By now he must have realized that if he keeps this up, he will continue to loose huge amounts of Kuret. He can attack me directly while keeping his tails intact like he was doing a while back. What's changed. In the middle of my thoughts two tails were coming from the opposite sides of me. Since I have been focusing on slashing and dodging all this time, I have used more stamina than I should. I could have dodged them, but I thought of an idea to figure what's Charles plan is here. I need to force him to get a reaction to understand his strange behavior.

I pulled up both my hands up and waited as the tails as they pummeled into my palms. The Kuretines on the tails were dried up to a point they there brittle as a pencil now. Instead of letting go, I grabbed the tail end with my hands. I could see the brown Kuret flowing into the Kuritine, trying to heal the damages I caused. By my natural Kuret in my palm doesn't allow to fix those cracks in the Kuritine. I heard Charles letting out a small growl feeling his tails getting caught. I softly spoke, oh how the tables have turned.

The other two tails just were swaying above in the air now. I turn to face Charles, he was just standing on his legs with his arms hanging on his side. I couldn't make out the expression under all those Kuretines on his face. The glimmers coming out from his body was covering whatever was coming from his own body. I hoped I could get hints about his plan from a cold read. I am still clueless about his plan. A few seconds passed by and still no movement. We both just stood here, me holding his two tails, and he just staring at me.

Is he making a plan of attack. Might be. After seeing my Kurets new form, he must be wary. But why isn't he attacking with the two free tails then. Charles seems to be a person who relies on instinct. I have seen only simple attacks without any deceptions or clever tricks. Something weird is going on here. Is he suddenly tired ? No, that can't be. With his ridiculous amount of Kuret, he could go on for hours. My eyes widen up when I thought of a reason, Kafar said Heraknus have inconsistent access to Kuret during battle. I dart my eyes to the tails, the brown Kuret is still pouring in. However, now that I am holding the Kuritine end so close to me, I could see the brown glimmer getting dimmer. Not only that, the Kuret is flowing slowly into it.

I then face Charles. I gazed around his entire body. I peered deep into the air around him to check the glimmer and saw its shrinking, albeit small. Almost negligible, if it was anyone else, they wouldn't see the Kuret changing. But I could tell that the Kuret coming out of his actual body is slow. I made a small smirk. I was right. Charles has momentarily lost his constant access to Kuret. While I was stalling with training my Kuret attacks, he too has been stalling to buy time and regain this Kuret control.

Now is my chance. I can't let this chance go by. I let go of the two tails and sprinted towards Charles. As I ran, the tails behind me started to move again and followed me. He must be trying to grab me and hold me down. Not happening. As I run, I willed the Kuret on my fingers to move around my ancles. I had a thought a while back on how to go about this. It should be along the same principle as I get pulled away from by Kuret. But instead of a pulling, pushing is possible now given the solidity of my new Kuret form. A moment later, the Kuret wrap around my ancles like accessories.

The tails were almost top of me. Just before they could grab me, I focused on the Kuret on my right leg to push forward. It felt like my legs were tied to a speeding boat as got lunged forward uncontrollably. The force was enough to make be jump and hover over the ground for few seconds. As I swayed in air I was turning around in wrong direction. Immediately I let the Kuret on the other leg push me forward to correct my direction. It was like my legs had a mind of its own.

Shit. Shit. I can't do this properly in the middle of the battle. I land on my right leg almost loosing my balance. With a swift motion of leaning ahead, I pivot my body and lean forward a bit to keep running. I realize its too unrealistic of me to try any of this this now. So instead I plan to push myself only in when needed and with less force. The little stunt was enough to widen the gap from the tails behind me and at the same time close the gap between Charles and me. I thought Charles would just stay still, but he also began to run in my direction. This is my third time charging into him like this. I don't know if he was surprised to see me doing this or not. But this will not be a repeat like those other times.

I rough outline of a plan was framing in my head. I can't match up with his explosive power. To counter, I have speed. Unlike the times we fought with bare hands, I plan to only act reactive for now until I find a proper moment to strike. As much as I want to land my Kuret attacks right away, while his Kuret is unstable, I can't mess this up. No need to act impatiently.

We both were heading for a violent collision in a few moment. Charles was now leaning forward with his arms in front, ready to cleave my face off with those claws. I duck on the left and roll away as his claws slashes the air where I was just running. I slide across the grass to his right and jump back right up. Charles without turning to me swings his left leg around from his side and aim to kick on my torso. I didn't want to get blunt force of his attack so I pulled back and his foot with sharp Kuretines as nails missed me few inches.

Charles turned around to face me. He took off from the ground while pulling his arms high in air, joined his hands. Seeing the glimmer of the Kuret coming off his arms, I could predict he was aiming for a crushing blow to my face with just brute strength. I can't afford to get hit with this, even with my Kuret blocking it. But I didn't want to dodge it either because an opportunity had appeared. He arms were away and his legs in the air away from this abdomen. Out of all the places on his body, he had the most Kuret, his physical mass, centered there. That means if I chip away as much as possible here, he would loose a lot of the Kuret reserve he stored up for healing his other body parts.

Its dangerous, but I got no choice. I don't know when another opportunity will show up. I closed my eyes to see the glimmers. I then immediately gathered all my Kuret on my left foot. This time I felt the Kuret was covered only till my heels. That has to be enough. Gritting my teeth I lunged in the air at the howling giant. I brought my left leg around and willed to push it hard as much as possible. I felt a huge tug on my leg and I started to spin. Shit, I don't have any control on it and my aim was definitely shot. I saw the glimmer of his arms coming down hard on me. Just in the last moment of complete desperation, I bent my knees and swayed my arms behind to pull my body backwards.

In a moment of confusion, his hands missed my shoulders but they graze my right waist. The force of friction cause my clothing rip apart and cause a sharp piercing pain on the skin. I yelp in pain but resolved to push it down for now. My left leg kept tugging me along and with nothing to protect himself with, Charles felt the full force of my kick on his face. Shit, I missed my mark. I could see the brown Kuret getting crushed under my foot. Charles starts to howl in pain as the Kuritines on his face to starts disintegrating. With his head stopping my motion, I was now falling down with Charles on top of me. Crap. While still in pain from Charles attack, I pulled the Kuret to my back and willed to push ahead narrowly missing his falling legs behind me. I bring my arms up to brace for the impact as I slid across the grass. Charles behind me stumbles a little but remain standing on the ground. He was now howling more in pain with orange glimmer around his face.

I came to stop as rolled into a stop. The rush of adrenaline was still in my veins. I had completely messed up the attack on his chest. But at least now he can't see me coming. I got up and kicked off the ground once again. I didn't open my eyes. I need to be the gimmers be my guide for a while longer. I saw the tails now swaying in the air in between us in a frenzy. Is Charles making them to keep us separated. No, he is impulsively wagging his tail to protect himself. I could make a dash for him and avoid getting hit by those tails. But I would waste too much energy getting to him.

I made a risky move to attack him from above. I still had my Kuret on my back. I jumped up and made myself push up above. I had to put enough force to bridge the gap between me and Charles. I am still not used to this movement, so my arms and legs dangle a little bit as is glide in the air. The air seeped into my slightly opened mouth and I could feel the air pushing into my throat. Note to myself, never jump like this with an open mouth. I was rising in the air, but not enough to jump over the tails Infront of me.

I didn't know if this would work, but I pushed myself once more. I felt a smaller tug from behind this time. It was then I realized that I can't do consecutive pushes with same strength. At least not with level of Kuret I have now. It was not strong like the one before, but it was enough to raise me over the last tail hovering in the air. I safely cross the tails and start to fall on Charles back. He was writhing facing away from me and resting on his arms above guarding his face. I could see the gimmers of brown flowing into his face.

I was hoping to take another shot at that chest. I changed my target to his lower back. The second best place where majority of his Kuret is formed - around his waist. As I fall I pull my Kuret into my right elbow. I plan to use gravity to my advantage and deliver a crushing blow. I saw those orange glimmers around his head dissipate a little. Not good. Charles must have felt my presence coming from above and starts to move away. I couldn't change my direction so I just kept going.

Charles was crawling away from me, but not fast enough. I instead land my elbow on this right leg, straight in the middle of his calf. As soon as my elbow connected I could feel the Kuret getting crushed under my pressure. I positioned myself to brace my fall as my right side of the body to hit the ground. Since those legs were large, it made my body pivot and absorb majority of the momentum I carried. I still felt all the air I had gulped thrown out in a rush as I hit the ground. I braced my right abdomen to take the hit. The pain sent shivers to my body.

I saw enormous amounts of orange glimmer around Charles now. His Kuret was now getting stripped away mercilessly by my Kuret. A large amount of Kuret was getting churned away from his leg. Charles howls were loud enough to make me go deaf. His Kuret was slow to heal and his desperation to get away could be felt from him. I was definitely chopping off his Kuret supply and I wanted to keep going, but I saw the tails coming for me. Must be an instinctive defense mechanism. I had to get away. I pulled away my right arm and got up disoriented from the shock of falling.

I wanted to run away hastily, but the shock on my legs was still not gone. I should not done this without the usual coating of my Kuret to protect my body. I gritted my teeth as I had no choice but to brace from the impact of those tails head on. Since I hadn't attacked the tails for a while, those Kuretines were healed. They were considerably smaller and blunt at the end, but getting hit without protection would be bad. My heartbeats took a higher beat when I saw all the tails coming at me from different directions.

I can block only two of them. I won't be able to dodge the other two. I was running out of options. I pulled my arms in front of my face. There is only one option. I have to pull out more Kuret right now. I plunged deep into my thoughts to focus at the last few second I had. This is my only hope. My body should be attuned to this new Kuret form. I kept focusing on pulling on more of my Kuret. I felt nothing. I couldn't feel the Kuret forming on my body. With a frustrated cry, I tighter my fist even more. Work dammit, I shouted into the air.

Just as the tails reached from different directions. A wave of Kuret finally conjured around me. This was not the new threads of Kuret, but my most basic burst of Kuret. If those tails were in their original state, I would have been if much more trouble. But with those Kuretines chipped and Charles unstable Kuret, the Kuret blast was just enough to disintegrate those Kuretines and the tails bounced back away after getting it by my Kuret wall.

I breath of relieve washed all over by body. I was able finally able to call upon my Kuret. I think I also realized what was going on with my Kuret. But I shelved those thoughts for now. I faced to the now incapacitated Charles lying on the ground. The brown Kuret was flowing on the leg I attacked. Unfortunately, the wound wasn't deep enough to have enough damage. At the very least I got him tapped out for few seconds. I didn't wait another second to let those tails or Charles recover more. This is best time to keep up the offensive.

I forced my legs to move after the shock subsided. I ran to Charles thinking over the best course of attack. He is guarding his chest with his arms while resting on his left knee. His face is partially healed and he is now focused on healing his leg. And based on the amount of brown glimmer lost, its best to assume his Kuret is still unstable. I focused on the gimmers however around him. I need to attack now to the point where his defenses were the least on his chest.

I caught an area close his left ribs where he was drawing out the his Kuret the most to heal the damages I delt. That’s where I will focus my attacks. I came dashing close to him. With his mobility cut short, I had a slight advantage. I still have to make sure not to get hit by any of this attacks right now. I don't have any defenses available to me. Even a single attack would be the end of me. As I get close enough, Charles makes a big growl at me. I still couldn't see read the glimmers with that banged face, but I bet he is not thrilled.

Charles makes the first move and throws his right fist to slash my face, I gather my Kuret to the left side of my arm and will it to push hard blocking the claws away from me. The force of that punch was pushing me back, but I didn't relent and kept going. Finally the force of my arm dominated and I swatted his arm away. I take the momentum of that force and launch a punch from my right arm to his chest. Charles reflectively, brought his left arm to defend his ribs. I gather my Kuret about my fist. While I was faster, he was still bigger. I couldn't land a punch on his ribs and instead struck his arm. My fist dub deep into his arm and started to strip off Kurets.

Charles took this opportunity and lunged forward with his broken mouth forward. I could see his mouth still hadn't healed, but those Kuretines in his mouth were still dangerous. He was about to take a bit out of my right shoulder. I was getting better at controlling my Kuret, I saw where he was going to attack me and covered that area with my Kuret. He bit into now my Kuret covered shoulder and he jerked backed away after getting hitting a mouth full of my Kuret.

I didn't wasn't going to let this opportunity slip away and brought another left punch. Charles face, his eyes in particular, shouldn't have been able to follow my movements, but somehow he did and brought his right arm again to defend. He blocked me again at the expense of my Kuret on my hand stripping away his Kuret. We kept going this hand to hand combine couple of times. I know I am not making a mistake by making any obvious moves, but Charles is able to counter it and attack me after healing his arms enough.

We kept going this even longer. I couldn't fathom how he is fighting just with intuition guiding him. While I kept him on defensive, this is just a momentary weakness. Once his Kuret is stable again, he will be on offensive again. I think he also know if I land a blow on that chest, he would lose a big chunk of his Kuret. We both kept each other on our toes. I haven't done this much martial arts since the beginning of this tournament against any opponents. After a dozen of the blocks, Charles leaned back a little. I saw the brown glimmers around him getting even smaller now. I have to do it now.

Charles probably felt my intent and raised both his arms to thrown down a barrage of slashes. I didn't give him that opportunity. I focused and made another Kuret wave blast around me. Since I have been tempering it inside me for long after the previous one. This blast was more powerful. Charles never got to land those arms on me. I saw glimmers of his brown Kuret dissipating at the contact of my Kuret hitting him.

He was thrown back a little with the sheer force I blasted. This is it. With all my energy, I pour my entire Kuret into my right fist as I prepare to punch on that rib. Charles didn't even get time to defend this time. My fist connected successfully on his chest. I lean forward to use the full weight of my body on the punch. Those large Kuritines peaking out his skin crackle under my knuckles and his Kuret gets blasts away. Charles let the biggest howl I have ever heard as I kept drilling hole into his chest.

My teeth shiver to keep going with the attack. Few moments later, I saw the glimmer of the tails behind me coming again. Not again. Those damn tails keep getting in my way. I finally landed a decisive punch on him, I can't just back away now. I wanted to throw another Kuret blast. But I know that the one I threw just now sapped away too much stamina to make another one. The tails won't be stopped this time. I had a make a decision fast. Charles wasn't backing either. He was trying to push me back, even with so much Kuret leaking out him, he was still big and strong.

Dammit. I spatted those words as I pulled myself back and start to run away. The tails were faster, so I had to gather my Kuret on my back and make myself push away as far as possible. I came to halt and staggering on the ground once I came to a safe distance. My breathing was heavy. I needed a moment to gather myself before I make another more. I finally opened my eyes. I saw Charles sitting on this knees now with his arms swaying on his side. He was in worse shape than I could have imagined. His brown skin had holes many places on his body where I punched and kicked just now. His leg which I attacked first hadn't healed and had been shaved down considerably. All most of the Kuritines on body had been gone. There was a large hole on his chest that I had attacked. His faced was completely bashed in with broken and crumbling Kuritines, his tongue weirdly hanging out of his broken mouth grasping for air. His arms and shoulders also seemed smaller.

I smiled unconsciously. As I kept breathing from my mouth, a small laughter come from me. I had been sweating buckets, some seep into my mouth. I immediately spat it out once I tasted the salt in my mouth. Even so I couldn't stop from chuckling. I didn't know why I was feeling this weird reaction. I was no where near a clear victory. I spent too much stamina. I got cut from my side a little bit. Yet I couldn't stop the jubilation I was feeling. I felt I like this fight has been going for hours. I still have so many unresolved mental issues, but I didn't care for them this time. I need to keep this pressure and finish his match as soon as possible.

I gathered myself and slowed my breathing. This isn't over yet, I said. I resolve myself for another round of relentless attack. I was about to sprint forward, then I stopped when I saw a huge amount of brown glimmers in front of him. Oh no. I closed my eyes to see clearly. I saw a huge amount of glimmer coming out of Charles now. This was so much more than what I have been seeing it blinded me a little. I opened my eyes to check it out. Charles Kuret was now flowing faster into this body now. The places were I attacked starts to fade away. The hole I made on his chest starts to fill up in seconds.

I pushed my lips in frustration. Charles Kuret is stable again. Charles whole body starts to grow bigger again. His leg heals up and he stands up again. His tails began to recover their strength and Kuretines on the end shine with even more luster and sharpness. His face is completely healed and so is his chest. As I looked in disbelieve, his entire body is healed up in seconds without any trace of his old withered self. Dammit. I lost the golden opportunity. He will be even more dangerous now since he knows my attack can hurt him.

My short-lived joy took a even deeper dive. I realized that I wasn't covered in my Kuret sparks anywhere. Shivers went through my spine. What the hell. I tried to pull on those sparks of Kuret, but none came. This is seriously the worst time to have a power outage again. Charles lets out a big howl and prepares to take a stance to chase me. Seeing him I reflexively take a step back. That last attack I did with my fist and then the force to back away must have drained the Kuret sparks out of my body. And now I am defenseless again. What the shit.

I didn't have anywhere to run anymore. That same trick with hitting his eyes won't work again. A thought came in this desperate situation. I should just give up now. I did the best I could. I even overcome one my hang-ups on irrational fears. That should be enough. Fighting further would be dangerous even if I get my Kuret back. This battle helped me to grow by leaps. I should be just satisfied with this. I just need to raise my hand and say the words to end this match.

But neither my arms or my mouth moved. Was I in so much shock to not move. No. That’s not it. Even in this frenzied situation, I wasn't willing to give up. I was in utter shock with myself now. How badly do I want to win this match. Even risk my life. What gives. Questions keep popping in my mind. Why can't I just this go. I made it till here. It is okay to leave now. I have done enough to show other Medrines our strength. That’s the ultimate goal. It shouldn't matter now who wins.

A large howl came from Charles snapping me out my thoughts. He was now charging straight at me directly. My body tensed up facing now a powered up Charles without my Kuret. My mind was still in turmoil. What is going on with me. I want to end this match. But can't. I thought I accepted that I can't while back, but it seems I still had lingering doubts. I can't keep myself stretched in two directions. I have to commit to myself now for real. Its abundantly clear now I won't end this match like this. Either I am going down or Charles.

I closed my eyes to resolve myself. I try to tune the thumping sound Charles was making as he was running at me. I take a deep breathes. I am sure others would be thinking I have gone crazy not moving while Charles is pressing forward. I need this moment to clear all my thoughts. If I need to continue, I need to make sure I don't doubt myself again. Charles was dangerously close. If it was just few minutes back, I would have been scared shitless. But after dealing those damages, he is not undefeatable. There has to be a way. He must have a weakness. Everyone does. People can only hide their weakness the best they can.

So what's Charles. So far the only thing that worked was due to his Kuret instability. I have to find it no matter what. An idea came to my mind on how to find it. But that is not possible without my Kuret sphere. Charles was so close that he made the Earth shake under his feet. I have to fight him on equal grounds until I find an opportunity to make my move. But how. Without my new Kuret form, I can't block his moves. Then I recalled what I realized about my Kuret.

I open my eyes and look my hands as I raise it in front of me. When I was defending against those tails, I remembered that I was just relying on just my new Kuret form and instinctively blasted a wave. I need to go back to the basics. I should listen to what my body is telling me. I pulled off a high level move and then forgot about the other skills I have. I make my hands into a mist. I need start again. Build my Kuret from the ground up. I thought training the new Kuret form was the way to win. I was only half right. I can't treat my other techniques I have learned, honed, and used over the years as anything different than the new one. I need to learn how to add this new Kuret into my existing skill set.

As in response to my conclusion, my Kuret finally flared all around me and I was wrapped up again with the usual glow I have. That’s right. The new form of Kuret I learned isn't different at all that what I have been doing in my whole life. Its just the next level I need to learn and master. Charles had reached me and jumped up high again to stop me for evading. But I was ready now. I threw a line of Kuret from my right arm and let it pull me away before Charles claws reach me.

I glide along the grass as is avoid the claws again. I reach a safe distance and recall the Kuret back. Hell yeah, I shout. I will not be wavering anymore. Charles lands on the ground kicking up dirt and rocks from the place I

was standing.

I am getting little excited to face off Charles. I even had a grin on my face. Weird. An unexpected development of emotions came over me.

# David (Chapter 14)

Friday, January 19, 2024 13:45

Charles closed the gap in few seconds and I dodged his attack by gliding away on my left. Unlike the last time, I wasn't going to get agitated and instead focus on running away for a while till I come up with a plan. I won't rush ahead until I learn to control this new Kuret to match Charles raw power. We kept this game of dangerous tag for a while. It helped that Charles kept his attacks very simple to avoid. He kept coming at me with those ferocious killing slashes and kicks. Yet his attacks were straightforward aims. Now that I have overcome the distraught of fighting someone unknown with no plan, I didn't given in to fear. I was eagerly waiting for an opportunity to attack while I was on defensive.

After a couple of close encounters, Charles brought his fists the ground with a roar. The ground shake on that contact and cracks formed on the grass like a spider web. Was that frustration. No. I could see the ground split into large pieces of dirt. Oh, hear we go again. Charles switched tactics, he is trying to corner with ground projectiles. Suddenly Charles leapt into the air raising his arms up in the air his claws began to grew bigger again. His jump is now even more powerful after stabilizing his Kuret. He was now hovering quite high up in the air. The tails that he had been not using to attack me for a while start to move again. He made his tails aim the ground instead of me. The four Kuritines hit the ground where Charles had just cracked the earth and began to dug into the ground. This is new.

Charles must have jumped high into air to get enough momentum to thrust his tails into the ground deep inside. Charles falls back down stomping the ground and creating even more cracks under his feet's. The ground shook once more. I assumed that he would dig up pieces of ground to throw at me next, but instead he begins to ran towards with me. I had an pretty good idea what is was planning to do now. I saw the glimmers of the tails under the ground borrowing through the dirt and heading towards me. I throw a Kuret line from behind my back and let myself get pulled back before Charles reaches me.

Charles was waiting for me to back away. He uses his right claws and thrusts into the ground. The ground tore apart and a piece of boulder the size of his arm split apart. Charles uses that pieces to fling it towards me. Damn. Did he get more powerful. No. He is getting more dangerous now. The boulder flew straight at me with uncanny speed. It chased me as I slid backwards on the grass. I could also see a glimmer of one of the tail chasing me from below. I throw a Kuret line to my right from the arm, curving my direction and dodging that boulder. It hits the grounds and cracks at the impact.

I braced for the tail as it rose from the ground in front of me. The Kuritine was aimed at my legs. He is trying to stop me from running away. Behind me, I saw Charles speeding up again. He had dug up another piece of ground from his other claw and preparing to throw at me. I can't let him capture me. I raise both my arms up throw my Kuret straight up. Flying up vertical on the air is slower compared to horizontal movement, but I didn't want the tail catching me. I lunged up getting pulled by my Kuret. The Kuritine on his tail miss me as I rise up.

I saw the glimmers of the rock Charles just dug up coming at me now. I was still flying straight above when the rock come flying at me. I brace my legs for the impact and force them side apart hoping the rock would fly underneath my legs. I couldn't completely evade the rock. The rock scraps the back of my knees a little. I get a sharp pain from the spot it scratched. But I managed to avoid major wound and got a bruise instead. My Kuret was still not powerful enough to protect me from non-Kuret physical attacks. I still am at a disadvantage.

The Kuret on my arms gather back in and I start to fall back on the ground. Charles wasn't giving me anymore chances. Another tail tore through the earth from where I was going to land. I can't stop my fall in his Kuret form. I saw Charles still coming at me from the side. I clench my teeth knowing I have only one move left. I pulled my arms below and aimed at Charles. The Kuret line flew at him with more speed. Since Charles is basically a big ball of Kuret mass, my Kuret would be attracted to it much stronger. As my fall begins to speed up, the Kuret from arms began to pull me down as well. The tug I was feeling on my arms was getting stronger as I fall.

The tail that was soaring in the air at me missed me as I began to fall sideways like a pendulum. I was now falling on a collision path towards Charles. Charles is running on all fours. He didn't even seem one bit fazed as I flew down to him. The air pressing against my face begin to heat as blood rushed to my face. I can't get away this time. The pull on my arms is to strong for me dodge now. I prepared myself with tightening up every muscle I could on my body.

The moment we were about the clash, Charles leaps a little into air with his claws raised in air preparing to pierce them right through me. Not happening. I mentally prepared for a dangerous collision and cried out as I blast my surrounding with Kuret dome. I wasn't planning to make it large. Just enough to cover my whole body enough with a physical barrier. I couldn't do this the last time. But since then I had a clue. I can't just let the Kuret grow out, instead I needed to keep it vibrating as it flowed out. I recalled the feeling when I was able to make the Kuret on my body vibrate and create the sparks. I want to make sure the Kuret doesn’t grow bigger. By vibrating it, I want to slow its size, condense it into more a physical form.

I felt relief when my theory worked out. The Kuret around me didn't grow big and the vibrations I focused on creating made the dome smaller. Just enough to cover my body head to toe. I bring my arms in front of my face and bring my knees to my stomach. This is going to be one hell of a clash. I braced for the impact. This newly constructed dome held better than I expected when I struck against Charles. He had his claws in front of me, but they were instantly blown back away at that impact. The Kuritines on his arms crumbles as I pushed them back.

Even as I wasn't directly touching his body, the impact vibrated through my entire body. His arms got pushed back, and the force I crashed into him kept me going. He was now getting his arms crushed between us. Charles was howling my ears off as he tried to push me away. Charles was struggling with his legs stuck on ground to keep himself up. Even with this arms pinned, he held his ground. I was loosing momentum slowly. My Kuret dome was disappearing now. I wanted this go on for little longer, however I still don't full control over this. I need to get away.

I lean back as my Kuret slowly begins to go back inside me. I pull out my legs and arms preparing to get away. I land on the ground, the disorientation of that attacking was hitting me. Just then Charles with his mangled arms tried to stop me. I felt a cold shiver as he was about to grab me from the sides. His arms were not even half the original size, and yet he wasn't going to let me leave. Hell no. I can't get caught now. I raise my arms to Charles and throw my Kuret line just few inches above Charles shoulder and pull me up.

I must have definitely surprised Charles with this move. I didn't have a choice but to escape this way, since I was seeing the glimmer of his tail coming at me from the behind. I get pulled up into the air before Charles arms gets me. I was pulled straight towards his head. He opened his mouth and snared me with those Kuritines. I didn't do this without a plan. As I got closer to Charles face I bow my head down and drew out another Kuret dome. I know I wasn't recovered enough to pull out another powerful one. I didn't need one. I just needed a small one. Small enough to cover just the top of my skull.

My concentration went through the roof as I was desperate. The Kuret came out of my temple and quickly covered my head like a cap. Since I was focusing on a small area, it was quick to form. The vibrating Kuret formed a strong barrier as I essentially head butted straight into Charles face. The force from my pull on my arms was just enough to overpower Charles. I felt a big pressure on my skull as I cracked my head into Charles. I saw his Kuretines breaking apart and I pushed him back. Charles lets out a big yelp with the second time me breaking his face and mouths. I flew past him as he couldn't stop himself from tumbling down.

The Kuret on my head quickly goes away, just as quickly it had appeared. I could only do it for few seconds, yet it was powerful enough to stop him. I was almost flying in air as I glide over the ground. Behind me Charles had taken a hit straight to his face and now stumbled down on his ass still managing to avoid falling on his back. I came to a slow halt when I was far away. I land on my legs, but I stumbled as I put my weight under by feet. Argh. I think I sprained my right foot a little when I crashed into him. I fall on both my knees forward as I couldn't keep my balance. I used my arms to support my fall.

My breathing was now ragged. Sweat kept pouring from my throbbing head. I could feel a little bit of blood trickling from the side of my temple. I nicked one the Kuritines when I struck against his face. That was a bit reckless. I had no other choice though. I open my eyes to take a peak again at Charles. He was already getting up. But he was considerably slow. His arms were already getting healed, and so was his smushed in face. A smirk formed at the corner in my mouth. I am slowly beginning to pressure him. But not yet. I have only managed to put up a good defense. I bought couple of seconds before Charles would be up again. I need to continue to keep this up and let me use up his Kuret as much as possible. I must have took a significant amount of his Kuret by now. I don't know how much, but there must be a limit.

I close my eyes back and scanned for the other tails underground. The three other tails were nearby me, but they didn't approach me yet. Charles must be focusing on healing himself first. I need to plan my next moves. It was the right decision to be on the defensive. While I continuously dodging his attacks, I had came up with the idea that I need to first vibrate my Kuret and incorporate it into my usual attacks before learning to change my Kuret form. I didn't plan to experiment it like this, nevertheless it was still fruitful. My Kuret dome was finally smaller and much stronger. What's more is that I can do it multiple times in succession. I don't have fine control the strength, but as long I keep it small, I could match up to Charles attacks.

Few seconds passed and Charles was back again with his healed body. I really need to do something about that pesky healing. I can't damage him badly enough when can keep healing those Kuritines on his body. I need to break into that cocoon of Kuret body and hit his real body inside. Now I know that I can overpower his strength momentarily. If I can just stop him from healing even for one or two seconds, I just might be able to land an actual blow. With that in mind, I formed a new plan. I can't defeat him the next couple of blows. Instead I plan to throw a single attack powerful enough when an opportunity occurs. An attack timed just right when his healing doesn't catch up.

For that I plan to cut off his healing for a while. An idea come to me. After having a feel to what vibrating my Kuret dome, I should next do the same to my Kuret when I throw it to help me move around. If the Kuret I throw around get stronger, I just might be able to stop his Kuret flowing on his body. I know that I can't make all my Kuret vibrate so I have to do it only when I am close enough to him. Charles was on the move again. He was running on his limbs with same intensity as before. Around my feet, the tails began to move as well. I want my body to first recover a little. I get back up and inspect my sprained feet. I felt the blood rush up on my vein. I felt the skin burning a little as the bruised surface began to throb. Fortunately, it wasn't paining too much. I need to keep a level head now and not give into the pain and fear now. Especially not when I can still win this fight.

I throw a Kuret line from my left arm let me pull away before Charles catches up to me. I want to at least give my body a minute to settle down before the next encounter. Charles changes direction when I move out from his path. He had grown his claws big again, ready to throw pieces of earth at me. I saw glimmers of two tails from opposite directions travelling inside the ground. Something was different, I could see the glimmers circling instead of coming straight at me. Charles is planning something.

I came to halt when I was a bit further away. I need to check whatever Charles was cooking first before I make my next move. I focus on seeing the glimmers of his tails inside the ground. All the four tails were digging their ways into the ground, but not in any particular direction. There was no pattern to it, looked like random directions. What is he trying to do now. I focuses deep into one of the tails to observe its movements. The one closest to me was moving in a spiral shape. Its almost like Charles is making his tails go crazy. I slightly shook my head, no. Charles attacks are simple, but not random. I didn't get a chance to conclude what those were doing as Charles was approaching me. He had dug up two boulders on each of this claws and preparing to hit me with them.

I throw a Kuret line from my right arm and began running away. Just as I slid across to Charles left, he threw on his boulder. But not at me, he threw it far away in the direction I was going. He plans to stop me from escaping. I was about to change my direction to my left. I saw another glimmer coming to the other side. Charles has thrown the other one in another direction. I see what he is trying to do now. He is trying to corner me further. Is that his plan, he only stop me from going in two directions. I have one more direction to run to. I could try to jump over those boulders, but I didn't want to risk getting caught in the air.

I threw a Kuret line on the last direction. Charles didn't try to stop this path, he kept chasing me from behind. I get that he is trying to limit my options to run away, but is that all. I don't see any of the glimmers of the tails following me from inside the ground. I am faster than Charles, so he can't be just thinking he will catch me. After gaining enough distance, I land on ground. As soon as I step foot on the ground, I felt the ground beneath me shook. The ground began to splinter into cracks and its start to fall apart. What in the hell. I was sure that his tails were no where near me when I land. In a total state of shock, I was sinking down in what looked like a dug out hidden pit.

Suddenly I recalled Charles making those weird motions with his tails inside the ground. That’s what he was doing. He was making traps for me. Ah, I never thought Charles would do something this clever. He must have noticed that I can track his tails even inside the ground. I think he purposefully lured me here so that I land in a place he kept his tails away. This is not good. With my footing lost, I was slipping inside the hole and was momentarily getting sucked in. Meanwhile, Charles glimmer was on the move. He would be on top of me any second. I had pieces of dirt and rocks sticking at me as I slide down. How big did he made this hole. I didn't wait to find out.

I pull my arms above and let my Kuret throw up in the air. I wanted to void getting caught in the air, so I made it shorter. I get pulled into the air away from the sinking ground. One problem solved, but the other one was fast approaching. Charles was not letting me leave.  I wish I had more time to recover before I fought head on, I guess that’s just naïve. He had one claw already raised and ready to slash me with an upper cut. With my arms tied up, I used the only thing to defend myself with, my legs. I raise my right knee to block the path his claws were coming from. With a short breadth, I began forming a Kuret dome from that knee. Just as I learned, I will the Kuret to vibrate faster as I made the Kuret flow out. My Kuret obeyed me and was now covering from my lower thigh to my ancles. With loud bang, my leg met his claw. The clash broke his claws again, but he didn't even stop. The claw came at me so much force that I was thrown backwards.

Since Charles had his entire body weight on his side, that attack made be push back hard. That force of the impact was lessened due to my Kuret protection, but I was flung back uncontrollability. I was spinning sideways as I went down. I was going to hit the ground soon. But before I did, I saw Charles preparing to attack with the his other claw. He had them swung from bellow with an undercut this time. If I had my eyes open, I would not have been able to block it due to the disorientation of my spinning vision.

I could see the glimmer of his arm coming in from behind me. I didn't have the time to throw a Kuret line and run away. I also didn't have the time to create the dome, so I cover my entire back with Kuret to prepare a Kuret blast instead. I blast my Kuret backwards, the Kuritines on his arms gets crushed and breaking but does not disintegrate. Shit. My Kuret blasts are not powerful enough to completely break them. I brace myself for the worst. His claws hit me and I felt sharp pain as some of the Kuritine pierced my skin. My skin was burned as blood dripped out from my lower back. I bit my lips in agony.

Charles kept going and flung me up in the air with such a force that took the wind out of me. I was thrown in the air with my arms and legs swaying behind from the force. With the pain searing from my back, I had few seconds before I fall back into the ground. He got me good this time. I saw the glimmer of my blood tricking out from the wound I just got. If I hadn't made that Kuret wave, I would have gotten a much serious wound. I got hurt, but he didn't pierce it too deep. My Kuret had damaged his claws. He was only able to wound on the surface tissue. But the pain I got from my lower rib was far worse. The power behind those arms were unreal. I can only hope he didn't break any of my bones.

I couldn't inspect further as I began to fall to the ground. I muster up another layer of Kuret on my upper back and throw a Kuret line straight up. The fall began to slow down and came to near halt just as I hit the earth. As I land, I coughed up the dirt around my face when I let out the air from my lips. I lay there for a second letting the shock of that attack wash over my body. I saw Charles glimmer approaching me fast. With an irritated feeling I immediately stood up with my arms supporting me. I felt the new bruise I got on my back throbbing with even more pain now.

I was relieved to not see any broken bones. But this not boding well. I have been slowing racking up wounds. I haven't gotten any serious would yet, but I can't keep this up. I threw a Kuret line from my left arm and run away before Charles next attack. This has gotten a lot trickier. Charles must have dug up other holes. I have to be now even careful where to land. I scan the ground and try to pick up any glimmers of dug up grounds. My effort was in vain, I can't tell the difference in the glimmers from places which are safe and those which are not. I see the same glimmers around everywhere. I might be able to figure out if I was close enough, but I can't do that without landing on that area first.

I open my eyes in desperation. If I can't rely on glimmers, then I will just eye ball it. My Kuret line was running out. I had to make a decision. I land on nearby ground with caution and ready to slide away in case I got caught again. But nothing changed. I landed on a safe place. I let a sigh of relief. I turn around to inspect the ground nearby. I caught glimpse of some suspicious looking patches of grasses. They had been cut short. No, they had sunk below a little from the underground hole. Yes, that’s it. By looking at the grass I can predict where to land. That meant I can no longer land on places where Charles has been digging up the boulders and leaving bare debris behind with no grass.

I threw another Kuret line from my back and flew away before Charles catches up to me. I close my eyes after noting down the safe area I plan to go. I saw glimmers of two tails approaching at me from the same direction as Charles. The tails burst through the ground out in the air just in front of Charles as he ran in front of them. What's this now. I was bamboozled as Charles leapt into air and uses his claws to slash the Kuritines from his tails. In a swift motion, he plucked it away from his tails. Then he threw one of them straight at me. Whoa.

The Kuretine he threw came at me with too much speed. I didn't have time to change direction. I crouch my head down behind just in time as the Kuritine flew past above me. I could hear the air hissing as it flew in the air. I saw the glimmer of the other Kuritine Charles threw. It was heading towards my gut. I let out a burst of Kuret wave towards the approaching projectile. The Kuritine broke into pieces before it reached me. I reach the area I wanted to land on. I hit the ground on my ass though. I quickly got up in haste.

I saw the other tails approaching me directly. It was now becoming dangerous to run away now. How long can I keep this up before I Charles catches me. He keeps attacking me in ways I don’t know. This is the biggest disadvantage of not knowing who I my opponent was. While he was able to observe me for long enough to know certain parts of my powers. I was feeling little frustrated thinking about Kafar's speech. Was it really the only reason that Charles couldn't access his Kuret for which he was kept hidden. I quickly dispel those thoughts. There's no point thinking about it now. Even if I knew who I was going to fight beforehand, the result would have been the same. Adding the name didn't solve the fundamental problem that I had no clue about the way Charles fight.

My hands tighten up with anger. At this rate I am going to be lose. And not just the match. Maybe even my life if he kept coming with those killing attacks. I have to go on the offensive now. I got no choice. I thought if I keep running away, there would be opportunities where I could use my new attacks. But its now clear Charles has stepped up his game. Ever since getting that beatdown when his Kuret was unstable and later with that cannon ball attack, he has become more meticulous and ferocious. The chances of him making mistakes or giving me opening is becoming scarce. On top of all that, I have been getting hurt more and more.

I let out an irritated sound from my mouth. Its come down to this. I can't slip up even once now. The tails were close enough now. I also realize that these tails are now becoming to much of a bother to deal with. I wanted to let Charles waste Kuret on them as much as possible, but now the situations changed. I have decided its for the best to cut those tails now. The tails fly out from the ground near my legs and go straight to my torso. I let out a small Kuret blast to push them away. Then I grab on to the tails in the middle. As soon as I made in contact, the tail begins to crumble under my skin.

Charles didn't flinch as I grabbed his tails. The next second, the tail section in my hand gets cut off and disintegrates. The head part of the tail falls to the ground slowly dissolving into the air. The rest seeped back into the ground. With that, I began sprinting to Charles, now, with no intension of dodging or running away anymore.

# David (Chapter 15)

Saturday, January 20, 2024 13:54

My Kuret is also responding to me better than ever. And I have decided not to buy time anymore, so all I have to do is completely focus on offense. So far I was able to put my Kuret domes for only few seconds. I will need it for longer time if I am going to stand a chance against Charles monstrous strength. The biggest difference in us is out height and weight, giving him an unparallel advantage over power. No matter how strong I wrap my Kuret around me, without the physical force behind it, it won't make much difference. I need to find a way to become faster. I got speed going for me for the moment, if I can just find a way to utilize it, I might me able to overpower him at times.

As we both ran at each other, I kept track of the tails under the ground. The tails were keeping a distance from me at the moment. Charles most likely plan to use them if I try to ran away in some direction. I thought about my plan a bit. I made a decision to cut those tails off before I start attacking Charles. I don't want to keep diverting my attention to ambush attacks from those tails. The most direct way was to cut all four tails from base on his body, but that will be very difficult.

We will be in a striking position in a second. Before Charles claws reach me I had thrown a Kuret line from my right arm and slid away in the narrow gap of his other arm. I used our confrontation as a distraction and went to my actual target, the closest tail beside me digging inside the ground. Charles came to an abrupt halt and began to change his direction. I already created a fair amount of gap between us. I was focusing on the tail now. The amount of glimmer I see made me believe its not that deep, maybe just 1 meter. I was coming to a halt near that area. I had also peaked a little with my eyes before landing to make sure it wasn't a hidden pit he dug.

I crouch down and lay both my arms on the ground. I have only few seconds before Charles catches me. I focus on the Kuret on my hands. I take a deep breath and began imagining what I need my Kuret to do. My purpose is not to create a Kuret dome which will go in all direction, instead I want to fire a targeted Kuret into the ground and cut the tail in half. I throw a Kuret line inside the ground where the tail was moving. I saw pieces of glimmers stripping off from Charles tails, but it was too slow. Almost immediately, brown Kuret was flowing and healing the portion I damaged.

I was expecting this to happen. I already saw my basic Kuret is ineffective against Charles Kuret. What came next is the core of my plan. Just like before, I began vibrating the Kuret I had thrown. There was a hard resistance, much more than when I did with the Kuret dome. Agh, making it to vibrate further away from my body is very arduous. I gritted my teeth as I continue to press on. A couple of seconds passed by, but I still couldn't make the Kuret inside the ground hard enough to cut the tail completely. I was out of time. Charles came dashing from my right.

Dammit. I stood back up and turn towards the next tail from here. I saw a different tail section at the edge of the arena. I didn't want to go there because if Charles corners me there, it will be difficult to evade. But I needed the extra time to think. So I made a risky decision and threw a Kuret with my left arm and slid towards that ground. Charles lets out a growl as I slip away from him again. I wonder why he is not trying to throw rocks at me now. Surely he must know what I am trying to do by now. Does he plan to keep chase me like this. Whatever his reason was, I was glad. I didn't want extra stuff to worry about.

As I came to a halt midway, I threw a Kuret line from my right arm after taking a single step. I kept thinking as fast I could on how make my Kuret stronger away from my body. I have to figure this out. Vibration is the key no doubt about it. But something else is missing for it to work outside my body. I kept racking my brain to look for clues. I recalled Blake's, Nate's and Jess's Kuret. Their Kuret form are the closest to mine. But so far I have never seen them having problem to solidify Kuret outside the body. They seem to do it intuitively. I should be able to do it too, at least that’s the theory. What's the difference between the Kuret form I use and they use.

I hurriedly came to the ground near the edge of the dome. I waste no time and place both my hands on the ground. I push out a Kuret line from my arms and vibrate them again. My Kuret hit the tail, and same like last time, it didn't cut the tail completely. An idea came to my mind. I am vibrating my Kuret after I throw it, but what happens if I throw the Kuret while its vibrating. It had to be more effective when my Kuret is moving while also vibrating. I need to try this. I pull my Kuret back into my hands.

My heart starts to beat faster with anticipation as I take deep breathes. I image just my right hand covered in a small dome, then I vibrate them like I have been doing. The Kuret on my hands fluctuate in consistency as I never tried this before. I turn my hand into a fist instead and place my knuckles in the ground. The Kuret on my hand becomes denser with the vibration keeping it steading. With another breadth, pull my arm up and punch the ground. I willed my Kuret to flow out as I struck the ground.

My Kuret was unstable, but, it was working. I could feel the ground I was crouching on shake a little. The Kuret flew out of my hand and it was actually digging slowly inside the ground. Incredible. It actually worked. This tail was closer to the surface, so my Kuret reached faster. As soon as it hit, the tail was sliced in the middle. A small roar come from the side, Charles. He has a slight glimmer of orange flowing out of him. I took a mental noted of this because I realized something.

I was relieved that it worked. The Kuret I has thrown had stopped vibrating and turns to its old form as it retreats back into my fist. So just like everything, I can only do this for few seconds and only at a small distance. But now I have something that could work against Charles. One part of tail I cut off slowly begins to disintegrates. That confirms that my Kuret really cut his Kuret body without him able to heal it. I stood back up. Charles was near the arena edge now. I threw a Kuret line from both my arms to the other direction. I didn't want to face him just yet. I need to know the extent of this new skill and while I do that, I should keep cutting of his tails.

There was something more I realized. Charles felt a little pain when I had cut his tail. Till now I thought he didn't want to dispose of those massive tails because he couldn't reabsorb the Kuret lost. But perhaps, there is more to it than that. He must be feeling pain whenever I damage the tail body. Even if I don't directly attack his real body, he would still feel pain if I cut pieces off his Kuret body. This must be another trade off for being able to make an actual Kuret body. I smirk on this realization. This means, if I keep cutting off his tails, keep shortening it little by little. He would feel mental pain. He might be able to physically heal himself, but the growing mental fatigue is something he will accumulate continuously. That’s one of the keys to my win. I now have one more reason to keep chipping off more and more of his Kuret body.

This might not be all that simple though. Charles must have developed enough mental resistance to such an obvious weak point. He must have trained to be resistant against pain. All the time I gauged out Kurets from his body, he must have felt pain from there too. I just didn't see it often because of his overwhelming brown glimmer that masks the glimmers from his real body. And yet, he keeps coming. He must have a high mental fortitude. But everyone has a limit. After I take a certain amount of Kuret, it must cause enough damage to his mind and body both.

I came to halt when I saw section of a tail underneath me which was closer to its end. Lets keep this up. I will target the tails from the top down, cutting it off little by little. I got ready for another Kuret punch, a term I just coined now. With my mind still fresh from few seconds ago, I was able to pull it off without a hitch. My Kuret flew down, albeit not smoothly, but it was enough to cut the tail again. Charles lets out a growl has he approaches me. He must have braced himself for this as I saw very less orange glimmer on him.

I threw another Kuret line in the direction I saw the glimmer of another tail. I reach the area and threw another Kuret punch without missing a beat. I continue to do this couple of times. Charles was getting more impatient with me running around cutting his tails in pieces instead in one go. He was gunning for me much faster, trying to grab on. He also stopped attacking with his tails, that would just make it easier for me to cut them off. After cutting down my 10th, I was in a sliding across an area close to where Charles had dug a pit. There was a tail section hiding in the ground there. Charles must have moved it there purposefully to ambush me.

I took a quick look around of my surrounding. Its not just this area, Charles moved nearly all of his underground tails near the hidden pits. Clever plan. So Charles is capable of tricking also. Maybe he always was and finally getting serious enough to think it through. Unfortunately, its not good enough. I already had came up with an idea to deal with this. The only change is that now I had to do it for all the pits he dug earlier. I came to a halt few meters before the hole. I take a deep breath as I focus on pulling out Kuret from my foot. I plan to cut tail with my leg instead of my fist. Just I have been doing, I steadily wrap my foot with a miniature Kuret dome and will it to vibrate.

My Kuret comes out in uneven shape. Its not a proper sphere nor flames. Its somewhere in between, an amorphous shape. I didn't care about the efficacy of my Kuret at the moment, so I throw an Kuret line over the pit. As I slide across the ground, I wait for the opportune moment. Just as I reach above the grass hiding the tail, I raise my leg a little above my knees behind. I mimicked the motion of kicking an imaginary ball, I will my Kuret to grow as I slid over the grass. In one swift motion, I kicked the air while extending my Kuret. My Kuret control over my foot was the worst, but it was strong enough to cut the tail inside. I made a smile as I came to a stop over a safe area.

Behind me Charles had grown his claws again and preparing to throw the pieces of ground. He is finally doing it. But this didn't stop me from cutting the tails. Charles kept throwing pieces of rocks at me, however, now that I know where the pit he dugs were, I was able to stay clear of those flying projectiles. At this point, it didn't matter how many rocks he would hurl at me, it wouldn't change my plan. About a dozen cuts later, his tails had finally shorten to almost his original size. To be honest, they were still longer than how it was, but cutting them shorter would mean getting more closer to him. I decided it wasn't worth the effort to cut it further.

I came to a halt at a safe ground after I safely dodge a rock thrown at my head. Its time, I mumble as I face the incoming Charles. Over this entire course of trimming his tail, I had gotten enough handle on my Kuret form. I am able to Kuret vibration and extend it a little bit over a distance from my arms and legs. I honestly wanted to get more familiar, but delaying it more would drain even more of my stamina. I was breathing hard with my face covered in thick sweat. My face is flushed with blood and my chest is beating hard.

I think I spent about half of my endurance. Maybe even more. I will probably last only a some more time before I am completely down for the count. If it was any other situation, I would have just high tailed out of here because I don't know what will happen next. I hate fighting without knowing an opponents weakness, especially, when I still don't what his real weakness is after exchanging so many blows. Well, nothing can be done now. I will have to just to figure it out as I go on the offensive now.

Charles roar made me bring out of my thoughts. He was a little faster. Perhaps due his tails shortening. Or maybe he knows that I will fight him and got excited. In my mind I was still holding back my desire to fight him head on, and that’s probably my justification avoid him temporarily and cut down the tails first. But now there's no excuse for me to avoid him head on. I focus on getting my breathing down and calm the nervous acting up. I patiently waited for Charles to reach me this time wanting even the extra seconds to clam down. The clock slows ticks slowly in my mind as Charles keeps getting closer.

This is it. We are now coming to the final parts of our showdown. I focus just on Charles glimmer, trying to find places on his body that has less Kuret mass. Since his Kuret is stable now, there is no point in focusing on just depleting his Kuret. Instead I will now change my plan to start attacking places where he has slow Kuret healing or less protection. But with so much Kuret around him, I couldn't find any good particular spot to attack. Then I have to figure this out as we exchange blows. I brace myself, raise my arms above my chest and tighten my fist.

Charles this time was going for a head on collision. He had a half opened mouth exposing those Kuritines underneath them. So he is going for more dangerous attacks. My fingers shiver a little in my hands. No turning back now. I formed a dome on both my hands. Kuret flows out and I vibrate. The vibrations could now be even felt over the hairs on my skin. I must be vibrating my Kuret more vigorously at the sight of him. I have to stay clam no matter what. One mistake and I am done.

Charles lunged forward at me head first aiming to take bit at my left shoulder. I saw this coming from his movements. In response, I move quickly to my side to avoid his bite. His teeth bites the air where my shoulder was. Then I tighten all the muscle I could muster on my right arm and throw an undercut punch. I put my entire body weight under that punch by letting my body fall in the opposite direction.

I was aiming for his throat thinking he would not expect me to hit him where the Kuretines have grown the most. I took the risk and attacked here thinking this would be closest path to his real body inside. My first connected to

his Kuret flesh. His Kuretines immediately crumbs into tiny pieces. I yell out a little as I extend my Kuret from my fist. Unlike the tails, I felt something very hard obstructing my path. I was expecting that, his body was naturally going to be more covered in Kuret.

Because of my movements, I couldn't see exactly how effective my punch was. I quickly push myself to hug the ground before Charles arms could grab me. Charles jumps are so long and huge, one can easily hide out under him as he passed over my head. I throw a Kuret line from my other arm to get some distance from Charles. As I slid away, I saw Charles glimmer spiraling around the Kuritines I crushed. But there was no visible glimmer of pain. It didn't work. Charles landed on his four limbs and shakes his head a little, like he was shrugging off that attack.

Shit. Not a good start. I didn't want to wallow much in disappointment so I came to a halt and got up. I threw another Kuret line from my other arm towards Charles hurrying to get him from behind. I prepare my other arm to try once more. Charles didn't stop to heal himself first, he got up on him legs and bared his claws at me. I let go of my Kuret line and poured more Kuret into my fist. If that amount of Kuret I attacked him earlier is not enough, I need to go big.

My control was failing as I make the Kuret dome on my fist bigger. But I didn't have any other choice, so I keep focusing on making sure the vibrations hold the dome on my hand smaller. I throw out my Kuret from my fist as my punch connects to his. His claws immediately disintegrates, but he doesn't budge. Instead his overwhelming force cause me stagger back and throw my balance off. I had left jumped in the air to reduce the counter force, but it was enough to throw me backwards. I felt the shock of that punch over my bones. Fortunately, I had chipped enough of his Kuret body on his arm and cut down the power of that fist, otherwise I would broken my arm.

I was thrown into air. I didn't want to my effort go to waste. The dome I had on my arm was getting smaller, but it wasn't gone completely. I have to get at least one more hit in before I get away. I instinctively throw a short Kuret line from my chest and I got pulled towards Charles. I saw his other arm trying to stop me. With a burst of energy, I tried to put up another Kuret dome on my leg hoping to kick away. I didn't even how much successful I was, but I managed to kick him at the wrist and cleared my path. My dome on my hand was now much smaller.

I decided to change my attack. With my free hand I grab on to the largest Kuritine back of his head. I grip it around my hand and pull myself closer. I pull my wrist closer to my chest, focus on putting my Kuret my elbow. The dome was still stronger on my elbow. I shout out once more as I extend out my Kuret and land my elbow to his forehead. His Kuritines on the face was completely crushed and continue to press on. I was hoping to at least push him down. But he was still standing strong.

All I was focusing was to put as much as pressure I could into my arm. Charles bark was smushed under my Kuret. A moment later I felt his tails glimmer grabbing me at both my legs. Shit. I didn't pay attention to his tails. A big careless mistake. The next moment he yanked me off his face and I let go my arms. His tails pull my to his side and I got pulled away horizontally. He makes me spin behind me and throws me up in the air. I felt my blood turning to my head as I was thrown up side down.

I saw the sky below and ground above me. I was too much focused on his arms and legs, I completely ignored his tails. Will not make a mistake like that again. The glimmers around Charles face was hastily running around. But for the first time, I saw another glimmer coming out of him. I saw sparks of blues flowing inwards is face. I grinned a little, despite my current airborne condition. That attack now just connected to his actual body. Those gimmers I saw was his nerves sending pain signals to his body.

I thought of another attack. I didn't want to waste this opportunity that Charles gave me just now. With the arms there were dangling below my head, I threw a Kuret line towards Charles. I pull slowly slows down my acceleration to the sky. I see Charles other two tails moving below me. They were wrapping around two rocks lying nearby. Even without his eyes, Charles was trying to attack my just by sensing my movement. His tails lift those two rocks in the air.

I was coming to a slow halt and then began to change direction. As I start to fall back down, I twist my body and position myself to attack. Charles throws one of the rocks at me. I was surprised how good his aim was considering he wasn't even seeing. But it wasn't enough to change my direction. The rock passed me from a little distance safety. The second rock he throw, however, was flying straight at me. In anticipation, I had thrown another Kuret line from my chest pointing below ground. My two Kuret lines pulls me in different direction, and I curve down as I fall. I narrowly pass by the rocks coming at me.

Now my path was unobstructed. I twist my body a little and join my legs together. If one limb is not strong enough, how about I use both of them together. With my legs anchored, I form a Kuret dome around my feet. My teeth grind in anticipation. I need to create a more bigger and denser Kuret. The vibrations from the Kuret was whistling in the air as I swing. I kept focusing on my Kuret till the moment I connected my foot against Charles backside.

Charles was trying to move away sensing my approach. But he was too big and I was coming in too hot for him to dodge this. My legs connected his Kuret body from behind on his back with a loud bang. I was right to drop kick him with both my legs. While the dome wasn't consistent, this was still my strongest attack I have felt. The Kuret I extended from my legs cuts deep inside his body. Charles with his half healed mouth howls vigorously. I felt Charles getting pushed ahead under the force I was hitting with.

Seeing Charles slowing loosing balance, I got a rush of adrenaline and will the Kuret on my arms to pull me stronger against him. My Kuret had definitely chopping off more Kuret he could replace. I now saw even more spark of blue glimmers from his back. I was hitting him on his actual body now. My teeth quiver with the push I am making. Charles finally gives into my pressure. Instead of toppling forward, he bends forwards to crouch down. With his body no longer stopping me, I got pulled away above him in the air. I bring my arms to cover my face from the debris lying all over the place. I slid over the grass for a distance and came a stop.

I see Charles glimmers running overtime. I take a peak with my eyes. Charles was crouching down and squatting his legs. This was the first time I saw so many Kuritines destroyed on his body. His face was still not healed, when I elbowed him, I was aiming for his eyes. I don't know if I actually hit him there or not. And if I did, would it heal faster?. The time I attacked his eyes with stones was around when Kuret was unstable. So maybe that was pure luck back then and he could heal his eyes faster now.

His Kuret behind his back shaved away so much that it looked like a large scope was taken out. I thought I didn't made the right choice attacking on his back where, like his chest, he had a lot of Kuret. But my the kick from both legs had enough Kuret to gauge out a substantial amount of Kuret. Even with my eyes open, I could visibly see large amount of Kuret flowing into it and still not healing faster. The pain he felt when I connected to his actual body must be a enough to rattle him at least a little.

I take a moment to inspect my body. I only had some new cuts on my arms, curtesy of my recklessly grabbing those pointy Kuritines and elbowing him straight at the Kuritines guarding his eyes. Everything else considered, I think I made it out without too much damage. I grinned a little as I get up. I face Charles thinking of my next move. I wanted to launch an attack immediately, but I also needed a second to shrug off the disorientation I am feeling.

As I was thinking about my next plan of action, my eyes accidently picked up a thin strand of red glimmer in the air. For a moment I was got worried that I was bleeding other than my head and back. But the glimmer coming off me was at a different direction. In a moment of confusion, I look around the ground behind me and didn't see the origin of this glimmer. I close my eyes and focus on tracking this. I followed the thin strand of red and traced it coming from in front of me.

Wait really. I began to feel excitement swell inside me. Was that last attack so strong that I actually able to make Charles bleed. I hastily focus on the back he was healing. But surprisingly, that wasn't the origin. Huh, my excitement took a turn and instead I was puzzled. I then gaze over his arm. There was a small cut where the red glimmer was coming out of. The cut was so small that the Kuret had already been healed over, but I could still see a small but clear line of red glimmer out from his wrist.

My eyes flew open in complete bewilderment. Did he accidently cut himself. No, that’s impossible. Then I did that. When did I do that. I recalled the time when I was pulling myself closer to Charles face. He tried to block me with that arm and kicked it away. That’s the only moment I connected to that arm. Hold on, that kick had barely enough dome. I was splitting my main focus into the bigger dome on my arm. What's going on, the elbow to the face and the kick to back didn't make him bleed. But I managed to make him bleed, even a little, over a half baked Kuret kick.

I turn my gaze to my left foot. What did I do. I tried to recall what I did special there. I racked my memories. I don't think I even put much thought when I was actually doing it. Then a answer came into my mind. What if at that moment, when I didn't have time to create a bigger dome, I made such a small dome while vibrating that it broke. But it didn't disappear, instead it turned to the Kuret thread and created my new Kuret form. It was probably not stable for even a full second, but in that moment I kicked him, my Kuret vibrated so strong it broke the Kuretines on his wrist. Not just that, it was powerful enough to make that scratch.

At that realization, I half opened my mouth to take in more air as I breathe. I finally got a hint into how to combine all my Kuret skills into the new form I wanted. My sweat slips inside into my mouth a little, but I didn't care. I was getting a new rush of excitement I had never felt since the match started. It felt like eternity fighting him, but I now it felt even slower. If I can do that again, learn and then do it on my entire body I would finally have a decent change of winning.

Charles would be done healing in few more seconds. I began to prepare a plan after this discovery. I softly say into the air, Get ready Charles. You are going down.

# Blake (Chapter 16)

Tuesday, January 23, 2024 22:11

The atmosphere in this room is filled with tension. People didn't even look away from the screens even for a second. It had been now 24 minutes since the battle started. The longest battle we ever saw was between Vanessa and Marina than went for around 30 minutes. Looking at both Charles and David, it doesn't like this match will stop anytime soon. Some time back, Kafar had started drinking. He was tensed earlier about Charles getting disqualified, but when we decided to leave it to David to choose, he has started enjoying himself seeing David struggle. A little too much actually.

David had started fighting against the tail instead of fighting Charles directly for some reason. He kept dodging and slashing with his hands. Ned asks, what is going on here. Charles doesn't need to use his tails to fight. Why is he going about in such a difficult way. No one gave an answer to him. I was also curious about it, but I was more focused on what David was doing. He had wrapped himself with Kuret around his hand. No, just his fingers. This is the first time I have seen him doing this. He never did something like this even in our match. Is that what he was hiding. No, why would he wait so late in the game then.

I chuckle a little after realizing a bit, I don't know about Charles, but I am almost sure that David is doing some sort of training. I spoke up giving my thoughts. Matt asks, huh. What. You are not serious are you. He is right in the middle of a match ?. I reply, think about it. Have you ever seen that type of black Kuret on him before. Look at him dodging and slashing those tails. He is moving uncoordinated. I might be wrong, but he is not fully in control. So he must be stalling for time and getting used to this first.

Vanessa asks me, is that the ace up his sleeve he was hiding. The one you mentioned earlier. I shook in response, I honesty can't say for sure. But I don't think this is it. Tessa who was looking at a different monitor that focuses on Charles asks, is it me or is something strange going on with Charles?. Cass asks, strange how. He might not be moving much, but I don't see any difference in his power. Everyone look to the other monitor. Kafar sets his drink down, Charles is no fool. He must be testing David after seeing his strange new techniques. Kafar showed indifference to Tessa's question.

Tessa replies, I don't think that’s all. I can't see well from the monitor, but I can sense something happening to his Kuret even from here. Its very small, but there is definitely a change in his Kuret levels. I wasn't sure what Tessa was going on, but she wouldn't say something without any reason. I turn over to the window and stare at the arena directly. I pulled in Kuret into my eyes and focused on Charles. The aura coming off his Kuret body was basically blinding. It was like a Kuret tornado with him in the eye of the storm.

But then I caught something. The aura around him was not stable. It was flickering and running wild. His Kuret usually would be in control. Like Tessa said, his Kuret was behaving strange. Nathan spoke to me, you see it too cousin. Nathan was also gazing at the arena and checking the same stuff I was seeing. I nod, yes. Its as you say Tessa, something is going on with Charles. His Kuret is running wild, almost unstable. Kafar stood up immediately from his seat, wait. What. No. That’s impossible. He ran frantically to the window and stares at his champion. He shouts, Derek. Can you check.

Derek cuts him off, way ahead of you. I turn to him. He was fiddling in fingers on tablet. A few seconds later he says, wow. Derek makes a small smile. But it disappears before Kafar sees that. Kafar, you might want to sit down for this. The sensors we placed on his body shows that he is effected from the Kuret blockage. Kafar eyes widen in shock. He walks to Derek and takes away the tablet from his hands and checks it for himself. Derek then looks at the monitor with a little smirk, so even the alpha can't avoid this. He takes a pause to think and then continues, You guys are right, his Kuret is unstable temporarily. Maybe he is stalling David for time to recover by using tails to attack meanwhile.

Cass chuckles a little, that’s incredible. So that means Charles got weaker then right. David will be on the offence now. Ned cuts in, even if that’s true. David might not even know Charles state. Vanessa beside him replies, there is no way that David won't pick that up. I am telling you, he will not let this opportunity go. She eyed Ned as he affirms her words. Ned was about to something curt back to her. I spoke before their private feud turns to another quarrel, we just have to wait and see. Hearing my words, they both backed down.

Kafar who was silently going over the screen, this is impossible. It has never happened before to Charles. He never had a Kuret block in the middle of a fight. He was probably in denial. It was a little amusing seeing Kafar panic again when he just leisurely drinking just a minute back. I didn't notice it, but Marina beside me standing and performing a Charm. I turned to her, what are you doing. She speaks, when you mentioned Charles Kuret was unstable, I wanted to confirm it. She takes few more seconds and completes the charm.

In front of her, the Kuret she drew turned into a figure of Charles. Marina continues, I linked up his Kuret form from within the dome to his. We can see his current Kuret state. She then points to a 3D figure of Charles that was projected from inside the dome. The projection showed Charles Kurets flowing out. Then as we kept monitoring, the Kuret began to decrease. Marina had her hands in the air trying to sense Charles Kuret, yeah. I think I got it. Its just an estimate, but Charles lost about a nearly half his usual Kuret. If David attacks, Charles would be fighting at half his strength.

I was amazed Marina able to figure out so quickly. Derek ask her, can you tell how long will he be effected. Marina presses her lips together trying to figure that out, I have no idea. This is my first time seeing a Heraknus you know. Just be glad I could tell about his much. All I know is that Charles is running on half the strength for now. Derek's taken aback with her irritated response, um, okay.

Vanessa lets out small chuckle suddenly, guys look. David is on the move. I turn back to the monitor, so did everyone. David was running straight at him. Did he realize Charles got weaker, or was this just a coincidence. Charles didn't move from his spot but instead used his tails to attack David from below. David didn't attack them, instead he jumps forward. It was strange though, it wasn't a normal jump. Its like was not able to control his own body and fumbling around the air. Whatever he did, it was enough to get away from the tails.

David goes on the offensive, starting with dodging Charles attacks. He was fighting without his full black Kuret, which seemed odd to me. Why would he do this so risky. David didn't stop his barrage of attacks. Charles leaps in air to attack, to which David jumps himself up and attack his face. Whatever David was training paid of, he shattered almost all the Kuritines on his head. He get a small side cut from Charles before he runs away. David was successful in landing the first blow in this exchange.

But he wasn't going to stop just yet. Charles had brought his tails to stop David in his tracks. David's again does the strange movements to hop over them. Its was very clear to me that David was struggling to control this new power of his. David while falling down, attacks Charles leg and Charles lets out a howl louder than ever. Everyone here were in awe seeing this incredible spectacle. The most shocked was Kafar. I could see panic in his face now. David defends himself with his Kuret before the tails was able to grab him. Cass lets a out relief of sigh beside me, that was too close.

David makes some distance between them. He was on a hot streak now. With two consecutive hits, Charles was slowly getting cornered. They both began a hand to combat. It was incredible seeing them duking out from here. Which Charles on his knees, he was still large and tall. Compared to him, David was not even half his size. And yet, David held in ground. Derek says, I am now sure David knows about Charles getting weaker. No way he didn't notice it. He wouldn't so fervor to continue attacking like this if he didn't.

Kafar takes a small gulp and tried frantically to correct his expression, why is this happening. Charles never been effected by Kuret block fighting anyone ever. Vanessa replies, well he has never fought someone like David before either. Everyone here, save few, couldn't help smile a little at that. Everyone here knows David finds a way in matter the situation. Marina giggles a little beside me, ah, Kafar, our champion is now in real trouble now. She nods her head to point to the hologram in front of her, Charles is at around one-fourth of his Kuret level.

We stared at the hologram and saw the Kuret around Charles dwindling down. Every time David attacked him, the Kuret from his body emptied out. Kafar was expressionless now. I think he might be finally realizing that Charles could lose this. After almost 2 minutes of continues attacks, David finds an opening. He blasts a Kuret wave and then punches Charles square in the chest. The punch itself was not strong, but his black Kuret was continually blowing off large amount of Kuret from Charles body.

Even more surprising was Charles not backing down. Even when getting cornered, he wasn't giving up. He made his tails crawl from behind and chase David. David ran away before he gets caught. Charles was in a worse shape now. Marina whistles beside me, oh boy. Charles is now just running on Kuret fumes now. His big showy body is just for show. He is almost tapped out. The hologram showed very less Kuret on Charles body. Everyone were tethering the edge now. Is this it, I spoke out loud without knowing.

David took a few seconds to shrug off his exhaustion. He then runs off towards Charles. This could be the end of this match. Marina makes a sharp cry from her mouth, oh shit. I dart my eyes back to her. The hologram she maintained was now showing Kuret coming back from inside Charles. I ask, wait does this mean. She reluctantly nods, yeah. His Kuret block is over. Matt brings his fist to the table beside him, damn. So close. We stare back at the monitor. David must have also realized like us when he stops in his tracks.

Kafar lets out a big sigh of relief. Oh jeez, I got worried a lot more than I like to admit. He walks and slumps back to his chair. Ned says, well don't get too comfortable just yet. All this has shown that Charles is not invisible. If another Kuret block happens, he will be done. While that premonition sounded dreadful to Kafar, to those who want David to win felt like a hope to hang on. Marina dispels the hologram of Charles Infront of her. I just confirmed he has recovered all his Kuret. He is still loosing Kuret from David's attack. But, its not as fast it was like these few minutes.

We return to our seats as Charles continues to heal himself. Seeing the new progression of the match, Nathan pulls out a drink from the table beside him. He tries offering to Jess, but she denies a little nervousness. I stare at him puzzled. He shrugs when he sees me, what. This is getting interesting by the minute. Its not everyday you see a mythical house's Alpha fight, let alone seeing getting his ass handed to him and to be saved by luck in the last second.

Nathan adopted a little of Kafar's style and decided to enjoy the time now. At least, Nathan is not showing his displeasure openly unlike Kafar. I decided to leave Nathan to his devices. I agree a little bit with Nathan though. I couldn't believe a battle like this was happening. Both of them were showing incredible fight. Derek says, well this officially marks the longest match of the tournament. He enlarges the clock on the screen. The number goes past 30 minutes now.

Matt says, it sucks that David ran out of luck, but I gotta say. This is the most interesting fight of all the ones happened. I mean, if you ignore that blatant killing attempt by Charles. I had to agree with him on this. I still thought David should have called the match off that time, but we left it to him. So far David's barely managing to avoid fatal blows. But how long can he keep it up. Charles had healed and sprinting towards David. Meanwhile, David didn't move.

Marina says, hey. That black Kuret on his hands are gone. That’s bad right. She was right, David must have blown his Kuret out from that last attack. I got nervous seeing him doing nothing and just standing there. Vanessa asks, what is he doing. She was understandably panicking, so was I. Just before Charles strikes him David Kuret black flames covers his body and he runs away with his Kuret. I let out a sigh. David hasn't lost it then. He was just waiting to get his Kuret back. He wasn't using that new Kuret he was just using, but at least he was back to his original Kuret.

I am curious about what was up with his Kuret. Is he really trying to figure out some stuff in the middle of this fight. I chuckle a little at that thought, no one other than David would be so crazy to do this.

# Vanessa (Chapter 17)

Wednesday, January 24, 2024 00:25

I thought the fight between David and Blake was insane, but this is another level. When Derek mentioned about it being becoming longer than my own match, it stung me. I know it was ridiculous to feel this way, but I was a little frustrating that David broke that record of me and Marina's match. I wanted something to go by with a mark or something in this tournament, even with the loss I was carrying. But now this match is the longest. I don't even how good my matchup with Charles would be if I was the on ground instead. Then I quickly remove those thoughts from my mind. There was no point now dwelling in the past.

Up in the screen, David had began zipping around the ground running away from Charles now. I don't blame his choice to keep a distance. David didn't know how close he was winning this match. Or maybe he did. But now he must be taking a beat and strategizing his next moves. Charles moves had regained his earlier power. He kept up the chase, but David was able to evade his every attacks. After few seconds, Charles switched up his moves. He punches the earth and takes off to the skies. As he floats in air, he brings those long tails of his and pushes them inside the ground.

What's this now, Cass voices her concern. David wary of this kept hid distance further away. Charles starts to chase him again, but this time he uses his claws to chip off a piece of ground and flung it towards David. David effortlessly dodges it, but then he gets cornered by a tail coming at him. He was getting smashed between another boulder hurled at him and a tail. He decided to jump off the air to avoid getting caught in between. Nathan says, woha, that was a close one. He then takes a sip of his drink.

I wanted to tell him off for his new rude behavior, how can he be so cavalier about this match. But I kept it to myself. I turned to focus on the fight. David wasn't out of the woods yet. Charles hurls another rock at him. I thought David would not be able to dodge this one, but he just managed to slip away. But now he was falling straight to Charles. What this now, Cass voices here concern now at David. David came crashing into Charles with his Kuret. David had wrapped himself with his Kuret in one of his dome. The clash made a loud bang, like a bell hitting the surface.

Booya, Marina claps at this. Her face glees with joy, that's got to hurt, even for Charles. I agreed. Charles couldn't defend against that. He was trying to stop with his arms, but the force and David's black Kuret had the upper hand here. He got another chunk full of Kuret sliced off him. David backs away after he looses his momentum. Charles tried to grab him, but with another wave of Kuret, David protects himself. I thought for sure we would run away, but instead he instead goes for a head-butt to Charles face. I was confused to see why he did that.

Then I saw the reason, the tails were coming up from behind David. Oh, that’s why. Incredible, David must be using his synesthesia at overtime. Blake says, That looked painful. That was one way to get away, I guess. I think everyone were thinking the same. David managed yet again to get away. Matt exciting says, guys check out at the poll. David's vote has shot up to 23%. Charles at 78% now. I couldn't help but smile a little at that. It was a small change, but it was enough to show that people are beginning to believe David can win.

Ned beside me didn't bother to check the stats. Instead he was deep in thought staring at the other screen with a blank expression. What is it, I ask. I nudged him a little to explain. He didn't turn face me nor did he reply to me. I wanted to prod even more, but I ignored it. I didn't want others to see us argue again. Whatever Ned's problem is with David, I will deal with it after the match is over. I diverted my attention back to the screen once David started moving again.

Charles and David went back again to their earlier cat and mouse chase for a bit. David was sliding around the ground avoiding getting caught by Charles or the rocks thrown at him. It looked like Charles had randomly thrown rocks and chasing his tails after David, but then it became clear it wasn't that simple. Once David stopped moving, he was pulled down into the ground. I hands tense up seeing David fall into what looked like a hole dug, wait what's going on, I ask. The others were also puzzled by this.

David managed to pull himself up with his Kuret before he got buried in the ground. Charles had covered the distance with David immobilized for few seconds. He threw a big boulder at the flying David, which he narrowly dodges. But then he couldn't dodge Charles frontal attack. They both clash, and David got flung back hard with a punch from Charles. I hear Cass's gasping at that sight. David was thrown in the air at quite some distance. My hand turned into a fist in desperation seeing him falling into the ground.

Fortunately, he used his Kuret to break his fall. I felt a little relief seeing David still moving. Nathan says, hot damn. I nearly chocked on my drink. Charles got him good this time. He gulps the liquid down his throat, that was quite a trick Charles concocted. Any guesses to how he dug that hole? I gave it a thought, and realized there is one way he could do that. Derek was the first to answer, using his tails to dug a hidden trap. I never thought Charles would do something like this.

Blake continuous on, a very simple but an effective trap. He pushed David to that trap by blocking his other escape routes. He then sighs with worry, I just hope David didn't got hurt too badly. I was worried about that too, David must be now collecting lot of wounds from all of Charles attacks. David started to move. I watched nervously hopping he didn't get hurt badly with that fall. He had got new bruises on his face, but he didn't stumble down or anything like that. So he is alright, that’s good.

Charles made another unexpected move and used the Kuritines on his tail to hurl it at David. They managed to almost pierce David, but he protected himself with his Kuret. Kafar says puzzled, that was a surprise. I thought I knew about all of Charles fighting behavior. He must be getting impatient. It was hard to know if he was being truthful or not, but there's no doubt that Charles was getting dangerous now. David throws his Kuret and runs away before Charles catches him. David has gotten a little slow reacting. Was it just my imagination ? Or is he getting tried more. Derek says, he must be wary about the hidden holes Charles has placed under the ground. No wonder he is a bit slow in reacting now. Derek picked up on what I was feeling too. I was right, David has become a little slower because of this, but that doesn't mean he isn't getting tiered from this prolonged battle.

I was becoming more worried about his wounds also. He doesn't heal like us. It would be really bad if has something like internal bleeding. I ask Marina, hey, is it possible to check David's condition like how did for Charles just now ? Marina shook her head with no delay, sorry. No can do. I tried it long time back when David and Jess fought, but as I expected it didn't work. There is no way to check up on him due his black Kuret, she takes a pause, at least not with Kuret.

What do you mean, Blake asks. You have a different way then. Marina was hesitant to say immediately. Blake waited for her to reply. After a moment she says, fine. Before the tournament started, David gave me this. Marina pulls up her sleave and shows a smartwatch on her wrist. I recognized it was the one David keeps it on himself. I guess, he gave it to Marina for safekeeping. Cass asks her, hey isn't that David's. Why do you have that. Marina replies, he asked me to keep it hidden. She then looks around us, ah, don't tell David that I told you guys. If he finds out, he might never trust me again. She makes an apologetic expression.

That stuck a nerve. Why didn't David gave it to me to keep it safe. Then a second later I was became uneasy realizing I was feeling such a ridiculous jealously at Marina. I shoved them down and ask her focusing on the immediate issue, does that mean you can check on David's condition. Marina pulls the sleave back on over the watch, yes and no, she replies. David didn't give me any controls. He just said that if he is seriously injured, his watch will alert me. Until then, I can't operate it. So if David has any serious injury, we will know.

Derek speaks, why didn't you tell us about this in any of the previous matches. She shrugs a little, He told me not to tell anyone. I guess he didn't want people to know where he hide it. I don't know if you know, but when you were back in Citradel a couple of weeks ago, David's stuff was ransacked. Some of his stuff was also stolen. So he was extra cautious and asked me to keep it hidden. Blake says, but you didn't. You just told us now. Marina rolls her eyes, yeah well, you made me tell you. And besides, it’s the end of the tournament. It shouldn't be a problem now.

Derek shook his head at her response, that is just cra-. He doesn't finish and chooses to ignore her for now. I understand David wanted someone trustworthy to keep it hidden. But why didn't he give it to Cass, Catherine, Blake or me. We have been together the longest with him. I didn't want the uneasy feeling coming up again, so I shoved them back in. I turned to Ned beside me. As soon as I saw him, he turned his gaze away from Marina and back to the screen. What was that reaction.

I didn't get to ask him. We returned back our focus to David who was now trying something new. Whenever he creates some distance from Charles, he would place his arms down the ground. What's he trying to do now. Whatever he was trying to do, Charles was not going to let him do for more than few seconds. But David was also not letting that stop, he kept doing it. After few times, I saw him switching gears and now he was punching the ground. I thought about what David was planning.

Blake snaps his fingers, brilliant. David is tracking the tails underground. He is cutting them off slowly. I turned to him, seriously. Blake nods, yeah. I don't know how exactly David is doing, but I can see the aura of the Kuret on the tails getting cut off in pieces. Derek chips in, that’s a good strategy. The tails must be a big hinderance to David now. And the way you say he is cutting the tails in pieces instead in one go means he figured it out that Charles feels pain whenever his Kuret body gets wounded. He then smirks a little and says in soft tone, impressive as ever. He noticed that subtle detail.

Kafar says, wait. What are you saying. How can he know where the tails are? He can't see or sense Kuret right. He looks around us demanding an explanation. I didn't believe it. Kafar didn't knew about David's synesthesia. David asked to keep us quite about it, but I thought Derek or Marina would have told Kafar about it. They actually kept their promise. After a moment of silence, Nathan says, does it matter how David is doing it, Kafar. How he is doing it doesn't change what is doing. He takes in another sip, I am curious to know though what David will do after when this is done. Are we finally going to see full on one-on-one confrontation now.

Nathan unexpectedly steered the conversation away from Kafar's question. I was glad to know Nathan didn't tell about David's synesthesia. Kafar wasn't going to let it go so easily, but he also knew knowing this won't change the battle happening right now. David was switching up his attacks now, he was now using his legs to kick his Kuret into ground. David was hopping all over the ground cutting off the hidden tails. This must be getting exhausting. I just hope he has enough stamina left after running so much.

The short round of tail chopping came to end. David stopped and let Charles chase him. He got ready to fight him now. He now covers his hand with his Kuret. But it was dense, like how he uses his Kuret dome. Blake says, he finally learned how to make that move of his smaller. That’s what he was doing for a while now. He was really learning it in the middle of the fight. That's just nuts. I had to agree with him. David's a genius no doubt, but this bordering ridiculousness. If it was anyone other than a mythical alpha, it would be more believable. But this is unbelievable. What's driving David so much to risk so much.

They both soon clash. David made the first move by attacking Charles, but it didn't look like it had any effect. Charles Kuritines broke near this throat, but he didn't back down. David goes for another punch, but Charles stops him with his massive claws. David then goes closer to him. Then atmosphere here heated up instantly as they began close quarter battle. David found an opportunity and landed his elbow straight into Charles face. The Kuret on his arm was the biggest seen. The much Kuret was now crushing his head.

Matt exclaims, hell yeah. That was awesome. He cheers seeing Charles struggling. I hoped Charles would go down now, but off course, it wasn't going to be so easy. Charles grabbed David's leg by his tail. David was pulled back and he was thrown into the air. I was terrified for a moment thinking Charles was going to smash David to the ground. David was thrown upside down. David should take step back, but he didn't. Instead he throws his Kuret and aims it towards Charles.

Jess says, look out, he is not done yet. David begins to fall back down, but he was flying towards Charles. Charles hadn't fully healed his head and had his back turned towards David. But that didn't stop Charles form attacking with two rock his tail threw. David dodges them in the nick of time. He positions his body to dive legs first. He covered his legs with his Kuret. Bang, Charles lets out a loud roar on the contact. Matt lets out a hooting sound

seeing Charles getting struck a second time in a row.

It was clear David had an upper hand and yet he didn't back down. Instead he crouches down to avoid falling down. David slipped away from Charles and come to a halt lying on the ground. That must be exhausting, I thought. Suddenly an electronic beeping sound flare in front of me. I saw Derek pulling out tablet he had set aside at the table. The noise was coming from that. Kafar leaned forward from his seat, what is it Derek. Derek didn't respond immediately. He was glued to the screen and scrolling the screen with his fingers.

After a few second he raises his head with out a surprised expression. He then doesn't say anything and instead raises the tablet for Kafar to read. Blake asks, what is it. Did something happen to Charles. Derek didn't face Blake, he was just staring at the monitor. He then says, Charles sensors indicate that he got a scratch. Kafar pulled away the tablet from Derek hand with a new nervous look I have never seen before. Matt asks, huh, that’s it. Dude, half of Charles back is gone. And you worried about a scratch?

Derek responds, you don't understand. He is bleeding a little from that scratch. Matt waited with expression saying so what. Derek continues, David managed to attack him on his actual body, not just his Kuret body. The real implication suddenly dawned on us. I was feeling a little bliss hearing that. David's relentless attacks finally did something. And based on Kafar's dismayed look it was even more important event. I ask, so what does this mean exactly for Charles.

Ned who wore a pained expression says, it means Charles can get hurt which he can't heal so easily. Is that it. He spoke so strangely like he was trying to be not be effected by his own words. Derek nods, yes. I told you earlier that Heraknus actual bodies are weak. When transformed, they still have that weakness to an extend. They can't heal themselves fast enough like their Kuret body. On top of that, their endurance takes a hit every time they have to heal their own body.

Cass asks without hiding her happiness, so what happens when Charles gets a wound much more severe than a scratch. Derek didn't respond to her. Maybe he didn't know what would happen. Blake asks to Kafar, you might want to consider what's going to happen if you lose your champion Kafar. The complete confidence you had that made us believe he was invincible is beginning to fall apart. Blake was trying to hide his chuckle as he said. Kafar remained expressionless for a moment.

Nathan spoke up, the real question is whether David can pull this off again. I am not saying he can't, but he only managed to make a small scratch after all his attacks. Don't believe its going to be so easy. He looks straight at Blake saying this, but I'll say this is now gotten a hell lot of interesting. Even when he was betting against David, Nathan must be feeling he made the wrong person to bet on. It didn't matter to me though. I know that if David didn't think he would have a chance of winning, he would have called it off already.

David behavior seems to be all over the place during the first phase of battle. And now its looks like David is slowly making a comeback, with a full gear in revenge. Marina's sharp voice pulls me out of my thoughts, what the hell is David doing? I gaze over to the screen. I think everyone watching this battle right now were completely bamboozled.

# David (Chapter 18)

Wednesday, January 24, 2024 18:18

Charles was going to heal in few more seconds. I made sure the time I bought was used well by preparing to plan my next set of attacks. I took a long breath of air to clam my nerves down. This is going to be the most difficult part I tried till now. I raise my palms facing to my chest and turn it into a fist. I grit my teeth as I start to pull out my Kuret from the entire body. I wasn't trying for making a Kuret dome. I come a crucial realization that the Kuret dome I make is a forced form of the Kuret I learned. The small dome I create is highly unstable, but by making it go bigger, I reduce that instability as I push more Kuret out into the air. The dome becomes solid after a certain level of my Kuret filled in the air. While this works, I am continuously releasing large amounts of Kuret to offset the instability and that takes a toll on my body.

After having learned about the unlocked Kuret new form and a clue I just got, I don't need to make Kuret domes. I need to instead harness that instability with vibrations instead. What I want now is to make the Kuret flames to vibrate like how I do with the Kuret dome. It's insanely tough to make it vibrate from my entire body that didn't have a fixed shape. But this is the only way. After few seconds I realized its impossible to do it right now. I wasn't making any progress. I change my focus just on my arms then.

I kept the Kuret flames wrapped around my body as is while I begin vibrating the Kuret on my arms. This was much easier to control. The flames on my arms was slowly vibrating. I recalled the feeling when I extending my Kuret through the dome when I was attacking earlier. I pictured the same here, just without the dome. The Kuret on my arms were slowly grouping together, but then abruptly split apart. It was never going to be easy. I tried few more times. It kept ending the same way. I am missing something. Its like the answer was just at the tip of my tongue.

Charles was all healed up. He turns to me and wastes no time in attacking me again. The back that was damaged was now healed. Not only that, but he now had grown a lot more Kuritines around his body. He knows I can hurt him now. This must be his way of putting up a more robust defense. This meant I have to figure this out. I can't keep relying on pure luck and intuition alone. Charles was reducing the distance between us now.

An idea came to my mind as I saw Charles coming at me. I focused on moving my Kuret around my arms. I never tried moving the Kuret flames before, but I was able to do it earlier with the sparks. Maybe now I can do it in this form also. I willed my Kuret to move, and it starts to move ever so slowly. I didn't wait for it to move faster and willed the Kuret to vibrate immediately. Then something completely unexpected happened. The Kuret on my arms began to behave weird. The Kuret had grouped together like I had intended, but I didn't have much control over them. Those Kuret groups together were clashing with other Kuret going in different directions. What I achieved was having Kuret wrapped in arms that were running totally wild and colliding each other. What's more is that it when they struck, they created the Kuret spark I had learned earlier, but they would instantly become part of the flames.

I essentially made my arm covered with exploding Kuret with almost zero control. I had to keep my arms away from each other to reduce the blocked vision I had from Kuret bursting in front of me. This is was not at all how I expected to fight Charles. I got no choice now. Charles came crashing to me. He used two of his tails to attack first, clearly wary of my arms. I throw a Kuret line from my back preparing to back away. But the Kuret immediately breaks apart before I can move. Shit. It has to be a side effect of my uncontrolled Kuret.

The two Kuritines were aimed at my legs to impale me. I jumped up in response. Without my Kuret to raise me, I only got to hop only little in air. Charles already had the other tail ready. He aimed one at my chest. I didn't have way to evade it, so I use my right arm to shield from the incoming tail. My arm was still exploding Kuret sparks all over. I was worried for a moment the Kuret on my arm wasn't stronger. Much to my utter surprise, the Kuritine was disintegrating before it even hit me.

I wasn't throwing a Kuret wave nor was the sparks touching, but the Kuritine was destroyed before it reached me. By the time the tail touched me, the Kuritine was destroyed and Kuret from the rest of the tail was being stripped off. I felt only a little of the force of the tail. I fall back to the ground near the tails he was slowly retracting back and stagger a little to find my balance. What the hell just happened. I didn't have time think. Charles himself was now coming at me with his claws.

I defended myself again with both my arms in front. The claw comes slashing through the air and struck my exploding Kuret arm. Unlike the Kuritine earlier, the claws don't disintegrate, but they still began cracking before clashing. I was worried about the force it was coming with, but the Kuret in my arms were actually pushing me forward a little and creating a countering force to keep me grounded. I still felt a lot of pressure, however soon it began to fade. The more time I was in contact, the claws was breaking faster. The brown glimmer rushing in to heal Charles was not enough to keep up with my Kuret damage.

Charles pulled back his arm in hurry before I could damage him further. He then brings his other claws and attacks me from sideways. I was able to see it coming and pulled my left arm vertically sideways to block it. The claws miss my head few inches. The claws began breaking the same way again. After 3 continuous times, I was sure this wasn't pure luck. My Kuret is doing something I never seen before. I need to get away for a and take moment to figure this out. Charles kept his barrage of slashes going few times more.

Each time I was able to defend myself. The first reason was the enormous force of those claws was cut down considerably when I break them and second was my arms was pushing me. Its like the time I was able to make myself push with I had the Kuret sparks covering me. So this must be close to it. Maybe an uncontrollable version of that. I didn't have enough time to think more when I kept defending myself. Charles slashes were overwhelming, I was on alert every second to see the glimmers of his Kuret and predict his next attack. After a while, Charles changes his attacks. He pulls both his arms back sideway and prepares a dual claw attack coming from the side.

This won't be good. I shift my legs to brace for the for a more powerful force. Both the claws strike at the same time coming from opposite direction. As expected he had more power on this. I got pushed back after getting hit. The glimmers of the tail was coming from my the side. He was trying to catch me by my waist. No, not happening. I didn't know if had the bare minimum power, but I didn't have a choice. I take my right arm and will it to push my ahead towards Charles.

The tug I felt from the arm made me panic a little. I was pushed forward with a sudden impulse that was nothing I felt earlier. My body pivots forward and my fist lands on Charles lower right chest. My Kuret began moving even more faster. That made more eruptions of Kuret spark. Charles roars as my Kuret ran wild on my fist. The Kuritines on him broke easily, then I was stripping off his Kuret underneath. Charles stumbles a little back after my hit. He was shaken, but still didn't back down.

I was able to make a gap between him and me. The tail was around my waist almost tightening up. The flames around my body must have at least slowed it down. I used my free left arm to push me sideways. I felt the same powerful tug as I was dragged away from Charles. My head leans to the other side from the sudden acceleration. My left arm was pushing with such force my legs starts to dangle a little in the air. The tail that wrapped me by the waist tighten up. But my Kuret flames and the force with which I was pulled away caused the tail snap behind me. The tail piece wrapped around me was instantly disappeared in thin air. The push of my arm went longer too, I forced it to stop when I got some distance away from Charles.

I land on the grass and struggle a little to get a grip on my footing. Holy shit. I saw brown glimmers pouring in on the chest wound I just did. I also the streaks of blue glimmers around his chest. He definitely felt that. This is insane. I open my eyes and gaze over my arms. Even after using so much Kuret, they were still running wild. The Kuret flames around me was still covering me. Whoa. I unlocked something astounding. I took note of few things immediately when I saw my Kuret up close.

I was unconsciously blowing Kuret waves with the Kuret moving on my arms. That’s why it broke the Kuritines on Charles tails before it even touched me. Same with the claws. But the claws were stronger, so they only cracked. Secondly, I also had formed a dome under the rotating and erupting Kuret sparks. I was more confused than excited right now. When did I do that. I explicitly made sure not to create one. And the third, the Kuret covering on the arms were exactly same as the ones I formed on my fingers from a while ago. In fact, with more Kuret formed, it was considerably stronger than before. This is unbelievable.

I realized something about the Kuret sparks. The one I used earlier was not the true form I needed. Like everything, they were just one part of the whole solution. That’s why I couldn't pull out more Kuret covering with those sparks. I was essentially using left overs of this unattained Kuret form back then. I was right to believe that I needed to build up Kuret from the start. I have basically clubbed all my Kuret techniques into one single form. But this made it that much hard to control it.

Charles healed up and came at him. Charles didn't attack with his tails this time. He was coming himself. His tails were swaying in the air behind him. One of the tails has shortened considerably. I recalled that the tail he tried to grab me with earlier cut off so easily, like it was nothing. That means I no longer have to bother with those tails anymore. I felt a rush of adrenaline swelling up in me. While this is not at all how I pictured my Kuret would behave, but the power up I got went beyond my expectations.

Charles is charging with a head-butt. He had grown a thicker Kuritine on the top of his head. He is getting impatient. I was prepared for this. I wanted to test out this new combined Kurets strength. I raise my left arm towards Charles will it push forward. This time, I braced myself for the sudden speed I got pushed. I may not be able to throw Kuret lines anymore, but looks like I don't need it anymore. This is much powerful and quicker to move around now. I prepared my right fist to make a blow.

Just as we were about to struck, I stop my left arms push and instead focus on pushing my arm as I twist and land a punch aimed at his head. I aimed the punch to land sideways to avoid a straight on collision. With the movement of my arm and the Kurets force I made, it made me twist around in the air as I follow the path of my hand. Out Kurets impact causes a bang that vibrated around us through the air. I felt the shockwave it created on my skin and the glimmers around the air gets filled with broken Kuretines coming off Charles body.

No matter how I attacked, Charles was clearly stronger. I was immediately thrown sideways from the impact. Even with my right arm still pushing ahead, the strength I faced was much greater. I struggle as I tried to keep my feet on the ground as I get slid backwards. I kept my right arm Kuret going pushing me forward to stop me from blown away. I felt the shock of that impact on my entire body. If wasn't having this Kuret infused arm, it would have been shattered.

Charles wasn't fairing good either. I didn't strike him down, but he was stumbling sideways trying to regain balance with his limbs. I opened one eye to check out my surrounding. Charles head had seen better days. I had completely destroyed the Kuritines on his head and cracked few on his neck. His Kuret body had also cracked a little near his jaw and around his side. There was a large chunk of Kuret missing as well. I see large amounts of blue glimmers flowing around his head. I even saw a small amount of red glimmer coming off. I felt a little happy now. Nice start. I got him to bleed again. I need to keep this up. Once I stop to a halt, I take a moment to gather myself.

I saw Charles tails coming at me. I decided I can ignore them completely now as I ran straight into them. The Kuritines pointed at me began to crack as I approach with my arms guarding me. By the time I was crossing them, the tails had lost the Kurets and holes were appearing on them. Charles made them pull back in a hurry. I smiled as I saw orange glimmers around him. It was such a great burden off my shoulder not to deal with these tails again. Of course, if he makes them more thicker with Kuret, I still would have to deal with them. But I doubt Charles would risk wasting more Kuret like that.

I reach Charles just as he completed healing his head. He made the first move with digging both his claws into the ground and hurling two big boulders at me. I bring my right arm and make my Kuret push me away. I dodge the first rock. The second followed next, I raised my other arm's Kuret and dodge in the other direction. I brought a jab to Charles throat, Charles lower his mouth to guard it and chomped down on my arm instead. That was

unexpected. The Kuritine teeth tried to bite into my skin. But the Kuret dome on my skin held strong.

I felt the pressure of having my hand stuck in between stones. It stung a lot. But at least I didn't have any holes in my hand. Charles wasn't letting my hand go. Even with so much my Kuret blasting on his face, he kept my arm pinned. Charles brought his claws trying to strike me. I use my one free wrist and made the Kuret to push it against the incoming attack with force. His claws clashes with my arm blocking my body. I somehow held my ground. We were in a deadlock. But he still had a free arm. I tried to break away from his mouth before he uses it.

Charles wasn't making it easy. I was panicking now. He raised his other arm in the air and preparing to slash me from my defenseless side. He moved his other claws to cut me up. Shit. I yelled out loud and willed to push the Kuret on my right arm, not forward, but backward. This was now stronger than Charles bite and I freed my hand. I immediately brought to defend myself from the incoming claws. The claws struck me and I was thrown sideways. I didn't had the time to put force on my Kuret and got pushed back.

I felt pricking pains on my arm. I grit my teeth in pain. Charles pulled away his other arm and was thrown away to his side. I fall down straight into the ground on my shoulders. My arms swayed away from me and get rolled above my head. The impact made my body shiver with a sharp pain. I saw Charles glimmer around me not giving me any second to get away. He raised his leg up in the air and begins to stomp on me. I made a ditch effort and willed the Kuret on my arm to push me the hell out of here. A sudden force pushed me backwards in hurry. I barely managed to get way just has his leg hits the ground. That impact shacked the area and I slid away on the grass.

I made it in the nick of time. I turn my eyes up and check up on Charles. His arms has thinned. His mouth, what remained, was crumbling away. His Kuritines breaking apart and falling in pieces. He is going to heal his arms and mouth first. At least that’s what I thought, but then Charles turns to me and takes off to the skies. While I was sliding on the grass, collecting debris on me, Charles was leaping into the air at my direction. Charles shadow quickly approaches me from above. Damn it. I was racking my brain for a new plan. I saw something at the corner of my eye. I was near a grassy area where the grasses had sunken a little. I was at the edge of the hidden hole Charles had dug up earlier.

An idea come to me. As I was sliding on the grass, I made my hands into fist and hammered a quick blow, infused with Kuret, to the ground. The ground starts to crack quickly and the ground tore up. I was pulled inside it. I stopped the Kuret on my arms to push and started rolling inside the ground. Above my Charles came down expecting to crush me. But due to the hole he himself had dug earlier, he misses me as the target and instead stomps on the rocks falling of the side. The dirt and rocks gets obliterated under his feet. I was avoided the same fate by some quick thinking. A huge sound filled the air along with a small cloud of dust around us.

Because of Charles forced entry to the hole, the ground shook, rumbling and spreading the hole bigger. I began crawling and pushing the debris off me before Charles gets me. The dirt stick on my face and I blew dust off my mouth. I tasted some dirt on my mouth also. I need to hurry up. Charles had sunken into the ground a little due to the fall. He was slashing off the rocks restricting him. Now's the chance. I raise both my arms in the air and pray I can do it.

I focus on pulling me out of his hole with the Kuret. I felt relief when the Kuret listened to me and raised me above the ground. I flew straight up in the air with my arms leading me. Charles saw me leaving and tried to grab hold of me with his arms. I mustered every strength I had and raised my legs above me to my knees. His claws just grazes me slightly. I was now hover up in the air. I came to a halt and then I pulled my arms down to the front. I blew another Kuret push and went backwards.

I need to put some real distance now. I was literally flying in the air horizontally in the air for a moment. A ridiculous thought came into my mind. Maybe I can now fly. I shoved that silly thought aside for now. I will the Kuret to stop and fall back to the ground. I didn't have the time to brace the fall properly so I fall on my back. I took deep breathes after a complete stop. The situation is becoming more precarious by the minute. I saw Charles shoving the rocks aside and pulling himself out of the hole.

His Kuret had began healing his Kuret body wounds. I wanted to take more time to rest up, but now's not the time. I slowly got up inspecting for any wounds. I was some new glimmers of red coming off me. I received a new cut from my ribs on the side. It wasn't big, but I could feel it probably cracked my rib bone a little. It was slowing hurting now, however the pain isn't too much. I can't let myself get hurst like that again. A new small bruise was now on my thighs and calves. I also got nicked from the rocks when I was falling down on my back.

I stumble a little getting up. I can't get more hurt. Any more than this and I will severely reduce my mobility. The Kuret was still good on my arms, though the Kuret sparks were still going off around me. I got some understanding of this power now. I noted something peculiar. While I had bruises over my body, my arms were protected. I still felt a bit of pain from the pressure, but it was just on my skin. Even after that barrage of slashes and Charles bite, I wasn't hurt badly on my arms. Compared to my other limbs, it was almost nothing.

That means I need to cover myself entirely with this Kuret form. That’s the only way to get stronger, faster and studier. If it worked, I would be able to handle more of Charles blows. I began focusing on a daunting task.

# David (Chapter 19)

Saturday, January 27, 2024 22:02

Charles took a little to get out of the hole. The problem was his landing, plus the weight had caused him to get buried a little in the weakened soil. His movements is also causing rocks and debris to fall on him from the sides. It's a little funny that he got trapped in his own trap. I thought of pulling out my trump card now. Then I decided against it. This was not going to stop him not even for a minute. I need at least two full minute to prepare for that. Anything less than that, it wouldn't work.

So I decided to stick with the current plan. Which was an hurdle of its own. Once I took a beat for a moment, I got up and got into the work. Moving the Kuret on my whole body was not working. The Kuret flames didn't listen to me. I was hopping to let my instincts guide me, but it wasn't happening. I needed to think it through. I have few seconds before Charles comes back up. In a search of a solution, I come up with an idea. Just like I just focused on my arms, I should focus on turning my Kuret on specific areas. Once that happens, I take some time to get adapted with the addition. And then move on the next. This is the slowest, but the most efficient way to build up my strength.

It was no brainer to pick the Kuret on my legs first. Not only will it help with my mobility, but I another way to attack that works on Charles Kuret body. I focused the Kuret on my legs till around the lower thigh to move. My intuition was right. I was able to move the Kuret on my legs. However, it was way to slow and hard to vibrate. So I choose to only do first my right leg. With less mental arduous task, I was able to move the Kuret and vibrate faster. A moment later the Kuret wild went. Just like earlier, almost instantly my Kuret fused together and began causing the sparks. Charles crawled out of the hole and started running at me.

I took a small breath of relief it was working. I now have 3 limbs with strong Kuret covering. But the struggle to take this form made me realize this isn't going to be a simple way of addition. With body part covered with the new Kuret form, the more time and energy it will take for me to work on the next. So covering my left leg is going to take more time. While the situation is still not optimal, it was gradually becoming better. I can work with what I have. Charles catch me off guard this time with his disregard of Kuret body. He also didn't wait for his healing to finish before attacking. He is switching up his fighting style. Meaning I have to throw away whatever I have learned about him up till now and be ready of anything unexpected.

I stayed my ground waiting for him. He was running on his legs this time. He was a bit slow due to this, because he was carrying two big boulders on each hand. They were much bigger than his usual ones. I waited for him to throw at me, but he kept running. If he was trying to restrict my movement, it would be best to throw it from a distance. He wasn't doing that. I was right on the money about him changing his usual tactics. I scanned for anything suspicious around him. But nothing looked concerning. His tails was still the same as last time I saw. The Kuritines on his body also had the same amount of glimmer. The next second he would be on me. I pulled my arms ahead in front of me, bracing for whatever is going to happen. In the off chance that Charles had a simple plan to just crush me with the boulders, I would just pull away behind.

Just half a second before he brought those boulders in front of me, I caught small gimmers of brown of glimmers coming off the rock. But inside the rock. It was so thin that I was able to notice only after coming near. I immediately ascertained what he was trying to do. I decided not to dodge this, instead I brought my arms to defend against one the boulders he thrusted forward. The force was overwhelming, I was able to counteract with a the force my Kuret.

The clash caused debris to fall of the boulder. I kept pushing the boulder back. If I was correct, I need to destroy the Kuret he was growing inside. I kept an eye for the other boulder also while pushing the boulder. With neither of us backing down, we kept this contest of endurance. It went for few seconds. The burst of energy I had pushed with my Kuret was quickly sapping away. I can't keep going anymore. The glimmers coming from inside this boulder was nearly done. I took a risk and made my new Kuret on the leg to force a kick into the boulder.

I felt my foot stuck into the piece of earth and small shivers went up till my hip. Thankfully, with the new Kuret protection, none of the fingers are broken. I hope. The kick was severely lacking in power, but I only needed to created a small gap between the boulder and his arm. And it worked, with the contact broken, the rest of Kuret remaining that Charles was flowing inside the rock became undone. I took this time to position my left arm away from us. I wanted to destroy the other Kuret inside the other rock before I back away, but the glimmers on the inside was strong now. I couldn't destroy it just with the Kuret waves anymore. So decided it wasn't worth the risk and my Kuret whisked me away and began creating some distance.

I halt at a distance. Charles lets go off the rock he tried to crush me with and carried the other one. A moment later, Charles out a roar. With his free hand, he stuck the boulder and it starts to crack slowly. Pieces of debris falls of his arm and the structure inside is revealed. When I saw what Charles was trying to cook inside the boulder, I was right to destroy the Kuret inside instead of running away. I only wish I had enough Kuret to destroy both of them.

Charles had grown a Kuritine structure on his arm. From his wrist up, he had created an intricate Kuritine that spread like a dears horns. It grew in random directions and there were numerous endings. It was big and thick, shining off the sunlight from it. Charles arm now had dozens of claws instead of that one set on his hand. I noticed earlier that he was using the holes and small paths in boulder to create this. Like it was a cocoon. He first poured very little amount of Kuritine inside. Then, once Kuritine turned and twisted following the gaps inside the entire rock, he poured in an enormous amount of Kuret. Doing this led him to create this, which has extended his reach. Not to forget that it was more dangerous now.

If that wasn't enough, I saw glimmers of Kuret being put into it continuously. Every passing moment, the Kuritines was becoming condensed. Incredible. For a moment, I was mesmerized by the aesthetics of the Kuretines he created. Then I was a little relieved that I stopped Charles from making this on his other arm. I bet he was thinking I would be running away instead of blocking that. Charles begins to run at me. I assumed that the added Kuretines weight on his harm would slow him down, but he was still running on his usual speed. Maybe even a little faster, no doubt due to the zeal he must be feeling to use that new weapon.

I choose to observe for a while I remain defensive. Charles charges while raising his Kuretine horn arm in air. I dodge away as he struck on the ground beside me. The force of his normal claws was already overwhelming, but now it was a hundred times more destructive. The sheer force caused causes a strong vibration on my feet. Charles basically rip the ground apart into pieces. There was now even disenable wind pressure flowing out from the collision. The wind made my hair sway away in the air.

What the hell. No matter how strong my Kuret was now, I won't be able to stop that. Even as Charles had struck the ground he was pouring Kuret into his horns. Just how much is he going to make it strong. I want to attack him while he Kuretine horn is now on the ground. I twisted my hip and aimed my leg to his chest. He brings he wrist to defend. I force the Kuret on my leg to push it with force. I struck him on the hard Kuritines on his arm. Even with the force I was throwing at him at this position, it wasn't enough. He was able to force me back once I started loose power on my kick.

As I pull my leg away, I brought fist to his head this time. Charles ducks his head sideways to avoid. That surprised me. I bring my other fist from underneath to the chest, but he blocks me again with this large arm. I tried a couple more punches and kicks. Charles had never avoided my attacks before, but he is avoiding some of my blows. After a few more tries, Charles begins to use pull other arm from the ground. I had no intention to fight that Kuretine horns right now. I decided to back for now. I used my arms to pull back. Charles wasn't going to let me go easy though.

He wasn't just pulling his arm out, he was pulling the ground also. Shit. Realizing his attack, I brought my arms to guard my face in anticipation. He hurls a large amount of small thin pieces of rocks at me. The projectiles was small in size, so they flew faster. I felt many hitting my arms as I was pushing myself back. Few hit on my abdomen. A large on just grazed me on my waist, tearing my skin and leaving being a small line of blood. I bit my lip to push the pain.

I managed to avoid more injuries and fall back after gaining some distance. I began to breath more erratically now. Not good. Even if can predict what's coming, there's no point if I am not fast enough to react. I understood Charles thoughts now. I have delt some powerful blows on him now. So he is actively trying to avoid getting hit. He also wants to attack with something I can't break easily, unlike the claws or Kuritines on his body. While it’s great that he is starting to feel pressure from me now, its become more troublesome to deal with him now.

Charles was charging at me with his Kuritine horn raised again. Since he is now opting a little bit of defensive approach, he will not let me destroy that Kuritine horns easily. I hoped when we had the short bout, the Kuret waves I was throwing would at least crack the Kuritines. But it never happened. Charles was continuously pouring with Kuret inside them. Even when my Kuret is not hurting him, he still pushes Kuret inside. He is definitely not stingy with Kuret anymore.

If I wait till I finally learn to cover my entire body with the new Kuret, it would be too late. I need to use my remaining stamina more efficiently. At the moment, there is only thing way to destroy that Kuretine horn. I need to stay engaging in combat near him. With enough time, even his Kuret wouldn't be able to handle it. It will be very tough to continuously be in combat for long time with him. There was no other choice too. I could use the Kuret dome. I would be able to destroy the Kuritine horn. But it would be drain me even faster. In a battle of endurance, that would be disastrous for me.

Charles this time lunges is the air as he reaches me. I avoid it ducking down and slip away to my side. Charles lands on the other side as the horns slashes the air. I felt another small breeze of air on me. Those slashes are no joke. Charles lands on his legs and turns to face me. He brings his other arms claws at me. I brought my wrist to defend. I manage to put enough force to keep me going. He is about to slash me with his horns. I use the Kuret on my leg to pull me away.

I used the kick to thrust me up a little into the air and I avoid the horns as I hover above. I aim for a punch on his face. Charles used his normal claws to block it. With my free arm I try another punch. Charles avoids again by ducking down his head. I was waiting for this. Using the Kuret on my leg that was raising me, I pushed it once more. Using the arm facing downward, I will my Kuret to pull me down. With a clockwise motion of the Kuret on my leg and on my arm, I do a summersault in the air and aim my leg on his head. I have never tried a coordinated attack like this, I kept hoping it was just enough to connect.

With no thing to defend in the path, the tip of my foot struck the side of his head. The two force I was making my Kuret push, created a strong kick. The moment I kicked his jaw, it broke the Kuritines immediately. The clash produced large amount of blue glimmers form his mouth. In repones, Charles was going to slash me from the below with his horns. I rushed in with in mind to take the hit by guarding myself with my arms. But I really wanted to avoid it completely. Those Kuretine were not still cracking.

I was falling with my face down and arms up. With desperation I willed the Kuret to push back the incoming assault as much as possible. The slash came from the side. We both collide and I could feel the incredible power behind it. As I was in the air, I was being pushed to the side. The incredible amount of force was making me shake. I was trying to push my Kuret as mush as possible, but it was futile. Charles was clearly superior in terms of raw power.

I didn't want to get blown away. Not again. With a bust of rush filled with anger, I shout out demanding more Kuret out of my arms. The Kuret on my arms suddenly begin to expand. It was hard to comprehend what I was doing right now. The Kuret on my arms were running faster than ever as it starts to expand. I was pulling out more Kuret from my body now. The arms on my arm were beginning to take shape. It was thinning outward and spreading a little out from my body. I don't know what I am doing on instinct. Whatever it was, there was more Kuret for me use now.

I couldn't push the horn back right away, so instead I use the Kuret Infront of me and angle it slightly to deflect the horns. The Kuritines slip out from the side and stumble falling into the ground face first. I twisted my arms that was still pushing, bend it pointing up the air, and pull me up so I land straight. I crash on the ground with my knees to break my fall and slid across the grass. I was aware behind me Charles didn't wait to heal his face. He uses

his other claws from up and aimed to rip my head off.

The Kuret on my arms had begin to shrunk as I was absorbing it back inside. I had no other choice though. I bring my both my arms up and make a cross with them to defend the incoming attack. I braced for the crushing blow I was receiving. He had me pinned me into the ground now. I was surely breaking the claws on his hand, yet he kept the me pinned down with the rest of his Kuret arm. I knew what he was trying to do. I panicked as he raised his other arm up and preparing to bring down the Kuretine horns on me again. With the angle I was being held in, he was going to swing his arm and slash me from down.

My body was shaking and not just because of the arms he was making me pinned with. I need to do protect myself. This won't be pretty if he gets me. Forget about the Kuret on my leg. I focused on the Kuret on my chest. With a desperate cry for urgency, I willed the Kuret flames around my torso to move and vibrate. With so much happening I don't know if it was working. I saw the glimmers of the Kuretines coming at me. It stuck me square in chest. I had unconsciously held my breadth as it collided.

I thought I was done for sure. But miraculously, I was still alive. I am blocking the Kuretine horns on the path. I hesitantly look down, thinking he had buried his Kuritine on my chest. But where the flames were originally flowing out of me, was now replaced with Kuret dome on my skin. Immediately, another Kuret layer forms outside and they began colliding against each other. Holy shit. I barely managed it. I thought I was done with just covering the new Kuret on my chest, but then I started to feel something odd.

It was like the new Kuret on my chest was trying to pull in the other flames running on me. As if the originating Kuret now was spreading out. I want to investigate this new feeling, but the unfathomed amount of force I was feeling started to become even stronger. Charles was pouring even more glimmer into his Kuritine horns. I wasn't able to block him anymore. He pulls his arm that was pinning me and pushed me back. The Kuritine horns had began to crack a little. Unfortunately it wasn't enough to break it completely. With another rush of strength, Charles pushed me back and was thrown back.

His slash cause me to skid backwards and I get dragged away on the ground. I brace myself as I feel pulling out the grass and unearthing the surface of the ground. I should have felt a lot of pain, but the Kuret running on my back was protecting me. I slowly came to a halt after a while. I nervously started to move. I was sure I had broken few, if not, all my bones. After checking for injuries, shockingly, I made it without any broken bones. My hands tremble a little as began to get up.

It wasn't just my hands, my legs were still shaking. That attack caused a mini earthquake on my body. I had also collected new set of bruises on my leg. But it was dumb luck that I got away with just this, even if some dripped few drops of blood. I couldn't fully shake of the attack, so instead I fall back and sat on my ass for a moment. I needed to bring my breathing under control. I was sweating too much also on my forehead. I wanted to wipe them off, so I intensively bring my fingers head to wipe them.

I jerked back in reflex realizing that exploding Kuret sparks would hurt me. But nothing happened. I don't know why, but I was irrationally fearing that my own Kuret would hurt me. When I checked nothing happened, I continued and wiped the sweat off before it drips into my eyes. I had a lot thoughts to unpack, but I first focused on Charles. I wanted to see his next move, but he didn't come at me directly. There was a blue glimmers coming off his hand. I also glint of red coming of his deformed hand. Because he kept me down for long, his arms was in worst shape I ever seen. His entire hand is gone!

There was a open Kuret wound at the end of his wrist. He was had his elbow in the air and began healing it. Whoa, that’s got to hurt. Even if didn't see the red glimmers of blood, it was clear that I did some serious damage. I doubt I hurt his actual hand since he Kuret arms are too long. But my Kuret must have been powerful enough to give him scratches on his real hand. I hoped that the Kuret horn would have broken, but I only managed to create some superficial cracks on them. The cracks were disappearing slowly.

The jaw that I broke was half healed already. I saw red glimmers from there also. So that kick was worth the risk. I bought a lot of time now. Even Charles can't ignore the hand and attack me. They way he is healing, I maybe bought enough time before the next round. I didn't waste a single moment and inspect my body. The Kuret on my chest was running rampant. But what caught my attention was that the small distance still having Kuret flames on the shoulder. The Kuret on my arms and chest were trying to connect to each other.

That’s the odd feeling I was getting. I focused on my Kuret around my shoulders. I was breathing from my mouth, so I focused on that. My body was trying to do something. I tried to feel what my Kuret was doing. It was like I was reaching for something just within my reach. As soon I try to reach it, it slips away. After few more seconds, I shut both my eyes to focus even further. I am very close. I have nearly understood it. My deep thoughts began forming an image. I visualize the flames to change. Not to put them out, but instead make it stronger by grouping it.

I suddenly a rush of blood flowing into my face. The next moment, I open my eyes. I understand a little bit what I need my Kuret to do. I let my instincts go forward, it was like removing something I was restricting. The Kuret on my whole body rush out. This is it. The Kuret on my chest began spreading all around my body. First my shoulders form a dome, then it crawls up to my neck. The new Kuret was spreading everywhere. To my lower back, then to my remaining leg.

In the next few seconds, even my head was covered with the new Kuret. Holy shit. I am covered from head to toe with the mini erupting sparks. I waved my arms around to get a feel for it. I wanted to get back on my feet. Then I thought to test out and use this new energizing feeling. I forced the Kuret on my back to push me up. The force I was thrown up was nothing I ever felt. I even tried to use as less force I could. And yet I was thrown up in air few feet above.

I straighten out my legs and plant my feet on ground. This is insane. Is this really my own Kuret. This power is a whole new level. I tried to think on why I wasn't able to do this a while back. What was the difference. Then I recalled that I pulled out an excess of Kuret from my arms when I was shielding myself. That desperate attempt must have done something. I think that shook me out of whatever was blocking me. The new Kuret I turned on my chest not only protected me, it spread across my whole body.

There were still many mysteries about this. Like how I am able to do something I couldn't even imagine doing just an hour back. What's up with my Kuret. What unexpected stuff will it be doing next. I pushed all those thoughts down. I was in a middle of the match right now. I have no time to dissect and understand my Kuret. I just have to go along with this for now. Especially now that I had reached to what I had envisioned ever since I learned my new Kuret form. I can now keep continuing this fight for a little longer.

Charles wasn't fully healed. He was about halfway done with the palm. I wasn't going to wait anymore. I am now suddenly bursting with rush of excitement. Now's the time to get the upper hand. I bring my breathing under control and began sprinting. I hadn't fully recovered enough of the shock on my body of the last clash, but I choose to power through. To make a point, I thought to close the distance faster. I willed the Kuret on my entire body to push me ahead.

On hindsight, I should not have done that. My entire body went beyond my control and I got dragged across the ground. I am almost flying to Charles. The speed I was flung forward was a little terrifying. What’s even more surprising was that I am enjoy this.

# David (Chapter 20)

Sunday, January 28, 2024 13:57

I bet Charles was more surprised by this than me. I am closing the distance between us quickly. But I was also loosing the momentum I started with. I wanted to attack with full force. I willed to put a stop on my Kuret push. Even without my Kuret acting on it, I wasn't slowing down fast enough. I decided to put reverse force and pull backwards on my Kuret. I felt another power tug and came an abrupt stop. The sudden deceleration makes me stagger when my feet touch the ground.

I clearly don't have fine control over this new Kuret. I have to make sure not to over do it. While this new power up is a new advantage, if I have lose control, it could become a disadvantage instead. Once I gained my balance I focused on making my Kuret push only my legs. Like the last time I tried on the Kuret on my leg, I was having a hard time coordinating my running. I can't even call this running, I was almost jumping and leaping as I put one feet in front of another.

In a moment I was near striking range of Charles. He is hand was almost healed. His Kuret fingers were growing. I needed to use this opportunity where he doesn't have the claws on his hand yet. His mouth was healed. He even created more number of Kuritines on his jaws now. He covered his entire jaw with an extra layer of Kuretine that now showed sharp edges near the entrance of his mouth. He now has a more ferocious jaw strength. I made the first move this time and bring a Kuret infused punch to his lower abdomen.

Charles prepared to block me with his Kuretine horn, slashing for the side. Both are attacks connect and throw vibrations in the air. The momentum my Kuret created was just enough to match up with his power. It lasted only for a moment, I began to loose the power on my fist. I pull back and prepare for a kick to his chest. Charles extends his arm to the side once I let go of my hand. He uses the Kuritine horns again for a block by brining his arm back inside in opposite direction. Another clash occurs, forcing both of us to another standstill.

I pull back with a short tug on my Kuret on the back side of my body. Charles leans back a little and prepares to land a kick on me. Instead of defending the kick, I open both my hands and catch his leg from the side before his face could stomp on my face. I had made the Kuret on just my hand to push towards each other, immobilizing the leg I caught between. The Kuritines on his skin began crumbling into dust. Charles lets out a growl as I began to tore out chunks of Kuret out of his leg. Charles tried to pull his leg back, but I had already forced another Kuret push from the front and canceled his strength.

With his leg caught, he brings out the horns to slash me from the side. I didn't want to get hit by that just yet. I let of my hands, I decided to at least get a hit on his leg. I turned my right hand into a fist. With a short burst of force, I push the Kuret downwards and struck into his knees from the up. Charles roars when my fist connects. The Kuritine protecting his knees was blown away instantly on contact. I let go of his legs. He begins to stumble a little, now that he lost balance, his Kuritine horn misses me and it slashes in the open air. Charles gets pulled back a little to regain his balance.

I also pull back a little in order to prepare for my next attack. Charles didn't wait to heal the would, which was radiating blue and small red glimmers. I willed my Kuret to push me up in the air angled to his head. When I get airborne, I pull out my left arm and aim to punch his chest. Charles brings his not healed hand to block. He puts a stop my fist with his wrist. I saw him bringing his Kuritine horns from the side to attack me. I use a Kuret forced kick to his arm and push it away before it reaches me.

I twist my body sideways and force Kuret to push me even higher. As I fly above, I raise my knee of the other leg and force it forward. My body tilts sideways due to the poorly coordinated attack, but at least my knees struck his jaws right in the middle. Charles tried to dodge it, but grabbed the back of his head with arm. I interlocked his head inside my arm. I have essentially wrapped myself around his neck. My attack begins to break his protective Kuretine on his jaw. Charles mouth was getting smushed in.

Charles grabs me other leg with his arm and tries to pull me away. I wasn’t going to let him do that. With my open arm, I will the Kuret from the entire arm to push me backwards. This created an angle with which he begins to lean backwards. Despite the power I was exerting, he wasn't falling down. Seeing that I at least his upper body bent backward to a degree, I made the Kuret on my entire body to pull me down. The sudden overwhelming strength was too much. Even for Charles. I successfully made him lose his balance and we began to fall backwards on his back.

Charles growls silently under my knees trying to get free. His grip on my leg also becomes undone. Which loud thumping sound, he falls on the ground. Just before he hit the ground, I made my Kuret on my body to pull me up. Charles groans since for the first time, I made him fall down on his ass. Blue glimmers came running from his face. Orange ones from his entire body. A little streak of new red glimmer was now flowing from his jaws and neck. I floated in the air above him for a second. The weight of his body causes the dust and dirt to get blown away.

I reversed the direction and forced my Kuret to push down. I get pulled to earth with the full weight of my body. I gather my hand into a fist and push out my elbow in front of me. Charles didn't have time to block this. I struck my elbow straight near his jugular. The Kuretines couldn't put up a decent defense and I chocked him on the base of his neck. The contact is sending shivers down on my whole body. Charles body jerks up in response. I grit my teeth hard, keeping up the pressure. Charles blue glimmers was flowing out hard now.

Charles gets his bearing a second later and lunches his Kuritine horns on me. I put my other hand and block it with the back of my wrist. The force was little much for me right now. I couldn't keep Charles on this choke hold. The Kuritine horns made me push away from him. I get blown away a little distance and slid across the grass. My breathing was out of control now. I has heaving once I came to a stop. I decided to lie for a little while. I grown as I force my shoulders up and make me rest on my back.

That was intense. While I was feeling excited that I finally made the mighty being fall on his ass, I expended way too much energy. The glimmers on Charles was becoming intense. I saw a substantial amount of red glimmers around his neck now. He was also lying down like me for a moment. His Kuret is already healing his mouth and neck. My attack on his upper body also caused Kuritines on rest of the body to crumble away. I saw few broken portions of his Kuritine horns.

Nice. By keeping up the close combat, I was beginning to damage those Kuretines now. I bet the Kuret waves around me is even more powerful. But this had caused my whole body feeling like it has been pummeled. I slowly got up before I let the exhaustion take all over me. I plant my foot on the ground and crouch a little forward. I rest on hands on my knees to support my posture. My chest rose up and down hard. My heart beats was filling up the glimmer around my body. My body was aching a bit now. Since I still lacked complete control over my Kuret, I was taxing my body lot.

I gaze upon Charles. His Kuret was healing his body. He doesn't stand right away. Instead, while supporting on one knee, he raises his arm with the Kuritine horns up in the air. He is up to something again. Charles the uses his other arm to struck his other wrist that was fused with the horns. The Kuritine horns break apart on the contact. The Kuretines fall on the ground like a flower shedding his leaf. Charles freed hand begins healing.

I started at him while he starts to break the Kuretines under his fist. I could only be shocked at this. He continuous to break down the Kuritines. I noticed he wasn't completely destroying it, instead he was only breaking at the joints where they diverged. I began to realize what he was trying to do. I thought to attack him now before he finishes this plan of his. But I was still exhausted. I needed time to recover every bit of stamina I could for what's coming next.

After breaking the large Kuritines into smaller pieces. He then grabs one of them. Using the Kuretine like a knife, he jabs himself on the other arm. This wasn't what I expected exactly him doing. Charles glimmer showed he felt little bit of pain. Once he removes his hand from the Kuritine, it begins to heal with Kuret. The Kuretine stuck out his skin like a large thorn. He then takes another piece and sticks it on his leg this time. So that’s his plan. He knows now that those regular Kuritines on his body stand no chance against me anymore. So with the Kuret he made on his hand, he is going to plant it everywhere on his body.

Charles begins to continue this in various places on his body. He plans to hit me with that strong Kuritine now. It would have been manageable for me to destroy it if they were just Kuretines. But once he plants it on his body, Charles pours Kuret inside them. That means the toughness will remain unchanged. He was placing the Kuretine on various places over his body. On his arms, hands, legs and chest. He then brings his tails forward. Till now I had ignored the tails completely, but he sticks the Kuritine on the ends. He then pour large amounts of Kuret on the tails making this thicker.

Dammit. I knew that if made those tails stronger, I could no longer ignore them anymore. Especially now with a deadly Kuritines at the end. I really wanted to stop him from distributing the Kuretine on his body, but I needed to recover a little. While this had become a little more dangerous, it wasn't something new. Charles is becoming more and more wary of me. He too like me is adapting to the situation and preparing in consideration. After about half a minute, Charles got up. He was now sporting with shinny new Kuritines on his Kuret body. He had a set placed on the knees, feet, elbows and shoulders. On his hand, instead of growing claws, he kept his hands a fist and stuck larger sized Kuretines on his wrist. They were protruding from his hand like a knife on top of his knuckles.

He also placed a bunch of them on his chest, definitely to protect his real body inside there. Behind him, the four tails were wagging in the air, showcasing a new Kuritine spears. Charles preparation was complete. This will be now even tougher. With those Kuritines, I can't just attack on him recklessly. Not unless I want to get skewered first. Thankfully, I was able to clam down with the time he spent preparing. But I was no where in peak condition. I was dangerously running low on endurance.

My plan hasn't changed since the beginning. I need to deal a blow powerful enough that it would take him least a minute to heal. Maybe two. I can then use my ace. Once I do that, I won't have to put too much strain on my body. So I will use all my remaining energy I have let and aim to deliver crushing blows. Now that I have achieved this Kuret form. I just maybe able to do it. Charles roars and then sprints towards me. I take a final deep breath and calm my nerves.

Charles reaches near me. He starts by jabbing with the Kuritine on his arm. I choose to dodge the incoming attack by stepping to the side. With those Kuritines covering his body, I need to wait for the correct opportunity to hit back. Charles uses his tails from under his legs to attack me. I force my Kuret to push me back before it reaches. Next, he tries to kick me. I block the kick with both hands while making my Kuret push me up in the air. Charles prepares for another jab to my head. I dodge to my right in the air. His tails try to attack me from the side, before they struck me, I thrust myself to the ground in haste.

I crouch down on the ground as his tails flew above me. He tries for a round kick aimed at my chest. While supporting my arm on the ground, I propel up in the air again. The kick hits the ground uprooting the grass and dirt. I decided to first analyze his attack patterns. We spend few more blows like this. While I wasn't making any headways with continuously dodging, I was able to slowly understand his new way of attacking. Whenever he attacks, he is only using the parts of this body that have that Kuritine. Which made sense, he went to long lengths to get it.

His attacks have become aggressive too. Since he has now disregarding his priority for healing, he isn't shying away from risky attacks that exposes his unprotected body. I should be able to exploit this. Charles goes for a elbow attack on my shoulder, I shove aside to avoid it. His tails tried to grab my legs. I jump into the air to avoid them. Charles goes to jab me from both his fist. I pull my arms in front of me and thrust backwards as his Kuritine connects. I narrowly saved getting shoved by him.

We kept going like this for long time now. Charles was slowly getting impatient. Yes, that’s good. I want him to make a mistake. I been tempering this long, wasting a lot energy just dodging because I need make every attack count from now on. Every time Charles think he is close to nabbing , skewering or stomping me, I evade them. Even when attacking would have been much more ideal. All this to land a single but powerful attack. After I dodge a kick from him, he tried to plunder me with both his fist Kuritines.

I saw an opportunity with this. Instead of backing away, I come closer to him. I stop myself just few inches in front of me. His arms flew past me and he thrusts those Kuretines into the ground. I stand now underneath his body, him facing me down. I raise my right fist and aim for his unprotected lower chest. I took a half a second to recall the feeling I had when I was cutting Charles tails and then recently when I formed the shield to protect with my new Kuret.

I twist my hip to provide my upper body with power and thrust my arm straight into his abdomen. The moment I came my fist connected to his Kuret body, I yelled out a little to push out Kuret from my fist. My Kuret comes out from my punch and digs into his Kuret body. The punch causes ripples of brown Kuret glimmers waves originating from under my fist. I grit my teeth hard to keep going. Charles lets out a loud roar above me. I didn't let it waver me. With another short yell, I will the Kuret on my arm to thrust once more.

More Kuret flows out of my fist into his body. A burst of blue glimmers comes out of Charles body. Charles roar was deafening. As he got desperate, he tried to push me away with his tails. But I wasn't done yet. I force my entire body to thrust forward now. The impulsive power of my Kuret caused Charles to stagger. It was so great that I felt shivers back on my entire body. And it was just enough to shove Charles backwards. His tails tried swirling on my foot, but the thrust caused him to lose balance his tails get swayed away.

I was loosing power slowly. One last time. I grunted aloud when I thrusted my Kuret ahead. The Kuret blown into his body suddenly tore out from the other side of his back. The glimmers of red flow in front of my eyes, covering my vision. I decided to back away for now. Charles was yelling loudly. I pushed myself back in haste. Even with such a painful blow, Charles had the gall to try jabbing me. I was a bit slow in reacting and he managed to struck me in my face.

I was panicking like hell. I bring my other fist from below and thrust into his arms before he could penetrate my Kuret. My fist blow away his arm upwards, but the damage was done. I could feel that the Kuretine had managed to pierce me. My face instantly throbs in fire. Shit. I went backwards to make distance. Once I came to halt, I crouch down on one arm. I head bowed down in pain. That was too close. My face was on fire. I saw glimmers of a new red line coming from the side of my temple to the cheek.

Holy shit. One more inch to the left, and he would have cut my ears off. The Kuret dome on my face remained intact. That Kuritine was so tough that even with such a protection, he managed to cut my skin. The only good thing is that the cut I got was not too deep. The blood drips from my head to the side of my neck. It could have been much worse. Speaking of worse, I think Charles was facing a much difficult time. He was down on both his knees and had one arm hugging the wound I had given. The fist he attacked me in the last second had a broken Kuretine on it. Ah, I didn't notice I was able to break it while I was running back.

What was even terrifying was seeing drops of blood coming out of the hole I made. The glimmers of red coming out from there confirmed that it was actually blood. Charles expression under the Kuritine was definitely a pained one. I think this was the first serious wound he suffered. His Kuret healing was not fast enough to cover the gaping hole I created. He must be healing his real body first. I was glad that my Kuret flowed out from my fist was powerful. I didn't expect I would be able to fully skewer it from inside, but then again the Kuret in the form is much more stronger than the ones I was using earlier.

I made the right decision to dodge all of Charles attacks for the right moment to attack. I had bought a little time with Charles healing. I could try to stall for time and let him heal. But no. I need to do it once again. Just once. Then I will use my final attack. My whole body was now aching more now. I think I would only last for few more minutes now. The only way I can win is now if I wound his legs seriously.

Ignoring the soreness of my body and began sprinting at him. I need to pull out even more power. I recalled the moment when I hit him. The Kuret on my hand had temporarily increased in speed. It even caused more Kuret sparks. I could feel that there was a moment when my Kuret vibrated so fast that it looked like it was completely still. It was terrifyingly calm and condensed. Compared to then, the Kuret on my body were still running wild in random directions. I got an idea about controlling these rampant directions.

I have managed to pull out this strong Kuret, but I think its still not complete yet. The Kuret sparks I am causing is a clear reason, since its was unnecessary and superfluous. So if the first step was combining all the Kuret techniques I have learnt, the second step must be to control it even further.  I realize that I have to try this out while I fight Charles. All the major steps I have made were in the heat of the battle. I will just have to trust my instincts for now.

I jumped into air when I came close to Charles and made myself propel in air continuously until I was hovering above his height. He hasn't healed completely, so couldn't move out of the drop kick I aimed at his chest. Charles uses his free arm and blocks my leg. I keep pushing forward. This is the final stretch. Victory is now within my grasp.

# David (Chapter 21)

Sunday, January 28, 2024 22:16

Charles choose to ignore healing and decided to give his attention to me instead. That’s exactly what I thought he would do. Two tails comes from below to impale me. I let go of my leg and push to the side dodging them. The tails flew up past me. I used this movement to land a punch on his head. He brings his other fist to block me. He still had the Kuritine on this fist. I concentrated to pull out more Kuret from my arm. Still reeling from the zone, I was able to pour out more Kuret of my arm. I will it to shape it into a sheet instead of wrapping my arm. I had done this instinctively last time, but I was able to consciously do it this time.

This feeling is eerily familiar to how I use my Kuret dome. A thin Kuret shield in the shape of my arm form around it. Just in the nick of time, I saved my arm from getting pierced. The clash causes shockwaves of wind and sound in the air. My Kuret was able to block the Kuritine on his hand. Since I worked on creating the shield, I didn't have time to propel with Kuret. I was pushed thrown back into the air from the pressure. The shield on my arm had gone. I felt shivers on my arm. On the good side, the Kuritine on his hand cracked and broke in half.

I didn't waste this opportunity and decided to attack immediately. While still in air, I propel forward. I raise my fist and aim his face. Charles bring both his arms to defend. He fell for it. Gravity was pulling me down and I pushed myself further down. My fist instead connected to the ribs where the Kuritine was not placed. I focused on pouring my Kuret out at the impact. Charles growls and staggers behind. I had hoped my attack went deep, but all I saw was blue glimmers.

It was too shallow. Dammit. Well it did took three continuous thrusts last time. Charles regains his balance and brings both of his fists down on my back. I twist my body and push myself away. I wasn't fast enough. One of the fist caught me in my lower back. I was pushed down to the ground. Just before the impact, I slowed my fall with a burst of Kuret push. I land on the ground face first. Charles thrusts his foot towards me. In a desperate attempt, I push my entire body above and I was yet again propelled into air. His kick misses me by few inches.

While I hover in air, one of his tail attack my from the side. I wasn't fast enough, I used my arms to protect myself. The Kuretine on the tails is not stronger like the others, so I wasn't pierced through. I made Kuret on my body push me backwards. I get thrown backwards. I tilt my body a little and fall back on my legs. Whoa, I was airborne for quite sometime. Fatigue is catching up to me now. My movements was sluggish and I am now reacting less quickly now. I tried to control my breathing. I know I have become impatient attacking him. But I have no choice, I need to stop him while I still have gas in the tank.

Charles wasn't itching to attack me right away. After that brief struggle, he resumed healing his wound. I have to risk letting him heal now. I had something new in my mind to try. When I formed the shield earlier, my Kuret became still again. I think that’s the trick to get to stabilize my Kuret. I focused on pushing out Kuret from my entire body. There was too much resistance by my body. But I didn't let it stop me. I focused on putting more effort into throwing Kuret out of my body.

A few seconds later, it happened. The Kuret flows outwards in all direction. Meanwhile, the Kuret on my body move and began vibrating faster. I felt a rush of adrenaline kicking in as I keep pouring out more Kuret. My control was loosing, but the desperation kept me going. I pictured what I wanted my Kuret to do. I wanted to cover my body in Kuret that I had used earlier on my fingers. That has to be the actual form my Kuret must be trying to become. But this time it will be without the Kuret sparks. Kuret would just cover my body while keeping this new form intact.

It was too hard trying to make my Kuret do this. I am missing something. I racked my mind trying to find the answer. Maybe I can't do it yet. Then it means I should focus on somewhere midway completion. I don't have to cover my entire body. I can just cover only essential places in need to protect and move it around like I did earlier. With this idea, I focused on covering certain areas. I felt my Kuret obeying me this time. Kuret around me in the air began swirling and rotating. The Kuret outside spins around me, creating a small gust of wind.

I was anxious about this a bit, but continued on. The Kuret picks up pace and it was blowing the dust off the ground. I kept rotating the Kuret around me. Slowly, the Kuret begins to shrink and it begins to fall back on me. It was vibrating fast, then it began to stabilize. Steadily, the Kuret starts to cover my body. This time it was covered in rings. Kuret formed round groups of rings that wrapped around my arms, legs and stomach. Kuret rings appeared over my forehead like a head band. Another two of them wrapped around my face in a cross shape, covering my eyes, ran through my nose, checks and then my neck.

This was not I expected it would appear, but the energy I felt from the Kuret was calm but powerful. I could feel that the Kuret was still vibrating, its just that it was so minute and fast, it couldn't be seen anymore with naked eye. So that’s why it looked like it was still. Another thing I noticed, the Kuret was still moving in circles on my skin. But it was just running the surface of my skin, there was an outer layer of Kuret that was completely stable. The Kuret was just as denser than the form I had just now, I could just tell this was much more stronger now because it was more stable.

More rings covered my body. A few seconds later, the all Kuret around me turned to mini armor. There a slow humming noise coming from my Kuret. The Kuret sparks were no longer happening. The Kuret that grouped together were not crashing into one another anymore. There were few places where my skin was exposed now. Around my upper back, ankles, shoulders and other places that usually don't come in contact during a fight. I managed to protect my joints at the very least. Even with exposed parts of my body, I could feel I am generating a more power now.

Charles was almost done healing. I used up all the time I bought earlier. But it was worth it. I decided to test this out first. I wanted to try something and also confirm if I can fight in this form that showed new openings to my skin. There was a boulder lying near by me. I walked there, letting my body get adjusted to his yet another Kuret form. I turn my hand into a fist. Immediately, the Kuret rings on my hand come together and join together to form a fully covered first. It was definitely like the time I learned about vibrating my Kuret.

I raised my arm back a little. I was a little nervous and anxious to see what would happens next. The Kuret on my hand bursts out and shaped into a dagger. I was imagining it in my mind, but I had no idea that it would actually work. The Kuret formed into a small dagger around my fist. It was just like when I use my Kuret dome. I then willed the Kuret from my arm to thrust forward. My Kuret listened and I threw a jab aimed at the boulder. The force I felt created a backlash of wind flowing backwards.
☐The moment my fist connected, my fist went through inside the surface blasting the surface apart. The debris gets thrown off and I gouged out a large position of the top of the boulder. Holy s
and they turn back into rings on my hand. Incredible power. I am now getting burst of excitement. I looked at my hand, there wasn't a scratch. I didn't feel much pain when I punched. This is insane. My Kuret now can effect physical matter now without taking too much of my energy. Not just that, I can use powerful attacks without feeling the rebound of the shock.

I turn to face Charles again. He was done healing completely. But I can see the faint red glimmers still coming from the wound. I even when I am not attacking right now, there is orange glimmers around him. He may have healed his Kuret body, but that blow did serious damage to him. With both his Kuretines broken on the wrists, he falls on all fours and charges at me. I was ready for him. I wish I could have fought him in this form from the beginning. I would have the enough energy to spare to defeat him. Sadly, I can't do that. I can feel that transforming this Kuret pushed me to my absolute limit.

In fact, I was sure I can keep this up for only two minutes max. If I don't stop him in this time, I will lose. I am sure M would now be showing my vitals to Marina by now. After so much struggle, I wasn't going to stop. So now I am just leaving that decision to others to stop me if the time comes. Charles was opening his attack this time with his tails. All the four tails were positioned forward to strike fast. I decided its time to cut those tails off completely. With a plan of attack, I sprinted towards him.

I waited until he was very close to me, then I willed my Kuret to thrust forward. I heard a whooshing sound when I blasted off the ground. My face felt the air on my face, draining the blood from my face. What the shit. I flew so fast that I hardly had time to notice I crossed the tails. The tails tried to attack me, but I left them in dust as I flew past them. This is way stronger the power I just had. Charles brought one of his arm up and tries to throw his claws at me. I wasn't even using my legs, so I had no way to use them to dodge. So instead, I used my Kuret to push down and slide across the grass. Charles claws reach me as I was sliding underneath him. With my wrist, I created a small shield of Kuret. The claws struck and broke immediately. I didn't even feel much of his power in that attack. Did he get weaker. No, the answers obvious. This form is crazy strong.

I safely slide between his legs and exit from his shadow. I urge my Kuret to reverse direction and push me up. My Kuret immediately stops my movement. The abrupt halt caused a little pain on my legs. Shit. I have no experience of a power like this. I need to be more careful. I stagger on my feet and turn back to face Charles. I took off the ground and made my Kuret to thrust me into the air. A powerful tug plucked me into the sky. At this point, I am basically at mercy of my Kuret. Its like I am controlling my own body movements with Kuret.

I was thrown in air so high that it felt I was actually flying. Charles wasn't going to stop this from attacking. He dug his claws into the ground and dug out boulders. He throws one at me as I hover in air. I could I have easily dodged it, but then I had a different idea. As the large rock flies at me, I raise my arms in front of me. I pull out Kuret from my arms and make them strengthen my hands. Layers of Kuret wrap on top of each other. I am wearing think gloves made of Kuret. I brace to catch the boulder in my arms.

The boulder hit me straight and the force of the impact knocks me back. But then I push forward to stop, then rotate myself along with the boulder to counteract the remaining force. Using the force of the swing I made from my Kuret, I throw the rock back to the direction it came. I can't believe it worked. I didn’t do it properly, the rock didn't have enough speed. Charles was able break the rock into pieces with his fist. Well, this was my first try. My fall was beginning. Charles was preparing to another boulder at me. With one open eye, I look for a safe place to land. A spot with grass caught my attention. Yes, this will work. I had initially jumped this high to locate this with a birds-eye view to begin with. The boulder catching stuff was just to throw Charles off a little.

I decided to change the direction of my fall and aim at a distance further away from Charles. From the glimmer coming behind me, I didn't even had to look to evade the boulder thrown at me. With a reverse thrust of power, I break my fall and land on my feet. Charles was running straight at me unfazed. Did he not know about it. Or he does know and just didn't care about it. His tails had wrapped more boulders to be thrown. I turn to face him and began running. I choose to run on my legs for the time being.

When we got close, he throws one boulder with a tail. In response, I wrap my arm with more Kuret and swat the rock away with my wrist. I was waiting to see if Charles would leap into air, but he didn't. He hadn't noticed it then. That’s great. I turn my fist with Kuret into a long spear and struck the ground just few meters away. The ground cracks on impact and begins to sink. Charles was way not fast enough to avoid the crumbling ground, he was slipping inside. I propelled forward into the air, avoiding sinking inside. Charles tried to jump outside, but he was not quick to react and I was already on him. I twist my body and lean forward. Using the Kuret on my leg, I made a sweeping attack in the air and hit both his arms.

Charles couldn't dodge this with his size and especially when he is slipping. Charles arms gets pushed inside with my attacked. The Kuretines on his body didn't even put enough resistance to defend me. Blue glimmers flow out of the impact. With a Kuret push from the rest of my body, I thrust sideways avoiding his falling body. Once clear, I thrust again forward to his back. The tails had been struck to the ground behind him to support him from falling down. Of course, his weight was too much for his tail to handle. He would have to make the tails more stronger like he did during the start of the match.

While I flew to his back, I transformed the Kuret on side of my palm into a thin sharp edge, like a knife. I hoped this Kuret was sharp enough to cut all the tails in go. With one swift motion of my hand, I slash at the base of the tails on his back. I felt the tails giving resistance, but I had enough force to pierce them all. Charles below me roars in pain as the tails starts to disappear. Without them, he falls harder into the pit inside. I came crashing to the edge of the pit on the grass. Fortunately, the Kuret armor protected the side I hit and reduced the pain.

Charles continued to growl as he was caught inside his own trap. While this was going as planned, I could feel my Kuret control loosening. I am tiering too quickly than predicted. I have only a couple of seconds before I get tapped out. I was breathing too hard. I had to ignore the aching body also. This is it. Without standing up, I make my Kuret thrusts me inside to Charles who fell face first inside. The hole on the ground had began slow down it's

shaking. Charles was trying to get up, but just like last time, he was caught with some boulders on him. The tail I cut didn't grow, instead Charles just the healed the open would. He won't be regrowing his tail then.

I raise my arms and turn both my Kuret fist into pointy edges. I aim to cut his legs so that he can't get up. Charles should have not been able to dodge this, but he forcibility turned his body to his side. I missed his leg and jab my fist into the ground instead. He then tries to kick me, my only one arm to defend, I was pushed backwards. I hit the rocks behind me. I made the Kuret behind me to gather together and protect me. Charles using one arm supporting the ground, tries to get up.

No you don't, I thought. I thrust forward again and aim for the arm that is supporting him. Charles brings his other arm to defend me. His claws come slashing from the side, I swatted it away with my fist. Just when I was about to cut the arm, he thrusts his jaws in front. Using his tough Kuritine teeth, he bites me in the shoulder. He had planted some of the few hard Kuritine on his jaws. I managed to cover my entire upper body with Kuret anticipating this. But his bite didn't waver. I saw his brown glimmer flowing continuously into his jaws strengthening him.

With the fist I initially planned to hit his arm, I used it to hit him in the face. At the impact I wrap more Kuret on my fist to increase the damage. The Kuretines on his face and head disintegrates completely. His head gets pushed aside from the force, but he still managed to keep his jaws locked on me. I decided to push myself back. The force pulls me behind and Charles couldn't keep me pinned anymore. I thought to attack again to his arm. Then Charles roars, the brief struggle gave him the time to use both his arms and he was now on his knees trying to get up.

No, if he gets out of this hole, I will not be able to another chance to restrict his movement again like this. With my entire body, I let myself thrust straight into Charles large body. I tilt a little sideways and aim for a shoulder crush. I was aware of those hard Kuritine on his body, but I couldn't care about them anymore. Charles didn't have full balance as he blocked me with his arms. And yet due to his size, I wasn't able to push him back. My mouth that was open for breathing, begins to take in more air with the push I was making.

We were in a deadlock for few seconds. This is not good. I wanted to do another thrust, but it isn't going to change much. I have no choice but to back away. But the moment I do, he will get up and crawl out of this pit. In desperation, an idea came to me. A very dangerous one. I didn't have time to second guess. I let go of the push. Instead, I made a complete reverse push with full force. Charles didn't get a chance to grab me. My relentless attacks had stripped off a lot of his Kuret body.

I then angled to be pushed up. I was reverse flying straight up in the air. I didn't know how much speed I needed, so I kept pushing myself higher. Charles on the ground slowly shrinks in height. I have no clue how high was going. I could vaguely see of the arena's seating area edge at the end beside me. Wow, I was close enough to the edge of barrier then. I didn't stop here, this is most likely my last attack. I was pushing my body with each push. I am trying something very dangerous. I have never went this high without any equipment. So many things can go wrong if this doesn't work properly.

Above me, I could finally glimmer of the barrier. At last, I could tell exactly how high I was. 0.85 miles above the surface. Holy crap. I could see the entire arena from here. With I final push above, I reach and hit the barrier on my back. Seeing the unbelievably height, I shut my eyes before I panic even more than I am right now. My body was trembling with a mix of anxiety. When my decent begins, my nervous dial shoots up. No turning back. As I fall, I position my body to point downwards.

I maintain the angle of body with my Kuret pushing sideways. It was tricky getting the proper angle as I fall. I barely managed to my body still as I fell face down. I place my arms behind me to the side. When the time comes, I will pull it forward. I willed the Kuret to cover my entire body to reduce the drag as much as possible. The speed picks up terrifyingly fast. Even with my Kuret covering me, I could feel the wind pressure begins to increase. Without the Kuret on my skin, I would have been just swaying uncontrollably in the air. I saw Charles glimmer becoming closer. He had crawled out of the pit.

Meanwhile my fall was frightening fast. I didn't have M with me, so I couldn't tell if had reached terminal velocity of gravity. I needed to time this perfectly, otherwise, I can't stop myself at this height and speed if I miss. Once the ground was becoming closer. I decided to do it now. I willed the entire Kuret on my body to push me down. The sudden acceleration knocked the wind out of me. I small cry came out of my mouth. Crap. This is madness. I have jumped from height before. But this is the first time doing with a parachute or flying gear. I have nothing but just my Kuret.

On the ground Charles was glimmer was becoming closer. I was close to the ground now. I yelled once more when I thrusted once again downwards. The acceleration kicked the speed a notch again. Charles decided to avoid this. He went on all fours and begins running. My hands tremble hard in fear now. Knowing what I had to and actually doing it is completely separate. I pull my arms above my head. The drag was making it difficult. With a small burst of Kuret, I push them forward.

Now comes the hard part. I began to push myself from the side. I sudden thrust pushes me to the side, but I remained vertical. Shit. Please work, dammit. I kept thrusting the side with every ounce of energy I had. Just as I was too close to the ground, my decant begins to curve. Hell yeah, I was now slowly curving down. My body strained under the never experienced pressure. I angled my Kuret to push me forward and became horizontal a moment later. At last. I was flying at top speed parallel to ground.

I made sure to angle my decent in the direction of Charles. Charles and I were going to collide into each other if don't change our path. I was ninety nine percent sure Charles wasn't going to evade this. Not because he thought he could stop me, but he knows that he isn't fast enough to dodge with the speed I have. Charles kept going forward. I was right. He wasn't going to back down now. Neither was I. As I flew at him, I kept speeding up with my Kuret. This is it. We became close to our inevitable clash.

Charles leaped to the air and raised both his arms to throw a punch instead of his usual claws. It didn't matter what he does, I am have to crush whatever he throws at me. I formed large Kuret around my arms. I tried to make the edge as sharp I could. With a final bust of Kuret push, we collide. The collision shook my entire body. It created a huge sound that made my ears ringing. The shockwave created blasted an wind that flowed out from all direction. The pressure I felt was maddening. If it weren't for the Kuret protection, I definitely would have broken my bones.

For few seconds, our clash is canceling out each others power. Then I could feel Charles getting weaker. Blood rose to my face and with another push I yelled out another Kuret thrust. Charles couldn't stop me anymore. His arms gets slapped away. I thrust the Kuret on my arms into his chest. Red glimmers comes off the point of impact. I pressed on with my assault. With no ground to support him, he was thrown backwards in the air. Due to his large size, he wasn't going fast.

My own speed had dwindled down considerably. But I had enough momentum to push Charles back. The ringing in my ears continued drowning Charles roars flowing in the air. I was sure this was enough to bring Charles down, but was managing to keep himself balanced. Dammit, he never gives up. Charles foot starts to drag on the ground. Even with everything going on, he is trying to stop me. I was now furious. How much longer will this go. I was at my limit. Anger swelled my entire thoughts.

I am not going to let this end like this. I let of Charles and began a reverse thrust to decelerate my speed. A weaker tug pulled me away from Charles. I was now clearly loosing power. A had few seconds now. Charles was still getting dragged across the field. I used the anger I felt to power through a set of continuous thrust towards Charles. Even with my ears blocked, I heard the wind blown away at my sudden speed. I kept propelling forward towards Charles.

With a loud yell, I take my fist and aim to his face. Charles tried bringing his arms to his face to defend himself. I wasn't going to let him do that. His arms was mangled from the assault, so just as I reach him I twist my hip and push his arms away with my other hand. The Kuret on my hand forced his arms away. Continuing the motion, I land my fist straight into his jaws. The impact vibrated my arm. A sharp pain rose from my fingers. Charles couldn't dodge this. He was thrown back hard.

As continues getting dragged, he begins to fell backwards now. Not enough, I thought. I pushed myself back a little and prepared for a reverse kick to his neck. The Kuret force was considerably less now. But it didn't stop me. My heel kicks into this throat and he gets push down further. He can't stop his fall now. Before he falls completely, I push downwards behind his back where he is going to fall. I was completely controlling my body like a puppet with my Kuret now. I skid across the grass and raise my arms above.

I don't know if had enough left in the tank. But I have to do this. I force my Kuret on my fist to turn into spears. I couldn't feel if the turned or not. Charles body on top of me. I was going to get crushed under his weight. As soon as his back connects, I yell and push my Kuret further. My Kuret tore inside his body and in one thrust it pierced him. I wasn't focusing on Charles glimmers to see I was making any damage or not. I was too anger to care at the moment if my Kuret cut his real body.

His body starts to tumble on me. I pushed myself out of the way before I get pinned beneath him. I can feel my Kuret dwindling on my body. Just one more. I force myself to push ahead, my feet gets dragged on the ground. I kept my Kuret spears in my fists. I joined my two hands together and fused the Kuret spears. I was now holding a Kuret shaped sword. I raise my arms and yell as I sung hard on his knees. I see the hard Kuritine there getting crushed and my Kuret slashed into his Kuret body.

Just then Charles brought he other knee from the side and kicks me to my stomach. Dammit. I was too focused that I didn't ignored his glimmer coming. My arms sway apart and the Kuret sword becomes undone. My Kuret on my body was disappearing slowly. The knee kick knocked the wind out of me. In a moment of desperation, I willed the Kuret on my chest to turn into spikes. The spikes tore into the knee breaking the Kuretine. But that’s all I could do and was thrown away from blow.

I was getting dragged back across the ground. My head hurt, my entire body was paining. All the soreness I was ignoring came rushing in all together. All my anger and frustration was slowly turning to nauseous and drowsiness. Oh no. I was going to lose consciousness. I can't let this happen. With what little Kuret remained on me, I will it to push me back further away from Charles as much as possible. I was slowly losing sense of time and feeling. I don't even know what happened to Charles. Did I do enough to take him out.

I vaguely sensed that I came to halt. A few second later my mind went blank from the exhaustion.

# Blake (Chapter 22)

Monday, January 29, 2024 22:32

David has been surprising everyone with completely unexpected moves many times in this match. But this one was the biggest. His arms were covered with his black Kuret, on top of that thin Kuret strands were coming off him. I tried to see into him using my aura, but nothing came. Whatever he did, it was still his own power. Cassandra exclaims, whoa. I have never seen this before. I was thinking the same. Maybe this is what he was trying to do at the end of our match. But I felt this wasn't it. Its like he trying to figure out his own powers in the middle of all this.

Everyone here were hooked to the screen. None could dare speak and interrupt the confrontation happening between. They began fighting once they both were ready. Charles made the first move, attacking with this tails. David was able to evade them easily. It looked like the Kuritines on the end were breaking before it hit David. I am in awe seeing Charles continued a barrage of claw attacks and David deftly blocked each time. Their battle had taken a big turn now. David had been on the defensive for a lot of time, but he is actively on the offensive now.

Charles kept throwing boulders, punches, kicks and even once tried to bite David. To counter, David jumped, dodged and even blocked few of his attacks without backing down. Near the end of this relentless attacks, David skid across the grass trying to get away from Charles who was coming at him from above. Just when I thought David was cornered, he punches the ground and it splits apart. Both he and Charles fell into the pit. Matt says, huh, wait. Is that another hole Charles dug earlier. Did David get caught.

It may have looked like that, but David flew away before Charles could grab him. Meanwhile, Charles is struggling to get out of the pit. I said, no. It wasn't Charles trap this time. Its David. Nathan begins laughing, quite the devils luck he has. Using his opponents own trap to use against them. He takes in a sip as he gulps down the drink in his glass. Vanessa retorts, you really think that was luck. David must somehow know where all the traps are hidden. Nathan just shrugs at her saying, yeah, whatever you say. Vanessa looked like she was going to rebuke Nathan on his flippant behavior.

Tess cuts in the conversation, do you think Charles even knows where all the traps he made. He used his tails to create them, so shouldn't he be aware of them. Why did he get caught himself. Tess made a valid point. I looked at Derek. He shook his head, maybe not. I am not sure. Charles is clever sometimes, but he isn't smart. David's a certified genius, so it isn't a surprise he can outperform Charles in some aspects. I totally agreed with Derek on this. David's slowly taking control of the situation. Kafar is siting silently with the tablet on his hand. I was sure he would jump at the chance to rebuke Derek and praise his Champion. But he didn't even open his mouth. He must be still worried to see David give a wound to Charles.

While Charles digs himself out, David was preparing himself with covering one of his leg with this Kuret form. Marina asks, is something wrong with David. Why doesn't he cover himself completely with this wild Kuret. I take a moment to think before response, I think because he is figuring this out for the first time. After a pause I continue, I don't think this what he has been hiding the whole tournament. If it was, he wouldn't be struggling so much. A nagging suspicion came to me. Is it possible that David… no. He isn't there yet. At least I don't think so. The whole step need for that is messed up. I push that ridiculous thought for now. Marina says, okay. But that's crazy, he shouldn't try something like this right now. I nodded with her, yeah. David's is behaving a little strange, no doubt.

Out conversion came to stop when Charles comes out of the pit carrying two boulders on him. I heard Matt saying, oh hear we go again. I bet everyone thought Charles would throw them. We were thrown a back little when he didn't and even more shocked when David didn't evade his assault. Instead, David rushed into one the boulder and tries to push it away from Charles. Cass speaks, what's going on now. Somethings weird. She wasn't wrong. David didn't attack the second boulder, or rather couldn't. He created some distance between them. Charles shocks everyone when he breaks the boulder on his arm himself.

What the hell is that, I exclaim. Charles had was fused to a Kuritine structure that looked so similar to an Earth dears horns. There were intricate and spanned dozens of sharp edges. They looked different than his usual Kuret. Derek who was shocked speaks up, This is getting dangerous. Charles must be feeling cornered to use this. Vanessa asks, you have seen this before. He nods, not exactly. I have heard about it during his battle against the Hives. But I was told he uses a different way to create them, like using a Kuritine rock or something that uses Kuret. I never expected to see it here though. I didn't think he would do it this way, I guess without his usual battle weapons, this would be a substitute.

I ask, is it powerful. Derek nods instantly, for sure. You see the Kuritine glowing even at the screen. They are different from the ones on his body. They are continuously supplied with Kuret inside, so they only become stronger with every second. Vanessa asks, isn't he worried about depleting his Kuret. Marina responds to his before Derek, I don't think he is worried about that. When I scanned Charles earlier, I could feel the endless amount of Kuret supply. I don't he is has even hit his half point. Matt says, jeez. That’s insane. How's David's supposed to beat this. Nathan asks, well you can always choose to switch your vote. He shows a gleeful smile.

I ignored him. Vanessa didn't, maybe you need to do that. David's not out of the game yet, and he is beating whatever Charles is throwing at him. The exchanges among us is getting heated. It was quieted when David and Charles resumed their attacks. Using his latest Kuritine weapon, Charles continues to slash David. David was able to block those Kuritines, but he couldn't destroy them. Those black Kuret only broke the Kuritines on his body. David switched gears and attacks his chests and face.

All this time, David's been the one who evades at every turn. But now Charles was avoid getting hit by David now. I could tell Charles is now threatened by David so much so, he can't just choose to block his attacks anymore. The intense battle was raging onwards. They both kept going with their relentless attacks. I could see David gaining momentum slowly in this battle. Especially since now with his new Kuret, he can move faster. His jumps are letting him soar in air for longer time.

This is nothing like our battle. I knew I would be at disadvantage if we fought at close range, so whenever I could I kept attacking David from a distance. But with Charles, both of them have advantage at close combat. Their fight however, is clear exchange of hand to hand combat. Does David thinks he can beat him like this. I was alerted back to reality when David does some crazy aerobatics and lands a kick to Charles face. Matt says, ouch. That was an epic kick. In your face.

Charles responds with his Kuritine horns. I thought David would be flung back from this one. But he created a Kuret shield from his arms and blocked that from skewering him. I exclaimed, that’s just like when he uses his dome to create physical objects. What is going on. No one gave me an answer right away. The battle was coming to a head. Charles used his fist to pin down David before he could escape. David arms were getting crushed under Charles arms. Or that was supposed to be. But my eyes widen in horror when I see Charles hand breaking.

Charles couldn't keep this for long, he went for another attack with his horns. This is bad, David's can't defend this one, Cass screams. Against all odds, David managed to block the horns. The Kuret on his chest turned into the wild Kuret in last second and protected. I let out a sigh of relief when David slid backwards and rested on the ground. Vanessa says, that was too close. David's making me crazy with all these close calls. I agreed and added, David's pushing his luck for sure.

They both looked exhausted a little. Charles was taking time to heal is hand and David was resting a little. The tablet on Kafar's hand begins to ping again. Kafar immediately opens up and rolls his eyes on the screen. Derek asks him, what is it. He shouldn't be hurt too badly from his. Kafar takes a moment to respond, he is bleeding a little from his mouth. I don't see his hand or arm hurt. But. He pauses a little. His expression darkens, with constantly healing himself, his blood pressure is erratic. His Kuret is not effected right now. However, he couldn't finish. Derek offers, you think if this continuous like this, he will suffer from another Kuret blockage.

When Kafar didn't respond on that, we know Derek was right on the mark. Marina got excited, so if Charles Kuret becomes unstable once more, he would be in serious trouble right. Derek hesitantly nods after looking at Kafar, if David continuous like this, then there's a strong chance Charles could lose. Kafar couldn't refute even this. Everyone here were delighted to hear that David's gaining the upper hand. Nathan says, well. Vanessa , I think you might be right. I might just change my vote now.

I looked at Nathan smiling even more. I followed his eye line to the monitor focused on David. I gulped a little when I see his Kuret flames slowly vanishing and replaced by that wild Kuret. Matt says, he is transforming his Kuret again. Damn man, David's Kuret is going for a roller coaster ride. I was enthralled with this change. When his entire body got covered, he was now a big mass of wild black Kuret. Thin Kuret sparks flowing out of him everywhere. He entire body looked like mini volcanoes.

Cass says, I'll be honest, this creeps me out a little. I know its just David's Kuret. But it looks ridiculous and menacing at the same time. She was right. I turned to face the window and looked into him directly. From the aura, I could tell the ambient Kuret around was pushed out. He is creating a pure black hole of Kuret void around him. The only time I have seen like this when he fought Derek and I with his dome. Has he really figured out to make his Kuret condense without the dome. It means he can move around more freely without the area of the dome to restrict him.

My conclusion was verified when David dashed towards Charles. He wasn't running, he was almost flying at him. But what was shocking is the speed he moved at. He covered the distance between way to fast. Charles was put on defensive with this new power. Charles had to defend David's attacks for a while with his Kuritine horns. David catches Charles kick gives a punch to his knees. The tablet on Kafar hands pings again. David is not even giving an inch, he jumps and latches on Charles neck. Charles tries his best to kick David off, but he kicked the arm with Kuritines horn.

David knees straight into Charles face. Whoa. David is overpowering Charles. For the first time we see Charles falling back on his back. Kafar's tablet pings once more. Matt cheers on, whoa. That was nuts. But that didn't stop here. David flew up and back down giving a choke hold on Charles neck. I never thought I see Charles struggle so much. Charles managed to break away from David with his Kuritine horns. David blocked it but was thrown back. Damn, I said, David was a beast on this one. Charles didn't even get one hit on him this time.

Kafar's tablet stops pinging. His expression was darkened. It's a little crazy to think to know that he went from blissfully enjoying when the match begin to such worried state. Vanessa asks, so Kafar. How's the champion of yours faring now. Kafar couldn't manage a response. Derek answers, don't just think David can keep this up. He is been fighting for too long. He has to be getting tired by now. Vanessa replies, yeah, but look can you honestly think David doesn't know it. He must have a plan for this.

Nathan says, you have a lot to say what David thinks, huh? Vanessa opened her mouth, but held back once more. Is it just me or Nathan is actively trying to provoke Vanessa lot more than recently. Marina says, whoa. Charles is doing something new again. I am not going to lie, I thought he lost his mind when he broke those Kuritines himself. I thought he went so mad that he did something reckless. But then he starts to stuck those Kuritines on his own body. I was now sure he lost his mind.

Derek spoke up immediately, hold on. This is too much. Kafar is Charles vitals okay. Kafar nods after checking, yes. He isn't himself. But this is taking it far, why would he intentionally hurt his Kuret body like this. I ask, I take it this is he hasn't done before. Derek nods, yeah. I mean, at least I have never seen him doing this before. He then takes a moment, this is a little dangerous, those Kuritines are strong enough to handle David's new form. Charles must be getting frustrated now.

Cass turns to Marina, is David fine. With all his face covered, I can't tell if got any bruises or cuts. Marina looks at her wrist, sorry. Until the watch opens up, I can't say. And with him being covered with his Kuret, I can't do a charm to detect his physical presence. I add, and I can't see any Kuret aura on him anyway. Matt asks, its fine then right. As long as the watch doesn't ring, David is still strong enough to kick Charles Kuret ass. A small giggle pass among the crowed. Vanessa murmurs, David has to have plan right. Maybe she was asking herself this.

While Charles was slowly placing the Kuritine on his body, David was resting up once again. He will be hitting his limit soon. Its amazing that he is able to fight this long without a Medrines stamina. He must really want to win the fight. I recalled the conversation we had earlier. He wasn't really sure back then that he needed to win badly. Something must have changed to risk his life like this to win now. I made sure to remember and ask David this once the match is over. Whatever be the outcome.

After a minute, Charles was ready. The Kuritine were shining over his body. Its like he added a spikes on his already tough armor. Here we go. What will David do now. I think his best bet is to use his Kuret to form physical objects. Fighting head on will be a challenge now. Charles makes a dash to David with a jab. David dodges them. Charles attacks continuous on, but David only keeps dodging them. After couple of moves, I realize this must be what he choose to do for now. Matt exclaims, what's David thinking. He should be offensive like he was till now. Fighting like this will just waste energy.

Cass beside him agrees, yeah. That’s reckless now isn't it. I reply, I don't think so. Any body would be wary of those Kuritines. He can't attack like that. Charles is cleverly adapting to the situation just as well as David if not better. The battle rages on like this. David continued to block or dodge his attacks for quite a while. Then he made a move. He caught Charles off guard and punched his stomach. Charles roars loudly with that single attack. Marina cheers, yeah. That’s what's you call a classic David.

I smiled at her words. She wasn't wrong. David always fights hand to hand combat with efficiency. He had to be waiting for this opportunity. I thought he would make another attack, but then something unbelievable happened. His black Kuret came out of Charles back. My expression turned anxious seeing that black sphere coming out through Charles. Kafar's tablet loudly rings. What the hell is happening now. Did David pierce through Charles hard Kuret body.

Everyone were clearly shocked by this. Kafar was the most. He jumped off his chair with tablet in hand, you can't be serious. This is not possible. I thought this had to be it, Charles must be done. But he didn't give in. He brought a punch and David couldn't dodge this. He got punched straight in the face. My thoughts turned sour again seeing David thrown away. This is crazy. Charles wasn't backing down even in this state. David comes to a stop. He lies on his back for a while. Derek pulls away the tablet from Kafar's hand in haste.

After a moment he says, Charles got wounded badly. He then pauses. We remained silent to let him continue, but he is already healing himself. It wasn't a fatal wound. Kafar, you can calm down. The Charles we know isn't going to lose like this. Kafar's expression showed relieved after hearing this, are you sure. But that black Kuret went straight through him. Derek responds, I don't think that was strong enough to tear his body completely. David probably didn't make his Kuret completely solid.

Nathan sets his drink aside, I don't know what I should be shocked for. David seemingly wounding Charles this badly. Or Charles still going even after such a wound. I say, yeah, if it was any other alpha, it would be bad but not deadly, Charles on the other hand. I trailed off. Vanessa continuous, what will happen now. Will Charles himself instantly or will it be slow. Derek thinks for a moment, I don't know. I know he has received deadly wounds before. He fought in the war at the last day on Medrone. And he also fought countless Hives on Earth too. Even the commander multiple times. But I have never seen him battle up close. You will have to ask other Heraknus how fast Charles would heal a wound like this.

Charles kept his hand on the wound to probably stop the bleeding. Tess says, this is getting wild by the minute. And I think people feel the same way. Look at the updating voting's now. David's win votes was now at thirty-five percent. It was less way less than Charles sixty-one percent. Considering that only few voted for him at the beginning of the match, this is an incredible change of events. I can't say for sure David is winning, but he isn't making Charles easy to beat him. The large difference in there powers that was there at the start has now been reduced considerably.

Suddenly a beeping sound came from myside. It was a different sound that Kafar's tablet. I turned towards Marina, where the noise was coming from. Maine looks at us with confused look, then she gasps. She pulls the watch out of her sleeve. The watch was glowing up. I said, that’s not boding well.

# Vanessa (Chapter 23)

Tuesday, January 30, 2024 23:53

I can't believe the person fighting in front me is David. The same guy who I met all those years ago who was struggling against a single Hive. Now he has become such a terrifying force that he can now fight at the same level on true alphas and mythical alphas. I can only be in awe. His Kuret had been strange since I met him, but now, I can't believe the various transformations it has gone through. All what's even more ridiculous is that he is getting strong in this fight.

It was shocking to see David turning his arms into a something like a Kuret hurricane. Then he later turned his entire body into one, I could hardly recognize him in that form. I think that David was hiding this power. But Blake is very sure this wasn't it. Then it is completely bonkers that David is pushing so hard and is actually discovering a completely new power right here. And what a power it is. I was sure Charles was done when David gutted him. Even then he still wasn't going down. Charles was equally impressive if not more. Only if David had fought Charles like this from beginning then David wouldn't be struggling like this.

I know David is getting tiered. His usual sharpness in reactions is slow now. This must be too much for him. The timer showed we crossed the forty minutes mark. David's has to be hitting his limit. After that last attack, he was lying on the ground. Charles couldn't ignore his wound and just continue attacking like he was doing a while back. This wound must be serious enough that he stayed back to heal. David slowly got up. He couldn't even stand properly and resting his hands on his knees. I got anxious seeing him this worn out.
Then the watch on Marina's wrist flared up. My expressions hardened hearing this. Does this mean that last punch David received was serious. Marina raised her wrist. The watch screens glows and then the hologram comes out of it. A 3D anatomy of a body showed in that hologram. It was David's. Then I heard the sound of the AI I have gotten used to, entering orange alert. Recognized current user Marina. Authorized limited access, granted. Then hologram begins to show details on the halo body.

There are different colored lines drawn across the hologram. After few seconds the entire body gets covered with colors. Some places had red other were spread wider. There was yellow and orange in various places. On the head, near the chest, and then his limbs. This was the state of David's right now. I saw the most red was on the side of his face and his chest. That must be where he was hurt the most. M continuous, diagnostic completed. Boss muscles have sprained all around his body. He has a small tear on his femur bone. His fingers on his hand and foot have sprained. His right ancle is sprained. Bleeding from 8 different wounds. Boss has suffered several mild injuries but no threatening ones. I felt relief hearing this. But then next moment I realized that M wouldn't act now if something wasn't right.

She continuous, however, requesting to stand by for medical treatment. I blurt out, what. You mean, we should stop this fight now? M continuous, inconclusive. I don't have enough evidence to see he needs to get treatment right away. However, boss has added this protocol whenever a certain threshold is crossed. Marina asks, what should I do then. M responds, I will be making real time changes to the medications and stiches he will need for his cryo bath. However, since I can't tell boss about his current condition, he has requested you to help him with telling him.
Marina asks a little worried now, how. I can't intervene in this match directly. He won't be able to hear or see me from the edge of the barrier. And I can't use a charm near him to speak through. His Kuret is cancelling the ambient Kuret around him. M says, you need to create a smoke of at least 15 different Kuretines together at the edge of the barrier. Boss will sense these many different Kurets at the same place. He said when he sees that signal, no matter what happens or the situations is, he will forfeit the match immediately.

I get it, David would see with his synesthesia and understand that he has to stop. I ask, so when do we know it’s the right time to pull the plug on this? I don't want to see David getting hurt badly, but stopping before will also be bad. M continuous, in the current state condition, boss can continue the fight. Orange alert is still in effect. However, I would recommend to inform boss when I go into red alert. Depending on the condition, I would advice to signal boss immediately with no delay. Otherwise, boss will be taking serious risk.

A moment of silence came over the room. David was finally gaining momentum on wining this fight, but now a new wrinkle threated it. Blake asks to Derek, will Charles be able stop himself when he sees David giving up. Derek takes a moment to reply, he should. But there is a small chance he wouldn't care and continue. If his was calm, I would be more sure. But seeing him now, I am not sure. He then turns to Blake, it would be prudent to have a backup plan for both Charles and David. This tournament has been seen situations were people in no condition to fight anymore don't stop in the heat of the battle and needlessly risk their life.

That was definitely a light jab to me. I know Derek wasn't trying to single me out. Besides, he was right. Blake nods, its highly unlikely that David would make a irrational decision and ignore his own plan to stop. But I agree with you. Its best to stop him, even if we want to forcibly. Blake then looks around us a moment and then takes a moment to think. Marina says, I will go to the arena's nearby barrier now. I need to prepare for the signal. Blake turns to her, yeah. Since you have the watch, we will follow your lead. You can go ahead, we will behind you in a minute. Marina nods and walks out through the door in a hurry.

Kafar asks, remind me again how David will be able to see this signal? More than half the time, he keeps his eyes closed. Can he really see Kuret, why does he need to close his eyes then. I don't know what to tell Kafar regarding David's secret. Blake choose to give an evasive answer to his question, he will be able to see it. He wouldn't ask us to do this if couldn't see it. Kafar remained confused a little. He let it lie for the moment. Blake then asks to Derek, you think you can help me stop Charles in case we need to intervene.

Derek asks, why me. Blake answers, he doesn't know any of us. At least he hasn't spoken to us. So I want to bring you in. Seeing you might just be enough to stop him. Derek thinks for a moment. Blake continuous, I would ask Kafar for this role, but bringing a non-combatant would be dangerous. So how about it. Derek nods and then looks at Kafar, he is right. Its best if Blake and I both stop him if the time comes. What do you think. Kafar looked at Derek. Not responding immediately, he faces the healing Charles on the screen.

He must be happy a little seeing that we were preparing for David's possible defeat. If was he wasn't showing in his face. He must be hiding it, or likely thinking the odds of Charles loosing. A moment later he says, Okay. I don't want Charles to win like this, but it would be bad if tries any more attempts to kill David. He then stares intently at Derek, but don't stop the match until the last second. We need to give people a clear victory. If they saw us stopping it before it was absolutely necessary, it would defeat the entire purpose of this tournament.
He didn't have to remind us that. We were painfully aware that this was just a glorified entertainment for people to see us and increase the odds of joining our communities. Derek nods, I understand. I don't want David and Charles to feel cheated. A pause later he says, but Kafar, you need to be prepared for any conclusion. I am not saying Charles would lose, but just be ready for anything. Just like we are planning for David, we might choose to decide to stop the match if Charles is going to far or risking his life too. Kafar just nods in response. Blake says, okay. Good. So the two of us on Charles duty. And as for David…
I stood up before he could continue, I will do it. My Kuret is the only thing that would be most effective on David. Ned beside me finally looks at me. He had been so silent this whole time. I think we was avoiding talking to me to make sure we don't fight again. He spoke just then, you sure. Maybe I should help you. I raise my hand, no. My Kuret is hard to control. You would just get in the way. Cassandra then speaks, you shouldn't do this alone. If I could do it, I would, but my Kuret is also a bad match for David.

Matt stood up, I'll help you. I was about to refute him, but he stops me. Don't worry. I am not going to use your Kuret. I will go and copy a Kuret different Kuret that physically intervenes. And its safer for two people to be David too. The more people, the better. It was hard to argue with his point. Ned sighs, fine you both can go. At the risk of being repetitive, just step in when absolutely necessary. Okay. He eyes me when he said that. It was a reminder to me of my own match. I didn't want to get into with Ned with everyone here so I gave him a nod in agreement.
Blake continuous, ah, I was going to ask for your help anyways Vanessa. Its good we agreed. Lets leave immediately before they David and Charles began fighting again. Matt says, ah guys, we should hurry up. They are starting again. I turned to the screen. David wasn't waiting for Charles to heal and rest up. He jumped into air and attacked with his knee to Charles. Charles blocked it with his arms. Blakes exclaims, huh. I really thought David was going to buy more time. Maybe his trying to wrap up as soon as possible.

I was thinking the same. Its no coincidence that M alerted us a while back and David springs back in action early. I say, we have to hurry. I turn to Blake, lets avoid the staircase and just jump. Matt says, hey. Not everyone can fly you know. I need to find the right Kuret to use on David. Maybe even on Charles. Derek walks to us, you both hurry up. Matt and I will catch up. We turn to the screen and see David zipping around Charles in mid air attacking and dodging. Blake says, lets move now.

Cassandra stands up to Matt, make sure David doesn't get hurt okay. Matt nods, don't worry. I got this. He gives a quick kiss on her cheek. Derek opens the door and walks away. Behind him, Matt follows. Blake prepares to open the window we were going to use earlier to stop the match. I face down to Ned. He wasn't looking at me anymore. I got annoyed at his behavior. I am not saying I wanted a relationship like Matt and Cass, but he could be more appreciative of me. I decided to leave just like this and walk.

As I walk, I turn sideways to Nathan, you don't plan on helping? You and Blake together would be more efficient. Nathan just smirks a little, too many people will create unnecessary confusion. Besides, you'll got this. He raises his drinks, and someone needs to keep the others here accompanied here. He points his head slightly to Ned and Kafar. I didn't know exactly what he meant. Maybe he doesn't want to help David out of resentment. Or maybe it was something else. I didn't care anyway.

Blake says, lets go. He covers himself with blue Kuret and jumps out the window. I walk beside Catherine. Like Ned hadn't spoken for a long time. She wore a worried and nervous expression, but never expressed it in words. She was one of David's best friend, and yet I was confused why she remained quite all this time when we are worried about David. She didn't say anything to Blake, me or anyone as we left. Something is definitely eating her up. I wanted to know what it is causing her to be like this. I'll ask her later.

Tess says, good luck. Keep the those guys safe. Jess chips in, and stop the match immediately when David gets injured okay. Without his Medrine healing, it could turn nasty quickly. I nodded, we will make sure this doesn't become worse. See in guys in some time then. I turned to look at Ned once more hopping for some sort of reaction out of him. But he doesn't say anything to me. I gave up a little mad and turned my back to him. I put my legs on the window edge and push myself outside.

I turn on my Kuret and blew a gust of window around me. I saw Blakes flying near the edge of the wall below me. I followed his direction and began my decent. We couldn't feel it from the window, but the noise coming from the crowd in the stadium was ecstatic. People were cheering, yelling and discussing amongst themselves. Blake and I stuck close to the wall as to avoid as much as attention from the people. It would be bad to cause unnecessary chaos. As I glid in air, I turn my gaze up and see David and Charles fight up close.

David was attacking his stomach with Charles defensives down. Charles didn't go down on that punch, he instead starts to attack David with his arm. David gets caught and he was thrown down to the ground. I was a little taken aback when I saw David flying up in air dodging Charles kick. Charles attacked next with his tail. David avoided them and backed away. I touched the ground and started to running towards the edge of the arena gate. I saw Marina standing nearby where there was a little more space than other area.

She was already casting charms to prepare the signal. Ahead me Blake was running also and reached Marina first. I turned my gaze to the arena. Being so close now, the ground looked like a war zone. The ground that was even before the match was torn in various places. There were pieces of land torn apart and debris were lying everywhere. We have seen the arena getting destroyed many times, but they usually have much less damage than this. This is solely due to Charles. A lot of his attacks involve digging up holes and pulling out rocks from the ground.

Inside the barrier, the brief exchange came to halt again. Charles didn't attack back, he looked he wasn't finished healing the wound. Why did David stop. He was now just standing on the ground. Few seconds later I reach Blake and Marina. The watch on Marina's wrist was still showing David's condition. I couldn't tell if he got new injuries. I saw more yellow around his body. Blake says, looks like they are resting a bit before they begin again. That’s good for us.

I step in and ask, is it done Marina. She was working with just one hand while keeping the hand with the watch raised on her side, almost. Not so easy with one hand. She was clearly trying to be sarcastic. There are hardly any people who can cast with one hand. She was waving in air and creating Kuret circuits in the air. She continuous, throw me some of your Kuret you two. It would save me some time. Blake and I raise our arms to her. We both pour out Kuret in the air.

Marina's charm sucks our Kuret straight in. A Kuretine was being formed in the middle of her charm. Once Marina points its enough, we stop our Kurets. She says, okay. Few more to go. She focuses on completing the rest. Different shades of Kuret flow out from her charms into the Kuritine. Blake asks to me, you okay. You look pissed. I didn't know my face was showing like. I think my mind was still reeling with thoughts of Ned. I didn't want to get into this, its nothing. He says hesitantly, okay. Just don't get distracted for now.

I know he was right, but I still glared at him. He must know it was about me and Ned. I turn my gaze to David to avoid any further conversation and focused on David. He was trying something again. At the sight of David, I let go of my relationship problems. I need to be here for David now. Blake says, what's David up to now. Honestly, the guy wasn't this motivated during our match you know. I couldn't reply immediately. On some level, I agreed with Blake. David has been pulling out unexpected techniques this match.

In the latest one, he had covered himself in a mini tornado of Kuret. He was standing in the middle of the Kuret storm. Beside me Marina exclaims, okay. All done. One Kuritine with a cocktail of 22 Kuret signatures done. She then turns ahead to the barrier, okay once I break this, I will lower the barrier here for you guys and then… she stops when saw David, what the hell is going on. I didn't understand Marina's shock. David was doing something again, but it shouldn't be such a shock.

Blake gulps a little, you can sense it too Marina. She nods slightly. I was confused, what's going on. What are you guys seeing. Blake says, whatever David is doing, its pushing away the whole Kuret in the air away from him. And I am not taking how when he uses his dome. The side of his entire arena is now deprived of Kuret. I turned back to the arena, say what. David is Kuret is effecting this much now. Marina nods, yes. A moment later she says, if this continuous to grow like this, it would start to effect the barrier soon.

I was stunned at this. I didn't see David's Kuret much away from him. Meaning his invisible Kuret was leaking out to farther reaches. Is David's trying to become even stronger. Marina then says, wait. I see its slowing down. Blakes says, not just slowing, its shrinking back. Like its collapsing on itself. The storm around David was becoming smaller too. We kept our eyes glued to him. David was slowly making the storm smaller. Soon it was just few inches outside his body.

Then his Kuret around him collapses completely. Blake says, wow. All that Kuret he was pushing out is gone now. I sense the ambient Kuret is filling up the space inside again. Marina backs his words, yup. I can tell that all that wild Kuret he was throwing out in the air is gone now. So that it, his new transformation. I couldn't say even when we saw it. David was now covered in pieces of armor around his body. Unlike his previous form, he was not completely covered. There were few places on his body where his skin was exposed. It looked like he was wearing large pieces of Kuret rings on him. He had one on his face that looked like bandana.

But the most distinctive feature of this transformation was that it wasn't running wild anymore. Instead his Kuret was stable. Wrapped around him like a semi armor, not unlike the flames that are usually on him. Is this form really powerful than the one from before. I wasn't convinced this was more powerful. David walks and stands beside a nearby boulder lying on the ground. He punches the boulder leaving as anxious. If it were a normal punch, it would have been bad. But he head created a dagger looking shape from his fist when he put his hand through the rock. The top of the rock was blown away, leaving behind a visible hole.

Blake exclaims, whoa whoa. Did that really happened. I gulp a little replying, it sure is. David's managed to make his Kuret dense enough to shape his Kuret to physically attack. Blake nods, yeah. Without his Kuret dome. Damn, this changes stuff. Marina says, I don't think it’s the way we want though. Look at this. We turn to see Marina looking worried at the hologram. It showed more yellow area inside his body. The red area on his face and stomach spread further also. M beeps in, boss vitals have taken a big hit. Detecting increased the pain receptors from his wounds. Also detecting high BP and high repository activity. Conclusion, boss is tiring out rapidly. Switching to critical orange mode.

The hologram grams blinks away and is instead replaced by a new hologram of David's body. This one showed similar stuff like before. M continues, monitoring boss's vitals in millisecond time accuracy. Be advised for red alert approaching. Marina then looks up, ah so we are still good, right? Blake doesn't reply. I answer, we just have to play this by the ear. If it becomes dangerous, we will stop this right. No matter what David tells us. Agreed. They both nod in response. Marina replies, yeah. Its not like its over yet.

From the side of the barrier edge, I see Derek running to us with a tablet in hand. We all set, ask us when he approached us. Marina says, yup. All ready. Derek says, good. I also got a backup tablet of Charles to monitor his condition as well. I don't know what's going to happen, but better to be prepared for anything. I looked behind him hoping to see Matt. Derek says, Matt will be soon. I gave an advice on whom to copy his Kuret from. He will be here in a minute. I was already prepared to head in even if Matt wasn't here. But I wasn't naïve to know I could handle David alone, better to have a two man team stopping him.

We all turn our gaze to David when moves. Enough time had passed for Charles to heal his wound. My mouth hug out a little when I saw David move incredibly fast. What, I gasp loudly. Charles was preparing to attack with his tails, but David flew past them easily. That was unreal. He is now almost as fast as us now. Charles attacks with his claws, David ducks down and blocks them with a shield on his arm. He slid underneath Charles like he did the first time they both clashed.

The from behind, he jumps into the air. His movements weren't like he anything human anymore. He was flying in air. Marina says, holy shit. David can fly now. I was too shocked to respond. Blake scoffs at this sight, nothing surprises me anymore. Derek says, technically, he is not flying. It looks he using his Kuret to throw him up. Marina says, yeah that’s same as flying. David flew up to a height, meanwhile Charles threw a large boulder at him. David should have dodged it. But he choose to catch it and then hurls it back to Charles on the ground.

Charles wasn't fazed much with that when he broke the boulder. David begins falling down to a direction away from Charles. Charles chases after him. A moment later David lands and then runs towards Charles. Charles threw a rock at David. David again didn't dodge it, he instead blocks it away from his path. They were heading for another collision, or it would have been if not for David punching the ground with his Kuret. The ground spit opens and they both get dragged inside.

Derek shouts, unbelievable. It happened again. Yeah, I thought. David used Charles trap again. Tess was right on the money when she asked if Charles himself knows where the traps are laid. Its not even funny anymore that Charles got caught a second time. Charles tried to get out, he was stopped by David with a leg sweep. He floated in the air while he cuts off the tails from Charles behind. Charles lets out a roar as he fails to get out and falls inside the pit.

David lands near the edge and then jumps into the pit immediately. Blake says, he is trying to pin him inside. Brilliant. David's trying to somewhat restricted Charles movement inside. David begins his barrage of attacks on Charles. The tablet on Derek starts beeping. He looks at it without saying anything. Even when lying down, Charles kept blocking David's attacks. He even chomped on David's to stop him. My fist tightened up when I heard M beeping instead. M says, boss's vitals are declining. Detecting high levels of muscle spams now. His movements are causing tendon pains.

I kept my eyes focused on David. Matt isn't here yet, but I will not wait. As soon as M gives the signal I will jump in. David's attacks didn't stop. He punched Charles in the face to get away. Charles lets go his jaws from Charles neck. David then thrusts himself at Charles. He should have been wary of the Kuritine on Charles body. Looking at his desperate attacks, he isn't worried about them anymore. I can only pray that those Kuretines can't handle David's new Kuret transformation.

David then backs away as Charles falls on one knee. David didn't attack immediately, instead he flies backwards in the air. I thought he just wanted to gain some distance before attacking, but he kept rising in the air. After a certain height I got worried, hey. What the hell is David thinking. Even after flying so high, he didn't stop. He kept going higher. Blake shouts, holy shit. Is he going to do what I think he is planning. Marina exclaims, now you can't deny it. Someone has joined the flying Medrine club.

Derek was shocked so much he too couldn't remain calm anymore, what in the world. How high is he planning to go. David wasn't stopping at all. His figure is getting smaller every second. Behind me, Matt came running, hey, sorry for the delay. Got the Kuret though. He looks at us and turns his head up in our direction, what are you guys looking at. Blake replies, at David. Matt confused asked, come on. Don't kid around. He then frantically looks around the arena. Only Charles could be seen in the ground crawling out of the pit.

Matt voice trembles a little asking, hey seriously. Where the hell is David. I ask, you didn't see him flying up in the air. Matt yelled, what. David's flying. His voice stammered and then he looks up, I was inside the stadium to find a guard. I didn't see, he stops when he spots a small figure up in the air, god damn. Is that really David. How the hell did he reach up there. Scratch that. What is planning to do. Blake says, why would anyone fly up so high. You know what he is planning.

Marina says, whoa. I turn to her thinking she saw something on that hologram, what. Is it David. She nods, yeah. I just felt the him near the barrier. His Kuret is tearing small holes on the barrier. I am a little relieved to hear, but at the same I was horrified he flew to that height on his first try. Marina continuous, looks like he is travelling to the top most point of the barrier, the center. Blake says worried, this is too much for David. He has never flown before. This could turn ugly real quick. He turns to Marina, can you make a door for us just in case.

Marina nods, yeah. Good thinking. She points to the Kuritine floating in the air, grab this will you. Blake plucks the Kuritine in his hand. Marina raises both her hands and begins to create a charm. Matt exclaims, Vanessa, should I copy your Kuret. The one I have now won't be of help catching a falling David. I shook my head, no. My normal Kuret is complicated already enough, it will dangerous for you to try flying like this. Matt urges, but you alone will be not enough. Blake cuts in, if that happens I will back you Vanessa. If I see David is in more danger, me and Matt can switch our roles.

I nod in agreement. I turn my gaze up to the center of the barrier. Sure hope you know what you are doing David, I murmur.

# Vanessa (Chapter 24)

Wednesday, January 31, 2024 18:33

All our gaze were up in the sky. Not just the five of us here, but every person in the stadium had there eyes glued to the sky. A few seconds later Marina says, David just reached the barrier at the top. I felt the a big hole healing just now. Oh my, he actually fly up all the way there. Dang it. She was excited, but a little scared too. I was the same. David's risking way to much to win. Blake says, okay, he has taken all the runway distance. He turns to Marina, is it opened yet.

Marina hands waved around fervently now, nearly done. You guys should get ready. I take a step little closer the Barrier. The mild humming noise was coming off. Matt and I stood near one of the opening Marina is making. Blake and Derek stood two step away from us which had the other opening. Okay, its ready, Marina said stopping her charm. I will provide support from here to both of you guys in case something goes wrong. Derek says, hopefully nothing happens.

We were on our toes now waiting for David to return back to ground. Behind us the crowd is restless pointing their fingers to the sky. The nearest people on the seats were standing and cheering loudly. I couldn't hear whom over the ruckus. At this point, I didn't even care if David loses. We just have to make sure he doesn't get hurt badly. Or worse. This match isn't worth risking his life. Blake speaks, heads up. I can see David now. I squished my eyes to try and focus on the dark figure falling from sky. A wave of excitement roars from the crowd. People stood up from their seats with a sudden shot of revitalization.

David has covered himself entirely with his black Kuret. He was falling his face first. I could tell the way is swaying around a little that he doesn't have complete control on his. Why did you go this far David, I speak to myself. I called on my Kuret. I raise my hands and open my palm outwards ready to fly. I can do this. I am the fastest one here. I can catch up to his speed. Suddenly a noise came from above us. It sounded like something small exploded in the air. The sound made my body shook with fear.

What in the hell, Matt raises his arm and puts it behind his head exasperated, is it me or did David just became faster. He was right, David suddenly picked up his speed. Another small noise same a second later. Blake yells, shit. That’s David. The sound is coming from him when he propels himself to get faster. David was too fast now. I am petrified at the speed when there's a third noise. He was falling way to fast. Derek shouts, is that on purpose. This can't be right. He can't be doing something this crazy.

Oh, but he is. I wasn't going to wait anymore. Even if David can aim for Charles, if he misses or Charles dodges he will not be able to stop this speed. I poured Kuret around me and focused on creating a hurricane. To match the speed I need to create a lot of power. I took a step at the barrier. Blake called me just before I stepped in, Vanessa. Wait. Look. David was still falling, but he was also getting pushed sideways. He tried few times more. He is trying curve his fall.

But I didn't want to risk that. Blake yells, Vanessa don't. Not yet. Give it few more seconds, I think David is making it work. Blake grabbed me by the shoulder. I shoved his arm back, don't. What if he can't. Blake replies, what if he can. Just wait for a second. I wasn't going to. Derek shouts, look. David's changing his direction. He is controlling his fall. David's fall was slowly but surely aching. A few seconds later he was almost flying horizontal, heading towards Charles. Incredibly, Charles chose to run away on all fours. He was running away from David's trajectory.

However, when David changed his direction, it was to the opposite side of Charles path. Charles should have evaded this. But he didn't change his path. He instead pick up his pace and running faster. He was stomping the ground so fast, I could feel the shakes here. Matt laughs, oh yeah. He raises his fist in air to cheer on, come on David. Kick his mystical alpha ass. The crowd went wild seeing the two on a collision course. David poured more Kuret into his arms. My hearts begins thumping faster than ever.

If falling from such a height wasn't enough, David sped up even faster with another couple of small wind blasts. Marina yells, oh my god. Charles leaps to the air and ready to thrown down his fist from both the arms. Then the two clashed. The shock created a wind that blow the debris away on the ground. The sound of them colliding vibrated the air and even came through the barrier to us. Incredibly, both of them stayed in the air for few seconds. But then Charles was thrown back.

I shouted, Do it David. I make a fist and raises it near my head in joy. Blake yells, that’s it, yeah. Charles was now getting dragged across the field, David pushing him back. I was so anxious a second ago, but now all I could do was grin. I spoke, he actually did it. My god, David is nuts. Charles was helplessly getting dragged across the field. David's Kuret suddenly pierced through Charles body and a small black Kuret spear sticks out from Charles back. The tablet on Derek's hand blazed up with continuous ringing noise.

Behind us a different, but similar noise flared up. Marina shouts, shit. I turned to Marina. All the noise coming from the crowd drowned out M's voice. Its was definitely not good based on Marina's expression. I turn my gaze back to David. Should we get stop this match now. No, I controlled myself. Even if I want to, I can't David to miss this incredible chance he risked his life for. I will at least see this all the way through. David was slowing down now. Charles was still getting dragged back, he was even using his leg to stop his fall.

David was flying behind a little. Is it done, David? I asked him in my mind. But against my expectation, he propelled again with a small wind noise. This one was a continuous set of blasts, like he was accelerating in successions. David's not done yet. He goes in for Charles face with a punch. Charles defense fails when David swats them away. He punches hard into Charles face from the side. The ringing noise continued from the tablet, and so did from the watch.

I didn't want to get worried by checking on M, so I just waited for the right moment to get David myself. David then drop kicks on Charles neck. Charles could no longer stay on his feet. He was falling backwards. I was sure this is it. But against all expectation, David dropped to ground and slides on the ground behind Charles. What. His body is moving so strangely I couldn't fathom how he is doing this. He sits on his knees and raises his arms. Two Kuret spears launch from his arms and pierces Charles from the behind.

Even with the crowd behind us, we could hear Charles loud painful roar. Just before Charles falls on the ground, David slips out. This has to be it. And yet David goes beyond. He jumps into the air and lands nears his legs. He still had his Kuret spears on his hand. He joined his hands and the spears joined into a sword looking shape. In one swift strike, he cut his knees. Marina cries out, holy mother of god. No freaking mercy. I was shocked beyond reason at this display of his sheer will.

But nothing lasts long, Charles in a desperate attempt knees him in the stomach. David couldn't block this and he was thrown away. No. No. His body leaned forward lifelessly when got dragged away far. I shout, enough is enough. We need to stop this match now. Derek shouts, wait don't. I wasn't going to listen to anyway now. I prepared for a wind to carry me. But then the wind gets disrupted. I see Derek raising his arm at me with his Kuret. What, I shouted at him.

Just listen to me. Don't do something rash now. Blakes steps beside him, no Derek. This is enough now. Even I can't let this continue anymore. David's in critical condition now. He points back, M just now said his condition triggered M's red mode. Meaning we are stopping this match now. I know its not ideal, but David loosing is the least of our worries now.

Blake raised his palm to him, Charles in a similar situation. I noticed it when he first collided with David. That clash made Charles trigger his Kuret blackout. So I am asking not to do it for David's sake too. If you go and stop this match now, you just might waste all his effort, especially when he has potentially won the match. His fervent voice made us snap out of our zeal. I took a moment to consider. I didn't want to wait, but if what Derek said was remotely true, then…

Like me, Blake is also thinking. We couldn't decide right away. I turned my eyes back to David. He was now lying on the ground face first. His Kuret was now gone. He wasn't even moving. Fear swept like a wave of tremor over my body. Marina shouts, Vanessa,. David's not what you are thinking. Calm down. He only got knocked out. I turned to Marina. She raised he wrist to me. The hologram M was showing now had turned to red in the background. It also showed a clock beside it now. The image had been blown up to show the brain. There was many colored lines zipping around the holo. I didn't understand the writing on the air M is showing us. I ask, are you sure. M replies, boss is in a temporary state of unconscious. Yes. The most recent blow shook his entire body. He isn't in immediate danger right now.

My fear changed to wave of huge relief. I had even stopped my breathing a little and took a breath back in. Matt asks, buts that’s just as bad right. If David's lost consciousness, then he has lost the match right. We should just get him now. I reply, yes. Lets go Matt. Derek cuts in, don't. Listen. Don't stop the match now. I was annoyed now. I yelled, what are you saying now. Didn't you hear David's knocked out. He can't fight now. The match is over. He shook his head vehemently, no you don't understand. Charles is incapacitated too. He raises his tablet and shows us, those attacks did so many damage to Charles that he can't move right now.

What, I retorted. I turn to Charles body. He was moving, but still lying on the ground with low howls coming of his broken jaws. Derek continuous, believe me. I am not doing this just for Charles. If David's condition worsened, we will stop this match. But now that Charles is also down, he won't attack immediately. With all the wounds Charles got now, and on top of his Kuret blockage back again, I bet he can't even right now. So just trust me. We can't stop the match now.

Derek's pleads us with stern but worried voice. I wanted to rebuke. Then I thought to get some more proof. Blake turn to M, are you sure that David will be fine. We don't need to get him treated right away. M responds, boss is not in immediate danger. Confirmed. He hasn't lost too much blood. All this injuries are either superficial or can be treated right away. I am continuously changing the medicine dosage he will require based on his vitals. Boss's brain activity is fluctuating. There is a possibility he might wake up.

I calmed down more after hearing this. I took a step back from the barrier. Derek says, believe it or not, Charles is in almost an exact situation. He got couple of serious wounds from David's Kuret attacks. He should be able heal them in time, but right now he can't even move right now due his Kuret blackout. His healing is way to too slow. If he can't control his Kuret properly, he might just revert back to his original form and won't be able to fight anymore.

Blakes shakes his head in disbelief, just as Nathan said, David's luck is incredible. He chuckles nervously, I can't believe the guy. Just when he is goes down, and now completely defenseless, Charles shares the same fate. I took a moment to think. Luck or not. What are we supposed to do now. Marina asks interrupting my thoughts, but where does leaves us. David's a sleeping beauty. And the beast isn't moving. I wasn't amused at all her clever choice of words. Matt says, what's with this timer M. Don't tell me that when it hits zero, something happens to David.

M says, The timer is a safeguard by boss. If he doesn't wake up in the next three minutes and twenty two seconds, he will not wake up anytime soon. If the neural activity in his brain doesn't go up before it zero, he will be go into deep rem sleep. It will be impossible to continue the match. Boss added this timer in the red alert mode for a situation of attrition. Matt says, bloody hell David. He even thought of such a thing.

Derek says, if you guys remember. We added a rule about this also. If both the fighters are down for more than five minutes, the match would end in draw. The fight resumes when one get backs up. He then takes a moment, in this case its even possible, whoever is just able to stand up, will become the winner straight away. I ask him, how long do you think Charles will not be able to move. He looks at his screen, I have no idea. I have never seen Charles beaten to this extend. I don't even know if can fight after he heals his wounds.

Marina ask, so they are in, what's the term you say in chess… I respond, statement. She clicks her finger at me, yes. That. We just wait then. Blake says, I don't know what else to do. I had a thought. I said, okay look. If Charles wakes up first before the 5 minutes countdown ends. Then we stop the match right. Derek nods, provided David also can't wake up and is no shape of fighting. I shook my head, no. Even if he wakes up, I don't think we should let him continue the match. He gave M those instructions right. He will stop when Marina blasts the Kuritine.
Derek says, yes. That’s what he plans to do. But all I am saying if David wakes up along with Charles, he might be able to continue the match. I was shocked to hear this. How could Derek think David can continue fighting after this long. Blake says, look Derek. David's been fighting for almost 45 minutes now. He has lost all his stamina, there is no way he can fight now. The only way he can win right now is if Charles doesn't get back up, David somehow wakes up and the time runs out. I won't let David continue this. Even if David decides to fight, we should just put an end to it.

Derek turns to M, you say if David doesn't wake up before your count down hits zero, he will not wake up soon. I agree with that. But what happens if he does wake up before. Is there a chance he would rest up a little while and be able to continue. M responds, boss didn't put any protocol for this. However, if boss wakes up and the diagnosis I run shows some positive vitals, then yes its possible, I will revert back to orange alert mode. I would still mention that the chance of that happening is very low.

Derek nods, yes. That’s all I am saying. Trust me guys, I am not saying this because I am following Kafar's order or because I am on Charles side. All I want is to give David one more chance. You have seen how much he has gone all out in this match. I can't point my finger on it yet, but he wouldn't go this far just because he doesn't want people to move to Citradel. I think more like he just wants to win. Whether its for pride, ego or for some other vanity reason, I got no clue. But don't you think you can give him least one more chance.

Derek pleading desperately to us. I didn't want to budge from this. But his words got me good. He was right that David's never been this desperate to win. Its different when he fought against Nathan, Hives or Echo's. He had to risk his life fighting them. But he shouldn't have to do the same in this match. Maybe like Derek suggested, David got his own reason. Blake says, I understand Derek. I know what you mean, when I spoke with David earlier. He wasn't even sure he would go full out or fight this desperate to win. He then sighs and turns to me, so what now Vanessa. Shall we give one more chance to David if he wakes up.

Even if he asks me like this I can't decide. I never thought I would have to decide something like this here. Marina asks, lets give not give up Vanessa. David's struggled this far. Lets give him one more chance. You never know, he might wake up and give up anyway. She turns to Derek, you won't have a problem if David does that, right. Derek nods, absolutely. Its David's choice completely. If he gives up, I won't stop you anymore. I only ask to not let David chance of winning slip by. Even if its very slim.

I know he was right, but I still unsure. Blake say, we are at two and half minute mark according to M. At this point, I don't think David can even wake up. But what happens if he did. What happens if Charles also wakes up. How crazy would they have to be to continue fighting. Then I chided myself. I have no right to even think that given I myself also went far. Maybe not to the extent David has gone. Or maybe I am getting too much emotional. Its all David's fault. I am frustrated so much its maddening. Why can't he just let this go. What's he trying to prove anyways. I sigh after resolving my thoughts, okay. Fine. One more chance. That’s it. The moment David wakes up, I will be watching him like a hawk. If I get even a hint of something strange, I am pulling the plug on this. I don't care if you pull out another cop out.

They all agree with me. Matt says, that’s all well and all. But is David's even going to wake up ? If he doesn't, then the best case is that the match ends in a draw. Otherwise, if Charles wakes up, he wins. Only way David has a chance of wining is he wakes up in about, he peaks at the timer, two minutes now. Blake says, I would have never guessed the finals would be like this. Both our fighters are down. And anyone of them can win if just got back up. I don't know whether to be amazed or shocked by this. Marina says, how crazy it would be if they still continue the match, right. I scoff at her. Even though I agreed to wait for now, I highly doubt it will happen.

# Blake (Chapter 25)

Thursday, February 1, 2024 01:23

As the time ticks, the tense atmosphere only increases. The crowd was restless with some shouting at them to wake up. I turn to Derek, what do you think Kafar will do. Will he allow for Charles to lose like this. He responds, he won't have a say. You heard me earlier, right, whatever I decide he go along with that. I am not blindly following Kafar, you know. We just have an arrangement. Once our cities merge, I can't wait to change the management. Matt slaps his back, I knew it. You don't like Kafar too.

Derek responds, its not like that. We need Kafar in the management, there is no doubt in that. But I will finally be able to get out of our personnel arrangement. Matt nods, yeah, he is one hell of jerk of boss I bet. Marina says, just imagine his face if David wins. I wish I was there to see if that happens. Vanessa says, you might. Don't forget we are recording the entire stadium. That include that VIP room. Marina smirks at that, oh yeah. Totally forgot. That’s even more awesome. I get to play it on repeat. I couldn't help a small chuckle hearing that.

Derek says, I bet that would be really amusing. His expression harden a little, but in all seriousness, we have a minute and half for David to wake up and two minutes left for a draw. I know I asked to play this out, but its looking grim now. He looks at the tablet, Charles isn't faring well too. If he can't get up in the next two minutes, this match is officially a draw. Marina asks, ah just throwing out a question here. If this does end in a draw, what happens to our cities. We still merge or not. We going for the person who delt the most damages. Or the person who has less injury. Or are we going to have another match or even the whole tournament. Like what's the rule we made for the finals.

I shrug, good question. I don't think we made any rule for this. We never thought the finals would be so evenly matched. Derek nods, Kafar didn't even thought for a second that Charles would be defeated. Vanessa asks, so we have to figure out something else. Matt exclaims, what a pain. I know I lost, but I don't want to fight again in front of everyone. Come on David, wake the hell up, dude. Marina says, one minute left. I don't understand this brain stuff. M, just tell us if David is going to wake up or not.

M responds, brain activity is subsiding slowly now. Chances of boss waking up is less than ten percent. Marina clicks her mouth, seriously. Come on David. Vanessa asks, look David is too tired. He never struggled this long with anyone else before. I not saying I want David to lose the match, but I just hope he doesn't wake up for his own sake. I could understand her concern well. If it weren't for Derek, she would be already running and get David treated immediately.

30 seconds left. I kept thinking that David would wake up. But maybe is too exhausted to fight now. To be honest, it was just our wishful thinking that David can still win at this point. Even if gets up, Charles has another minute. Even if doesn't heal immediately, Charles is way too strong for David. I don't know what kind of power David is hiding, but what could he do when he probably won't be able to move properly. The five of us keep our eyes fixed on the timer, now down to 10 seconds now.

We were anxious now. In a few seconds, we would have no choice but to make David forfeit. The countdown hits zero, and nothing changes. David is still unconscious. Marina says, dammit. This sucks. Matt stomps with his leg, oh come on. Derek doesn't say anything. I let out a sigh, well, that it then. I turn to Vanessa. She was mostly relieved than dismayed. Given her priority for David's safety, that is not surprising. She turns to David's lying on the ground.

She says walking into the barrier, look, I am not happy about this. I didn't want for David to lose like this. Lets just get this over with. Maybe things would have been different if David fought…, suddenly a loud noise around us. M says, boss's neural activity is spiking. He is stirring and waking up. Marina screams, hell yeah. David's' back. I let out a shout, surprised on my own emotion. Derek chuckles a little, I really thought he was done. Matt raises his arms up in air overjoyed, oya. He's back baby.

Vanessa's reaction was the best one. She places her palm on her forehead and sighs loudly. Then mumbles, I can't even deal with this. He is just a pain…she trails off. She bows her head a little frustrated, but I could tell she was laughing a little too. She walks back to us and raises her head. A little bit of her smile remained, fine. He woke up. But I am telling you, if David's going to fight again, he better not do be reckless again. I nod excited, agreed. I then turn to Charles. What about Charles, is his Kuret still blocked.

Derek takes a look into his tablet. A moment later he waves his hand in air, yeah. The best I can see, he is still not healing fast. Marina, you could probably can figure it out better. Marina says, way ahead of you. She had already started casting a charm similar to what she did earlier in the room. A moment later Charles figure conjured up. She says, the Kuret on him is running at half strength like last time. She takes a moment to analyze further, yeah, all his Kuret is going towards his wounds at half capacity. But unlike last time, he has too many wounds. He Kuret should be depleting faster, but he is somehow keeping himself just stable.

Matt scoffs, David isn't the only one not giving up huh. Have to admit, Charles is just as determined as David. Marina says, yeah. But I don't know how long he can keep this up. Suddenly the crowd let out a roar of cheer that vibrated from the entire stadium. I turned to the arena. David got up. He was covered in dirt and blood. Small lines of blood run on his face. There was blood around his stomach too. But since he was able to stand, even if he was leaning forward a little, he must be feeling okay.

Once he got his bearing and stood properly, he looks around frantically around until he spots Charles. After a few seconds, he catches our presence. We all waved him back. Matt screams, hey, shake it off. Marina shouts, get your ass up and win this already. Marina always got a way of words. I call on my Kuret. I use my Kuret to write just one word in the air. Win. I couldn't see his face from here, but that got to cheer him up. Derek smiles, but chose not to say anything. Probably wary of Kafar a little. Vanessa on the other hand went with a different response.

She shouts, you're crazy. I cracked up a hearing that. She is way too honest with her feelings. Others also got a good laugh hearing that. I don't know if David heard us, especially with the crowd going nuts behind us. David takes some time and then responds in a way which is simple and yet electrifying. He raised both his arms up and give us the two thumps up. The crowd goes wild once again seeing this. A never before atmosphere erupted among the crowd. People started to clap and a lot of them turned on their Kuret in excitement. Marina whistles, whoa. A wave a excitement has completely eclipsed the previous gloomy atmosphere.

Vanessa turns to us, M, is he okay to continue. M responds, with boss expect the unexpected. His vitals are still weak. However, its just strong enough for me to switch back to critical orange mode now. I would strongly suggest to be alert every second. The four of us, save Vanessa, felt relief hearing that. Vanessa was visibly frustrated. But after moment she couldn't help a smile, she says, typical David. How in the hell he is going to fight Charles in that state.

Matt says, that's if Charles makes a come back. For all we know, he is going to revert back any second. I ask Marina, any change on Charles. She shook her head, nothing. Still the same. At best it’s coin toss. If his Kuret stabilizes before he succumbs to his wound and before the clock runs out, he will make a recovery. Otherwise, he will revert back and lose. Derek, I hope you are ready with treating Charles. Derek nods, yeah. Since his body gets weak after matches anyways, so we have stand by medics dedicated for him. But I don't think they expected him to be injured this much. I messaged them a while back to be prepare for everything. So we are good to treat Charles.

I ask M, I hope it’s the same for David. M responds, boss current physical vitals are being considered every second. I am correcting his needed treatment in real time. All the injures are within the limits of the cryo bath. Vanessa says, that’s good to hear. We might just need it now. I think so too. I look at David, he was walking slowly towards a large boulder nearby. He slumped on the ground beside it, supporting his back on the large piece of rock. He brings one knee up and takes a resting posture.

Derek says, yeah. I would have done the same. Just wait out for now. Considering David's injuries, he probably would be more tired If he walked all the way to Charles and try to attack. Matt says, less than a minute left. Any chance of Charles waking up now. Marina shrugs, lets wait till the last second. The last time he got back his Kuret, it was within seconds. Vanessa says, come on. Don't jinx it. Marina responds, believe me, I want Charles not to get back up. I am just telling you what I know.

For the second time, we were conscious of another countdown. But this one we wanted it to go faster. Charles is wriggling on the ground, but he couldn't get up. Just a little more. 20 seconds. A wave of excitement flowed in the crowd with the countdown so close. 10 seconds, we were focused on Marina's charm. Charles Kuret was still low. Just when the countdown hit zero, Charles is still lying on the ground. Yeah, I waved my fist in air with excitement. Matt was jumping in joy, hot damn. The entire stadium erupts in frenzy. People are howling and shouting at the top of their voices.

Marina lets go of the Charm and shouts in enjoyment, booya. David won. Even Vanessa couldn't stop her excitement, bastard actually did it. He won against a freaking Heraknus alpha. Derek claps his hands while smiling, I can't believe Charles lost. Marina screams, you better believe it. Vanessa says, come on. Lets go get David. I nod my head with zeal, yeah. We all started to walk inside the dome. I looked at David. I can't see his face from here, I bet he is must be ecstatic. He was still sitting on the ground. Must be totally exhausted. Suddenly, there was a continuous pinging notifications coming from us. Then the same sound slowly started come from the crowd.

I turned back confused, What's going on. Derek chuckles while saying, don't know. Maybe the announcement of the winner I guess. Let me check. He looks at the tablet. Vanessa was already ahead me walking. She was more worried about David than the message. A moment later Derek stops laughing and angrily said, What. His sudden change in tone made us look at him. Vanessa stops in her steps and turns back, what the hold up. Derek's expression showed utter shock now.

I turned to look at the tablet. There was a message written, As per the rule, since one fighter is down, they will be given 5 minutes to get back. Unless the fighter is able to resume in this time limit, he will be disqualified and the victory goes to the person left standing. My joy crashed and burned after reading. What is this, I ask Derek. Others got worried and walked to us. The crowd also was also slowly quieting down. Derek then raised his head and closed his eyes dismayed, Kafar, he said.

Marina asks, wait. What's going on. She and Matt then read the message. Marina yells, this is bullshit. What's going on. Matt asks, what's with this. What in the actually hell. Vanessa's face darked hearing us, what's going on. What's does it say. Derek opens his eyes looking dejected, we had a rule that if one fighter goes down, but not completely, then he or she has 5 minutes to get resume fighting or get disqualified. Vanessa confused asked, yeah, didn't we just have the countdown.

Derek speaks with a stern voice, no. Technically that countdown was for a draw. Now its for a fighter disabled situation. Vanessa rebukes, what. That doesn't makes sense. Isn't the two same. Derek shook his head slowly, as I said, technically no. It’s a very clever loophole. Blake spats, it's a very scummy loophole. I grit my teeth with anger. Marina and Matt throw their arms around in frustration. Marina says, this is ridiculous. So not only did Charles got the 5 minutes, gets this 5 minutes to get his Kuret back. Matt yells, man this is absolute bull. We gotta stop this. David won. He can't do this.

I turned to Vanessa, who didn't say anything. She was pissed. I mean, like really pissed. She wasn't blinking and her eyes were throwing daggers at certain someone in the VIP room. I thought what to do now. Should we pull out David from this or let it continue. I couldn't decided what's the right thing to do. While technically the rule made sense, it was just nothing but a technicality. It clearly showed there was a bias against David here. Soon small people within the crowd began wooing, while others instead cheered. A mixed reaction to this announcement. Kafar is playing a very dangerous game here. He might be technically correct, but he is not showing impartiality. Would he show a similar consideration if Charles had got up before David did. We have Derek here, maybe he could have thought of it. But it would have to go through Kafar still, since he was the manager of the tournament. I shook my head disregarding my thought. There's no point in thinking about that.

I hesitantly ask Marina, what are the chances that Charles doesn't gets his Kuret in the next 5 minutes. She was cursing at the VIP room from here, clearly to Kafar, then turns to me. She sighs and answers, I don't know. But I highly doubt he will remain like this forever. I honestly don't think if David has enough luck for another turn. Matt kicks dirt from his foot in fury, come on. How much of this bullshit we should tolerate guys. First Charles existence was hidden from us, then he got away with a clear violation of the match rules and now this. Isn't this a match a little to much stacked against David.

Everyone were sure to think the same. However, our feelings weren't going to change the rules. If even they were twisted in ones favor. Behind us two people were walking to us from the arena gate. I could hear one of them swearing out loud as they approached. It was Jess and Cass. Cass is shouting on top of her lungs, let me go back now. I need to punch that arrogant little sorry of a man. Jess held Cass arms while walking, almost dragging Cass with her as they walk. Jess sighs, for the love of god. Calm down. You might kill him without knowing. Just forget it.

Matt turned around and asked, what's going on. He walked towards Cass who was throwing a fit. Jess says annoyed, control your girlfriend. Cass shouts back, let go. I don't need to be manhandled. She frees her arm from Jess. Jess makes a pleading expression with her face at Matt. A moment later Matt walks and grabs Cass's hand. He says, Mel, I think I have an idea what's going on. Try to get a hold of yourself. No matter how much we want to kick the day lights out of him, we cannot. Cass tried to pull her arm away, but Matt held firmly. She barks, shut up. Cass asked me to kill him. Matt eyes widen, really. I don't believe that. Not the kill part, but that she asked you for it. Mel grunted and then said, ah fine. She didn't ask anything. But she did call on me, so it meant she wanted me to do it.

Matt sighs and says a little forcefully, please don't make things more complicated. The situations already chaotic enough. Cass looks around to us. Her anger didn't quell down completely, but she stopped her tantrum a little bit. Matt let goes her arm. Cass puts her arms in a cross while muttering in low tone. I turn to Jess, thanks for helping with Cass. Jess nods, yeah, to be honest the room had become a little too much for me as well. I thought it would be best if we both come to you guys. You know, we have the team David here after all. She tilts her head towards Derek, except you of course.

We were silent for few seconds. In the last couple of minutes, our emotions have been a roller coaster ride. Marina says, we have 4 minutes now. She had once again casted Charles Kuret figure. She continues, so far no change in his Kuret. Matt asks, dammit. Well on the plus side, David's gotten time to recover. Vanessa finally breaks her silence, I can't take it anymore. Looks like she was in her thoughts about something. She just turned her back to us and starting to walk again to the barrier door. Vanessa, I ask, where are you going. She didn't stop, while answering with a cold voice, where do you think I am going. I am going to tell David about this and stop this match. He already won. This bullshit. I don't care if this within rules or not. Kafar had enough time to send that message after David woke up, but he sent it only after the countdown was over. You know what that means.

Derek spoke, I was thinking the same. He should have started the next countdown immediately when David woke up. But by waiting till the end, he gave at least a minute extra. In a situation like this, even a single minute might be enough to change the outcome. He shook his head with a little disappointment, I know Kafar's can be a little haughty, but never this devious. I didn't even realize that until Derek pointed out. Shit. How low Kafar's willing to go for Charles. Derek wasn't even trying to stop Vanessa unlike the other times. Does that mean he also thought we should end this match.

Cass scoffs, what are you saying. Kafar didn't do this. Yeah, he was the one who sent that message, but it was your boyfriend's idea, Vanessa. Vanessa stops walking and turns to her, what. Say that again. Cass shrugs, what. My eyes witch at this, wait, is that right. I ask Jess. She nods, just at the 30 seconds mark, Ned got a text message from someone and told Kafar about the rule. He said the rules didn't tell that one supersedes the other, so there's no problem having two countdowns like that. Well, not morally at least. Kafar had no idea about it until then. He was panicking so much and when he heard Ned's idea, he practically jumped out of his seat and sent out the message without checking with other admins first.

I was now even more angry. I don't know if Ned did it intentionally or not, but I am little shocked to see him go this far. I turn to Vanessa. In fact everybody's gaze were at her. Vanessa's was infuriated hearing this. Her hands turns turn to fist. Her anger is clearly now redirected to Ned. I don't know what's going on between them, but this clearly isn't helping. I spoke, Vanessa. Don't do it. Whatever you are thinking, just don't. No one is denying this is a terrible and a dirty tactics. But you agreed to give David a chance if Charles wakes up. So nothing has changed. We just have to wait another 3 minutes.

Vanessa didn't agree, but she didn't disagree also. I think she is more angry towards Ned right now than worrying about David. I'll taking anything to keep her from doing anything rash like stopping the match. Marina says, hey guys, what about David. Shouldn't we till him about this. Derek suddenly exclaims, shit. I was so focused this, I totally forgot about informing this to David. Everyone turns to the stadium. He was now standing up, leaning against the rock on his back.

I say to others, I got this one. I call on my Kuret. My hands covers with Kuret. I open my palm and make the Kuret to create words in the air. I wanted to keep it short to avoid wasting time, so the I drew the words - 3 min. Few seconds later David saw my message. Then I began preparing to change the Kuret to form other words. Then I saw David using his Kuret. I stopped for the moment to see what he was doing. He had is Kuret wrapped on his arm, however, only till his elbow. It’s was just the Kuret flames initially. Then it changed to the wild Kuret. Then finally, the latest form of his transformation happened.

What's he thinking. If he is still willing to fight, he should wait until Charles gets up. He should save his strength as much as possible. Vanessa breaking out of her thoughts said, he really is planning to continue this. Why is he not forfeiting. If Charles heals, he can't fight properly. I wanted to confirm David was prepared for this. In fact, I think everyone of Team David wanted to know it. I changed the message I was going to write and instead ask, sure with a question mark.

David either didn't see my question or he ignored it. He was now walking, albeit slowly towards the other side of Charles. He walks for some time and then halts near the edge of the barrier. He turns his back to the barrier and raises one arm up. The Kuret on his arm begins to flow out of him. They slowly spread out and began forming words. He wrote in our language. A few seconds later the crowd slowly begins to yell in excitement. I am surprised to see him this confident even in such a situation.

Vanessa asks under the noise of the crowd, what did he write. Marina says with a smile, he wrote a declaration of war in our language. To be exact, it means to will win no matter what thrown at him. It's like a popular motto from my and David's nation. A moment later she her smile turns a little awkward and says, ah, I mean I told him about this a while back. I didn't think he remembered it. Nice save Marina. She almost let it slip that he remembers Medrine.

Derek bluntly spoke, of course. David already figured it out. He probably this would turn like this even before it happened. Just think about it. He saw the crowd and us when then clock went zero. Yet he didn't show any excitement. No one, not even David, will be this humble when they win against a Heraknus alpha. He then turns to me, you know what that means if I am right. I take a moment to consider and then it hit me, he was prepared all this time to not forfeit the match. Derek nods agreeing with me.

While David's determination has always been rock steady, this match had thrown too many hurdles at him. Its beyond my imagine how he can keep it together even when the odds are against him. Vanessa says with a stern voice, this doesn't change anything. Even if David's ready to fight, lets stick to our previous agreement. We will stop the match when it becomes too dangerous. I answer, yeah. I totally agree with you. If Charles gets up, we should all be ready to step in anytime. I turn to Marina, we have about 2 minutes now. Is Charles close to getting his Kuret back.

Marina shook her head, it's not back. She focused a little more towards her charm, I learned what I need to keep an eye on from the last time when his Kuret starting coming back. At the moment I can't sense that. Matt says, so we still have a chance he won't get up, right. Marina couldn't answer that. Cass shouts, well someone believes this match isn't over just yet. Cass shook her towards David. Our gazes met David. He is already preparing for the battle.

He had his arms outstretched away in opposite direction. A layer of Kuret flows from his arm. The Kuret above him turns into a large round sphere. Then he slowly brings his arms closer, while the Kuret above begins rotating. My eyes immediately widen at those movements of arm. Those are the similar ones he tried to do in our match and earlier against Charles. Is he finally going to reveal it now. The Kuret above him suddenly starts to spin. Then it begins to collapse in size.

The Kuret around him suddenly turns to a storm. The Kuret from above merged into below and now there is a mini storm in front of him. The storm begins to rotate even faster now. The Kuret sparks we had seen earlier begins to come off the storm. The storm ever so slowly continues to shrink in size. Matt shouts, I know I will sound like a broken record, what the hell is this now. I take a moment and reply, this is it. I am certain of it. This is the power he has been hiding till now.

Everyone were surprised at my answer. Jess asks, this the one you mentioned earlier. Have you seen it before. I shook my head, no. I only recognize those specific movement of his hands. This is my first time seeing it in action. Vanessa asks, its about damn time. Why can't he didn't this do earlier. She takes a pause and then asks, a better question, why is he even doing it. Charles isn't ready to fight yet. I don't know. There were times when he could have done used it. Why only now.

Derek snaps his finger, time. He needed time to prepare. His answer caught our attention. He continuous, yeah. That’s it. That’s the only thing that makes sense why he waited this long. Whatever he is planning must take a shit load of time. Earlier I said David decided to wait out the countdown. I am half right. He was using the time to rest as well. At least whatever he could get from these mere minutes. And once he was ready, he does this. Derek made sense. But then another question came to mind.

The same question Vanessa asks a little irritated, how would David know he will be fighting Charles. We got what, a minute left, right ? She raises her eyes to Matt for confirmation. Matt nods and raises a single index finger. Vanessa continuous, it doesn't makes sense. Derek agrees, yeah. I don't understand that. Maybe David is just planning for a worst case. Or Maybe he can see something with his Synesthesia that we cannot see, something even Marina can't sense.

It made sense. David never does things recklessly. Well lately in the match, he had been in the beginning a little. But when given ample time, he always comes up with the best path. Even with David's declaration of war, it didn't stop use from feeling anxious. We were actually even more nervous at the 40 second mark. We kept our eyes glued to Marina's charm. So far nothing changed. Maybe all this worry was for naught and Charles wouldn't get his Kuret back.

However, reality is a bitch. At the 30 second mark, Marina yells, shucks. You have got to be shitting me. She spats her words out. Everyone steps closer to Marina. She says, I don't know how. But god damn, David might be a prophet for this one. Charles Kuret is coming back to him. Those were not the words we dreaded to hear. Everyone showed visible expression of distraught. Even Derek, on Charles side looked a disappointed. Vanessa turned her gaze to the arena in silence. Soon Charles will get back up and David would have to fight him again. So much for wishing that this would end without any more danger.

# David (Chapter 26)

Monday, February 5, 2024 16:53

I am running. My feet hurts, my breathing is rampant and I feel my face burning from all the fires. I couldn't figure out where I am or where I am running to. But my body is too heavy to move. I am able to slowly recognize my surroundings. I see building half broken and burning. People lying on the streets and bleeding. Some were stuck inside the buildings that were falling apart. The red sky is covered with smoke and dust. I could hear ships flying above me in the sky being chased by other ships. The ship in pursuit launches a beam of blue energy that hits the ship running away. The ship catches fire on its wings and falls out of the sky. The ship descends in my direction. My breathing becomes more erratic when I see the ship falling on top of me.

I stop and turned back to run in the opposite direction. I tried looking around to find safely, but there is none. All the underground passages have collapsed and the buildings are falling apart on itself. Then the slow fear of my imminent death swept over me like never before. The ship crashes to the edge of the buildings and few of its body gets torn out in pieces. The pieces burned and were now falling even faster. I kept pushing my legs forward even when my bare feet were bleeding. I am never going to escape from the shadow of the pieces of building and the ship forming one me. I closed my eyes in shock and panic. I recalled thinking, this is where I will die. The shock of my death made me lose consciousness. My vision is blurry and my ears stops working. Just when I am about to be crushed by the falling ship debris, I hear someone's voice. I can't recognize who it is, but something felt familiar. The mysterious voice said, finally found you. My mind went hazy next.

Then suddenly I am being carried by someone. I felt my body shake as the person held me in the arms. My vision clears and I could see the face. I heard my own weak voice, Hansen. He looks down on me and replies, good, you are awake. I was worried you wouldn't. But thankfully you got treated before you lost too much blood. I roll my eyes to my legs. Just below my knee, there is a cloth wrapped around it. It was completely bloodied, but it stopped from more blood loss. I manage other words, what happened. Where am I.

He responds, you were in Langton. Someone found you and brought you to us just in time. I turn my head around to see people running around us. They were carrying other kids with this. Some carried on their arms, others used their Kurets to haul them as they ran. We were in a forest. The trees were burning and the path were covered in ashes. I turn my face to where Hansen is running to. There is a ship in front of this. I know this ship. I have seen it before. Hansen says, its almost a miracle you are here. This is the dantlement base hidden in Tangela empire. I can't believe he actually managed to bring you here in time.

My headache is so worse I couldn't make sense out the things happen. Who is Hansen talking about. Why am I on the opposite side of the planet. I felt something on my arm. I lift my arms up. It hurt when I moved. My whole body is so heavy I feel I am dying. I saw something on my elbow. It's some kind of bracelet. It was a purple colored stone shaped ornament. It had some words edged on it which I couldn't read as my shook from the running. I have never seen this before. How did I get it. I ask Hansen meekly, who. He doesn't reply me.

Suddenly we clear out of the forest clearing. The ship is in full view. It was massive and there is large entrance on the side. Others quickly hurried inside with the kids. I couldn't see who all were here, but some faces were familiar. Hansen halts near the entrance and then puts me down on the ground. My body lumps helplessly on the cold ashes, leaves and broken branches on the ground. Hansen says, this is as far I go. I grown and face to him, what. I couldn't see Hanses face completely. It's so hazy that I began feeling frustrated on why I can't remember it.

He says, you don't have to worry about me anymore. I knew from the beginning that this was my last job, to get you to this ship. I have fulfilled my promise. What promise, I wanted to ask. But my throat is paining. Hansen says, in time you will understand this. You once asked me how I know you will become strong, it's because I have seen your future. I never believed in fate. But now I know that you have a destiny to fulfill. You just have to trust me. Among all the shadows, no, all of Medrones, you have the greatest potential. I have witnessed it with my own eyes. I don't know when or how, you will find your path.

What's he walking about. I don't understand a word of what he is saying. I am the weakest of all the Medrones. I can't even use any Kuret. Behind him, another person approaches. I know him. I take some time to find his name. Its Brandon. The only senior who has helped me the most, guiding me throughout the college. He stops running when he sees us, you made it Hansen. He then turns to me. His face is also blurred out. Why can't I remember them properly. He says, you are here too. I can't believe this. He actually rescued you.

I ask with a cough, who. Brandon says, don't you know, its…Hansen cuts him off, don't. Its better if he doesn't know. You understand what he explained to you right. Brandon replies, he did. But I thought that…Hansen stop his, whatever happens is up to this young Medrone now. We shouldn't influence his path anymore than it already has been. A moment later Brandon says, okay. I don't understand most of it, but I know the stakes. He turns to me, Ryzen, I know this must be confusing for you. But just know that you are important. We can't tell you how we know. But know that you are.

I am in complete loss. What are they talking about. All my life I have been a loser until I became shadows, and that is only due to my intellect. Suddenly a forest behind them erupts in fire. The ground shook with the explosion. With my weak body lying on the ground, I felt the tremors all over me. Hansen says, they are close. They need to leave now. I croak, leave. Where. Hansen shouts, to Earth. This ship is going to take few people including you ahead. My head is throbbing even more when I heard the name Earth. My life's goal. But this is not how it's supposed to happen.

The forest erupts with another explosion. Brandon says, shit. They are getting closer. Hansen, tell the crew to take off. Hansen replies, what about your siblings. His voice turns grim, I couldn't find John. He got separated from Catherine before they arrived. I will look for him, but Catherine will have to take Johns place for now. Hansen says, okay. I believe all the kids are here. I'll inform the crew. Hansen is getting out of my view. I blurt out some blood calling his name to make him stop. He turns to me, Ryzen, remember what I said earlier. You are the best student I have had. You are now far more important than me. Don't forgot all the things I have taught you. This won't be easy for you. You'll be in lot of pain, you'll may even go mad, but then you will become strong.

With those cryptic partying words, he left us. I tried to move my arms and get up. I wanted to stop him. But my own weight was giving me pain. Brandon says, don't get up. You lost a lot of blood. I'll also need to leave Ryzen. I need to find my brother. He took my arms and carried me by my shoulders. My voice is gone at this point. I am so much in pain. I kept trying to call Hansen back in my mind. But I couldn't from any words with my mouth. Ryzen, Brandon asks, I need a favor from you. Its an unreasonable ask, but please take care of Catherine for me. If don't find John and I don't make it, she will be all alone. We have spoiled her rotten a bit too much. He makes a small laugh, she is not the strongest, but she has the biggest heart of us. I don't want to lose that part of herself. I can't imagine how much pain she will be. But I will be relieved if I know you are there for her.

I want to say no. Brandon can board the ship with his sister. Why can't he come with me. Why can't Hansen come with me. Why are they saying goodbye like this. No words came from my mouth. I couldn't even move my head anymore. Brandon continues, Just promise me you will do whatever you can to protect her. Please do it for me. I was too torn inside. His heartfelt request made me want to hide away. But I couldn't run away. This might be the last time we see each other. I blinked my eyes. He says, thanks you. I didn't want to put this on you, but you are the only one who could do it. Like Hansen said, you will need to get stronger. Not for Catherine. But for yourself too. Hansen is right you know. I don't know when, but you will become the biggest weapon against Hive.

I still don't understand them. Why are they choosing me. He carries me through the door. Behind him I heard my name being called out. Brandon turned us around just before we head inside. A person was running at us. She is carrying a small black box in one hand. Once got closer I could recognize the voice. It's Zakerine. My heart beats faster realizing she was safe. But before she could reach us the ground around us erupted when a bean of energy hit us. The whole ship vibrated and we fall off the door.

My mind went hazy again. All I feel is confusion, pain and more frustration on why I am not able to remember more. Remember? Is this a memory. Yes. This is a dream. I am dreaming right now. I heard Zakerine calling me in darkness. Wake up, she screams. I felt her warm hands on my face. She keeps calling my name and all I could see is darkness. She screams, wake up. You can't die. You have to get up right now. Her screams keeps me barely conscious. I don't want to lose her. I get all the courage I could muster and try to get out of this darkness. Her voice gives me the power I need. She screams one last time, wake the hell up.

At that moment, my eyes flutter trying to open. I feel cold on my cheeks. Then a moment later, my whole body felt cold. Where am I ? For few moments, I am caught up in the nightmare. I need to find Zakerine. She needs me. I need her. Then it all came crashing down when I realized what is going on. It's all a dream. No, a memory and nightmare. I can't save her. I can't save Hansen or Brandon, they are already dead. I felt brief but sudden anger swell in me. And then regret. I should have made her come with me. Then I calm down a moment later. I have already felt the pain of losing them already a year ago when my memories returned.

I gather myself before I completely get lost in my memories. The intense nightmare had caused me to sweat. That's the cold I am feeling. But where am I. What was I doing. My hearing is hazy. But I can see lights in front of me. Different colored lights. Just then, my eyes slowly open up. The world was turned on its side. I saw the sky on the right and ground on left. My breathing blows a little dirt away. Like a bolt of lightening hitting me suddenly everything made sense. I am in the middle of a match. I am fighting Charles. Did I also dream me flying in the sky.

No, that's real. I gather my strength and begin moving my body. I am lying on my stomach. Holy shit. I am completely awake. I recalled all the events that happened. Did I lost consciousness in the middle of a fight. I close my eyes and look for Charles glimmers. I could see his glimmer. He is farther away from me and not moving. What happened. How long was I out for. I don't understand. Why am I still here. I was knocked out, I should have lost the match already. Why am I waking up in the arena.

I focus on Charles brown glimmer, it's weak. Looks like my last attack did a big number on him. I see glimmers of his Kuret coming off him and healing him. Shit. Even after all that, he still isn't down. Dammit. This is too much. I should just quit the match already. I am here lying on ground, completely drained while Charles is healing himself. What chance do I have. Then it occurred to me, why isn't he attacking me. He could have ignored healing himself and just attacked me.

Something doesn't make sense. I slowly moved my body. My body felt like a brick, so heavy with sourness. It took me few seconds to roll over and lie on my back. My chest and stomach feels a lighter after being crushed underneath. My breathing is a little erratic, but considerably less constricted. My eyes flew open. I took a moment to recall the nightmare I just had. I have been getting pieces of my memories of the last day of Medrine back ever since I got my memories. I never full recalled the specific emotions or the details of the conversation. Until now. I only remembered the broader stokes of that time. Hansen saving me, Brandon carrying me and Zakerine giving me that box containing my only inheritance before they all died.

I could now remember the conversations just before we left Medrine. What in world were they taking about. I think I remember Hansen talking about destiny. Did he really said that. Hansen is the smartest I know apart from Zakerine. And we both shared the many similar sentiments. We never believed fate or destiny are real. Only coincidence and luck are real. For him to ignore logic and suddenly believe it doesn't makes sense. What did he know about me did he know that made him say that. Did he knew I had Kuret. Did he knew I was actually born on Earth. Did he knew my body would get stronger and even grant me special abilities. No. I didn't knew those things about myself until these past few years on Earth.

Even Brandon spoke I would become stronger. What did the previous generation of the shadows knew about my future. What's even crazier is that some of its becoming true. On Medrine I was undoubtedly the weakest Medrone. At least in terms of combat. But look at me right now. I am somehow at the level of some very incredible people. If my past self could see me now, he would just laugh it off like pure coincidence. But is it really. I suddenly can't believe in fate. But I believe they had faith in me, even when I didn't. While I didn't plan or want to become stronger, I have unconsciously been guided by their words. Even if I didn't remember it, my brain has been secretly using the emotions of that day to keep me going all this time. Is that why wanted this so badly. Because I owe them my life and get stronger for their sacrifice. Maybe. Maybe something else. But its definitely part of the reason. I want to be the strongest Medrone. A new emotion is rising in me. The need to become the best no matter happens. I won't stop. I don't think I can stop.

I tried to recall the conversation with Zakerine, but the memories are still hazy. I know we spoke more than what I remember. Maybe in time I will remember them too. I feel I am on the cusp of understand all my baggage. My PTSD and night terrors is tied to the last day on Medrine. Maybe recovering all the memories of that day is what will finally cure me. For now, I need to bring my focus to the match. Both Charles and I are still inside the arena. No one has won yet. I still have a chance.

I open my eyes. My body is too tired. I am covered in bruises and bleeding a bit. If I was in worse condition, then M would have definitely told Marina. I already programmed M to tell others to forcibly make me quit if I get more injuries than acceptable. I am awake now, M, would have detected that. And yet I don't see any signal from Marina. Unexpectedly, I smile a little. This means even with my current injuries, I can still fight a bit more. Then I starting to laugh. I can't believe I still have chance to win when I was knocked out cold. What are the chances of that.

But nothing will happen if keep lying here. I struggle a little getting up. But with deep breathing, I kept pushing oxygen in my blood and muscles. I carefully get up hoping to avoid any further injury with any cracked bone. I am so relieved to know that fall didn't broke any bone in my body. Holy god. I flew up so high, managed to attack Charles and somehow avoided getting my bones crushed. This is no luck. My new transformed Kuret protected me. That is incredible. This opens a whole new avenue for me. That Kuret form is the badass. And very difficult to control as well. All the movement caused by my Kuret sprained my body. It will probably take some intense training to learn it properly.

Once I got up I looked over to Charles. He is lying on ground, writhing in pain. I could red, yellow and blue Kurets coming off him even from here. One of his leg is mangled in odd shake. The other one is bleeding. His face and abdomen also is bleeding. I couldn't believe I did that. I even managed to wound him with the spikes when he kicked me. I started to laugh even more. Not because of the wounds, but because I finally realized why he is lying down. Now that I have a clear head, I can see the Kuret glimmers off him. Its not just weaker, its shrinking and fluctuating. He is having another Kuret blackout. Now this is luck. We knocked each other out. And since the match is still going on, I woke before M's red mode ended and the match five minute countdown.

All this time I have ignoring crowd in the stadium. But now that I am not focused on attacking or defending, I could see the glimmers of the Medrones coming off. My ears were filled with the crowds intense shouting. I couldn't tell from this far if they were cheering for me or Charles. But considering the situation, it had to be for me. I regained my confidence now. Then I caught glimmers of five recognizable individuals. They were standing near the barrier edge. There were two holes made.

I understood immediately. Marina made preparations to intervene if things went sideways. Actually things had already went off the rails already way earlier. I freaking flew for the first time in my life. I am sure they would have stopped the match seeing me fall with such less control. I can see its Vanessa, Blake, Derek and Matt. The way they stood, I could glean their plan. Vanessa and Matt would rescue or stop me while the other two were on Charles duty. Derek and Blake there made sense why the match hasn't ended yet. Especially Derek, he has a cool head and uses good judgement. They are why the other three haven't ended the match.

Suddenly all of them beginning waving at me. They were shouting something at me. Why are they shouting like that, I can't hear them at all. But seeing them so excited made me feel better. Blake even wrote win with his Kuret. My ego took a big boast seeing that. Even Vanessa was shouting with that looked it could be a cheer. But I am not convinced. Knowing her, and all the risky decisions I been taking, she is more likely reproaching me. Marina and Matt were visibly the most excited to see me.

I felt the urge to respond to their enthusiasm. Maybe this would answer the best how I am feeling right now. I raised two thumps up in the air. The crowd goes wild once again. And all five glimmers coming off them become a little stronger. Well that definitely made my day a little better. Then I turn back to Charles. Well, lets see figure out what's happening with the match. Since the countdown started, if Charles doesn't get up when time runs out, I win. But his Kuret blackout has been going for long now. I still don't know how long I was knocked out for. Maybe there's only 2 minutes left. Or even 5 seconds. Is this how I win. I contemplate about it a little. While I want to beat Charles fairly with my new found confidence, it wouldn't matter if he doesn't get back up. A wins a still win though. We can always fight another time.

But I something kept nagging me. I don't think some people want the match to end like this. Especially the ones behind the scenes meddling in my life and the tournament. Whoever spiked Marina and Blakes drinks earlier are still a mystery. But the intention is clear, control the flow of the matches. I don't think its Kafar. His personality might come out as a rude and annoying. But he wouldn't do something that drastic. Someone is behind him or controlling him. Whoever is supporting Kafar, they must have similar interests aligned. I have been suspicions why they would resort to such lengths to drop Blake and Marina out of the game like that.

I didn't had the answer then. But now, I think I do. The final ultimate champion of Citradel is a Heraknus alpha. Whoever is behind this wanted to make sure Marina and Blakes to drop out because they are probably the only people among all the Medrones alive powerful enough to possibly defeat Charles. It makes perfect sense now. Even if Charles is from a mythical bloodline, Blake and Marina are pretty powerful themselves. A dual Kuret true alpha with overdrive. And a prodigy caster alpha with overdrive. They didn't want these two compete against Charles. There is conspiracy going on here.

I need to figure this out immediately. But I also need to rest for the moment. If I am wrong about it, there is a chance I would win without doing anything. I have time, at least until the current countdown ends. I turn eyes around to look for a good place to rest. There is a large boulder nearby. It might the one Charles had attacked early in the match. I take small movements and walk over that area. Once I reach, I lean my back against it and slip down on ground. I pull one knee up and keep my hand on it. I close my eyes and lay back my head along the rock. This is no way comfortable, but it is sufficient. I don't know how much time I have. Every second of rest my body gets is crucial.

I take a deep dive into my thoughts to confirm this theory. If Marina had lost, Vanessa would have advanced. Would they had poisoned Blake even if he was fighting Vanessa. I don't can't be sure of that completely, however, the chances are high. Marina was poisoned because she was a potential finalist. It makes sense Blake would have been poisoned too since he was too a potential finalist. So regardless of whether Vanessa or Marina won, Blake was always supposed to get poisoned. But he wasn't when he fought against Marina. It could only mean one thing, they didn't care who won with its Marina or Blake. Even if they poisoned one of them, they are both potential dangers to Charles. That has to be the reason they weren't targeted then. They would just target the one who goes to the semi-finals. Which is what happened.

The entire plot is slowly sense to me now. Derek or I weren't spiked for our match. So again, they didn't care who won. If Derek had won he would be fighting against Blake or Vanessa or Marina. They wanted Marina and Blake to lose before semi final. Then Vanessa would become the one of the finalist among the three. And the other one would be me or Derek. What would have happened in a match between Derek and Vanessa. I don't want to belittle them. If Derek won against Vanessa, then the whole tournament is moot anyways. Derek already said he wasn't strongest in Citradel, so even if the finals happened, Derek looses and we all move to Citradel. Lets suppose Charles didn't want to fight or forfeits the match against Derek, the result is the same, we all move to Citradel.

Then what about a match between me and Vanessa. Honestly, I am not sure who would win. I might be a little biased, but I do have my ace against Vanessa. Apart from Derek, her Kuret is the best advantage over my Kuret. So I developed a plan against both of them. If someone asked me before this match what my chances were, I say 60/40. But now after learning my new Kuret transformation, I think its more like 90/10 in my favor. I don't think Vanessa is so much weaker than me, but objectively speaking me winning is more likely. I don't think she would be able handle my trump card.

I am digressing now, so I change my thoughts. Lets assume Vanessa had won against me or Derek. She then faces Charles. Charles would definitely fight her. I might be a little rude, but I don't think she can win against Charles. So Charles wins again and we move to Citradel. So we have now 2 of 3 scenarios which favors Citradel winning always if their planned had worked without interruption. And finally it comes to a scenario where I win and I battle with Charles. Since I uncovered the poison in the drinks, I don't know if they were planning to poison me in the finals. More likely not. The whole world knows Marina, Blake, Derek, Vanessa, Nathan, Tessa, Catherine were the favorites for the finals. Its bad luck of draw Catherine got matched up early with me. She could have defeated June and be in semi-finals.

Even if I was titled a dark horse, I wasn't a real threat for Charles. I laughed a little more now. I figured out the entire plot against us. They waited until the last rounds of matches to evade suspicion. It would be too much of a shock to eliminate Blake and Marina in the beginning. They had everything planned it very carefully. Making sure Charles win every scenario. But what they didn't expect is me. I figured out something wrong with Marina before she left and asked her to clean her blood. I didn't know she was poisoned back then, doesn't matter, Marina cleaned her blood at my request and dissolved the poison unknown to both of us. Then I stopped Blake from drinking the poisoned water. Interrupting their plan again.

But what's ridiculous is that this is match is still within a possibility in their plan and they believed I am going to be defeated. So even though their plan has been disrupted considerably, I am still inadvertently within the predicted matchups. Whoever is behind this is a true mastermind genius. To make such a devious strategy, I have to find who it is. Hopefully the spy I have employed is getting closer. Lets forget about the identity for now. I bet they never thought I would win against Blake or even become someone a threat to Charles. So this leads to my final conclusion. They will do whatever they can to make sure I lose. The violation that Charles did by almost killing me was a problem, but the match never stopped. I don't know if its because of Kafar's or others. Its possible its the person or people behind this whole conspiracy. Then they also can't have Charles loosing like this with his Kuret blocked.

If they are fine with incredibly dangerous plans to make sure Marina and Blake gets eliminated, they are not beyond bending the rules blatantly. They can't have Charles lose like this. They want desperately for Charles to win and for us to move to Citradel. So how they go about it. I quickly went through the rules once again. Loopholes, there has to be some here. As I spent time thinking about it, I saw glimmers of small light blue all over the stadium. I opened my eyes and gaze over the crowd. Something has happened. The excitement they had had gone down a little, in fact I felt mixed glimmers of emotions coming off people. What was that glimmer, I could faintly hear some sound flowing all around the stadium.

Few seconds later I realized it was a notifications sent to all the people tablet. I turned my eyes to the five nearest people. The excitement they showed earlier had was no longer there anymore. I saw Marina kicking the ground, Matt shoving his arm in the air. Those movements doesn’t look like people who are happy with something. Did we hit the countdown. I didn't know, but something had clearly changed. No one is coming in to stop the match. I waited for few more seconds, but none of them came through the door.

I see two new glimmers in the mix. It's Jess and Cass. It looked like Jess was dragging Cass with her. Then I think Vanessa was stopped from coming inside the barrier. I can't be sure from here. It’s a shot in the dark, but I think something unexpected has happened with the results. I feel like I hit bullseye when I thought this match won't be over like that. Someone found a loophole with the match. As I went through the rules, I found 3 rules that could have been applied now.

I decided to be prepared just in case. I got up from the ground and leaned my back against it. Being knocked unconscious and having this much rest has given me much needed respite. I am no where near battle ready. But I don't need to be. If I am right about the loopholes, there is chance I will have to fight soon. And even if Charles gets his Kuret back, those wounds will take long time to heal. I have bought enough time to use my trump card now.

First one, they will postpone the match because of violations from both us. Charles tried to kill me earlier, and now my arial strike could also be considered a violation. So they should disqualify both of us. But since this is finals, they instead postpone it. Second one, its very clever and scummy. They would run a new countdown for a opponent down situation. This would provide Charles the time to possibly recover his Kuret back. Since we never mentioned the rules for draw or disqualification don't supersede one another, this is possible. And third, delay the match by creating a medical emergency for Charles due to his Kuret blackout. That way they could say the match has to be delayed further until he recuperates.

My moneys on the first one. The other two are way two risky. It would show clear bias against me. They would be interrupted that Charles is given preferential treatment. At least with the first loophole, both of us are equally blamed for violations. Its also possible there are some other loopholes I am missing. With such limited time and no communication, I have no idea what's going to happen next exactly. I kept close eyes on the seven individuals now. Maybe they would provide some useful hints.

After some more time, I saw Blake writing 3 min with his Kuret. God dammit. Loophole number two wins. They intentionally choose a risky move. Was that a statement that they didn't care how it looks like as long as I lose. But this confirmation proves everything I deduced was true. I also immediately understood one thing. Our match will never end in a draw or disqualification. Even if the match gets postponed, they will make sure this doesn't end any other way than a clear decisive victor. I should be totally furious that someone is targeting me to lose. But unexpectedly I am not. When I woke up, I wanted to win at all cost. That feeling hasn't gone away even after knowing someone has been manipulating the match against us. In fact, I am more confident than before. Weird.

Hansen and Brandon words have effected me quite a bit. I have to meet their expecting. I will be one step closer once I win against Charles. I will win against anything thrown at me. Be it Charles or whoever's hiding in the

shadows. I am briming with complete determination. I spoke out loud, its time to finally reveal my trump card. I have the perfect opportunity to use it. To be honest I wanted to keep it hidden if possible. But the only other option would be use my new Kuret transformation.

That’s not happening. I am way to tired to use it now. And even if could use it, it would be a risky gamble. The transformation is completely in a whole new level. I need to study it and train properly. For which I don't have the time to do right now. But like Vanessa says, nothing goes according to plan every time. Using my ace would open a can of whole new problems later. I initially planed to use it against Hive only. Using it now would accelerate the situation I want to create way earlier than I thought.

But then I almost used it against Blake. And now, without it I can't beat Charles. So clearly, my personnel emotions are taking priority right now. Whether revealing is correct or not, I didn't have the luxury to think anymore. One thing is fore sure, I am going to shock the entire world.

# Vanessa (Chapter 27)

Saturday, February 3, 2024 01:25

Nothing works out the way we want things to happen. My emotions were such in turmoil, I didn't know what I am supposed to feel. I was worried sick about David. Then he finally woke up, I got angry at him. Then even more when I had to agree to wait this out. Then Jess tells me Ned went out of his way to help Charles. I understood a little that he only did it because he picked Charles. And I made my peace with it. But what turns me mad is that he wants David to lose this much.

Maybe I was reading too much into it. But his earlier outburst showed his true emotions. I thought I could keep it together, but I am mad at myself also for not being able to stop getting mad at Ned. The only thing that made me break out of the swirl of emotions was David declaration. Its incredible, he believes he can still win the against the all powerful Charles. I can't help being impressed with him right now. To think that when I met him all those years ago, struggling against someone like Toby, and now he is powerful enough to stand against a mythical alpha.

But that didn't stop me from being any less mad at him. He also has never been this reckless before. Is winning matters so to much him. I don't think anyone would call him out for forfeiting now. Everyone knew exactly just how crazy strong he has become. I still had some unresolved regret for not being able to fight him during the tournament. How would that outcome would be now that I have seen what's he capable of now. Everyone thinks my Kuret had the best chance of beating his. Even I thought I had advantage over him. But now, after seeing his sudden growth. I am not so sure.

I felt more unsure about our hypothetical match when I saw David finally reveling his trump card. I can't figure out how this new Kuret storm he brew gives him edge. Maybe like Derek said, he needed time to prepare. It wouldn't be surprising if his Kuret does something unexpected next. He kept making the storm smaller around him. Maybe he is trying to prepare his Kuret to take a physical shape that helps with his exhausted body. With so many transformations, I can't be even sure of anything.

It didn't made sense to do this when Charles is still down. What did he see with his Synesthesia. And finally in the last seconds, Charles Kuret comes back. Like I saw earlier, Charles Kuret begins filling in the charm Marina had created. What little hope we had that David would win without fighting any further, they were gone just like that. Matt yells frustrated, oh come on. Why does this happen just at the last moments. Marina shook her head with pouting her lips, it’s a freaking joke, that’s what it is.

We turn our heads to the arena, now towards Charles. His Kuret begins to move faster. Those wounds on him were finally getting healed. With slow movements, he got up. The crowd goes wild again. People are shouting and getting excited at the sight of Charles giving a loud roar. He didn't move immediately, instead he remained still as he continued to recover his missing Kuret body. Blake says dejected, all that time David spent wearing him down as much as possible, every wound he has, all will be for naught in some time. That is perhaps the most terrifying and maddening power of a Heraknus. The only thing David managed to do was buy enough time to recover a little and prepare his Kuret.

I knew exactly how Blake felt. I was frustrated at this as well. David might have the best Kuret to fight against Charles, but even then its not enough. On the other hand, David didn't seem effected by this. He continued to work on making that Kuret storm smaller. I wondered what kind of new Kuret form are we going to see. Sure hope its enough to bring down Charles. Otherwise, I am charging in and stopping this match. Marina collapses her charm and scoffs, Charles got back his full access to Kuret.

I ask her, keep an for David's injuries with M. The moment anything happens let us know. Marina nods and raises her wrist to show M's hologram to everyone. It had a little less colors around his body, that’s a good sign at least. Perhaps getting about 5 minutes of rest did just enough to keep him going. Matt walks to me and stands on my left. Blake and Derek stand against the other barrier door. Marina, Jess and Cass hung a little behind us. Charles was almost healed after another minute. His wound had closed and the Kuritines were growing on his body. Behind him, his tail regrew to the original size. They were sporting new Kuritines on the ends. And just like that, he was all healed up.

Blake says, get ready guys. Charles lets out a ferocious roar and begins charging on David on all fours. The way he moved hardly made sense because he was lying on the ground so helpless for the last 10 minutes. He doesn't even look like someone who was in trouble just now. Meanwhile, David didn't even bother to move. He was still working on the Kuret storm. He probably decided to not evade anymore, not with all his remaining stamina. David is now within Charles range. Everyone here leans forward towards the barrier in case of any trouble. I am a nervous recked than even before. Charles leaps into the air when he got close and brings his claws to slash David.

What happened next went beyond my wildest expectation. Just at the last moment, David's Kuret storm broke a little and made a hole. A bright white ray burst out, it hits Charles right in the middle. I couldn't believe what I am seeing. Charles was thrown backwards before his claws could reach David. The white light threw him backwards with a tremendous force. Charles arms and legs sways in air helplessly as he gets dragged away from David. He gowns as he was dragged away. In a desperate attempt, Charles tried to stop himself with his feet and tails. The grounds tears up when he couldn't find enough grip to stop himself. And soon enough, Charles was heading towards a collision course towards the barrier.

Marina shrieks, holy mother of god. A large thump sound vibrated the entire arena when Charles gets hit with the barrier. He was helplessly getting crushed between the invisible wall and the white ray crushing him. Charles looked like a wild animal trapped and trying desperate to get out. What the freaking hell. What's going on. It wasn't just us. The entire crowd had gone quieted down to almost silence. What did David do. Is that white light is his Kuret. No. This isn't his Kuret.

Matt shouts, what the hell. How is David doing this. From the barrier door, we could small gust of wind escaping from the incredible power of that white. Jess cries, hey don't tell me this is what I think it is. Is not possible, right. My jaw hung down. I don't understand what's going on. I yell, Marina, what the hell is David doing. Can you tell. Marina shouts, I am clueless. A moment later she says, one thing is for sure, that white light, its Kuret. Not David's black Kuret, but it’s a the most purest form of Kuret. The one I used against you in our match. But not at this scale or this powerful.

Derek, who usually remained calm seeing David's every transformation, finally couldn't stop from freaking out, impossible. Its just not possible. He has anti-Kuret. How is it possible for him to use normal Kuret. Pure Kuret on top of that. I don't understand this at all. Cass shouts while laughing loudly, freaking hell. This is nuts. Someone tell me this not a dream right. To be honest, I was feeling like that as well. Blake responds, nope. This is real. What in the world David do in that Kuret storm.

Marina says, all the normal Kuret around him gets broken down. I don't even sense much Kuret around him in the air. I don't sense Kuret inside that storm. Not like I ever could. But as soon as the white light leaves, I could tell that its Kuret. Then she starts to laugh hysterically, I can't believe what's I am seeing. I noticed something on Charles. My pull my jaw back and ask, hey guy, doesn't it look like Charles Kuret body is cracking. His Kuret is leaking out. It looked like that. Charles was getting hit with pure Kuret. His Kuret couldn't hold properly against the pressure he was feeling from both side.

Now Blake starts to chuckle a little, freaking shit. Look at David, he is getting dragged away too. My eyes turn to David. Like Blake said, the force of that Kuret ray was too much for him. He was slowly getting dragged away. But Matt asks, whoa whoa. Is he okay. David wasn't struggling, unlike Charles. He let himself get skid across the ground. He is getting dragged back towards the opposite end of the barrier. A few seconds later, he was stuck on the barrier on his back, like Charles.

Derek, controlling his shock a little says, Marina. This is bad. The barrier will break if this continues. I don't know how that white Kuret is coming out, but his black Kuret is still there. Marina shakes off her smile and instead bites her teeth, oh shit. We made the barrier in consideration to David's Kuret. If it was just him, the barrier would hold. However, she turns to Charles, he also getting putting pressure on the barrier. Blake immediately says, this is not good. If Charles is thrown outside, he will hit the people sitting on the stadium.

He turn behind, Jess, Cass, come with Derek and me. We will go and get the people around that area to evacuate. Derek agreed, yes. Lets go hurry. Derek's turns to me, but I cut him off before I could say, Matt and I got David. You guys focus on that. Derek gives a slight node and turns his back to me. The four them began to sprint around the barrier edge. People around us were shocked to see this unbelievable spectacle. Some continued to cheer and some straight up began yelling in panic.

Only me, Matt and Marina stood here. Marina had begun casting a charm. Her charm created a pieces of Kuret and they flew to be merged with the barrier. Matt asks her, tell me it will hold. Marina didn't respond immediately. She was in zone and solely focused on strengthening the weaking barrier. I shout back into the air, what the hell are you doing David. Stop this now. It was waste to say when he couldn't hear me. He needed to be stopped. I turn to Matt, lets go to David. Let others deal with Charles and Marina can keep working on fixing the damages. I don't know if we can stop David, but its better than to just stand here and do nothing. Matt nods, Yeah. He turns to Marina, you good Marina. Marina nods her head signaling us to go. We both waste no time and began sprinting towards David. We had to cover quite some distance, but I hope we could reach David before the barrier gives in. Matt shouts, Vanessa, look. Matt running beside me points to the white Kuret in the middle of the arena.

The beam was slowly tilting upwards. I spat out, what. I twist my head and look at Charles. Charles was getting pushed up in the air along the barrier. Matt grunts, what’s this now. A moment later I realized what's happening, David is trying to move Charles up in the air to avoid the people on the stadium. Matt replies, what. Why doesn't he just stops it altogether. We covered some more distance before realizing something, maybe he can't control it. I mean it’s a white Kuret. David can only control his black Kuret.

Matt shrieks, freaking hell David. I could see David now. He was covered in dirt all over. He had torn his clothes in too many places. He was covered in stains of his own blood. His face was a picture of utter hell with blood covered on one side and bruises on the other side. He was leaning on his back against the barrier. Both his arms were still inside the Kuret storm. Its as if he is trying to stop the Kuret storm from getting pushed back. He was slowly trying to move the white Kuret above.

The barrier around was becoming incredibly unstable. Marina won't be able to keep it together for long. I just hope others are able to move the people out of the way in time and David keeps moving Charles higher. The white bean was now almost close to the edge of the stadium. I saw Blake using his Kuret to move people out of their seats. Jess created a Kuret slide for people to hop on and get down quickly. Derek made the air denser and carried people on top of it to safely. Cass, on the other hand, wasn't that delicate with her approach. She was actually hurling people out of their seats and throwing them down. Blake worked double time to catch the people flying in the air and making them land safely.

There were other guards helping out there as well. I saw one flying away with carrying few people. Another one was manipulating the cement to melt the seats and create a better path for people to run. Good thing we have capable Medrine here to protect the crowd. We were now close to David. I yell out loud, David. Stop this before you hurt anyone. David didn’t turn around and instead shouts back, help me. I don't have control over this. Shit, I was right. He really can't control the white Kuret. The barrier had too many holes. And wherever they weren't, cracks had appeared.

We both came to a halt once we were behind him. Matt asks, what do we need to do. David says, I am going to be pushed out any second now. Vanessa, create a tornado behind me to keep me getting blasted away to the arena wall. I already figured he wanted me to do something like that. I had formed a small gust of wind. He grunts a little, Matt get prepared to grab me from behind and make sure I don't get pushed away. Matt replies, you got it. He runs behind David. I channel more Kuret into the air and form a tornado strong enough to counter the force David was facing.

The people on the seats besides us had already been evacuated by the guards. With a sudden thumping sound, the barrier behind David broke. David was hurled backwards. Matt catches David with his arms on David's back. I yell, Matt hold on. Matt nods when I push the tornado behind him. The combined effort of us both kept David from getting pushed back further. David is biting his teeth hard, almost there. Just one more push. With a yell, David moved the white Kuret even higher.

In the opposite direction, the barrier finally broke. Charles was thrown outside. With nothing to stop him, he was bashed near the edge of the stadium. The building begins to shake and crumble away in pieces. Good thing Charles crashed near the top of the stadium. People had time to get clear away from that area. Charles was thrown out, leaving behind an chunk of the edge stadium gauged out. After few seconds, the white Kuret becomes thinner. Just then David dispels his Kuret storm.

The white Kuret is finally cut from the source. Without it anymore, my tornado pushed Matt and David forward uncontrollably. David yells, Vanessa. Oh shit. I was distracted and didn't realize I still have my tornado. I quickly dispel the tornado. But I was too late. Matt and David were thrown into the air a little. With a wave of my arm, I through a gust of wind from the other direction. They both get hit by it and get pulled down. Fortunately, they were not too high. Matt managed to grab David just before the fall and lounged himself underneath him.

David lands with his back against Matts back when they hit the ground. I ran towards them as they fall like dominos on ground and roll off the grass. Matt grunts face first into the ground. David rolled away and lies on his back. I cry, oh shit. David. I am so sorry. Are you okay. I panic a little as I crotch down near David's face. David bellows a little, argh. Its okay. I used my Kuret to break my fall a little. I put my hands on his arm giving him support to get up. Beside me Matt gowns, oh don't worry. I am also okay. He turns to the side and lies back on his ground. He had dirt covered on his face, he spats out dirt from his mouth, my Kuret didn't work when you landed on me. Thanks for that.

David stumbles a little when I help him up, he says, Sorry. I had no other choice. He turns to me, appreciate the save. I don't know what would have happened if you guy hadn't come over here. Seeing him up close and safe, I felt a little relieved and calmed down from all the anxiety I had. I nod as he lets go of me to give Matt an arm and helps him up. He pulled Matt up. Matt dusts off the dirt on him, Thanks. But dude, just what the hell is going…Then like a bubble bursting all my emotions comes to the surface.

I blurt out before he could finish, David. What the hell. Have you gone crazy. David turned to me with a little surprised look. Really, it shouldn't come a shock for him. I continue, do you how many times you were almost killed. What's were you thinking attacking doing all those insane stunts to defend against Charles. What's going on with your Kuret. You transformed so many times, it feels completely different now. And why the hell did you fly so high. You got yourself almost got killed with that. Do you have any idea how much me, and others were worried about you when you didn't wake up. Do you know any idea how close we came to stopping the match. I can't even begin to understand what you have been thinking all this time. I take a short breath, and what in the name of god was that white Kuret.

David was bamboozled with my questions. No, he is probably shocked to see me so overwhelmed as I spoke. To be honest, I surprised myself. I even shocked Matt with my ranting. David composed his expression, I am sorry. That’s I can say. I am sure my actions worried you. He pauses and then says, to all of you. And I will explain it later. Or at least try to. So calm down, Vanessa. He smiles a little. He had the nerve be so clam about the situation, even finding it amusing. It was annoying the hell out of me.

However letting all my thoughts made me feel better. I sigh and shook my head, you ass. How the hell are you so clam right now. Matt continues, yeah dude. You can't even fathom what been happening in the VIP room upstairs. I know you were having a terrible time here, but it wasn't exactly a picnic for us too you know. David smirks a little, I bet. And I will hear all about it later. But we are still middle in the match. I need to finish this. Hearing him say that, my jaw opened a little unconsciously. I spit out, what. Have you lost your mind, you want to continue.

Matt is also shocked to hear that, shut the freak up man. You literally blasted Charles out of the stadium. You already won. David shook his head, nope. Technically, both Charles and I were thrown out of the bounds together. So basically its a draw. He sighs a little, no way that Charles or Kafar going to stop the match. I yelled out him, you think we will allow you to continue the match in your condition. You are clearly exhausted, got injuries everywhere and taken beating all over.

David replies, the only other way is to forfeit the match. He takes a pause and says softly, And for personnel reasons, I have decided to win this match no matter what. I was shocked to hear him say with such determination. His earlier actions showed his will, but when he showed it in words, he was oozing with confidence. I go so far to say he was a little bit arrogant too. Something seen very rarely on him. Matt asks, wait what. What the hell happened during the match dude.

David bluntly says, many things happened. And yet I don't know myself for sure. What I know is that I am defeating Charles at all cost now. He then turns his back to us and faces the arena. He closed his eyes and stood there for a few seconds like that. Both Matt and I were too stunned to speak. This is something I can't believe David saying with so much confidence. Does he think his trick with white Kuret is making him complacent. A moment later I thought threw that thought. Even if he was a boastful here, he wouldn't fight without a plan.

He opens his eyes a moment later and lets out a long breath, that’s a relief. No one got hurt. Everyone reacted fast enough to move people away. So he was checking up the crowd with his Synesthesia. Matt says, look. Even if you say you want to win, there's no point if the match doesn't continue. David responds, do you really think Kafar will allow the match to end like this. His can't have his prized champion, who by the way is okay and will soon be back, end the match like this. I don’t know exactly what's been going with others. But I can made pretty good guess. He continues, you guys tried to stop this match when Charles violated the rule by almost intentionally killing me. But Kafar, maybe even Derek, put a stop to that. And now you all couldn't stop Kafar after figuring out that loophole.

He is right. He figured it almost all of it. But he didn't know it was Ned who brought it up the loophole. I wanted to correct him, but I couldn't do it. I was actually ashamed a little. I couldn't tell him Ned voted against him. Matt says, ah. Yeah pretty much right. Except it wasn't… I cut in before he would say further, but Kafar won't allow the match continue when people safely is compromised. I couldn't believe I am covering for Ned here. Matt understood my intention not wanting to reveal that. David looked at me a little trying to figure out my rudeness.

Then he says, you think that will stop him. With the lengths he has gone to conduct his match, hiding Charles, making out him to be an ultimate weapon and even stretching out the rules. He then looks to the ground, no one got hurt. And yes, I am at fault for that danger. But clearly, it was an accident. I actually surprised my own power with that. Anyways, the solution to avoid this again is simple. Erect an even stronger barrier. Tell Marina to use the Arvada spell that uses physical Kuret properties instead of the one she used. She will understand. A moment later he says, she will be reluctant a little so let her know that I will be owing her big for making her do that.

I didn't understand how he knew what it was or how he knows it would work. They must have discussed it earlier. Matt says, hold on. You say Kafar will do whatever he can to keep the match from being a draw. I am not sold on that. I mean, that was just a lucky fluke when, he paused to look at me and then clears his throat, I mean, finding that loophole. You don't have to continue the match. We can put an end or at least postpone the match for a while. We can figure out a way to stop this, especially if you want to.

David thinks for a moment, maybe if we had more time. But like I told you. I also don't want to end the match like this. He takes a pause, and besides, do you think that was the only way to continue the match in that moment. I know of two other ways Kafar could have made sure Charles or I weren't disqualified. I knew after I woke up, that no matter what happens the match will continue until we have one clear victor. And that works perfectly for me since I also want that.

I couldn't speak for a while. I ask, what do you mean there were other ways. How could… he raises his hand to stop me, don't get me wrong, it would have great if I was wrong and the match ended there. While I want to win, I know Charles is too much for me in my state. If there was an easy way to end this match, I would have done it already. I don't want to risk this much when I am not even fighting Hive or Echo. But in every scenario I can think of, there will always be trick, a loophole, a way for Kafar to keep continuing the match. So I have no choice but to resolve myself. I can either forfeit myself or purposefully lose to end this match immediately. None of which I will do it myself.

Matt says, how can you know that Kafar or someone will keep getting in the way of ending the match. David replies, I can't answer that at the moment. You'll have to just trust me. A moment of silence came between us. The people around the stadium were buzzing and moving around. Loud chatters of confusion and shouting were erupting among the people. But the guards were coordinating the people to adjust the rowdy crowd. The hole that tread the stadium had stabilized. Some guards were roaming around there to inspect the damage.

David suddenly says, he is back. A sound of roar filled the air around us. It was Charles. Large thumping noise could be head coming from the arena gates. David starts to walk inside the ground. Matt says, whoa dude. Hold up. You are serious about this. David nods while leaving us, just trust me. I know what I am doing now. I know you guys saw me fumbling at the beginning of our fight, but now I am in control. I am totally stunned seeing him like this. His arrogance and blatant disregard of danger was something I never seen before.

I ask before he leaves, you could die. You hear me. If something goes wrong, you might die. You think you can still win in your condition. David stops in his tracks. He turns he head to me. There's a deep silence between us. He then finally breaks it, I won't die. That’s a promise, if things go beyond my expectation and becomes incredible risky, I will drop out. But until then, I have a way to win, even now. He smirks as he says, this is nothing. Wait till you see my complete trick. A small shiver went down my spine hearing those word. I shriek, what. You are kidding right. I don't even know how you can use white Kuret. David ignored my question and continues walking, trust me. Wait for the announcement telling the match will resume, tell Marina what I told you. And oh yeah. On more thing.

He takes some time to say the words, what you saw was just the tip of the iceberg. Tell others you haven't seen the real shit yet. With those parting words David left us speechless and walked away. Me and Matt turn towards each other and lock our eyes in utter shock. Matt whispers to me, Vanessa, what the freak just happened.

# Vanessa (Chapter 28)

Saturday, February 3, 2024 20:50

What just happened. Matt and I just started each other and to David's back as he walks away slowly. I came here thinking I would be able to stop David, but now all I could was see him continue fighting in such a state. Matt clears his throat, jeez. What now. He is asking my advise. I am confused as hell at the moment. I am almost tempted to knock David down and carry him back. I can tell everyone that last attacked knocked him out. Matt would definitely cover for me if I did it. Then, I recalled David's unshakable confidence. He said he still has more to us. I think I had my fill of surprises for today.

I reply, as much I want David to quit, he isn't going to listen to us. So for now, we got no choice but to let him continue if the match resumes. Matt eyes widen, and you are okay with that. I shook my head, absolutely not. But David didn't left me with much choice. So lets just had to Marina and tell her about that barrier. Matt nods slightly mixed with an anxious look. We both began walking back the way we came from. The crowd was restless than ever. Some people were asking the guards what's happening, others were arguing something. Matt sees me checking up on people, what a mess, right. If David's right, then we should be hearing from Kafar and the admins about their decision with the match.

I reply, I still can't believe we will allow this match to continue after that accident. Suddenly Charles barged out of the arena gate. The doors tore away from the hinges as he emerges out. The doors lands on opposite sides of him. He had appeared from a distance, and yet we could see Charles Kuret body was shredded in pieces. That pure Kuret blast crushed all his Kuretines and shaved off Kuret over his body. His jaws and face was healing, but we could see it almost cut in half. His body had even shrunken in size. Two of his tails were cut of in the middle. Charles roars loudly and sprints into the arena. I got worried that he might attack David immediately. But he stops in his tracks after entering inside some distance.

He did something unexpected, he sat down on the ground. His ached body breathes heavily and his arms hung on the sides. Matt whistles, wow. Not even Charles is able to shake that attack off. I reply, I am actually relieved to see even Charles has to rest and heal from getting hit from that pure Kuret beam. We both resume our journey back. I turned to see David. He was back again preparing another Kuret storm. I stammer a little seeing him, seriously. That wasn't a one off attack. I was sure that David would be too tiered to try this again or had to wait some more time before doing it again. Matt answers, man, if we see more attacks like that, then maybe David will win.

I wasn't sure. David might be a little over his head with his attitude. I am still reeling a little bit with his sudden demeanor change. Looks like his Kuret wasn't the only thing that transformed during the match. We arrived back at the spot we left earlier. Marina is still here. But she wasn't alone anymore. Nathan and Ned were here as well. They were in the middle of a conversing when we came. Nathan is speaking Marina, to the officials. I left after they wanted just the admins in the room. Nathan turns to me and raises his head up. He asks, you guys are back. So how's our mighty warrior. Still in the game. He asks with a smile.

I ask him instead, what are you guys doing here. Ned didn't respond. He instead looked behind me and watched David. I didn't know what I would do if I keep talking to him, so I choose to just ignore him for now. Nathan replies, I was just explaining to Marina that Kafar in a call with all the officials. They our discussing on how to proceed. Since it was none of my business, they kicked us out. Matt asks, where's Catherine and Tessa. Nathan says, they went to help others on the stadium. We had enough people helping, so I just thought to get a better view of the action. And he just tagged along with me. He turns to Ned.

Ned then turns to me, is David willing to continue this match. I had to control myself from going busker. He had the nerve ask about the match, not caring about David or how he used that white Kuret. Matt probably sensed my anger and steps in, ah. We spoke a little with David and boy, not only wants to continue the match, but he straight up told us he is going to win. All three of them got taken back hearing David's intention. Marina spoke up with a smirk, he must be very confident after that last attack.

Matt replies, try cocky. You should see the way he talked, all covered in busied and bloodied clothes, and yet not a shred of doubt. He has overblown confidence. Marina widened her eyes, really. I find that hard to believe he would behave like this. I back him, its true. I have seen him scared, confident and sometimes even vicious before during a match. I point the last part towards Nathan who just stood there with even a bigger smile, but never like this before. Nathan waves his hand in air and snaps his fingers, oh. I needed to see that. When I saw that pure Kuret blast I spilled my drink. And then there's Kafar, who had been on edge ever since David woke up first. He went complete mental after seeing Charles thrown off the stadium. He laughs out, man that was some insane trick David pulled off. Matt and Marina snickers thinking about it. I was too much focused on Ned to care about Kafar's attitude. He continues, it could have been a clear victory for David, but sadly, both of them where thrown out of the bounds nearly the same time and were back inside the arena within two minutes.

I finally gathered my thoughts and asked Ned, why aren't you there with Kafar in the room. You are handling the broadcasting and media right. Surely you should have a say. Ned takes some time to respond to me, I actually don't have any authority. They are hosting this tournament while I am just handling the logistics of the media. I don't hold a vote on how to veer matches. I scoff, bet you just want to see Charles win no matter huh. He replies, what do you meant by that. I retort, don't deny it. You could have stayed quite when the countdown started, but chose to tell Kafar about that loophole.

Ned stares at me for a second before replying, that’s not fair. You can't be mad when you already know I supported Charles. I shook my head in anger, supporting is fine. But going out of your way to come up with such a scummy way that is a clear bias against David. I am not just talking about you. Both you and Kafar are showing too much partiality. I was almost yelling at him now. I am angry too much to remain calm all the way. Ned didn't respond back. He just looked away and started at the arena.

Oh no you didn't. He just ignored me. The nerve. I was to bite his head off, then Nathan raises his arm. Oye, that’s enough Vanessa. Take your lovers spat later. This is not the place to being doing this. I am about to aim my anger at Nathan instead now. Matt steps in before I could say more, Marina. David asked to you to create another barrier. A more powerful. Marina turns her arms to cross nonchalantly, forget it. I won't make a powerful barrier all alone. I will call others to help me. Matt says, David asked you personally for something called a Averna charm.

Marina chuckles hearing that, huh. Seriously, David thinks I would use waste a powerful charm on this match. I mean, I could use do it. I would be wasting a lot of my personnel stack of precious Kuretine if I do that. Nathan asks, will it be able to handle those Kuret blasts. Marina thinks for a moment, yeah. If I made an Averna barrier, it would be nearly impossible to break. Even for David. This is a self sustaining Kuret siphoning top grade barrier. Matt replies, sounds good to me. Then do it.

Marina shook her head, you crazy. I told you, something this powerful would cost me some precious Kuritines. I have them in case of emergency. Nathan says, this is an emergency you know. She rebukes, no. An emergency is like when Hive or Echo attack us. I can't use it for here. I would be wasting when I could need it for actual emergency. Its not easy to make or come by the Kuritines needed for this. Just forget it guys. I will ask others to help me make barrier again and hopefully make it stronger.

I recalled something David said, he said you would be reluctant. So mentioned about him owing you. Marina stared at me with suspicious eyes. A moment later she opens her arms and smirks a little, your serious. Well that changes. If he said that, then it means he is knows what I want from him. Marina pulls out a smile. I got curious, what is it. Marina says, sorry. Its between the two of us. Marina thinks for some time. She then finally makes up her mind. Fine, David got a deal. I will invoke the charm. Ned says, wait for the announcement first. It should going out soon.

Nathan turns to him with a suspicious expression, you say like you already know what they will say. Ned didn't reply him. I almost pressed for more from Ned, but I doubted he would say anything to me as well. Marina asks Matt about our conversation with David. Nathan got interested as well and listened in. With just Ned and me, our silence made me awkward. Ned finally spoke, I don't know what's got you so mad at me. But I know whatever I say will know make you even more mad or you won't believe me. So we should finish our conversation later. He was about to turn and walk away.

I asked puzzled, where are you going. He replies, to check with my team. I need to go over the details with them and make sure all the Medrines watching the match don't drop the live streaming. I am thinking to give a message explaining the situation. Hopefully, by the time crowd cools down, we will have an announcement. He didn't wait for me to reply or anything. He just walked away coldly from me. He is mad at me. Well, that’s make the two of us. I can't believe he choose to just walk away. But after thinking about it, maybe its for the better. If we say something that can't be taken back, we would have another argument.

I turn back to the ground to squash my feelings about Ned. Marina suddenly bursts into laughing, he said that. Matt replies, yeah those were his exact words. Nathan also laughs, whoa, looks like David finally wore his big pants. If he says he has more powerful stuff to show us, maybe he really can put money where his mouth his. Matt replies, jury's still out on that. On that note, we saw a group of people heading towards us. It’s the others. Blake, Derek, Jess, Cass. And now Tessa and Catherine are tagging along with them.

When they reach close to us, I ask to Blake, is everything under control. Blake sees Nathan who gives a light nod and then turns to me, yeah. We moved people around a bit and made them sit away from that damage area. Marina asks, no one got hurt right. Derek replies, thankfully no. We got there in time. Your barrier held out just long enough time to move people away. Jess says coming to a halt near Nathan, we helped enough so left the rest with the guards. Cass then excitedly says, you all missed that epic moment when that bastard Charles was thrown out of stadium. He looked like such a helpless monkey lizard howling when he landed on the ground outside. She laughs when she recalls that scene.

Matt says, oh really. I bet you that you guys missed something even more interesting. Blakes asks to me, what is he talking about. Is it David. Catherine after long time asked me, how is he doing. Blake saw you guys leaving him, so I can only guess if he is okay. Marina says, oh please. Let me tell what them. She pleads to Matt and me. I had no interest in explain such a messy situation. Matt motioned for Marina to convey her own take of the story. After about a minute, more shocked expression popped on peoples face.

Derek spits out, what. This wasn't him going all out. Blake eye twitches a little, is it weird that I am little scared now. I mean, won't this mean it will become even more dangerous. Catherine asks, I know I supported Charles, but I don't want David to try something even more reckless. I tell her, try stopping him. He isn't listening to me or Matt. I think no matter what, this won't end until there is only person standing. Catherine scoffs, that’s insane. Matt says, right. Blake asks Marina, I sure hope this new powerful barrier of yours will hold Marina.

Marina raises her hand in defense, oh trust me. It will definitely work. Let me tell you the part that you can understand. The charm is so convoluted and dangerous that anyone not trained properly will get a nasty backlash. I can't ask others to help with something this dangerous. In fact, I will only be able to do it if I overdrive. That made my mouth twitch. I recalled our battle when she went overdrive. If Marina needs to into use that, then this must a very powerful charm indeed. Blake eyebrows raises, seriously. You can't do it without it. Marina nods and Blakes asks her, sure you have recovered enough to go into overdrive this soon.

Blakes and Marina match was about a month back, but overdrive takes a huge toll on the users body. Even after their bodies heal, they may not be able to use it soon. Marina puts her finger on her lips and thinks for a moment, I might be able to pull it off just for couple of minutes. That’s more than enough for me to cast this single charm. Blake nods with a surprised expression, wow. I actually tried to go into overdrive myself just a while back, but I couldn't do it. Blake pride took a hit on his own words.

Marina replies apologetically, don't beat yourself up too much. I just have more practice with my mine that’s all. You will soon learn it. Blake slightly nods with a little embarrassment. I can almost imagine his feeling. He won against Marina with his overdrive, but just barely. And yet he is still playing catch up with her in certain aspects. I could almost relate it to me and David. But then I chided myself. David's now probably leagues above me. Nathan says, okay, if you two overdrive users are done flexing and looking down us mere mortals, I think its about time. Nathan gets everyone's attention. He was facing to the podium that was used an hour earlier. Kafar was back again standing on it.

For a guy who shows his true emotions to us, he is someone who can immediately pull out a diplomatic and stern attitude when needed. He turns the mike on his collar on and speak, hello. Yes, great. Everyone. Please could I your attention. The crowd begins to quiet down hearing his voice. Few seconds later he continues, first of all, let me say that no one got injured in the last accident. Few people are little shaken, but nothing physical happened. The quick thinking of our finalists and guards ensured everyone's safety. So I give a heartful thanks to their efforts. He pauses and raises his hands and begins to clap.

Slowly everyone in the crowd begin clapping and cheering for all the people who helped. The people nearest to us from the stadium were raising their arms in air and praising us. With everyone on the spotlight, we all waved back delighted with the appreciation we got. Matt asks, hey, Nathan, why are you taking waving your hand. You didn't help at all. Nathan scoffs, of course I did. I gave you all my moral support you know. Almost everyone rolled their eyes on him. The claps slows down soon. Kafar takes the center again.

He says, thank you again for keeping us safe. He clears his throat, after reviewing the last moments of that curious and shocking attack from David, we concluded that it was accidental. As were any of the possible violations during the battle. Its good we were far away from people to hear, because I spoke out, really. He thinks Charles violations were not intentional. I let out a breath of anger in my voice. Others whisper in agreement hearing me. Blake says, he is just covering his own ass with that. Kafar continues, in regards to the disruption of the match. We had a talk with the admins, we even took a survey of our viewers about whether to stop or to continue this match. He takes a longer pause. Everyone on the stadium were anxious to hear the verdict.

But the ones with me here, pretty much had already guessed it already. He continues, we will continue the match. The crowd goes wild and people wariness left immediately. He waves his arms and wait for people to calm down. A moment later he says, both the fighters were thrown outside the bounds, but there were back inside within 2 minutes. So none of them are disqualified. The crowd cheers once again at that message. He continues, however, we also know that continuing the match without protection would be dangerous. This tournament doesn't mean anything if we can't keep people safe. Because the goal of this tournament is to show our current strength and create a safe environment. We also can't have our fighters fight restrained. So we will only start after we create another barrier and adjust it for the extra protection. We will soon have it ready before our fighters get impatient. Hopefully, before they bring the whole stadium down. Haha.

That joke is in poor taste. Yet few people in the crowd laughed at that. Kafar left the podium and went inside. Derek says, Marina, you heard him. The match continues, so you erect that charm now. Marina asks, is it okay. Kafar didn't spoke with me yet. Derek nods, don't worry about it. I will message him now. Besides, he would have approached you anyways instead of the other casters. Marina nods, okay. She then pouts a little, David better make sure to keep the end of his deal. When I said I could do it, that doesn't mean it will not make my body sore like hell. She sighs, anyways, guys give me some space.

Everyone back away from Marina few step back. Marina first creates a charm to open her Kuret vault. She sticks her hand in and pulls out a large but thin stick. It wasn't just a stick, once both the ends were out, it had Kuritines stuck on its side. There were about a dozen of them, all in different colors. The Kuretines were small, but even I could feel the incredible amount of Kuret it was radiating. The upper end of the stick had one large Kuritine of green color. It was carefully sculpted in a shape of flower looking pattern.

She closes her vault and sticks the other end into ground. Marina closes her eyes and puts her hands on the Kuretine rod. A moment later charms starts to gather around her. Having seen this up close many times before, I thought I would get used to see it. But no. It still amazes me every time. I usually would forgot that Marina is in a league of her own because of her frivolous behavior. But ever since our fight, I can't deny she is powerful. She is on par with Blake, and maybe even Charles. A thought came to me, David is also included among these top tier group of people. I felt even more regret of my own loss. The roles have reversed between me and David over the years. How very cruel and true.

Marina overdrive starts and her body begins to cover with numerous circuits of Kuret charms. The Kuret radiating from her starts begins to make physical waves around us. And soon she was fully consumed with her charms. The rod begins to disappear as it slowly turns into Kuret mist. Marina absorbs the Kuret into her own body via the charms. Once the Kuretines also turn into mist, Marina starts to floats into sky. She was slowly ascends into air. Soon the entire rod is gone. The Kuret mist is slowly swirling inside her. Once it was completely absorbed, she raised her arms in front of her. A moment later a green colored Kuret flows out from her hands. She then flies straight up into the air.

We turn our gazes up in the air following her path. She was flying to the center of the arena. David and Charles were standing on the opposite ends of the arena. Once she gained some height. She falls straight between the two people and hits the ground. Suddenly a large green colored Kuret flowed out from the impact and immediately gulfed the entire arena. The green Kuret begins to flow in every direction. Including towards David. I got worried a little thinking his Kuret storm would break her charm. But the green Kuret that didn't pass through him, connect from behind him keeping the charm intact. Soon the green Kuret slows its growth and becomes still around the same place the previous barrier was placed.

The crowd which were mesmerized by this giant charm began cheering for this amazing display. I saw Marina flying from inside her barrier. At the edge of the barrier, instead of creating a door she just phased through the barrier and come from other side to us. She gracefully settles down on her feet. Immediately, she dispel her overdrive. She stumbles once she reverts back to her normal self. I was the closest to her and caught her by her shoulders when was falling back. Whoa, Marina. Are you okay.

Marina gave a thumbs up and then tried to smile but her mouth only turned half way up. A okay, she murmurs. He eyes were droopy a little and couldn't walk on her own. She definitely pushed herself. I supported her while I took her near the arena wall and let her rest on the ground. Others made way for us. Marina says, thanks Vanessa. She settles down and leans on the all. She says a little meekly, I am embarrassed. After all that talk, I didn't think this would make me this drained. I said, don't worry it. Trust me, I of all people know what you did wasn't easy. Marina smiles at me. She says, I think I need to start working out now.

I couldn't tell if she was joking or serious. Derek comes from behind, that was great. Thanks for this. Here, drink this. Should help with your sourness. He handed a bottle that containing liquid Kuret. Marina take it from his hand, you don't need to thank me. David's the one I want to hear it from. That and what he owes me now. She gulps down the drink. Derek asks, must be pretty something equally important. Marina nods, lets just say if I had that before my match with Blake, I would have won instead no question. I guess she was already feeling better to try act tough in her weakened state.

Behind me Blake snorts, is that right. Awfully sure of yourself. Marina smiles with small giggle, you got lucky, nothing else. She drinks for the liquid. Her skin was regaining her lost color. Nathan then speaks, again. Cool it with your egos. Let me ask something more important. How strong is this one. We can't have another crisis on our hands. Marina brings out a devious smile, why not don't you try it yourself. Hit the barrier with everything you got. If you make even a small dent, I will give you anything from my secret stash.

Nathan begins flexes his arms in repones, challenge accepted. He grins and walks to the edge. I retort, Nathan this isn't time to play. Nathan replies, this is a valid question you know. If I can make a dent on it, bet your ass Charles or David will break it again. I turn to Derek to help out. He says, let him do it. I was about to suggest it anyway. Its important to test it out before they start fighting again. Once we confirm its power, we will tell Kafar to resume the match. It made sense when Derek says it. But that didn't exempt from their childish behaviors.

Nathan stands near the barrier. He raised one arm in the air and covers himself with Kuret. Then swings down his fit bursting out with Kuret. The Kuret should have clashed the barrier, but just when it made contact, his Kuret was siphoned off his arm and gets absorbed by the barrier. Nathans Kuret less fist touches the barrier. Instantly he was thrown back. Whoa. He grunts as he gets dragged away and lands on his ass near Tessa. Shit, he gasps. Tessa chuckles a little, you all right. She gave him her hand. Nathan reluctantly takes it and pulls himself up. He looked a little rattled, but then brings his usual expression, okay. Its strong. Why didn't you tell me it would do that. He asks annoyed at Marina.

Marina smiled in response, you didn't ask. Nathan thought he was going to bite back, but instead he nods. Yeah, should have asked before. My bad. He walks back to Jess's side. She asks, sure you okay. He nods, yeah. Nothing just a little bruised ego. Marina laughs a little with his comment and then says, anyone else care for a try. No one responded thinking she was just joking. She pouts, hey I am not kidding. Derek said we need to be absolutely sure it will hold. So shouldn't we test it more.

Derek sighs a moment later, yeah. She's right. All though I know she is enjoying this. Marina doesn't even denies it. She looks at me, I immediately say, ah no. Thanks I am good. I doubt you made a barrier that is weak against non Kuret attacks. She makes a slight disappointed look. This girl, at least hide your intentions. Blake offers his turn, I'll do it. He turns to Derek, how about we both try it together. That would be a much better way to know that it will hold against both David and Charles.

Derek thinks for a moment and then replies, yeah. That would conform its strength much accurately. Nathan whispers softly to Jess, was that a jab at me saying mine was weak. Jess shushes her husband. Boys, I grumble a little. They both walk to the barrier and take a stance to prepare themselves. Blakes calls out to Marina, hey is your bet still on the table. Marina immediately says, get the freak out. With the two of you, the barrier won't break, but I can't guarantee it won't create dents. Blakes replies, ah. Fine. Blake pours out Kuret on his arm and makes it solid. Derek pulls one arm back keeping his palm open. He makes the air dense and positions to throw it from his palm.

Blake says, on three. One. Two. Three. They both land their attacks on the barrier. The barrier tried to siphon away Kuret from them, but the force and amount this time was a bit more than Nathans. It couldn't absorb the attack completely. Blakes Kuret was still on him. But even he couldn't break the barrier. All he could do was bend it inside and stretch it inside. Derek had the same result. His attack was a slightly targeted a smaller spot, it bent the barrier more with a sharper depth, but it didn't break.

After seeing the blowback from Nathan attempt, they were braced themselves when they were flung back. They manage to keep themselves stand upright. Blake says, damn Marina. This is good. Derek agreed, yes. I didn't expect it to be stretch like that. Marina bows her head with a gesture of appreciation, thanks. She raises her head, I told you earlier. This the top of the line, ultra grade level stuff. I snort at her, really. You just smashed some words together. She smirks, whatever. The point is it works good on both Kuret and non Kuret attacks.

Matt asks, what about David's black Kuret. He threw a white Kuret. But lets not forget his actual Kuret is the black one. Marinas says, no worries there, this barrier will heal the missing portions much faster than the previous ones. So David can keep punching or kicking with his black Kuret, the worst could happen is that he could tear small holes which will close within seconds. Derek nods, Great. I think this would work fine. He pulls out his tablet from his pocket and begins typing on it.

Catherine asks, um guys. I know we were all busy with the barrier stuff, but there's something I should tell you. We turned at her. She points to the arena, I have keeping on eye on both Charles and David. Neither have moved an inch and have been having a sort of staring contest. The short amusing atmosphere we had for a while changed instantly. We were painfully reminded that the match is still happening. I turn my gaze to the two people left inside the barrier. She is right. David was completely focused on making his Kuret storm. In fact, now its even smaller than last time. He must have been concentrating on that all this time.

Charles on the hand, was fully healed. He was making his Kuritine shine even more now. He is pouring more Kuret inside it. Like the one he made with his horns. The only thing that was keeping from attacking was probably us to finish this. Matt says, I know what you mean. They didn't even seem concerned when Kafar give his little speech, nor when Marina created the barrier. Blake asks, I don't know if this is good or bad development. They both are giving a complete different vibe now. I think everyone could feel it.

# Vanessa (Chapter 29)

Sunday, February 4, 2024 17:02

Marina beside me pulls her up taking support from the wall. I ask her, what are doing, you look like you still need rest. Marina replies, who cares about that. Before the match begins, I need to give the four of you with charms so that you could pass through the barrier when needed. Derek says, good thinking. Marina creates a charm to her Kuret vault and pulls four Kuretines the size of a peanut. She says, take this. It'll let pass immediately without needing a door. Me, Matt, Derek and Blake take one each from Marina. The Kuritine felt cold on my skin. It is so small, yet I could hardly believe the amount of Kuret it was radiating. She continues, a warning though. This will only work once. So don't go barging inside without being absolutely sure. I don't have many of these. So use it carefully.

Few seconds later, Kafar comes back to the podium. He speak, everyone. Thank you for your patience. We have made the preparation. So will resume - Kuret was cut off. Looks like Charles hit his limit of patience. He roars loudly and begins charging towards David. Kafar's rest of the statement gets crushed the voices of the excited audience. Kafar waved his hand and walked away from the podium. Blake yells, ah damn. Hear we go again. Guys get in position. Derek and Blake stood together while me and Matt waited some distance beside them. I can't recall how many times we have gotten anxious seeing Charles charge across the ground like this. Charles had prepared something more this time. He made his tails much thicker and grown the Kuretine at the end much bigger. This was to counter that white Kuret blast. He would be able to stop himself from being dragged away.

How will David make sure he hits Charles again though. Charles knows what's coming now, he can dodge it. Though that Kuret blast is fast, he can still evade it if he had the distance. They were in striking distance. Charles jumps into the air this time. I assumed he would use his claws to attack, but he twists in the air has jumping. He instead uses that jump to use his tails to have more momentum to attack from below. The four tails swing in tight circles with their pointy Kuritine ends aimed at David's body. Meanwhile, David didn't try to dodge it. All this time, he remained fixed on the same position.

My mouth twitches in fear. What the hell is David doing just standing there. Shouldn't he shoot the Kuret blast by now. Just then, David's Kuret storm shakes a little and throws out a Kuret blast. But it was no longer white. It was blue. My eyes widen at this. A cold shiver went through my spine. The blue Kuret instead of blasted in a single beam, spread out like wave of water in the air. The Kuret wave hits Charles and his tails, pushed them away from David. The blue Kuret was so strong that Charles was thrown away like he bounced off a wall. He falls back on ground on his side and stops himself with his arms before he gets dragged away. The blue Kuret stops from the Kuret storm and it disappears within seconds.

The crowd was becoming silent after seeing this new attack. I could even hear my own breath as everyone here were beyond shocked here. Why is it this shocking, its not because the Kuret wasn't a blast or white this time. But because it was a different Kuret itself. It was no longer pure. It had changed its nature. Nathan breaks the silence, who had his smile just till now turns sour, what the freak. Blake had his jaw hung low. Matt is freaking out, holy hell. That Kuret. Marina despite being weekend was so shocked that she put her hand on her mouth. Others were showing signs that was mix of shock and awe.

Meanwhile my mind went to a complete blank trying to comprehend what just happened. David used Nathan and Blakes Kuret. To be accurate, their bloodline Kuret. Tessa asks hesitantly ah, isn't that your Kuret Blake. Yours too Nathan. They both were too stunned to speak. Cass snickers, don't tell me that David's actually from a royal bloodline too. She then laughs nervously, has he hidden his past till now. Blake closes his mouth and replies, don't be ridiculous. Derek had turned to a stone, asks, Marina, did you sense what David did.

Marina pulls her hand away and shook her head slowly, no. I didn't sense any thing. Derek turns to Nathan, did you see anything within the Kuret aura. Nathan lips twitches, nothing. There's no normal Kuret on David even now. Jess shrieks, what does this mean. No one knew the answer. In the arena, Charles gets up. Some of his Kuritines were broken from the blue Kuret impact. He dugs his claws into the ground and pulls out two large boulders. The then grabs few more with this tails. Honestly, what's even more shocking is Charles not fazed by what he saw and just continues fighting like it was nothing.

He charges again at David. But instead of a head on collision, he throws all six boulders at David in consecutive throws. He did this to make sure at least few would go through after the blue Kuret wave pushes the first few away, leaving David unprotected against the last ones. David shakes his Kuret storm again. I was expecting another blue Kuret, instead a yellow shade Kuret pours out. I gulp a little seeing the new Kuret. This one created a shockwave of sound that vibrated through the entire arena.

The noise was so loud that the green barrier vibrated along with the noise creating a small humming. The rocks hurled at David bursts right out in the sky before it was anywhere close to him. I tried blinking my eyes thinking my eyes were playing tricks on me. David didn't just pull out one bloodline Kuret, he pulled out another one. Despite the insane stuff happening, Charles yet again starts running towards David. How can Charles be not shocked by what's going on.

This time, David's Kuret storm shakes before Charles reaches him. My eyes widen when a third different Kuret comes out. This one was greenish with a hint of blue. I shout, what. My hands tremble a little with shock. That was my Kuret. Immediately, lightening flows out from in the air away from the Kuret storm. The lightening flies out straight and instantly strikes on Charles. He lets out a loud roar when he gets hit. We could feel the land vibrate a little from that lightening strike. Charles stunned from the attack falls on his legs and takes his arms to support himself.

I put my hands on my temple to support my burning head. What the freak is going on. Blake shouts, No way. This, this is exactly like what Marina did in my match. Blakes words triggered the memories of my own match. Yeah, he is right. Marina used her overdrive to throw multiple Kurets on both of us. Everyone turned their eyes to Marina. Marina twists her head swaying left to right from everyone burning gazes. She shook her head vehemently, don't look at me. I didn't do anything. David can't cast Kuret, remember. Whatever the freak is going on, its all David.

This is too much. For an instant I was hoping David took the help of Marina. But she was right, David can't cast Kuret. So what in the hell is going on. A ringing noise comes from Derek. Derek pulls out the tablet from his jacket. This was the same sound whenever Charles gets injured. Derek says in low voice, that lightening strike did a whole lot of damage than I thought. The current went through his entire body, his real body too. We should have been happy to see that one attack was so powerful that Charles got hit badly. Instead, everyone is too stunned to be enjoying this. A moment later I realized some thing about that last attck, that lightening strike was more power than mine. I could feel it from here that when David used my Kuret, it was very potent. I have never created a lightening this strong without any clouds. I was very sure of it, the sky is completely clear. There's nothing in the atmosphere to augment the lightening strike.

A moment later Blake also says, since you mentioned, that first Kuret he used. Ours, he points to him and Nathan, was also incredibly strong. David only used it for few seconds, but in that time the Kuret he used was too strong. It would take me much more time for me to throw a blast like the one he used. Nathan nods slightly, same. Its as if he is skipping many steps and directly using strong Kuret. Tessa asks nervously, this doesn't makes sense. How is he using our Kuret. Better yet, how is David using them at such a high level. Matt asks hesitantly, does it means his black Kuret is actually not only anti-Kuret. Its something else. Derek replies, no possible. David's Kuret is strange, but everything we know about it shows that its not compatible with Kuret.

Blake asks a little annoyed, so what does this mean. He can now use any Kuret. Mines, yours or anyone, like Matt's and Ned's bloodline. Derek didn't have an answer for it. Catherine says with a stern voice, it looks like we have new omega among us. Just think about it a little. Her words shocked us to our core. I thought she is just saying it because of his strange power. Then I recalled omegas like me and Catherine's, who don't have other people using the same Kuret, can develop sometimes unique abilities. My elemental control and her ability to change Kuret nature in her body.

I always knew David's power was strange. It would make even more sense if it was unique and he was actually an omega from beginning. Especially when we have not found anyone of the same bloodline as David. But there are too many flaws in that theory. He doesn't display any of the qualities of an alpha, let alone an omega. He doesn't heal, has no Kuret symbol on his body or even owns a bloodline marker. But then how is it that he has already bested so many alphas, against an omega, even against a true alpha in overdrive. He is now on par with a mythical alpha. If you ask someone who could do this, they would know it had to be someone like them.

Suddenly the intense silence after that comment was overwhelmed by the crowd breaking out of their haze of confusion. The whole stadium erupted in chaos. People were shouting, yelling and even jumping like crazy. Some were running downstairs, probably to get a better view. This was the biggest level of excitement we had seen. Marina was the first of us to go along with the flow. She begins to giggle and then it becomes to a full blown laugh. She becomes so hysterical that small tears from her eyes, I don't know if David's an omega or an alpha or something else. He is kicking Charles mystical ass. She bows her head a little, this is freaking ridiculous. Her emotions is becoming infectious. Everyone begins to break out of the confusion and joins her with slow laughs.

I couldn't help myself. I burst out laughing too. With so much happening with me and Ned, then with David, I finally hit my limit. I don't understand how David's doing this, but like Marina said, he is winning against Charles. Even the guys from Team Charles were laughing. Derek chuckles, just when you think you know someone. David surprises the hell out of everyone with something outrageous again. I replied with laughter, that’s just David. Matt and Cass raised their arms up. Cass shout, gets his furry ass, David. Matt shouts, freak him up.

Seeing their enthusiasm, everyone begins to join in. I shout out, come on, you crazy genius. Marina shouts after me, drag his ass out of here. Blake goes next yelling, show who's the boss now. Everyone shouts with such zeal, David must had heard us from here. Even if he did, he didn't showed us. Charles was already back up after healing from the shock. He just stood there for a while. I get another laugh out of this, yes. Finally, a real reaction from Charles. He must be thinking how to deal with such crazy attacks now. I know the exact feeling. When I fought against Marina's overdrive, I couldn't tell what was happening. At least with Matt and Ned, you know what Kuret they have. But its insanely tough to defend when you have no idea what's coming next.

But David wasn't going to wait. He already prepared for another Kuret. The Kuret storm throws out a new grey Kuret. Like a rocket it was thrown straight up to the sky. The Kuret explodes and throws a plethora of spikes of Kuret everywhere. The spikes fall like rain from the sky covering the entire arena. Some hit the barrier and they turn to dust. Others hit the ground in a barrage of continuous projectiles. Charles tried running away from getting hit, but the sheer number of spikes can't be outrun no matter how fast someone was. Charles growls when his body gets struck by dozens of those spikes. Meanwhile, David didn't need to dodge. The Kuret storm was protecting from any of the spikes falling on him.

Matt, who biting his index finger shouts out loud, holy smokes. What's the hell is this. Anyone knows which bloodline Kuret is this. Tessa replies with wide eyes, its from a bloodline in Tegna's nation. I don't know the name, but I remember someone in our family got married into. He must be using the Kuret from that bloodline. But this is not what had seen earlier. The guy was only able to create few dozens. Not hundreds. The tablet on Derek rings more. Charles is now pinned on the ground in a crouching position with his back to the sky and protecting his face and chest from the spikes falling. Dozen of the spike fall into those hidden traps and they land was getting buried there. Cass says, that’s take care of the those pesky traps. Derek says, not that it matters. David doesn't look like he doesn't plan to move always.

Few seconds later the spike rain ends. The arena is completed destroyed. With all the hidden traps from Charles gone, the ground was torn in various places. And now those Kuretine spikes created a land of spikes. They made movement for Charles incredibly difficult. Marina glees and says, nice. Charles will not be able to move freely. Derek replies, think again. Charles got up as soon as the spikes rain had ended. He was already on his way to David once again. He didn't wait to heal first. As he moved, he clawed all the spikes out of his way. He would slash, kick and even bite the spikes as he sprinted without difficulty. Derek says, the best this did is make Charles slower.

He's right. Charles cutting through those forest of spikes with ease at the cost of a little speed. Maybe that’s David plan. David throws another Kuret out of his storm. This one is a red color one and threw hundreds of thin

laser around the arena. This looked familiar. Jess shrieks a little, hey, he is using mine now. I am in complete awe. David's using so many Kuret in such successions, it's goes beyond even what Ned's bloodline can do. The red lasers when hit the spikes, they burst and disintegrates in a grey Kuret dust. One by one all the spikes were getting destroyed up in smoke. Charles halts his assaults when he gets hits with those red Kuret. I thought it would at least destabilize his Kuret body. But apart from the Kuritines disintegrating, nothing happened to his Kuret body.

Jess says, god. Even my Kuret is over powered. Nathan besides her says, and just look at Charles. He is completely fine. His Kuret body is incredibly dense. I can't believe how Charles is still so unaffected by all this. I mean, David's doing something insane, and yet Charles is just bulldozing everything thrown at him. The arena is temporarily covered in a thick smoke of grey Kuret dust. The visibility becomes near zero for few seconds.

Matt says, whoa. Whoa. This is nuts. Few seconds later the dust was clearing. Something even more unbelievable happened. David's not where he was few seconds ago. I looked over the entire arena, but no sign of him. I shout, were the hell did he go. Everyone panic at the sight of him missing. I even check the sky just in case, but it was clear, no sign of him flying. Blake yells, what the hell. The crowd behind us slow down their voices in murmurs of confusion. Soon the entire smoke clears. The whole arena is empty save Charles. Charles howls loudly. He begins to run in random directions on all four limbs. His tails waving around him.

Beside me Marina creates a charm. She then waves her over the entire arena. She freaks out a moment, holy shit. I can't sense him anywhere. Derek says, he has to be using a Kuret. I ask him disbelieve, a Kuret that even works on himself. Especially with that black Kuret storm. Derek puts his fingers on his forehead trying to figure out. He shrugs his shoulders when he couldn't find answer. Charles finally stops running around realizing he was getting nowhere like this. He growls and slowly his tails begins to grow larger. I shook my head and said, ah shit. Hear we go again. I knew what he was trying to do. He already done this in the match when he was trying to find David.

His tails grew to huge size once again. He then swings them around the ground sending them in search. Blake says, is he hiding in one those holes. I mean that’s the only place he can hide, isn't it. Think about it, those spikes reveled all the traps. He can now safety run without falling into them anymore. He is right. David must have jumped into one of them. Marina asks, even if he is inside one of them, I still can't sense him. I am not talking about his Kuret. I ran a body heat search too, the only signal I pick up is Charles. Derek turns to her suddenly, are you saying he is able to evade both physical and Kuret detection. Marina shakes her head with a big smile now, Yeah. I can't believe he has a way to avoid me too. A moment later she says, let me go into overdrive once again. I bet I find him then.

I put my hands on Marina, don't do it. Even if you find him, its not going to change the match in any way. Plus, you might knock yourself out over the exhaustion this time. We might need your help with the barrier or something like that again. So don't waste your energy. Marina mauls on my words for a while and nods slightly, yeah. You got a point. She then giggles, guess I got excited that whatever stealth Kuret he is using is so powerful that even I, with best Kuret sense, can't find him. Blake says, I feel you Marina. I can't even find him using aura. Can you Nate. Nathan turned his head around a little. He then brings his arm up in defeat, Nope. I can't believe what I am seeing. Or rather, not able to see.

Derek scoffs a little, that’s how he went undetected earlier. He used the same way when to visit other wing to scope out Charles. He smirks a little, not bad. Not bad at all. Matt says, whoa. Guys is it just me or the grounds becoming a bit weird. Everyone turns to the arena's ground. Even I could feel it. It was radiating Kuret, like a gas. It was coming from the entire arena. Marina shrieks, got him. She had a charm on her arm. It showed a small spot of black and violet color. Marina says, yeah, he is hiding in one of the holes. But whatever Kuret he was using to hide it's gone. He is using something else now.

Charles also figured out something was wrong. He stops his tails from flying in the air. He keeps them fly up in the air without touching the ground anymore. The violet Kuret was flowing out from the ground like a gas coming out of a busted pipe. Marina says, guys. Take a look at this. I turned to her charm. At the first glance, it looked like the violet Kuret was flowing in random directions. But then few seconds later I realized it wasn't random. Derek also realizes it, David is pushing out this Kuret using the path that Charles dug with his tails earlier in the match. He then turns away to look at the ground and says, he didn't jump into the hole just to hide. All the traps are connected underground. Even if some paths have crumbled away, a large number of paths must still be intact underground.

I asks, this is what, a delivery system for the Kuret to spread to over entire arena. Derek nods, yes. Maximum coverage. And the best part, David is doing this all from one single place. This all feels like a…I finish his sentence, David's strategy. It must be. Blake says, he used those spike to uncover all the hidden traps. Jess says, he used my Kuret to create a distraction. Marina says, and then he is using Charles own holes to use it against him. Hot damn. That’s one nasty plan he cooked up. Derek mumbles, like a chess master, he already has all his moves played out in his mind. Blake says, then against a player like Charles, who only fights with simple strategies... I say, David's got the edge by a mile.

Everyone on Team Charles had to agree that Charles is getting cornered now. Nathan smirks, I should really change my vote now. He turns to others who voted Charles, how about it. Whether he is serious or not, no one could figure it out. Just then a huge wave of Kuret appears on the arena. The violet Kuret coming out of the ground begins to join together to form huge crystals of Kuritine floating in the air. They were shaped into snowflake like design. I turn to Marina, what is that. I have never seen this type of Kuret. Marina waves her charm around the Kuret. I waited for her to respond. She closes her eyes to sense the Kuret. She says, I have never seen this Kuret. It going to take time analyzing it. Unless someone already knows what this Kuret is.

No one responds. David pulled out another unknown Kuret. Blake asks, un-freaking-believable. Just how many unique Kuret is David going to use. The crystals were forming all around the arena. They were all spread in random directions. One of the Charles tails swaying in the air comes in contact with one Kuritine crystal. The Kuritine shines instantly and without any warning explodes. The explosion blasted a large amount of Kuret around the origin and the tail that came in contact instantly disintegrated. Charles gowns loudly when his tail becomes cut so suddenly. The explosion created a powerful wind, I felt it hitting barrier in front of us. Matt cries with his arms behind his head interlocked, freak. Now we know what those Kuritines do. They are freaking bombs.

I gulp a little. The explosion was fairly far away from us, and yet it could be felt all the way to us. Marina says, well. I don't recognize which Kuret bloodline this belong to, but I can tell that the Kuret is highly compressed to form those crystals. And its incredibly unstable, it will explode like that when another Kuret comes in contact against it. Catherine asks, just where did he find these many crazy Kurets. Nathan asks, those bombs might be strong. But its easy to defend against. Look, Charles is already doing it. Charles remained still on his place and then brings all this tails around him. Those long tails avoid the crystals floating in the air and coils them around his own body. He starting wearing his tails around him like a extra layers of protection.

Jess says, well that is unexpectedly a little clever plan. Limiting his chances of touching and at the same time protecting against the explosions. Nathan says, yeah, and now that he knows where David is, we can just avoid them and attack David. I ask, will it be that simple. This is David we are talking about. Nathan couldn't deny and nods slightly. Charles begins navigating cautiously in those Kuretine bombs landmine and is slowly closing in on David. Unexpectedly, David himself comes out of the hole he was hiding in. His Kuret storm was still intact as he slowly crawls out.

Charles picks up the pace seeing him out in the open. Tessa asks, why did he came out himself. If he was buying time, he could have just stayed hidden. To answer her, David's Kurets storm begins shaking. A second later, a dark blue colored Kuret comes out. The Kuret flows out like a comet, its head covered in Kuret and then tail burning off the Kuret in its trail. David aimed it straight at Charles. I didn't feel any incredible power coming from that Kuret. Then something changes on the ground. The crystals floating in the air begin to move in the direction of the Kuret David just threw.

My eyes couldn't keep up with all the wild stuff happening. This left me in utter awe. The entire Kuritine crystals floating on the arena are pulled in by that dark blue Kuret and which was heading straight towards Charles. Charles tried to get run away. But there is no where to run. The Kuret comet hit him on his legs. And then the crystals follow behind. I realized this moment David's entire plan. The Kuritine crystals begins exploding on contact with Charles. But that was just one, like a hail of targeted bombs, dozens of Kuritine keep rushing in and exploding on Charles.

The continuous explosions shook the entire arena. The explosion even reached the barrier. The force created small dents on it. The explosion continuous on like fireworks. Under the sound of those explosions, Derek tablets ringed frequently. I was too engrossed with this spectacle to care about that. I couldn't keep track of how many bombs kept exploding on Charles. Everyone here were freaking out. Matt was yelling something inaudible to Cass. Everyone did. I too shouted at the top of voice to ask Marina how many more Kuretines are left. She couldn't hear me under the noise.

I was about to come closer to her ear, but then the bombing finally stop. The barrier vibrations slows down. The ground near Charles has turned into a mini creator. A huge dust cloud swirls around in the air. Charles is still not visible under all the dust. On the other hand David is still fine. He wasn't pulled in like those Kuritine bombs. His own Kuret must have protected him. Once the noises of explosion is over, a new wave of noise erupts from the whole stadium. People couldn't keep still after seeing such a thing.

I don't think anyone expected the match would turn out like this. I almost feel bad of Charles now. The tables wasn't only turned, it was broken completely by David.

# Blake (Chapter 30)

Monday, February 5, 2024 00:18

Freaking shit. Is this happening for real. Not one, not two but several Kurets were popping up in front of me. I felt all the hairs on me stand up in shock when he had first used my Kuret. Even though he only used half of my bloodline Kuret, it was still didn't make any sense how he did that. I rejected Cass's ridiculous thought that David is actually from the royal bloodline. But actually I couldn't dismiss it completely. Then he pulled out a another Kuret. That completely shattered any possibility.

One after another, he kept using others Kuret with such ease. Just what the freak is happening in the Kuret storm. I can't see any aura until the Kuret actually comes out of it. David had such a trick up his sleeve. Even when I laughed it out like others, I couldn't believe he didn't use it during our match. I don't know how much more tough it would have been, but it would have increased David's chances of winning. Derek's theory that it takes lots of time made sense. In all our previous matches, he never had enough time to prepare that Kuret storm. He spent almost a quarter of an hour fighting Charles to get this chance. Seriously, this was worth the trade off.

Once the bombing stopped. I turned to look over Charles. He wasn't visible, so I used aura to check up on him. He is lying inside that crater. He was lying face first on the ground. I couldn't tell how badly he was hurt. But then again I didn't need to. Beside me Derek's tablet had been ringing nonstop. Derek catches me looking at his tablet. He says with a surprised look, even with all that bombing, he still has his Kuret body. But he got hurt pretty bad. He got multiple injuries that are bleeding. I never imagined Charles taking such a beating. I turn back to the arena. The dust clears and shows Charles getting up on the ground.

His body is badly torn apart. There were scratches everywhere and a lot of his Kuret body was gauged out. All his tails were blown off. He stands up slowly and begins healing himself. What a freak. He sustained so many damages, and yet its not enough to bring him down. I said to everyone, I know we think David's winning. But lets not forget that Charles is somehow keeping up with these relentless attacks. Matt says, what the freak was that. I am still shaking you know. He is clearly freaking out seeing those many large explosions so close.

Vanessa asks Marina, check with M if David's okay. I saw he didn't caught up in any of those explosions, but just need to make sure. Marina nods and brings out the watch. M pops out with the holo of David. M says, orange critical mode still in effect. Boss vitals are holding steady. I don't detect any further injury on him. I detect slight increase in inflammations of muscles on his palm. But they are minor. Vanessa expression shows relief. I got an idea. I ask M, hey do you know how David is able to use others Kurets. M flashes a little and then speak, invalid authority. Information restricted.

I didn't think I would hit the mark. I ask with little impatience, come on. Its already out now. David is using it in front of the whole world. How is he doing this. M repeats the same answer. I gesture Marina to ask. Maybe David programmed M to reveal it to Marina only. Marina asks, hey. David gave you to me. So can tell me. She asks coyly. M responds, temporary user doesn't have authority outside the privileges given. Information restricted. I wave up my hands in air frustrated a little. God damn David, you really need to work on keeping your secrets. M blinks away the holo back inside the watch.

Nathan says, I am actually a little speechless. Not sure what surprises me more, David using so many Kurets or the fact that he isn't even exhausted already. Jess beside him says, don't forget that all the Kurets he is using are incredibly strong. What the hell was that last one anyway. I didn't know any Kuret that sucks in so many stuff. Catherine speaks with confusion in her voice, it doesn't work like that. It pulls in just the Kuret induced stuff in its vicinity towards that dark blue Kuret. Tess asks her, you know about that Kuret.

She nods slowly, my eldest brother had a friend from the bloodline. I have seen it couple of time when they used to hang out. But when I saw her using it, it was nothing like this. I mean, she could only pull in Kuret from very small distance. She used it to just collect tiny broken pieces of Kuret covered stuff floating in air. But this is completely on a different scale. David pulled in all those Kuret crystals from the entire arena. Maybe the alpha of the bloodline could do it. But considering David has been continuously using a powered up version of our Kuret, I have doubts if even the alpha could do it.

Marina spats out, shit. You are telling us that David turned a vacuum clear type Kuret into jumbo magnet of Kuretines. Freak. Catherine shrugs a little gesturing maybe. Nathan turns to Catherine, are you sure about this Kuret. Catherine nods, yes. I told you the scale of this too big, but this definitely from that bloodline. Why. Nathen had a tensed expression, because when you told about this Kuret power, I remembered the bloodline. But that’s not the issue. He turns to face David, that bloodlines extinct now.

Vanessa ask, what do you mean. Nathan replies, it means what I said. They are no Madrones with that Kuret anymore. I ask him now, how do know. Derek asks after me, and why does it matter. Nathan continues, I know they are not on alive anymore because I searched for them extensively when I was, ah, he nervously peeks at Vanessa, ah, during my research I needed them their help. I spent close to four month searching all over Earth for their Kuret signature. We never got any hit. Without their Kuret, we had to change our plans considerably. So that’s why I know they are now extinct.

His research. He is talking about the experiments he ran when is was ruling over the valley. Vanessa asks, okay. Even if that’s true, why are you talking about it. Nathan shook his head a little, don't you understand. I thought David is somehow copying our Kuret. I can't say how is boasting them, but I thought at least the bloodlines he is copying from are here. A moment later I realized what Nathan is getting at, you mean bloodlines that are here and alive. Nathan nods and a huge realization hit me, David is not only copying Kurets from bloodlines that are alive, he is even using the ones from that are extinct.

This made everyone tense up immediately. Marina shrieks, shut the freak up. Are you serious. Even I can't use Kuret from bloodlines which are no longer alive. Matt shook his head with eyes closed in horror, not just you. My bloodline can't do that, Ned's can't do that as well. I don’t think anyone can do it. Tessa speaks next with confusion in her voice, except for David then. The surprises keep coming like a wave. With each revelations of David's new power becomes even more mysterious.

Vanessa says, that’s where that complete confidence comes from. She looks at David, he planned this out from the start. Even if know we know he can use others Kurets, he can use extinct Kurets also. Meaning the next Kuret he pulls out his ass might be something people have forgotten or know nothing about. Its one thing to defend against what's going to happen after seeing the Kuret. But can what can you do when even after seeing the Kuret you don't know what it will do. Marina slaps her palm on her temple, freak this. She starts chuckling, I can't believe David's been holding out such a power this long. He kept it hidden right till the finals. Charles isn't the only monster now.

I had the same thoughts as her. He almost used it in our match. Even if had got back up, I don't think the result would be any different. I bit my teeth hard. Me and Marina are the only one know he remembers his past. Did something from his memories helped him unlock this power. But he told pretty much all important stuff. He said he didn't even knew he had black Kuret on Medrine. I know he didn't lie to us. Maybe he knows something about those extinct Kuret. But that would be just knowledge of their existence. How does that help him do this.

Everyone of us are shocked and excited at the same time. David has an out of the world power now. He is too strong for Charles now. Derek interrupts my thoughts, look, I have no clue how David's doing it. But nothing is all powerful. There are limits and weakness. I turn to him, what do you mean weakness. This is the ultimate power. He can channel into any Kuret he wants in existence. Derek shook his head, no. Not any or every Kuret is at his disposal. I been trying to figure his for some time. I don't have all the details, but I reached some conclusions. First of all, if he had access to all Kurets, why doesn't he just blows everything he got at Charles directly. Why did he make such an elaborate plan to corner Charles leading to that Kuret bombing.

He takes a pause and then continues, why doesn't he blows all the Kurets on Charles nonstop. The answer is because he can't. If he can do that, then match would be over by now. No one can defend against barrage of super charged Kuret attacks. I was actually thinking David should have used Heraknus Kuret to transform himself. That comment scared me a little. Derek continues, obviously he can't do it. Because his Kuret is still anti Kuret. But that made me realize, he can't use any Kuret that physically changes or augments his body in any way.

He made sense. We had apparently jumped the gun a little. I nod, yeah. I didn't think of that. Derek says, right. Also I bet he can't control the Kuret that comes out of his Kuret storm. David's hiding it every good. I also almost missed it. When he used your Kuret, he should have been able to redirect just to block Charles. But instead he threw the Kuret everywhere. I initially thought it was just because he didn't have time, but then later, the way he created those exploding crystals and use the extinct Kuret, I realized he has been always throwing out Kuret, like the white Kuret he threw in the beginning. He can't control any of the Kuret that comes out of his Kuret storm. I am sure David's choices of Kuret are limited.

I gotta hand it to Derek to be able to figure it out so quickly. While have been freaking out, he is able to remain calm enough to think things over. Vanessa asks, then it means he didn't control the lightening he threw. Derek says, yes. He just aimed at Charles. Same with yours, he faces Jess, if he wanted to destabilize the spikes with your Kuret, he should have only targeted the spikes on the ground, but he sent the beam in all direction. Marina says, so basically David is just throwing those Kuret around, making everyone believe he is using them freely.

Derek replies, exactly. Devious isn't it. I only figured it out just now. I ask him, so he can't use all Kurets or control them. I understand that. But they are over powered Kuret, right. With all that powered up Kuret, he can just aim at Charles or his targets. Derek raises his hands in air, I am only telling you what I think. I don't have a freaking clue on how he is using other Kurets let alone how he is giving them a boast. And even if we now know this, it doesn't make it any less dangerous. If David had used it during my match, I would have lost much quicker and even more spectacularly without a doubt in my mind.

Catherine says, shucks. I can't even image what I would have done if he pulled his out during our match. Jess chuckles, I don't even want to think about it. I am the same opinion as them. Even with those limits, he is still a freaking menace. Marina speaks, huh. So at least he isn't able to control those Kuret. Thank the gods. I was almost on the verge of collapse thinking my ultimate move was stolen. Vanessa asks, that's what worried you the most. Marina shrugs a little, well yeah. How would you feel if he was suddenly able to control the weather like you, huh.

Vanessa stammers at Marina's words, oh. I never thought like that. She got nervous a little. It felt like Marina brought up a sore topic for Vanessa. I understood a little how they both felt. Both of their Kuret are extremely unique, especially Vanessa with quintuple Kuret like nature. If David could copy hers or Marina's Kuret completely, their Kuret status would be no longer unique. Even I was almost felt sudden jealous at David when he used my Kuret. He is already strong with his anti-Kuret, he would practically be invincible if was able to freely use all our Kurets. Honestly, it's a relief to know David isn't eclipsing our powers completely.

Charles had finished his healing, meanwhile David hadn't made a move yet. Tessa asks, it's curious that David didn't attack immediately. Why did he wait till this long. Charles is injured. Shouldn't he be attacking right away. I suggested an answer, maybe he can't Kuret in successions. Vanessa offers another explanation, or he is trying to wear down Charles slowly by making him use his Kuret as much as possible. Derek says, you both could be right. Marina asks, but he would wasting his energy if he keeps this up. Derek shook his head, at this point only David knows what's he doing.

Cass says, that gorilla is doing something new again. Just then Charles growls. The Kuritine on his body begins to shine. His Kuret is physically coming out of his body. Gradually, his body begins to become bigger. With every Kuret coming out of him, more Kuret body was being formed. His legs grew, then his arms. His head and neck grew thicker. The jaws become longer. More Kuritine teeth grew inside his mother. He has undergone yet again a bizarre transformation. His tails is the only thing that didn't become bigger. He is now almost fives times the size now. Catherine shrieks, whoa. He turned into a Godzilla. It wasn't a total exaggeration. Charles is perhaps 40 feet tall now.

Vanessa asks to Derek, didn't you say that the Kuret becomes part of Charles body. Then adding more Kuret body won't backfire with that more pain when it gets blasted away. Derek didn't have an aware right away. He had his face hooked on Charles massive body, like the rest of us. Charles didn't just stop here, the Kuritines on his body grows more thicker and longer. As they grow they something different, they started to twist and bend. Whoa.

Slowly his entire body is wrapping in layer of Kuritine. They grew like ropes around him. Seeing this new form I said, David isn't the only pulling out total random and unexpected moves. Charles keeps coming with new ways. Its not the same, but I have to admit Charles is just as unpredictable. The crowd behind us creates a new wave of shouts and cheering seeing Charles large body.

Derek says after a moment, I have never seen Charles doing this. Tessa says, this is obviously to block all the Kurets David's throwing at him, but like Vanessa said, he is risking it all with such a large body. Matt says with a disheartening voice, this is exactly what happens when you corner someone. They become dangerous. Catherine asks, but why now. If he was capable of growing this big, why not do it early. I reply, you notice David's not using his black Kuret anymore right. Maybe David won't or can't use his Kuret with all the other Kurets. So Charles is no longer concerned about his Kuret body getting stripped off. Derek adds on, and David's hardly moved at all during his attacks. Even if Charles has become slow, he has gotten more edge now.

Soon enough, Charles gigantic body is now armored with Kuritines all over him like a armor. This new terrifying look has to be the most dangerous form Charles has taken. His Kuritines, long tails and Kuret horns seems nothing in comparison now. Charles roars, the voice comes out a bit different, much deeper and louder, due to so much Kuret body. He takes a step towards. As soon as he stomps the ground, the entire arena shook. Not just the arena, the entire stadium as well. Everyone becomes tensed seeing this. I could feel visible dirt vibrating off the arena as he keeps walking. My eyes move anxiously as his towering figure moves leaving mini quakes as he goes, what the hell. Tessa nervously suggests, ah guys, I think we should back away from the arena a little.

I think everyone thought like her for a moment. But Vanessa replies, if you want to leave, that’s fine. Me and Matt will be stay here to pull out David. Matt nervously looks at her, ah, we will? You want to enter inside where Charles could kill us with one step. Vanessa nods, Charles doesn't matter. All he got is height and weight. We can move faster than him and grab David. Matt didn't respond to her right away. The poor guy is actually terrified he had to enter the ring. I got an idea. I say, Derek, switch with Matt. At this point, even if Charles can see you, he won't be able to stop. So its better if two physical Kuret users keep an eye on David.

Derek probably thought the same, because he agreed almost immediately. He nods, yes. That makes sense. Honestly, I am not thrilled about stopping Charles as he is right now. Matt shrieks a little, ah, I don't know if I can help stopping Charles. I reply, you don't worry about that. You only need to support me by copying my powers now. Matt didn't looked convinced. So I add, I will go into overdrive if I have to. I honestly don't know if can do it. But maybe if push comes to shove, I might be able to do it for few seconds. Matt looks a little less nervous. He turns to Vanessa who nods, yeah. That’s fine. Derek and I can cover David. Matt nods and then he and Derek switch the places. Matt places his hands on my shoulder and copies my Kuret.

Matt speaks lightly, ah thanks. I know I shouldn't be wimping here, but come on. This is nuts. I nod in response, it's okay. I get you are overwhelmed. He faces to Charles now. Unlike the 3 of us, he isn't even an alpha. Its no wonder he's feeling out of place when Charles has become so dangerous. Nathan asks, yeah, that’s well and good, but what about our safety. He turns to Marina, that barrier is strong, but please tell me it will still hold if Charles attacks it.

Marina had been quite for a while ever since she saw Charles gigantic form. She had casted a charm unknown to us and been fiddling with something. She had a little frustrating look on her. She says, the Kuret on Charles is off the charts. I know he supposed to got an incredible amount of Kuret endurance. But this is just maddening. She turns to Nathan, the barrier will hold. But now I can't guarantee anymore. Jess asks her, can you make it stronger. Marina shook her head, no way. Even with other casters help, we can't add more layers to it. It will take hours and more preparation to make it stronger. Nathan scoffs a little, that’s not good. Vanessa says, do you know else is not what's not good. David is still not moving. He is standing in the same he has been all this while.

She is right, we are nervous, while David's behavior is totally opposite. He just stands there. We saw him move earlier with his stealth Kuret. Why doesn't he do that. With Charles so slow, he can easily run away with his Kuret storm. Meanwhile, Charles is dangerously close to David. There's like two more step between them now. David's Kuret storm finally goes into action. This time a purple shade of Kuret comes out. This one comes out a sheet of thin cloth and slowly unfurls in the air. What's this Kuret. I have never seen it.

Derek spats, again some obscure Kuret. The Kuret sheet begins to unwrap like a cloth and straighten out a sheet of large wall directly opposite Charles. Marina freaks out, is David really thinking to stop Charles with that thin Kuret wall. Charles takes his final step. His large arm raises in the air and begins to land on David's down on the ground. Because of his large frame, the punch takes time as it descends directly at David. But before the fist even comes below his waist, the large wall moves forward and hits Charles entire body.

I really thought the Kuret wall would stop Charles, but it broke instantly when it came in contact with it. Charles didn't even had to block or attack it, it broke on its own against his armor. Matt shouts, what the hell. The wall is completely useless against Charles. I see both Vanessa and Derek lean forward a little, readying themselves to get inside. I panicked seeing David still not moving away. What is he thinking, that wall didn't do shit against Charles. Then unexpectedly, the broken pieces of wall began swirling in the air. They started move, pieces were flying and joining together.

Just then David Kuret storm shouts out a greenish Kuret. The Kuret instantly turns into wall of thick ice in front of David. He used Vanessa's Kuret again. The punch comes in contact with that large iceberg. The ice breaks away in pieces as Charles fist goes through it. But the ice was too strong, Charles wrists stops just few inches from David. The surface of the ice is melting into gas at the contact. Charles large fist is covered in snow now. I let out a sigh, David managed to stop that. Charles slowly begins to pull out his hand back up. David finally made up his mind and backs away in hurry gradually creating distance from Charles.

Vanessa yells, damn him. I almost made my mind to get inside. Why did he wait so long. Good question. Derek beside her says, what's those broken pieces doing. The pieces were not only grouping, they were now forming into some shape. David while walking back in reverse, decides to throw another Kuret from this storm. This time he throws mine. Blue Kuret comes out filling out the entire space between the two of them. Just like last time, my Kuret is way too powerful in such a quick time. In fact, it’s the same intensity. What the shit. I had been thinking those Kurets power should be decreasing, but instead, they are at the same level.

David keeps filling up the space with my Kuret as he backs away. Charles didn't immediately return attack. He instead becomes wary of the Kuret forming a figure in front of him. David finishes off throwing my Kuret. He immediately throws out a new maroon Kuret that comes out like a beam. This one belongs to one of us here. Jess cries, what the hell is this now. He has now used both of Kurets. The Kuret beam hits my Kuret inside the air. The bean breaks at contact and turns into waves that mix inside.

Matt freaks out, what the hell is going on. David's is using so many Kurets suddenly. I couldn't believe what my eyes were seeing. I have never seen so many different aura coming off this strong, and all from a single source. Jess and my Kuret are now mixing in the air like paints thrown in a wall. On top of that, the Kuret wall pieces were shaping into a large figure around all the Kurets flowing in the air. Its almost at the size of Charles. Marina begins to laugh, freaking shit. Is that what I think it is. I couldn't ask her what she meant. But what's even more shocking about the situation is that David isn't done.

David continues to fire more Kuret. He shoots a Kuret of tortoise color. This one, again was one of our Kurets. Matt feverously asks, wait huh. What's my Kuret doing here. The most unexpected of Kuret came out.
And another paint gets mixed into our Kurets. But then this one creates a change in the amalgamation of our Kurets. Matts Kurets begins to change into my and Jesses Kurets. What the freak. I can't believe this. David is using Matts Kuret to turn more of mine and Jesses Kuret quantity.

I was sure this the end. How wrong I was. David fire off even more. This one was a grey colored one. The Kuret shoots out a web into the air. This one I knew. One of the participant used this Kuret. It can stick any Kuret into anything physical. But she only did it block her opponents Kuret in short intervals. This is nothing like that. The Kuret begins to covers the entire mixed Kurets filled in the air. Vanessa shouts, what the hell is David trying to create. Marina replies, I think I know what. Don't you see what that first Kuret David shot like a wall is shaping like.

I was too mesmerized by the sheer number of Kurets thrown here. When Marina said that, I began noticing some noticeable features of the pieces forming. A head, legs and arms. My mouth opens halfway in total shock. Matt raised both his arms up in air shouting, freak this. Even Charles is probably too stunned to react. He just stood there as another Charles made of purple color is forming. All the Kuret David threw later, mine, Jess, Matt and the last one were inside the duplicate Charles. The pieces were slowing becoming solid and encapsuling all the Kuret inside.

Suddenly another Kuret is thrown by David. I am too shocked already to be surprised anymore. This one is blue. But not my Kuret. It was shot like a large beam straight at the duplicate Charles. The Kuret breaks into smaller threads when it came in contact. This one spread across the whole body outside like a network of ropes. Soon enough the duplicate Charles begins to solidify completely. What David has sculpted is a perfect replication of Charles. The same height and size. The blue ropes acted like a cloth lining on the purple body. Some places on the surfaces had small holes, which showed my and Jesses Kuret.

Nathan says, freak. Now we have two gigantic beings inside the barrier. I am about this close to getting the hell away from here. I couldn't disagree. But even when after all this crazy stuff I asked, but that’s just a dummy right. How the hell is David going to make it move. Its just a statue of Charles. Right. I could tell my own voice is hesitant asking this. Against all expectations, David throws another Kuret. At this point he has crossed what's possible. No one person can do what he is doing. This Kuret threw like a bullet into the air. But it wasn't aimed at his creation. Nor was it aimed at Charles. It was aimed to the ground between the two Charles. Instantly the Kuret lights up and covers the arena and turns the ground into a shining white light. The white light begins to move on the ground. The light slowly begins to roll into a white line connecting the two Charles from the ground.

Another Kuret which I have no idea. The white Kuret finally turns into a single thread connecting the shadows of the two Charles. Marina shouts, freak. He actually used that. I turned to her, what. You know that white Kuret. She nods, yeah. One my cousins husband uses that Kuret. Derek asks, well, what the hell does that one do. Even Derek is clueless at this. Marina turns her lips to a nervous smile, well. You will know when you see it working. The statue that was still till now suddenly begins to move. My eyes twitch at that sight.

Cass shouts, freak. That scared the shit out of me. She wasn't alone. The duplicate Charles moved, but he didn't do much movement. Instead he like Charles is just standing. Then I noticed that shadow connecting the white light. I instantly recognized what just happened. I used my aura to confirm it. I see mix of too many Kurets coming off that Charles, but the way it moved. Its exactly like the original ones. I put two of my palms against the side of temple, god dammit. Its mirroring the original. That white Kuret is using the shadow connect their movements.

Everyone here are too stunned to speak. We kept waiting any more Kuret to come out. But none did. Finally, David is done. I let out a sigh and pull my hand, this is just insane. Vanessa says, get it together guys. She says that, but her expression betrays by showing clear panic. That was meant more for herself. Charles finally makes his move. Immediately the duplicate moves in perfect sync. Every movement of their stride and arm moves are exactly same, but in complete opposite direction.

They both move towards each other. Charles not showing any signs of stopping keeps stomping and shaking the earth. What's even worse, the shaking is now doubled. When David used my Kuret to create mass for the duplicate. With an equal if not more weight, the stomps of the duplicate was added to the originals. The whole stadium is now shaking hard. Even the barrier is vibrating hard. But this stop the people from going wild. They were making vibes of their own as they shout, scream and jump in excitement.

With both Charles covering the distance coming at each other, they cover the distance faster even with slow strides. Charles goes for a punch with his right arm. Duplicate Charles mimics the movements with its own arm. Its eerily too see two large figures doing the same movement mirrors. Everyone watches in awe they the two fist connects. The clash creates a loud boom of noise and the shockwaves reaches all the way to use from the barrier. Charles Kuritine covering him on the arm cracks a little in places. Meanwhile, the duplicates surface also cracks. But neither of them get serious damages.

Charles pulls his arms back and the duplicates does the same. Charles tried to turn and move away from the duplicate trying to move towards David. But Charles had to face harsh reality that your mirror reflections follow your exact movements. The duplicate copycats his movements and blocks his path. Matt yells, this is crazy. This is some next level shit. Charles can't attack David when he got this bodyguard. Vanessa shrieks, what the hell is he doing. I turned to David. His Kuret storm had finally broken down. The storm slowly disappears and the Kuret gets back inside him.

Tessa says, looks like he finally stopped. What an insane power he has using that storm looking thing. David started walking now. He turns his back to the two towering giants and slowly creates even more distance. He halts near a spot where there is a broken small boulder lying. He puts one leg on it, bending his knees on it and rests one elbow on it. He crouches a little forward and rest his chin on his palm.

Vanessa shouts with a small laugh, just look at him so leisurely chilling out like that. Even I had to smile on that ridiculous scene. His is just resting in that position while watching the two giant Charles duking it out. Nathan nervously asks Marina, ah, I know you said the barrier will hold with one Charles. How about now. Marina begins laughing nervously, to be honest, I am not sure anymore. Charles Kuret level is too much. But that duplicate is no less, both their combined Kuret strength…I can't imagine what's going to happen.

# Vanessa (Chapter 31)

Wednesday, February 7, 2024 21:55

I think its safe to say David has shocked the whole world with this. No one was expected the match like this. The match is already now past one hour. Almost the double of the previous record holder. What's even worse knowing that I am outclassed in every way as that the match is heating up every second. In my match, I was actually dragging it out, but this one is becoming increasingly dangerous and insane. Charles revealed another transformation that blows out all his previous ones.

Then David ones ups him again. After using so many Kurets in succession, he has created a duplicate of Charles. Arena suddenly becomes smaller when seeing two tall monsters fighting in unison. Charles kept trying to punch his way out. But every attack has been blocked with equal power. Charles even tried a head butt, only to became a dual head butt clash. The only thing that achieved is some Kuritines breaking on Charles and some cracks forming on the duplicates body.

I couldn't keep my thoughts in a single file. So much has happened in the past hour it, yet it feels we have been watching the fight go on for hours. The blows the two create keeps creating loud sounds. Few even created strong wind that blew away the dirt on the ground. The two kept going at each other non stop. Meanwhile, David had the nerve to just relax and observe the watch from the sidelines. This is not the first time in the tournament that a fighter fought from a distance. Many Medrones have Kuret that work over large distance or use substitutes to fight in some way. But this is the first time that one is just chilling outside the main fight without an ongoing effort.

Marina says laughing, just look at him. I would give money just to able to zoom on his face. Derek says with a big smile, you know what. That’s something I want to see too. Its not everyday you see something like this. Even on Medrine this would be standing out. Charles tried for a kick aimed to his duplicates stomach. The mirror copies it and stops it in mid air. Another sound of Kurets clashing fills the air. Jess asks, why doesn't Charles just stop moving. If he does that, that other one will also stop. Then he can just wait it out to lose Kuret. I can see Kuret leaking out of it slowly.

Derek says, the same with Charles. If he waits, he is using too much Kuret continuously for too long. Even he would tire out controlling so much Kuret. Blake says, so whether Charles fight or not, he is blocked from attacking David. I said, this has to be the most ridiculous thing David's pulled out from his bag of tricks. He first used multiple Kurets in succession, and now he combined multiple Kurets. Matt says, what the hell, is David a dual Kuret user on top of an omega now.

Marina laughs at that, nice one. Blake says, the juries still out on that. However David is doing it, he breaking away all the norms of how we use our Kuret. The two Charles attack each others fist again for the dozenth time. Its about almost 2 minutes this has been going on, and neither of the two Charles are stopping. They both have numerous broken Kurets on the surface. Charles wasn't healing the broken parts, I guess his healing is not included in his gigantification. The arena has become a ring for their boxing match. Charles couldn't make fast movies with his size, so he remained the same place for long time.

Charles tried a different approach. He brings both his arms up in air trying to grab his counterpart. I chuckle a little thinking what will that do. The counterpart did the same and now they both have each other arms locked in air. Charles with his mouth forward leans forward and tried to take a bite. The duplicate did the same. Before their mouths could crash into together into a wired kiss, their heads struck first and they come to a standstill yet again. Cass laughs out loudly, okay. This might be an instance match, but this is just too damn funny.

I couldn't fully deny her. Since David is unexpectedly sitting this out, I am actually relieved he isn't doing anything more dangerous. His new power is too much of a mystery for me, but I understood from Derek that he can't control those Kurets. That means he is not wasting any energy while the duplicate Charles is autonomously mirroring the originals moves. He really is just going to rest up until they both run out of steam. Suddenly Charles bending his knees and crotches down a little. He then gradually pushes up. He is trying to jump. My amusing mood came to a sudden stop.

I ask, what happens when Charles breaks away from his shadow. Before someone could answer, Charles leaps into air a little. I get nervous thinking that breaking away his contact with ground, his shadow would also break the connection. But the white light didn't break. The duplicate followed the original and they both jump with their hands and head joined. They both land back on ground even more earthquake. The ground on arena actually cracked in pieces and created mini creators on their feet.

Marina laughs once the ground stops shaking, that might have worked if he blocked the sun. You can escape from ground, but not your shadow. I have seen it few times used by my relative, obviously, not at this level. The only way to break the connection is to remove the shadow. Blake replies, which isn't going to happen in broad daylight. Marina nods, actually there are number of ways to break that white light, but none of which Charles can do. And just like that the giants continued to duke it out.

Catherine cries with giggles, check out David. I turn his spot. David had removed his elbow from his knees and is actually doing a slow clap with his hands. He is waving his entire arm and making a show out of this gesture. I couldn't stop myself from bursting out a laugh. No one could hold it. David behavior is not only showing arrogance but now blatant amusement at Charles helplessness. I tried to clam down, trying to reason that this is still a match and is still very much dangerous, but the comical scene is just too much for me. I blurt out, that’s the same guy who was unconscious just 10 minutes ago.

Blakes says, I can't believe he is so ballsy to enjoy himself in the middle of the match. David brings his hands down and then folds them into a cross. Marina yells, what the hell. Is he for real. Nathan says, freak you David. This too boring for you?. 3 minutes passed away like this. The two Charles were still going at each other. Even the people behind us were laughing at this. This match has been a roller coaster of my emotions. And now this. I was now even more mad at David for putting me through all this.

Both the Charles had gotten scratches from the continues attacks. Charles tried bunch of things to break out of this. He tried running back and running ahead faster trying to evade the imposter. Obviously, no matter how fast or slow he will go, the mirrored Charles would do the same movements. Charles tried next to grab boulders from ground and hurled at the imposter. This one had a better result since the mirrored Charles boulders crumbles more faster than Charles. The ground near the duplicate must be too damaged already. More pieces of ground hit the duplicate than Charles. This would be alarming that a weakness was found. But then those projectiles didn't do much damage on either of them. Even if more pieces hit duplicate Charles, the blue Kuret outside on the surface and that white sticky Kuret inside, both kept the body intact.

Matt says, holy shit balls. Is this not going to ever end. We are now at 4 minutes since this started. Blake asks Marina, every Kuret has limits. Just how long will that white Kuret last. Marina waves her hand on air, freak if I know. I analyzed the Kuret level of that connection. Its definitely loosing its consistency, but slowly. Like all the Kurets David's been throwing, this over powered one should have lasted only about half a minute at this size. Its lasted eight times more than normal. Its too unreal for me. If I wasn't here, I wouldn't believe that such a powerful quality was produced from someone other than the alpha.

Just then I noticed David moving. I call out everyone attention, guys, David's finally on the move. The situation is still tense that a single movement from David can change the direction of the match. I thought he is going to use his Kuret storm again. But instead, he used his normal Kuret flames. Matt exclaims, what. After all this crap, he is using something basic. David throws a Kuret line into the ground ahead and zips across the field. He aimed to the center of the two giants fighting.

Everyone got instantly regain their composure. David throws another Kuret line and drags further into their position. I am actually not happy seeing him heading straight into them. He should have stayed until the duplicate Charles broke down. But he must have seen his creation reaching the limit soon. The two Charles were now having too many damages. Charles Kuretines had broken in places revealing his skin underneath. Some even had holes on his skins. The duplicate also had torn purple Kurets. Those blue Kurets holding it together had been torn in places were hanging out like strings. Blakes and Jess's Kuret were leaking out more often now. Maybe they both of them have to a similar limit.

Charles sees David heading towards him and tried to grab him from the ground. Like a dutiful bodyguard the double blocks his approaching his hand. David didn't need to evade that. When he approaches to the side of the double, he throws a new Kuret line, straight up. Once reached some height, he slowed down a bit, but then immediately sends out another Kuret line up. Blake yells, whoa. Is that really his plan. I also understood David's intention. With a couple more Kuret lines, he gradually climbed up the duplicates body and finally lands near the neck.

I have no clue what made David do this. When he lands on the Kuret, his contact gradually begins to creates small cracks on the surface. His body naturally breaks Kurets. Yet he intentionally chose to do this. Nathans asks, what's the hell is he going to do now. Charles had his eye on David all the time. Once he saw David just standing on the neck, he tried to grab him in reflex. Of course, this isn't going to work out. The duplicate mimicked the same motion and stopped Charles.

Charles tried two more times, but he was just wasting his energy. Marina asks, what the is David trying to do. He is literally riding on the duplicates body. Then Charles stops attacking directly. He moved his own arm on his own neck. I instantly froze for a second. Shit, Charles realized he doesn't need to attack David directly. Since the duplicate is copying him, he can just grab David my gesturing on his own neck. I was a little worried about that when David first landed there.

I almost thought to ran inside the barrier thinking David would be grabbed by his own creation. Just before the arm would reach him, David throws a Kuret line angled down to the ground. He aimed his Kuret straight into the spot with the white Kuret is thinning out. His black Kuret lands on the Kuret on ground and cuts the connection. What. David cut the connection himself. Charles claws reached his own neck trying to grab empty air. However, with the connection gone, the duplicate couldn't mimic the movement. The arm is frozen in its place.

Jess says, whoa. That was a close one. David broke it himself. Derek says, the Kuret was weakening right. So it was anyway not efficient anymore. Marina nods, yeah. Its been running almost 5 minutes, I could sense it would going to break after maybe another minute. I ask, if there was another minute, why did he risk climbing and cutting the connection sooner. Matt says, yeah. Doesn't makes sense right. Blake then says, ah, this is David we are talking about, he has been doing outrageous things for more than half of the match.

Nathan says with a little nervous look, you mean something like this. David's Kuret is expanding. His is making his flames move like snake around the duplicate. Matt cries, holy shit balls. Don't tell me he going to do that. I thought I had my fill of surprises, but hell no. David is pouring his Kuret all around the duplicate like strings around his legs, torso, arms and neck. The black Kuret was creating even more cracks on contact, but the body is still holding for the moment.

Soon David's Kuret covered all the necessary joints on the duplicates body. David himself had sunken a little on the neck. But now he had vines of black Kuret covering the entire purple surface. Marina laughs with her arms up in air, this is absolute nuts. This is just too unrealistic. For some brief time, David's black Kuret and other Kurets are working together. Charles now free from the lock he was on for so long begins to attack with a punch.

The arm that was raised to grab David moves. Freaking hell. David is actually controlling the entire body with his Kuret. The arm intercepts the path of the punch. David had made few black vines on hand, he used them to open the palm and catch that punch. Then with a swift motion, he raised his other arm from below with a fist. Charles had been fighting too long with mirrored attacks. He couldn't prepare for a move that wasn't his. The fist hits square at Charles chin.

The punch broke the Kuritines on that area, with the black Kuret wrapped on his fist, even the skin was broken in. But that wasn't the shocking part. The weight of that fist was apparently too much. Charles was thrown back from that force. He was close to the barrier near, his head crash against the barrier. The contact begins to siphon off the excess Kuret off Charles. David doesn't stop there, he goes for a kick from the base of the foot.

The foot moved a little wobbly as it rises in the air. David has never manipulated such a big body before, he obviously doesn't have fine control. But he didn't need it. With such a size, the body would land its target anyways. Charles is trying to stop his fall by trying to grab on to the barrier with both arms. Wrong move. The barrier not only is siphoning the Kuret on contact, its even repelling back a little. The barrier begins to wobble now. Its stretching and showing visible bends on contact.

The kick from the duplicate lands straight at the Charles chest. Charles body gets pushed back even further. His entire back is in contact with the barrier. Derek says, he is trying to make Charles lose Kuret as much as possible. Marina laughs nervously seeing the two of the duking out, look, I am not responsible if they continue like this. Had I known this was going to happen I would have used all my Kuritines to make the barrier. Blakes says, its okay. Looks like its holding.

I ask, for now. But look at the two kaiju's. Blake says, David is also on the same boat. His Kuret his constantly creating more cracks on that surface. Is he trying to maintaining the status quo with a draw. Derek says, possibly. I didn't see him seeing us, but he must have noticed when we tried to test that barrier. Catherine asks, so he knew this barrier sucks off Kuret on contact. Derek nods, I am not sure. But look, his is trying to pin Charles against the barrier.

Charles falls on his ass at the edge. He tried to get up, but then David had prepared for a blow with both the hands joined. He brings down the fist straight at the chest again. The same spot. The hammer fist caused another loud noise inside the barrier. Charles back gets pushed even further. I say, David's trying to pull out Charles from his Kuret body. Derek eyes widen at that realization, whoa. Your right. He must have located Charles real body inside that.

Charles back was dangerously getting his Kuret siphoned off. The barrier behind him is wobbling, but it managed to remain intact after absorbing that Kuret from Charles. With David covering the fists with his Kuret, the Charles chest is even more exposed. The last punch created a large whole. At that point David lets of the Kuret controlling the body. He crawls of out the sinking neck. I am too much in haze to do anything at the movement. David kicks off the neck and falls from the duplicates body. The body was leaning forward and begins to fall on Charles.

David's Kuret around the body comes off like smoke and begins to go back inside David. As he falls, David throws a Kuret line to the air and begins to swings down slowing his fall. Charles tried to block the falling body on himself with this arms, but the duplicates surface had too much damage that it began breaking. First the blue Kuret becomes undone and then purple surface. This spilled out all the Kurets holding inside onto Charles. The grey sticky Kuret begins to spread out along with Blakes and Tessa's Kuret. Charles hands gets covered in all the Kuret, and soon all the Kurets gets spreads on his upper body.

Unbelievably, just as the duplicate body gets dismembered into Kuret pieces, David lands on the ground on his feet safety. David turns keeps his back to Charles and then makes a showy gesture of cleaning his hands like his job is completed. The people who had been shouting in excitement were even more animated seeing him like this. Everyone were half amused and half shocked at this display. I even let out a little laughter seeing David do that. Charles is stuck against the barrier, while David softly landed. Soon all the black Kuret comes back in David. Blake is the first one to speak out, that was something else. Marina giggles, that was epic. She makes a gesture with her fingers showing an okay sign.

Derek who is in a daze says, this is not only epic, but a also strategic plan. Just look at Charles. I turned my eyes to Charles. His entire body had been covered with Kuret mixed, but that’s not all. The grey Kuret had made Charles stuck to the ground. His entire lower body is now stuck to the ground, his arms as well. Only his upper body and neck remined free. But the back of the body was constantly getting zapped from the barrier. Charles should have been able to free himself with his size, but Blakes and Jess's Kuret were still sticking against Charles creating a pressure from its weight.

I had forgotten how many times I have been shocked in this match, yet still couldn't believe this happened. Even with such an enormous body, Charles couldn't defeat David. A new unexpected feeling came from me. Fear. That and complete new respect for him. David has broken past all his limits in this match and leveled up unbelievably. I couldn't take my eye off him during the whole ordeal. David had become tired and was crowing down with his hands on the knees.

Nathan says with smirks, David's exhausted huh. That little, actually big, stunt must of sapped all the energy he had stored up since he woke back up. He is right. David might have shown out of the world capabilities, but he isn't immune to fatigue. He had to be reaching the limit. However, M hadn't showed up once during all this. It meant he is not at any grave risk. Blake says, what's Charles going to do now. His body is stuck right, shouldn't he just ditch it now.

Derek says, not so easy. He feels the pain from his Kuret body right. He risked awful lot making himself so big. The blowback of cutting of the Kuret would be too much for him. He didn't even cut the tails himself in the middle of the match when David was cutting it up in pieces. He will likely wait until the Kuret tying him is gone and he frees himself. Matt asks, even with the barrier is continuously cutting away his Kuret? Derek nods, unless he does something unexpected, Charles can't avoid it. David planned this one also very carefully.

I have to admit David has been almost unstoppable since the second half of the match. Ever since his Kuret threads and exploding Kuret, he had slowly been gaining on Charles. And now, David might have pulled ahead finally. All of Charles attacks have gone unaffected. The only way David would lose the match is if he forfeits himself or gets too much exhausted. But he already said is not going to quit. David straightens up and stands for a while facing Charles body.

Blake says, oh. Is he going to pull another Kuret storm. Everyone turned their attention to David. David is once again preparing a Kuret storm. But this time something has changed. He isn't making it bigger. Instead this one his just around his height. Nathan asks, what happened. Did the fuel run out of tank. Blake reply, is he really though or is he making it smaller on purpose. We couldn't say for sure. David takes a while to prepare it. But since it is smaller, the Kuret is rotating faster and shrinking quicker.

About a minute passed and David had prepared a smaller Kuret storm. I thought he would attack immediately, but then he begins walking. His pace is slow, but he had the time. Charles had been struggling against the restraints, but the Kuret still hadn't loosed its strength. David makes his way from the side where less Kuret surrounded Charles. He halts when he gets close enough to the hole he had gauged from Charles chest. The Kuret storm finally shakes and then a Kuret comes off it.

It's a orange colored Kuret. This one came out like machine gun, firing off dozens of small but incredibly fast Kuret shaped bullets. Nathan says, hey that’s the same Kuret I fought against early in the matches. I remembered. Nathans opponent had a Kuret that fires off in small but fast projectiles. And just like always, the number of projectiles coming off is way more than then. Few seconds in, David stops the assault. The hole he fired on became more bigger. It something is now exposed out.

It's Charles. His normal Kuret body from the neck up is completely exposed. Matt shouts with a loud laugh, freak. Charles looks those people who are buried in the beaches. He is not that far off. The rest of Charles is still inside that gigantic body, only his head popped out. I say, David must have targeted with his Kuret to just have his head exposed. Blake nods, definitely. But what's he going to do now. Then David prepares for another Kuret. This is one is pink in color and flows out in the air like a gas.

Seeing that color made me recall the hideous scene that happened couple of years back. Nathan had captured Blake, Matt, Catherine and Cass. Nathan used that Ruby alpha girl with her seduction Kuret. This is the last place I expected to see it again. Blake exclaims, what the shit. Isn't that Ruby's Kuret. Nathan smile had gone now and replaced with shock, yes. But why is David using it. I can't believe he is resorting to such nasty Kuret. The Kuret flows in air and soon covers Charles face.

Matt suddenly bursts out laughing, holy balls. Is David going to ask Charles to drop out. The comment took everyone by surprise. I nervously ask Derek, is that even allowed. Derek face looked like he had a huge problem to solve. Few seconds later he says, I think yes. Even though Charles does it against his will, he is under a Kuret influence. Marina yells, hell yeah. This is such a classic David move. Make his opponent drop out. I don't like the Kuret he is using it, but whatever. Whatever gives him the win I am in.

Nathan nervously asks, even if Charles obeys and drops out. Would the guys upstairs consider it. I mean they allowed a stupid loophole, so what's to stop them again. Blake says, but its in the rules that if you make the other opponent drop out anyway you win. Tessa says, sure. But I think we have been thinking dropouts in forms of something like keeping them outside the arena for more than 2 minutes. Or keeping them constrained until they give up. Will it be even considered a drop out when Charles says its unwillingly.

I wanted to believe this would end with Charles declaration, but I also know both David and guys upstairs are not going to make the match end like this. David stops the pink Kuret. Charles couldn't stop the Kuret in air from flowing into him. Charles tried to turn his head away, but unfortunately, this Kuret doesn't need to be inhaled. It will be absorbed through skin. Now that even this hideous Kuret is boasted, it would be more effective against Charles.

Suddenly David storms shakes. Another Kuret flows out like a gas. This one is green in color. I didn't recognize this one. The green one also slowly spreads out in the air above Charles. The air is filled with two types of Kuret. I turn to Marina, what's up with that green one. She says, give me a sec. She draws a cast and waves her around to sense it. A few seconds later she says, whoa. I have heard about it, but never knew it actually existed. Sheesh. What is David planning to use this one for.

Derek asks curiously, what is it. Marina replies, believe it or not. It's something like truth detection. Instead of working on your heartbeats, it attaches to the Kuret inside your blood and detect lies. Nathan spats out, seriously. There's a Kuret like that. Marina shrugs, I guess. I have only heard from my grandfather about this. This is highly unreliable since the Kuret reacting to lie is not easily detected or reliable. I shook my head, not for David. He can use his synesthesia to check for lies. Like the way he tell our lies.

Derek asks, okay. But why would he use a compulsion Kuret and a lie detecting Kuret. If he is just going to make Charles drop out, what's that got to do with Charles lying. A thought came to me, Marina. Is there a way to hear their conversation. Marina looks at me, seriously. Isn't that against the rules or something. She turns to Derek. He takes a moment and says, if we don't speak to David, we are fine. But its better if we keep to ourselves. I don't want Kafar to know we are doing this.

Marina nods, okay. I can actually use the barrier as a medium and skip making any complicated charm. She starts to create a new charm. David stops the green Kuret a while later. Suddenly, the Kuret storm breaks apart. Blakes says, that’s it. He was only able to use 3 Kurets with that one. Derek nods, yeah. Looks like if he makes the storm smaller, he can't produce much Kuret. David then starts walking towards Charles. And then without waiting for a second, he begins climbing's his body.

I hurriedly ask, Marina how long. David's heading to Charles now. Marina replies, I know. I know. Just few more seconds. David didn't even need to use his Kuret for making foothold. The Kuret on the surface was mostly Blakes and Jess's Kuret, they were crumbling slowly on contact giving David enough room stuck his foot and hands. He reaches the top with ease and walks on top of Charles uninterrupted. He walks near where Charles head is exposed . He then leans down, takes a knee and rests his hands on his things.

Marina shouts, done. We can hear him now. Everyone walks closer to Marina in anticipation. At first we heard only some hushing noise. Then I realized that’s David's and Charles breathing. Few seconds later David's voice comes out from the charm, didn't expect this to happen huh Charles. I'll be honest, I didn't think I was going to make it few times. I went through some crazy stuff figuring out my Kuret. But I do have to thank you though. If it weren't for you, I would have never figured it out. And because of that, I have improved significantly. I can't believe it worked out like this almost perfectly. You really screwed your Kuret when you went into Kuret blackout a second time huh.

David's talking they were already buddies. He continues, you even tried to hide it when you created this massive Kuret body. That was a little unexpected. But that just confirmed me that your Kuret control has plummeted hasn't it. Constantly losing Kuret and repeated healing has taken a lot of toll on you. You tried to hide by doing something reckless. I won't deny it wasn't my luck. But I actually did plan to use a clone of you from the beginning, but with your size, I had no choice but to increase the scale of the Kuret attacks. That drained me completely you know. David takes a big breath, we both are in the same boat you know. I am totally exhausted and your Kuret controls for shit.

He continues after a sigh, so how about it Charles, what is your weakness. Tell me how I can beat you right now.

# David (Chapter 32)

Thursday, February 8, 2024 20:27

I never expected my Kuret blast would go wild like this. The moment I fired off the white Kuret out of my newly powered up Kuret storm, I knew I couldn't turn off the output. The power is so much that I couldn't stop it with my own Kuret. I managed to blast Charles away before he could attack me, but I had a new problem. The barriers going to break. I couldn't stop the white Kuret and Charles would probably be thrown out into the crowd. In a desperate attempt, I thought a way to get out of this situation. I had been making a counter balance with my Kuret storm, I turned it off slowly making me push back towards the barrier. To this work, I would also break the barrier this side. This is definitely shatter the entire barrier.

I hit my back against the barrier. It begins to fizz out a little and then begins to crack under the pressure. Shit. I need to hurry up. I tried to push my Kuret up. I took a lot of effort to change the Kuret beam. I had no idea my new Kuret transformation would become this powerful to create this strong Kuret. Slowly, I make the white Kuret beam move up. But the barrier behind me is going to break soon. The I saw two glimmers approaching me from the side. Its Vanessa and Matt. They must be here to get me out. It was my luck, they could help me out. Ahead me Charles is slowly pushed upwards against the barrier. Just some more height and he will be above the stadium. On the other side, others have begin to clear out people.

It is actually a miracle that no one got hurt. Once Vanessa and Matt got here, they helped me out just in the nick of time. Charles was thrown far outside the stadium after seconds of my own exit. I had to take emergency action when Vanessa's Kuret tornado pushed me into air. I couldn't risk breaking any bones or getting seriously injured so I covered part of my body with Kuret and willed it to push up. I barely managed to land on Matt like an air bag. I felt a little guilt for using Matt like that, but this had to be done. Charles isn't down yet. The match will continue.

Our conversation made me realize others had also picked up a little on Kafar's intention. I get even more confirmation that this match will not end in any other way except for a clear victory. But that’s all right. I have already made up my mind that I am going to win this no matter what. My new overblown confidence had definitely shocked them. When Vanessa told I will die if continue this I contemplated a little. Its true that I am being very rash and brazen. But I can't stop now. Not when I am so close to shutting down Charles for good. So I gave her an answer I think she wanted. I didn't want to deceive her, but I was sure if spoke freely she would interfere with our match. I don't want others to get caught up this.

The truth is I am not going to forfeit this match no matter what happened, even if its dangerous. Hansen and Brandon, their words had an unimaginably hold on me. At the beginning I was surprised at myself, but then it started to feel right. Like I am beginning to own my thoughts. It like something weighing me down had been finally broken. I am not just Ryzen, or David from Earth. I am both and more now. And Charles has given me the perfect stage. I already showed one part of this power. And now that I got a first hand experience of how powerful this has become after my Kuret transformation, I am both prepared and excited.

Charles had barged inside the arena and chose to wait out first. Good. I need will get the time I need to prepare the Kuret storm again. As I focused on making my Kuret storm, I caught glimpses of new people gathering at the edge of barrier. Now that people were safely evacuated, others came back. Now in toe will rest of the gang. For some reason Ned left them. I guessed he must have went to get on top with getting this match continue streaming world wide. The whole VIP room is now here, except for Ned and Kafar. I bet Kafar got shocked with I threw Charles outside.

But the real shows about to start. Now that I have decided to reveal my full powers, I won't pull any punches. I have kept reaffirming my drive to win, but I know its not going to be easy. The set of Kurets I will pull out will seriously impact the flow of the match. While we waited for the match to resume, Charles focuses on healing his body and I on my Kuret. Soon Kafar himself came and made an announcement about continuing the match. I was right when I thought they would call out both of our violations. However, it’s a little surprising to hear that they are chalking it up to accidents. The only accident was my last attack with Kuret blast. No way people will believe all the stuff Charles did or the arial attack I did were just accidental. We both were intentionally doing them.

But it doesn't matter what actually happened if we don't deny Kafar's words. People will choose to believe him in the end. And its not like we both were going to admit it anyways. I could tell both us wanted to keep going without interruptions from others. Once the barrier was set, our fight is going to resume any second. With all this available time, I had figured out on the best way to make my new Kuret work. I can't be sure, but its possible I might be able to create dozen or so Kurets. I have never been to create to beyond 4 or 5 Kurets. So this is my biggest creation yet. And the glimmers of the Kuret coming from inside is the most pure Kuret I have managed to create. So the Kurets I fire will have to be strongest too. I couldn't help a smile at this realization. The Kurets I am going to fire is on par with alphas or omegas, perhaps even more powerful.

I want to win this no matter what, but I also know I can't be reckless. I need to make sure every Kuret I use has a purpose in bringing down Charles. That means I need to make a strategy to makes sure I don't waste needless energy and prolong the match any longer than necessary. If I has not exhausted myself already this much, I would have come up with dozens of plans. But right now my options are very limited. I don't have the energy to move around and pretty sure I can only make another Kuret storm of this size one more time.

So lets plan this carefully. I began devising my strategy into three parts. The first one will be to make Charles lose as much as Kuret as possible. He doesn't know what's coming next, so he won't be able to prepare all my attacks. It will also help with learning my Kuret control. I have never tried to fire this powerful Kuret before. I need to get some degree of control before the final phase of my plan. And If I can get in some serious hits that drops his endurance while I try to figure my Kuret, that would be a good bonus.

Then, the second part is to somehow trap Charles long enough for me to extract the information from him. I knew from beginning that figuring out his weakness is going to be extremely hard if not impossible. It would be a different case if he was from a bloodline that was relatively known. But Heraknus has been considered almost extinct in Medrine history. So far, the only weakness he has shown is those Kuret blackouts. But are they really a weakness. Sure, if he were fighting multiple people he would most certainly defeated. But in a one on one, its not the same.

During his first Kuret control, he was able to keep his body stable, even if his Kuret control had taken a hit. It may have looked like I was keeping up with him because I somehow managed to use those Kuret sparks. But he managed to bring his Kuret control back in minutes. Then the second time. That was just me being incredibly lucky. I got in several hits before his Kuret got out of control. If hadn't made those blows, or had been slower, he wouldn't have had this much trouble. He would have at least be able to move like the previous time. And then I would have lost without a doubt because I was completely helpless for so much time. So I am really sure this is not his real weakness. Maybe it could be part of it, but there has to be something else.

I don't have the time nor energy to figure it out during this match. So I should just take the easy route and just ask him directly. I will use the compulsion Kuret to make him tell his weakness. I also thought to back it up with a lie detector Kuret to make sure he isn't lying about it. I had a small thought that I could just force Charles into quitting. Even if I set aside my pride of winning like it, I highly doubted Kafar and the mystery people backing him would just let this end. They will argue that Charles was made to say it unwillingly. If I wanted to, I can counter it by telling them so many others have already tried it and some won in a similar way. That conversion would be highly controversial. So its pointless to think about it when I can't guarantee wining like that.

The final phase of my plan is actually a blank right now. Once I know Charles weakness, I will use my last Kuret storm to defeat him. This is not even a plan, just a regular guide for anyone wanting to win. But I didn't want to make any unnecessary assumptions or conclusions until I hear it from Charles. If I make some strategies just from some half baked clues about his weakness, it will instead me who bites the dust. I do have some a rough outline of might need, like evading, trapping, attacking or blocking against him. But I will not make any real plan until I have more critical understanding of what makes Charles tick. In this case, no plan is the best plan.

After a while Marina fly towards us. She is in overdrive when she lands on the center of the arena. A green Kuret erupts from her and it expands in all direction. I could see strong glimmer coming off the barrier, it meant this is way tougher than the last one. That’s good, I don't need to worry about people's safety for now. The green barrier zips past through me, even though my Kuret storm should have completely shattered it, the hole instantly begins to close behind me. Marina kept her end of the deal. She must have used most of her stash. I know what she will ask her in return. I actually think she is ready for it after seeing her fight against Vanessa and Blake. I haven't given her yet not because she isn't worthy of it, but because she wasn't ready yet. But now, she needs it to become even stronger.

I gathered my thoughts to focus on Charles now. Any second now, the match will resume. In the corner of my view, I saw the glimmers of others testing out the barrier. Nathan couldn't put a dent on it. Blake and Derek managed to only bend it a little. But what's more important is I saw the glimmers of their Kuret getting absorbed by the barrier. This is one impressive barrier Marina constructed. And one that I plan to fully use it for myself. Charles body is made up of Kuret, it would be really bad for him to get hit by that barrier. I changed my second phase of the plan accordingly.

Then finally the moment came. Kafar made his announcement and Charles made his move before he could finish it. Its actually understandable. Charles must be patently waiting and healing all this time, he can't wait even a single second anymore. I couldn't say that I had the same outlook. I wished I had more time, but I can work with what I got. The first Kuret I chose was Blakes. I bet no one expected me to use their Kurets. Would the be surprised or shocked. Maybe both.

My first phase of the strategy went not to bad. What I planned on how it would end did happen, but there were few changes I had to during the batter. Some Kuret worked even more better than expected. When I used Vanessa's Kuret, I had no way of knowing what will come out. It could have been wind, fire, water or ice. But it was lightening that came out. I honestly wasn't expecting that. Some worked less effective than others, the Kuret spikes I had laid out should have bought me more time. But Charles just powered through the arena. I knew that this wouldn't stop him, but his movement wasn't as restricted as I had hoped. That’s why I had to resort to use the stealth Kuret I didn't initially include it in my plan. This one is incredibly powerful, but because I have to use it continuously to hide, I would be using too much Kuret.

Nevertheless, I did manage to create those Kuret crystals in time before Charles could find me. I wished I could spare more Kuret to create even larger number of those bombs, but I need to save it for other Kurets. Once I hit Charles with the magnetic Kuret, I had finished the first part of my plan. And boy did it turn out pretty well. The bombardment had done a whole lot of damage on Charles. I could see from the glimmers Charles kept his Kuret body healing in overtime to reduce the impact. If he hadn't, the Kuret bombs would have struck his real body. Its actually crazy that Charles managed to survive at the end without serious injury. The only other people I think could make it out from that is, Blake, Marina and, well me.

I was hoping to at least incapacitate in some way. But his endurance is beyond rational. How deep does his Kuret supply goes. When all the dust clears, he is already healing all the places where red glimmers were coming from his body. I didn't let this stop me though. My first plan wasn't to drive him into corner. It was to cut down his Kuret as much as possible. And even though he still has Kuret in reserve, I must have made him use a big portion of it. Additionally, I got bare minimum handle over my Kuret attacks. I wasn't sure how my Kuret storm would hold out in this new form, but I managed to work without relearning everything from the scratch. So that’s good.

However, there is one weakness I just realized. After using about half a dozen Kurets, the Kuret inside has become a little unstable. I don't know exactly how it happened. I kept the rotation, vibration and everything in near equilibrium. Maybe its because I am too tried, or I don't have full control over it yet. Whatever the reason, its good I noticed this limit now. I kept focusing on making it stable while Charles is healing his body. That’s the next hitch in my plan, I wanted to keep on the assault on his weak body, wear him even further. It is what it is. I am have been extremely lucky that my first time experimental Kuret has hold out this far. My Kuret might be resonating with my emotions, who knows, at this point anything is possible.

While we both waited, I saw glimmers of everyone around us with total confusion and more excitement. The people closest to were even laughing at one point. Can't say I didn't see that coming. Once the shock is over, the next thing is laughing at such a ridiculous power. Marina must be freaking out right now. I figuratively and literally stole her power. Well, to be fair I only stole an idea from her after seeing her match with Blake. Obviously I can't use other Kurets like her, Matt or Ned. Would they eventually figure it out this weakness. Maybe they already do.

Some time later, Charles healed his body. But the problem is the Kuret inside is still not stable. With this amount of Kuret, its going to take a bit more time. Coincidently, Charles didn't attack me next. I could the Kuret glimmer on him behaving weirdly. It’s a little slow and not efficient anymore. He still had the same amount of glimmer is see on him. But its like his control on his Kuret has become difficult. I wasn't imagining it. I looked all around him and could see slivers of glimmers slipping out of him which doesn't happen unless my Kuret comes in contact.

This made be happy. My plan had cracks, but unexpected results sometimes gives new opportunities. After loosing so much Kuret, Charles has lost some control over it. All my attacks, from my Kuret, his blackouts and now this. It must have finally pushed past his limit. This is great, he is loosing steam. But that doesn't mean I should be reckless. He has only lost quality, but not the quantity. He might be become even more dangerous in his attacks now in his state. And it turned out to be right. Even after healing, he didn't stop adding Kuret. Gradually, he kept on adding more and more Kuret on him. Like a balloon getting pumped with air, he grows into a completely five story building.

Damn. My gaze move slowly up has his figure grew in height. He didn't stop just there, he even started cover himself with his Kuritine. Instead of sticking it out like spikes, they began curving on the skin and began covering all over him. He made himself a Kuritine armor. If it was me just an hour ago, I would have been in a would of trouble. But now, I could only think how I will relish in the idea of beating him down. Charles took a good decision in choosing this Godzilla form. I am not moving much like most of the match, plus all my attacks are others Kuret and not mine. He decided to risk creating a bigger target for defense and power.

There is no doubt in my mind that Charles is fighting such a way to hide that his Kuret control is not as good as before. I could see the Kuret glimmer coming out of him everywhere, but he assumes that everyone interprets that’s just a by product of his massive size. But I notices his Kuret behavior way before he transformed. Too slow Charles, I am not so naïve to not notice it. This development is both good and bad. The good part is huge Kuret body is now a part of him, so he can't discard it like when he didn't cut his tail off. On the other hand, the downside is that I have to use all the remaining Kuret on him. I didn't have to strategize an entire new sequence of Kurets, but the scale has gone up considerably. And I would most likely drain out after I do it. I didn't think I would have to use all the remaining Kuret so soon.

Well, no matter. I can still make it work. Once he is trapped, I will have the time to create another Kuret storm. But my immediate problem is that the Kuret inside is still not stable. Charles on the other hand was already on the move. His giant steps create earthquakes. God damn. He made the land termer with his normal form, but now its full blown quake. His every step is creating mini craters. The only upshot to this is that he is taking his sweet time to walk here. I am really in a pinch here. I concentrated more to make the Kuret stable.

Charles is only 3 steps away. Come on. Don't betray me my Kuret. I didn't know if my Kuret actually heard me, but the storm is becoming stable again. Nice. Just in time too. Charles had raised his arm to crush me. I decided to first throw the shape copying Kuret on him. Him being so close would make the Kuret copy his shape even better. Once I threw it, I instinctively threw Vanessa's Kuret. This time I was saved by a thick iceberg. I was glad it was something sturdy. If fire or water came out, I would not have blocked his punch all the way.

That punch managed to almost get me. It was way to close. I began to walk in reverse as I threw all the other Kurets. Considering I have never tried this before at this size, it went perfectly. I managed to copy his size and strength almost equally. I think I even shocked Charles with this. He didn't make any moves as I worked my magic. And once it was over, I added the final touch. A white shadow Kuret to connect the two of them. I could feel I am running on fumes, so I decided to make the Kuret stronger so that it remains longer. If I am going to take a brief timeout, I need to make its long.

Once the last of Kuret from inside is gone, I let the Kuret storm go. That was intense. Even though it wasn't physically demanding to fire all the Kurets, its mentally exhausting. I didn't plan use all the Kuret for this, but Charles latest transformation forced me. At least now I can get some time off and gather some more strength. I looked around for somewhere good to rest up. I choose a small rock lying to my side. With leg over it, I let my back relax on my knee. I am grinning all the time Charles fought his clone. Charles tried so many things to get the clone out of his way, it was becoming amusing.

Charles then tried to jump up thinking disconnecting from the shadow would stop the mirroring. A decent try for Charles. That actually warranted an applaud. I couldn't help myself when I do a big showy gesture of clapping my hands. Charles didn't had a choice but to keep this up. Its's so insane that I managed to find a way to sit out in a battle when I am in it. If Charles hadn't made himself this big, I would have more Kuret to use while he fought the clone. My original plan was to make him fight his clone, while I keep firing off all remaining Kurets on him. I fold my arms in a cross to wait out as long as I could.

Too bad it didn't go the way I wanted. But hey, at least I got rest up a bit. Charles and the clone kept going at each other for minutes. It blew my mind that the all the Kurets I thought of in this rushed situation is working so well. This just goes to show you what the Kuret at their respective highest level could achieve. After about three minutes both the Charles had sustained a lot of damages. Because of the way Charles kept attacking, he got hurt in unexpected ways. He has wounds that are not healing everywhere. His Kuret control is really taken a big hit.

After another minute, I saw the Kuret glimmers of my Kuret clone becoming weaker. While the inside three Kuret were still holding out, the purple shell, the blue ropes and white Kuret connecting them is weakening. I decided I need to intervene now while the Kuret body is still relatively working. I don't need to waste energy on transforming my Kuret, so I call on my Kuret fire to wrap my arms. I throw a Kuret line and began working my up to the two giants. Charles had the gall to try and grab me when he sees me coming. Doesn’t he get it mirror doesn't work like that. Obviously, the clone mimicked his hand and it blocks him.

With nothing to stop me, I threw a Kuret line on top of the clone. I still haven't gotten used to flying, even though I already done it a while back. It's not safe to use something so risky, but I didn't have a choice. I have to take control of the body before it becomes any more weaker. I reach the top and land near the neck. I dug my right hand into the reck grabbing it with my Kuret. I kept my Kuret as small as possible to keep from damaging the surface and just strong enough for me to hold on. It is very strange to stand here like this. I felt like I had climbed a tall moving building that is fighting another one. The clothes I had torn in places when in contact to the Kuret, begins to form cracks on the surface. I had to open both my eyes here because so much glimmer of the Kuret is coming, its blinding me.

The wind kisses my face and my hair sway around in air. Its eerily like I am manning a boat rocking on waves. Charles still didn't understand how mirror worked when he tried to grab me. It's incredible how amusing this had become. But it has to end. After couple of tries Charles realized how silly he is being. He tried to grab me by moving his hand to his own shoulder. Well, this had been a good show. Time for the finale to start. I throw a Kuret line to the ground and cut the white Kuret line connecting their shadows.

The arm of the clone stops before it could grab me. Now for another difficult part. I blast a wave of Kuret around me. I need to use my transformed Kuret to grab the clones body. Just as I had learned, I first vibrate the Kuret as it expands. Then I make it rotate around the body to keep it stable. The Kuret around me obeyed as I wanted. Its incredible. The Kuret flames gradually turns to condense and then finally becoming physically solid. I didn't need it to strong, so I willed them to be shaped into thin ropes. Then I used them to go around the body under me. I don't have enough strength to cover the entire body, so I will just wrap it in the essential places. The knees to walk and kick. The shoulder joints and elbow to punch. I made some extra Kuret covering near the foot and hand to give some extra damage to Charles.

I couldn't believe I am able to make my Kuret work like this in my first try. I don't have proper control on using it on large distance. And yet its just barely enough to do simple stuff. I have been trying so many new things in the match I have lost count. But this is one tops all my ideas. I am going to control a Kuret body with my anti-Kuret. There wasn't even a second where I wasn't grinning ear to ear. I even chuckle in between trying to imagine how it must be looking for others.

I bet Charles didn't even thought I would try this. I want to enjoy this so much. But the timer on this temporary control has started. Not only I need to save my energy, but I have to finish this faster before my Kuret weakens the body further. I can't have the Kuret inside spill outside before I am ready. Charles comes out of his trance and attacks with a punch. With simple commands of pushing and pulling, I control the arm already in air. I use the Kuret on the joints to be pushed ahead, then the Kuret on the hand to open up the palm. Using very simple movement I just manage to block Charles punch. It's good that Charles is so slow. I wouldn't have been able to stop it if not for that. My Kuret wrapped there already begin to damage his armor. But that wasn't all I wanted.

Up close, I see some odd glimmer coming from a spot on his chest. The glimmer was a little denser than other parts of his body. I realize that Charles must be hiding there. Great, I found him quicker than I thought. Using the free arm, I pull it up for an undercut jab. Since I am not fully in control, my aim is just a guess. But by timing the Kuret thrusts, I managed to hit a fist into his jaw instead of the chest. The moment it struck, a loud bang came out of it. The shockwave it created moved all over the place. Charles should have been able to dodge it. But funny thing happens when you fight a mirrored clone for too long. You get so used to same attacks, you can't break out of that habit immediately. I laughed out a little once Charles stumbles back towards the barrier.

As he falls back, he pulls his arms to the side and tried to grab it and stop his fall. I bet he never expected the barrier would not only push his hand away, but also take his Kuret on contact. I needed to make sure he doesn't back away. So I prepare for a kick. This is one is even more tricky. The whole body is stumbling forward when I willed the Kuret around the knee to move up. My view becomes tilted to a side as the body leans forward. Just one more hit in on the chest. I focus all my Kuret on the leg to move, ignoring the falling clone's body. My breathing had become suddenly fast from all this. If I had more time, I would have come up with a much better plan that wasn't this tiring. I didn't even have a backup plan, everything is riding on this.

Charles is too much distracted to block this kick. The clones kick hit him around the place I Charles is hiding. Hell yeah. This is going to work out just as I wanted. Charles was now on his ass with his back against the barrier. I let go of the Kuret control. I drew in deep breathes from my lungs. It's even hurting a little now. But I am ignoring it completely. I couldn't keep my excitement under control when this risky plan actually worked. I need to get out of here before the clones surface breaks. I crawl out of the hole I had sunken down on the shoulder. I turn my back on Charles lying body and jump out. The wind feels so cold on my skin. I am half drenched in sweat. Its weird I didn't even hesitate before jumping off. Doing something like this had become something of a obvious thing for me. Like breathing.

Before I crash land horribly, I throw a Kuret line from my back upwards. The line puts me into a small arc and I land on my feet safely. Behind me, I saw the glimmer of my clone body falling apart. The Kurets I used inside now showered on Charles. Charles tried to grab the clone, but it is useless. The body didn't have any form anymore now that its purpose is fulfilled. This is too good for it to be true. This was a rushed plan from the start, and yet it worked. Charles slowly begins to get stuck to the ground from the sticky Kuret I had thrown in the mix.

I couldn't stop from making a gesture with hands on a job well done. My palm hurt a little bit with this. I may have a little too overenthusiastically. But its all good. I turn to face Charles. The hole I made wasn't healing and neither was he able to get out of the Kuret I had tied with. This is the opportunity I needed. I wished I didn't have to use up all the Kuret before. Oh well, I will make a smaller Kuret storm. And then after I recover some energy, I will create another Kuret storm on full power.

Charles struggled to get out, but his efforts were in vain. Good. That gave me time to focus on preparing a Kuret storm. I raise my arms up and began working on my Kuret storm. I just need only two, no, three Kuret blast. So I should be able to make it a bit faster. About a minute gone, I finished creating it. The Kuret storm is not completely stable. I should hurry before its gone. I slowly walk towards the exposed chest. As I had guessed from the glimmers, Charles body is not completely out yet. Good thing I prepared for an additional Kuret blast. I create a Kuret from one the participants that fought Nathan. The Kuret shoot out like a machine gun. The efficiency of this Kuret had dropped due to such a slapdash rush job.

I become a little worried that I didn't have enough power. But then I saw his glimmer becoming more clear. I immediately stopped the Kuret when I see his head out. I just need that part to be exposed. Then I blast the air on with Ruby's Kuret. Initially I had planned for a alternate compelling Kuret, but that one required more Kuret. When I had to let go of the Kuret storm earlier, I decided to change the Kuret to this. I am not so sure about the effect of this Charles. But Ruby was able to influence not just guys, even girls. Since her Kuret interferes with the people's pheromones, I should still be able to pull out information from Charles. Evan Nathan had enough faith on Ruby to use it against us way back then.

Once I am sure that enough Kuret has been absorbed by Charles, I blast the final Kuret on him. I can't control Ruby's Kuret like she does when compelling us, so I have to use another Kuret to know if the words coming out of

Charles mouth is the truth or not. Charles continuous to struggle under the second Kuret gas I blast him with. Once I see the glimmers of both the Kurets seeping inside his real body, I let go of the Kuret storm. My entire body is so sore, I just want to finish this an lay down. Maybe I actually can. Charles isn't going anywhere. I may have bought about 5 or 7 minutes before the Kurets on him disappears. I should use that time to strategies and rest up.

But not yet. I stand up straight and walk to nearest place where I can climb inside the hole I made on his chest. My arms are in pain. I am really abusing them so much with the Kuret storm. But I won't let it stop me. I grab on Blakes and Jess's Kuret covering around Charles chest and haul myself up. After a few seconds of arduous task of climbing, I reach the small tunnel on above. I see Charles head peaking out from the neck up. He had no Kuritine on head, only his raw Kuret body remained. He is wriggling when he sees me. I don't know how much control he has on this giant body when he doesn't have his head connected. Can he still move it if he is rest of his body still intact with the giant Kuret body. I can't be certain. It matter though. He is completely helpless right now.

I take few steps toward him in all this uneven Kuret skin and take a knee near his head. I had to wait for a while until I catch my breath. I don't want to sound like I am too tried. I even wipe off a some sweat dripping near my jaw. This is very important for my final plan. I need to use all the tricks and lies I have to get him to tell his weakness. Few seconds in silence, then I began talking and finally brought up the big question,
so how about it Charles, what is your weakness. Tell me how I can beat you right now.

# David (Chapter 33)

Saturday, February 10, 2024 21:00

Charles didn't answer me right away. Did Ruby's Kuret didn't work. No I could see traces of pink glimmer on Charles. So he must be resisting. Like how Blake was doing in the beginning. I need to keep talking and get him to open his mouth. First I need to make him talk about anything, once that happens the Kuret will take over and compel him more. I continue my efforts on sweet talking Charles, you don't have to be shy you know. Just tell me what's your weakness. I know there is one.

Charles voices come muffled under his Kuret body. Maybe he can't speak in this Kuret body. No, that can't be. His mouth opens up from outside, so it wouldn't be just for biting. The noise he is making is to resist speaking. Good. I ask, you don't want to tell me your secret. Fine. I can wait for a while. I got some time to kill. It's a lie. I can't waste too much time here. But if hastily approach him, I would waste this golden chance. I clear my throat, why don't we talk about your bloodline, Heraknus. You guys have been hiding all for countless generations on Medrine. Regardless of the situation on Earth for hiding for the past decade, you didn't need to hide on Medrine. So what gives. Why didn't you want people to know you existed.

More stiffened noise comes from Charles. I should keep going this track, come on. You guys are out of the closet now. And Medrines sadly gone. So there is no reason to keep the reason a secret anymore. Charles shook his head for the first, like he is physically trying to stop from speaking. Nice. Just a little more, I have a theory. Tell me if I am wrong okay. I didn't plan this to go this long, so I didn't have anything good to talk. At this point I am just fibbing. But as long I keep him engaged like this, whether I say something real or just lies, he should finally give into the compulsion. I continue, I think some few centuries ago, you guys did something, or was done something to you that made you guys hide your entire bloodline from others. You guys did such a good job of it that people turned you to urban legends.

This is already obvious something happened in Medrine history to make them into hiding. I plan to just keep him in suspense and believe I will eventually get to the truth without him. I add more bullshit, what did you guys do. Or maybe not do. Maybe your ancestors killed a whole bunch of people. Huh, is that it. Maybe there was some internal strife and you guys had a cold war. Am I close. Charles faint voices comes out, but it wasn't audible. He is desperately trying to keep his moth shut. I said, is that a no. Hum, I thought for sure that was it. Because of your ancestors crime, you couldn't reveal your existence and become a target. Hum, nah. Your right, this can't be the reason. People turned Heraknus into to a bed time story, so they had forgotten all about you. Maybe the old families like royals knew about you.

I take a sigh feigning my dissatisfaction, then what is it Charles. Huh, do you guys just hate other bloodlines. Maybe you guys think that your Kuret makes you all so much better than us. I mean, I can't deny it. Heraknus Kuret is just to insane. When the alpha is this strong, the rest of the members must be strong also. I tried a different approach now. Do you guys look down on other bloodlines. I actually don't care for the reason right now. I just want a reaction from him. I think provoking him might be more successful seeing how much he is trying to hold back. I was right on the money. Charles finally broke.

The same voice I heard him from the beginning of the match comes out, no! That’s not the reason we have hidden all these time. His voice came out rushed and forced. He is almost yelling at me. I didn't care for his attitude. I made him finally talk. I lean forward a little and rebuke, why don't you enlighten me Charles. If you don't want to talk about your weakness, you can tell me why you guys are in hiding. Charles retorts, you have no idea what our bloodlines have been burdened with. If you knew, you would agree that hiding was the best way for everyone.

I jumped on that chance, so why don't you unburden yourself right here. Just tell me what's your weakness. How can I beat you. You can tell me all about your reasons later. Charles voice become muffled again. But he couldn't keep it like that or long. A few seconds later he blurts out, you keep asking for my weakness. I don't have one. I chuckle a little at that, yeah. Nice one. Unfortunately I don't believe you Charles. You're a liar. Charles couldn't keep himself from talking anymore, no lies. Its the truth. Heraknus alphas have no weakness. We are warriors that can fight for hours continuously.

My mind is telling me he is still lying. But my eyes see a different story. The green Kuret I threw on him earlier wasn't reacting. I didn't see any change in the glimmer inside Charles body. I grew silent for a moment. That’s not possible. He must be still hiding it. But the compulsion is working now. He is telling truth now. My expression darken. I ask him irritated, I don't believe you. There is not a single being in existence that is completely invincible. Your bloodline give you incredible power, but you also have big limits. You guys have to wait for a long to recover your Kuret in your original bodies. You guys have Kuret blackouts in middle of the match. You even lost some of your Kuret control. I don't…

Charles cuts me off, that is only happening on Earth. What's the term you guys have used it, ah. He thinks for a second, the humanization. We didn't have this limit back on Medrine. We only had a minor instability in our Kuret bodies. But that has been severely effected on earth. And as for my Kuret control, you are right. I did lose some control. But as you can see, I can still fight longer even in this state. I have never fought someone like you in my entire life. The only other person to push me such length was my late mother, the previous alpha. So I am telling you the truth, I don't have any weakness as long as I can use Kuret.

My eye is twitching now. This is not what I expected to hear from Charles. The green Kuret on his body didn't react. He is telling the truth. Freaking hell. Is this really happening. I can't believe Charles only weakness was really his Kuret blackouts, that actually was because he is on Earth. Does this mean on Medrine they were unstoppable. I shook my head. Freak no. If such a bloodline really existed, why did Medrones lose the battle against Hive. With these guys they would have completely crushed the enemy.

I said, I refuse to believe that you Charles are unbeatable. You say you don't have a weakness, then tell me how someone from not the Heraknus bloodline win against you. Charles didn't respond immediately. He then says, I don't know. For the first time, I saw the green Kuret glimmers running wild inside Charles. I sliver of hope came. So there must be a way to beat him even when he doesn't have a weakness. I urge him, Charles. You are lying again. Come on. You know there's a way for me to beat you. Tell me. You want to unburden some of the stuff weighing on you.

Charles tries to fight a little more. But then he blurts, keep fighting me and make me use all my Kuret. That's the only way I can be stopped. As long as I have Kuret, I will get up every time. I will heal all the wounds on my Kuret body and keep fighting even with my Kuret control lacking. He wasn't lying. He believes this is the only way to beat him. This is also not what I wanted to hear. No way I can keep fighting like this, not against is seemingly unlimited Kuret endurance. Freak. What the hell should I do now. The way things are going, I will have to use my last Kuret storm without any real strategy. That’s really the worst case scenario. Once I finish off all my Kuret blasts, I will be done. Is this it. There is no other way. Maybe I have to face reality and swallow my ego to forfeit the match right now.

Then what about all the confidence I showed Vanessa and Matt. I made them believe I will win this no matter what. I can pictures Vanessas, Blakes, Marina's and others faces when they try to console me later. Ned, Kafar, Nathan, and who knows other would pity me. I grit my teeth in frustration. God damn. The strategy I made was too flimsy. I should have thought of something, a backup incase this interrogation was a failure. Can't believe I let my ego or pride or whatever messed up my head. My emotions had taken a dark turn now.

Charles speaks his mind for the first time, don't tell me you still planning to continue. Even after what I said. I couldn't tell what Charles saw on my face that made him say that. Perhaps he interpreted my anger and somber look as just frustration. But when I think about it, he might be right. I could just end this match now. But if I am going to lose, at least I want go all out. Even if it’s a hopeless cause, its better than quitting now. I have come this far, I will take it through. And who knows, if I am extremely lucky, I'll win. I brought back some of my weekend determination. I think hearing Charles surprised, gave me some more push to continue on. I can't let all my efforts go to waste like this.

I made up my mind. I take a deep breath and calm my emotions. I can't panic and lose control of myself. I am still in the game. If there is even a one percent chance of wining, you bet your ass I will go looking for it. So I need to pull out whatever information I can from him before the Kurets disappear from his system. But what should I even ask. What will he be attacking me next with. He can just change it later once this compulsion wore out. I need some way that can end this match end quickly. Any other method will not work with my remaining stamina. I keep thinking of a way. A moment later I realized I could ask him a different approach. I ask, tell me how to use up all your Kuret completely in one go. You said as long you have your Kuret, you will continue fighting. So if I make you use all your remaining Kuret all at once and if I beat it, victory will be mine.

Charles shook his head with whispers trying to escape from his mouth. I force him, you have used your Kuret so much already. There must be something you have that will make you use your remaining Kuret continuously. Tell me how I can make you do that. Charles wriggles his head more furiously. Then second later he says with a pressured voice, I…don't…know. There is nothing…don't…know. I didn't even need to see the green Kuret glimmers to know he is lying.

I say with stern voice, just let it out Charles. You will be unburned even more. Tell the way to make your Kuret use all at once. I swear, I could hear Charles teeth grinding to keep himself from speaking. I got a even more curious by this reaction. What could be so huge that he is trying so much to hide. Then suddenly Charles couldn't keep the lid on it anymore. Never in my wildest thoughts did I expect to hear the words. He stammers, overdrive. He pauses a little trying to stop. But he continues despite his will, if I go into overdrive then I would lose large amounts of Kuret every second. Then the only way I lose is if you are able to survive until my overdrive ends.

What. The. Freak. He can use overdrive. My jaw flew open unconsciously in response. My eyes widen with shock. Did I hear him right. I close my jaws and swallow hard. I ask, are you serious. You can overdrive. And once its over, you loose all your Kuret. Charles nods his head in defeat, yes. I can do overdrive. If you managed to keep up with me till the end, you win. No reaction on the green Kuret. He is speaking the truth. Shit. In a way it makes sense. If he has Kuret blackouts in this form as the weakness, his overdrive must have even more limitations.

Then I become more nervous realizing that overdrive meant he gets even more stronger than his current form. I ask hesitantly, does your overdrive works like Blake and Marina. Does it power up your Kuret to even a greater height. Charles nods, yes. My overdrive…He abruptly stops himself. He wiggles his head instead. Ah shit. I didn't notice that the compulsion Kuret on him has weakened. He is coming out of it. Damn it. I didn't get into more details. I got up and started to back away to the opening of the hole.

I need to get some distance before Charles gets up. I didn't have the patience to climb down normally, so I jump off directly while throwing a small Kuret line to the sky. I stagger hard as I touch the ground. I slowly began walking. But my legs were heavy. Not because of the wounds, but because of the impossible task ahead of me. I am only managing against Charles for the moment, fighting him in his overdrive would be overkill. But if that’s the only for me to win, I have no other choice. The prospect of fighting him in his overdrive is too crazy to even to think about. I don't know where to begin.

I understand some of how overdrive works from Blake and Marina. If it works similarly like theirs, then Charles overdrive form should be completely bathed with his Kuret. What kind of insane form will he take on. I halt after gaining some distance. I turn my back against a boulder lying and lean on it. Is this really going to happen. I need to fight another overdrive user. With Blake I saw him use earlier against Marina, so I could strategize in advance. I even cooked up plans that would have worked against Marina if ever got matched up. But now, this is too dangerous. Without knowing what how is Kuret powered up looks like, I would have to just wing it. In my current condition, there is no way it will happen.

So what should I do. Huh, I grunt in frustration. I don't want to stop now. But I know I can't beat his overdrive. Maybe once I learn my new Kuret transformation I might be able to handle his overdrive. And if I can master my Kuret storm, I would definitely have more chances. Shit. Such an impossible situation. I distract myself a little to avoid this grim future and turn my gaze to others. Everyone had hurdled up together around a person. I saw Marina's glimmer in the middle. What are they doing. I focused a little more too her charms glimmers coming from her. She casted a charm. What's that for.

I saw faint glimmer connecting her charm and the barrier. I followed with my eyes the path of the glimmer, all the way to the backside of the barrier where Charles is stuck at the moment. A moment later I realize that going on. I let out a sigh. They were watching us. Must have been curious to what I do with Ruby's and the other Kuret. So they head that shocking reveal. The existence of the 3rd overdrive user. This is so unreal. Among the 10 billion Medrones, only 10 or 11 people could use overdrive at a given time. And we have 3 of them here all together. I know its not a coincidence since our species is on the brink of extinction, more unusual and powerful people would be observable now.

This tournament already has shown hundreds of alphas, 18 omegas and 1 true alpha. In the mix comes a mythical alpha. And the icing on top the cake, 3 overdrive users. This had to be the most powerful group of Medrones ever be in one place, both on Medrine and Earth. Thinking about the statistics makes be laugh a little. How ridiculous was that I came in top among all these people. Some people have said I have been lucky so far, but is really though. I believe I have been lucky, but that's not why I am fighting Charles and not someone else. The memories of my past, the people I made promises to and their sacrifices have pushed me here. Maybe I have been trying to suppress that desire to win unconsciously. Maybe now that I know people like Hansen had such unexplainable faith, it made me stronger all these years, even when I didn't remember them.

I take in more air from my mouth. I have to fight Charles. I need to surpass him. Those people who died to keep me safe on the last day, they said to survive. To grow stronger. And I have to answer their faith on me. That meant fighting even when the odds are against me. Ah, freak it. I shook my head and face Charles giant body. Since the beginning this has been a impossible battle. If I think about it, nothing about the situation has changed. What had changed is me. My Kuret. And my reasons to win. I speak out to myself, you got this. I raise my hands and prepare for my final Kuret storm.

I initially planned to rest for a while. But I scrapped off that plan. I need to make an even bigger Kuret storm now. One that will hold at least 2 dozen Kuret blasts. I need to use the compulsion Kuret I planed earlier and make Charles go into overdrive forcefully. Then I need to keep him away from me for all the time and maybe even trap him again. I need to avoid a direct confrontation as much as possible. I am basically savaging for scraps from the shattered strategy I devised earlier. I came up few important Kurets I have to use no matter what. I rack my brain trying to recall what other powerful immobilizing Kurets I can use.

In the middle of my thoughts, a loud roar comes from Charles. He brakes my attention and I avert my eyes to him. His glimmers showed sparks of blue and orange as he continuous to howl. Whoa, what's he doing on. Is he inflicting pain on himself. Then I notice his glimmer moving. Holy shit. He is trying to break out of his giant body. What. The glimmers around him swirl more on him. Why is he trying to break out now. He feels real pain when his Kuret body gets cut off. The amount of blue Kuret keeps increasing as he tries to slash out the other Kuret crawling out.

This is bad. I didn't think he would become this desperate now. What happened. Does he plan to finish me before I could make my move. Even risking so much pain. I am way to stunned at Charles reckless behavior. My Kuret storm is no way near complete. I only just started. I need at least 4 or 5 minutes to make it bigger. I have only seconds now. God dammit. I thought of another idea. I have to take on even a greater risk and use my Kuret transformation. Without this Kuret storm, that's the only other power that can beat him down.

But can I even do it. Charles lets out another loud growl. He is almost out now. Shit. No choice. I have to do it. I let go of the Kuret storm and turn my hand into fist. I wait to absorb all my Kuret inside me. I am a little nervous to try this. M hasn't gone into red mode, but I bet once I do this she will alert others. They will stop this match and make me forfeit. I don't want to let them get in my way, but I can't exactly stop them either. What the hell I should do. I have to risk it and hope my body can handle the Kuret transformation.

I began pouring out my Kuret around me in a wave. Just like I learned since then, I repeat the exact same process. Keep making it vibrate and rotate it at the same time. My Kuret obeyed me ever so slightly. I am mentally exhausted now from all the Kuret blasts. This is way to difficult for me. I kept concentrating hoping to make it work. But then with a last loud bark, Charles comes out free from the hole in the chest. The giant Kuret body instantly begins to crack and slowly shatters in pieces. Then it begins to turn to Kuret dust.

Charles comes out flying and lands on the grass. His body which had no Kuritine looked like he was wearing a large brown skin colored cloth. He then starts to run towards me. The mind sends out an alarm to my entire body. Holy mother. What should I do. I ditch my idea to cover my entire body and just focus on my arms. The Kuret dome forming around me breaks apart and slowly condenses to just my arms. Charles isn't waiting to heal his body. He kept running at me at top speed. Orange and blue glimmers is still coming off him. Holy shit, just when did he got so desperate to win.

I concentrated hard on the Kuret over my arms. But even this much was too tiering for me. So I changed my effort once again and just go with the wild Kuret. Its inefficient, but its at least faster to make it. As I expand my Kuret, I vibrate it and rotate it. Like I thought, this was much easier and faster to make. My arms was covered once again with the exploding Kurets in few seconds. But I could tell the power coming off it is way to less than before. Also, I could only cover till my elbow.

I grit my teeth hard. Fine, I will just use this to win. I don't even know how I can be still stubborn about winning. I didn't have time to think anymore. Charles is within his reach. But something unexpected happened as he came rushing in. He is yelling at me, stop. We need to talk for a moment. That almost broke my concentration, what the did he say. His voice and his behavior didn't match at all. He is coming at me with gusto, no way he is asking me to listen to him. I must be hearing things.

Choosing to ignore him, I let the Kuret on my arms thrust me forward. The familiar sensation of my Kuret gave me more confidence now. For some reason Charles had slowed down a little and wasn't even trying to attack me. Maybe I did hear him right. But I won't stop. Charles comes to an abrupt halt and pulls his arms to defend against me. I pulled my right arm in and prepared to throw down a fist. He doesn't have those Kuritine protection and his Kuret body is weak. Meaning both our Kuret is not strong, so I should be able to keep up the status quo.

I land a punch on his arms protecting hoping they gets crushed. But the power is too less. The moment it clashed, I could tell it didn't have the explosive strength my punches had earlier. His guard remained upon our contact. Charles barks out, wait. David. Cease fire. I want to talk. I am literally bamboozled. What the hell is there is talk about. I use my other arm's Kuret to pull me back and gain some distance. Charles didn't follow up with an immediate attack. I don't know what he wants to discuss. But I can't let this opportunity go to waste.

I land on my feet a distance away. My breathing becomes labored. Shit. Just one punch and I am already dead tired. I knew this was way to much for my body to handle. M must definitely gone to red mode. Anytime now others would barge in and make me forfeit. I press my lips in angered. This is not how its supposed to end. I yell out in frustration and let my Kuret thrust me ahead again. I will just throw both my fist into him in a straight on collision. Then suddenly Charles body begins to smoke.

I abruptly make my Kuret to stop. The rough movement caused me stumble controllably when my feet touch the ground. Charles Kuret body slowly turns to dust, mimicking the exact thing happening to his giant body. I see the glimmer of his Kuret subsiding inside. What's going on. A sudden overwhelming thought came to me. Was he trying to confuse me by saying those things and is actually going into overdrive. No, Charles is too much of a simple minded guy to try such a tactic.

I decided to wait a little more. I kept the Kuret on my arms ready for anything. But I wasn't ready for this. Charles comes out of the Kuret dust. Not his Kuret body, but his real body. He had clothes torn in places. They had stains of blood all over him. His skin was bruised in multiple place. He had one eye closed from a nasty swelling under his cheek. He had one arm crossed on his chest supporting his other arm. I thought I was looking bad, but Charles is in a worse condition. Its unbelievable he fought me such condition. Wait, the most shocking thing is that he has let go of his Kuret body.

He spats a spit to his side and faces me with a big smile, that was one of the most exciting and terrifying battle I had to fight. Just what are you son. I was too much in shock to respond. What's going on. Is he quitting? That can't be right. He said I had to make him use up all the Kuret, that's the only way to win. But he just stopped his using Kuret himself. I shook away my confused thoughts and regain my sense. He did say he wanted to talk. So maybe I should just wait and see what he wants.

I answer him, what I am doesn't matter. You should be asking who I am. I am the one who will be winning this match. I showed all the conviction I had in my voice. Charles smile becomes even bigger and chuckles. Its crazy he finds it amusing considering in his own face full of bruises. His laughter dims down, such overwhelming confidence. I honestly don't know what happened to you since we started this match. But clearly you are no longer the same person I met before our match. Just what in the world happened. First your Kuret becomes suddenly grows stronger. You take on a strange form. And I was told you use anti-Kuret. But ever since our match resumed, you are using so many others Kurets. What's up with that.

I unconsciously smirk at his confusion, bet you didn't see that coming. Charles nods, that totally shook me to my bones, you know. Derek told me only few people in this tournament could do something like that. But what you did goes even beyond that. How in the hell did you do that. Honestly, it was amusing to see Charles so confused. It made me forget a little about my own confusion about this absurd situation. I wasn't going to give him my secrets, it doesn't matter how I can do it. You only need to worry that I can use it.

Charles snickers, true. I doubt if you would have told the truth anyway. He then pauses and shakes he head to the side and cracks his neck. He continues, speaking of truth. The biggest twist of all was you making me spill my guts out. I never thought you would just make me tell you like that. That might be the most craziest thing you have done in our entire battle. Despite his tone annoyed, he seemed to be still enjoying. What a guy. He continuous, my overdrive is actually a secret even in my own bloodline. Only my family and few trusted others know about it.

That's a surprise, why would you want to hide it. Only hand full of alphas can go into overdrive. He nods, yes. Well, my overdrive a little special. My great-grandfather could do it. We never got to meet, but I know of him from others. Gaining more power is one part of it. But there is a catch. As you already know, our bloodline is already powerful. A Heraknus overdrive user would be essentially unstoppable. I reply, jeez. If you are going to just make me listen how powerful your overdrive form is, you might as well just tell me the way to stop you as well. I make small smirk at my witty remark.
Charles smiles at me, trust me kid. I am not being rude here. I already told you that my overdrive is the best way to beat me in short time, right. The reason why I hide it is part of it. He takes a breath, since you made me reveal my secret, I have no reason to keep it hidden anymore. Our overdrive is powerful, but dangerous. After our conversation, I got worried that you would use some Kuret to force me into my overdrive. I purposefully took on a lot of pain to rush here and stop you from doing it.

I am confused at his reasoning. Dangerous?, I asked him confused. I shook my head, Charles. I don't know if you have been aware of your own actions. I lost count how many times you tried to really kill me. If you are worried about becoming more dangerous, you shouldn't have bothered to stop me. This battle from beginning has been incredibly dangerous for me. Charles shook head, no. No. I mean, yes I did some mistakes. I can't deny that. He makes an apologetic voice. I got too much worked up in my Heraknus form. You kept bringing up powerful attacks, that kept pressuring me and I pulled out some reckless attacks. For that I am regretful and apologize.

Only some attempts. Try about a dozen. His apology felt sincere. But no way in hell is it acceptable. Saying sorry that he almost killed me so many times in what was is a friendly match is crazy. Charles continuous, also I am not saying its dangerous to you. Well, it is. But that's not what I am worried about. I said its dangerous for others. The people on this island. The ones sitting on the stadium. That left me speechless for a second, what. What do you mean. He replies, the reason I have to keep my overdrive a secret is because its dangerous to everyone when use it. I become too violent. An inner beast born from our Kuret bloodline takes over me completely. You wouldn't be fighting me, but an animal driven on pure instinct. Hunting and killing any prey I find on way.

My eyes widen in shock, what. Are you serious. It's really that dangerous. Charles nods, yes. I am telling the truth. You asked me about why Heraknus have been hiding for so long on Medrine. This played a part in it. He pauses like he recalled something nasty. He says, if you want, I can tell you the whole story about our past. But lets keep it for after this match. Now you know why it was absolute necessary to stop you before you forced me go into overdrive. I shook my head, but we have a strong barrier. You wouldn't be harming anyone. He nods slightly, maybe. But unfortunately I don't know for sure I wouldn't just break it away. I ask, why would even try to attack it while I would be inside.

Charles says, I don't know why but when I am go into overdrive, my instincts drives me to hunt and kill anyone who isn't smelling like my blood. I would attack anyone who wouldn't have the same Kuret scent as mine. Meaning I would become violent anyone who is isn't my immediate blood relationship. My grandfather use to tell stories about his father. Whenever his father would go into overdrive, he would lose all sense of things. Only the primal instincts remain. A powerful primal urge to eliminate all others who aren't their parents or children. My grandfather and his siblings were only the ones who could stop him from attacking others. And even then, the best they could keep him restrained until the overdrive is over. In an attempts to control his overdrive he tried to train himself, but always ended in failure. It also endangered others. So I was told to keep it hidden in our alpha line until you would master it.

I was a little enthralled in this story. What an incredible situation the Heraknus are in. He continuous, my grandfather and mother didn't show any signs of overdrive, but then I began showing signs of it when I hit puberty. I was so happy to know I had the potential. But then grandfather told me the stories. Then, well, I become less happy about it. He lets out a big sigh, after a lot of convincing, they agreed to let me train it after couple of years. The first time I was finally able to go into overdrive was just few years before Hive came. I don't even recall what I did during the time. Thankfully my grandfather had the expertise and experience, so my family was able to keep me restrained. I never managed to train it more than 3 times on Medrine.

I realized something. He said earlier he looses a lot of Kuret every second. I ask, its because you lose all your Kuret all at once. And once its gone, you have wait months before you try it again. That's why training your overdrive had been so difficult. Especially now on Earth which has put even more restriction on your Kuret. Charles had a surprises look in his one opened eye, whoa. That's right. You really figured me out huh. He shook his head slightly, its like you said. Earth has made us weaker, no doubt about it. But now that Kuret is flowing in the Earths air more now due to our presence, we have slowly been getting better control. However, not completely. I never stopped wanting to learn my overdrive. Especially when I now need to avenge my late wife. His voice broke a little and turned somber.

Damn. This took an unexpected but all too familiar turn. I reply, I am really sorry for your loss. I understand how you feel better than anyone. Charles replies, thanks kid. Its been some time since I had got over the grief of her death. My kids had to grow in an alien planet without her. Even when I got remarried, I never stopped wanting revenge on Hive. And the best way to make sure Hives never reach my family every again is to master this overdrive. I have tried it to learn it few more times in Earth. But still I haven't gotten control over it. My kids are not strong enough to stop me in that form, so I clued in some of my trusted friends and capable people into my secret and help me keep restrained. It takes at least dozen of my people to keep me from turning into mayhem. They have to keep rotating amongst them in turns, until my Kuret is depleted.

He turns to the side facing the crowd, if I go into overdrive right here. I can't even imagine how much dangerous it will become for others. I only brought my wife and kids with me. And some close friends of my family. Without the special equipment's and guards here to protect others, this could easily become a massacre. And the worst part is that with so many different Kuret scents, I might be even more berserk. This is total nuts. I can't believe I came this close to unleashing a true monster.

He then faces me, of course. I know there are some exceptionally powerful people that might be able to stop me. Especially that group of people you are close with. If both Marina and Blakes had their own overdrives in full form, I might let them handle me my overdrive. But that's still dangerous. They least should be made aware of the risk well in advance. I gulp a little hearing him. If what he said was true, then he was right to stop me. Blakes not learnt to control his overdrive and Marina hasn't recovered enough to use hers. It's a little perplexing that every known overdrive user is having problem with that. Its an incredible power, but it comes with its own risk.

A moment later I ask, but where does that leave us. I can understand you not wanting to go into overdrive here. But also understand that I will defeat you no matter what. Charles slurps a little hearing me, are you serious. You still want to fight me when I just told that I become so violent that I lose all sense of reason. Honestly, out of all the things I have heard from Charles, that's the least of my worries. I reply, I already told you. I was in danger since the beginning. I have been in various life and death situations. From my perspective, this is just another added difficulty I have solve and overcome.

Charles one eye widen. A moment later he say, kid. I thought were supposed to be some genius. You are willing to risk your own life over such a thing when its not even Hive you are up against. I reply with a scoff, I am not being reckless here. I have considered the risk. Honestly, I am a little scared. But this isn't something new. Last six years of my life has been one crazy dangerous ride. At this point, even after knowing your situation, its not different than the other crazier stuff I have been up to. I am sure Derek or Kafar or someone has told you of some of the insane things we have gone through. I have managed to survive through. Some with luck, some due to others and but also due to own skill. So try not to underestimate me. I might not know how powerful you will become, but I have been fighting powerful people all my time on Earth.

My unshakable confidence left him speechless. Few second later he says, you are total nuts Kid. My own family gets scared of me when I use my overdrive. And you expect me to believe you can handle me all alone. I remain unfazed at that provocation, I don't know what I will or will not do. But I do know that if I don't even try, then I already lost. Charles then smiles, damn Kid. Just what have you been through to become like this. I don't believe a few years of fighting would make you so much battle hardened. I know you don't remember your past, but what kind of life did you lead on Medrine.

I could tell him about it. But what will that accomplish. I doubt he would be bothered by the fact that I was a shadow like Blake. I choose to remain silent on this topic. He scratches the side of his temple a little, your right about one thing. This a tough situation we are in. Should we keep continue fighting like this, or should I really go into overdrive and hope people will be safe. I really wanted to say the latter option. But I am not crazy to endanger others safety at the cost of my selfishness. Also, I am very much doubting how well I can handle in my current state. I began thinking for ways to resume our match without causing a lot of fuzz.

Charles then suddenly snaps his fingers that jar me out my thoughts. He brings out a smile, I got it. I know what we should do now. I got curious to know what this new outrageous suggestion he was about to give. He chuckles, you should me some real guts David. I am beyond impressed by the fire in your eyes. Even more than those ridiculous Kuret powers you hold. So I have decided, if someone has even a small chance of surviving this all alone, it might be just be you. His compliment made a little happy despite how childish it was to feel like this. It felt like I am become worthy enough in eyes.

He then turns to the crowd, but I can't make this decision alone. I need to bring Kafar here. I scoff at that suggestion, seriously, you want to what, take a leisure break in the middle of our match and bring in him to make a strategic plan. He shrugs his shoulders, why not. Its our match. We can do whatever the hell we want, right. If we both agree to take a break to discuss the rest of our match, it shouldn't be a problem right. He wasn't completely wrong. Technically speaking, based on the rules if both of us are not willing to fight, we get disqualified. But in the finals, where the rules have bend so many times, I doubt they will disqualify both of us.

After a couple of moments to ponder this ridiculous idea of his, I decided its worth exploring. At the very least, I would get some respite. I turn to him, okay. I'll go with you for the moment. What is your idea. He says, I don't want to get your hopes up until I ask Kafar a question first and hear the answer. Once he does, I will tell everyone about my idea. You can even choose to reject it and we would resume our battle, of course, without making me go into overdrive.

Interesting proposition. I nod, okay. Lets do it then. I can't wait to hear your plan.

# Vanessa (Chapter 34)

Sunday, February 11, 2024 12:29

Every word coming out of David mouth is making us nervous now. Marina whispers, what the hell. You just asked him for his weakness directly. Crazy with a capital K. It was totally unbelievable. Everyone here were sure he was going to make Charles drop out. But I nagging suspicion that David was planning something else. He tries to further prod Charles from opening up. Charles kept his mouth shut. David changes the topic and instead talk about Heraknus reasons for hiding on Medrine.

Derek says to me, he is purposefully chatting on unrelated topic to open up Charles. No wonder David has been talking non stop. Charles would eventually slip up. I still couldn't understand why David doesn't just make Charles drop out. Why does he want to continue risking so much for this match. And then it finally happened. Charles mental defense broke and he begins to talk. What he said made us incredibly anxious. Nathan scoffs, who is Charles trying to fool. He doesn't have a weakness. No way that possible.

I was also shocked to hear this. Even David didn't buy it. He keeps up the conversation and telling Charles not to lie. But Charles talks how his bloodline has effected on Earth and their only weakness is that Kuret blackouts. We didn't hear David's words for a while. I can almost feel the grim expression he mut have in his face. Blake nervously asks, Charles has to be lying right. I mean he has to be some sort of flaws right. Derek replies in slow voice, maybe all their limitations have been evolved to be only when they don't use their Kuret. They are basically humans when they don't use their Kuret. I say that’s pretty much the biggest drawback of their powers.

I shook my head, but what when they are in combat. Are they really invincible. Derek didn't respond. Tessa offers, maybe if there were a group of going against Charles, he would lose. Charles already admitted he lost a lot of his Kuret and even slowly beginning to lose his Kuret control. But he still as lot of Kuret reverse. The only to make him use up all is to keep fighting him until its over. Matt shrieks, but that’s not possible in a one-on-one. David's too exhausted. Tessa nods at him, yes. It seems rather difficult for one person to do it, isn't it.

The atmosphere around us had yet again changed. Now Team David is the one who were distressed with the latest turn of events. Even if David is currently on a hot streak, he can't keep up with Charles endurance. He doesn't even have our Kuret stamina to boast him. Just him being able to do this much after getting knocked out goes beyond anything humanly possible. David had remained silent for long now. Blake asks, is he going to make Charles drop out then. Derek replies in low voice, I don't see any other choice David has. He must have been banking a lot on this plan. The best way for David to win is to force Charles now when he still under compulsion.

I wasn't sure about it. Something tells me David is not going to do it. I was proven correct when he instead asks for a way to use up all of Charles Kuret in one go. That was a ludicrous idea. One that just might work out. Its borderline insane that David still wasn't giving up and grasping for anything he could. Everyone here got tense hearing Charles stammering. I lean even more trying to hear Charles voice stammering. Then his voice finally comes, overdrive. One word that rocked me my whole mind. He continues to tell that’s the only way for him to use up all his Kuret in short time.

Everyone here were completely speechless. David was no exception. I could hear the shock in his voice when he asks again to confirm if that’s true. Charles says he can use overdrive and if David survives that, he would lose. David becomes silent again, no doubt trying to comprehend what we just heard. Matt raises both his palm to his temple, sweet mother. He can overdrive. What the actual freak. Marina and Blake were visibly shocked to know they have another overdrive user joining their extremely rare group. Marina had her mouth half opened and Blake eyes were wide. Catherine puts her hand on her forehead, my heads going to explode now. Of course Charles can do overdrive too. She emphases the last part more to show her sarcasm. Nathan asks, hot damn. Just when you think this match can't become crazier. Jess asks hesitantly, so what's going to happen now. Tessa replies, anyone's guess now.

I am confused and perhaps more shocked. This is not how I thought we would finding the 3rd existence of an overdrive user. Somewhere in my mind, I had a ridiculous but small hope that I would be the one to achieve it next. Charles becoming one doesn't mean it will never happen to me, but its like I am slowly getting left behind by everyone. Few years ago, only I and handful of others were the only powerful Medrone known to everyone. But now, I am nowhere near them. What's more disgusting is that I can't stop being jealous of them. I have no right to be mad at them, but I couldn't help it. Especially now that David is fighting at their level.

I ask, no, almost pray, David don't do anything stupid. Either drop out or make Charles to drop out. A moment later he asks Charles if his overdrive is like others. I can't think for a second hearing David's still not backing down. Charles says yes and then grunts suddenly. We hear a shuffling noise. I turn my eyes to the arena and see David coming out. He jumps off the giant wound and begins to walk away. Derek says in low tone, I guess the compulsion wore off. Marina calls out with nervous voice, is this really happening. Is Charles also an overdrive user.

Blake shook off his frozen expression, didn't David use a lie detecting Kuret. If Charles was lying, David would know. He clicks his tongue, as incredulous it may look. Charles at least believes himself that he can overdrive. Whether he is delusion or not, that is what he believes. Right. He turns to Derek. He nods in response. Cass asks him, hey. Did you knew about this. You know this freak the longest of us. Derek shook his vehemently, this is the first time I heard. I ask him, but can he do it.

Derek didn't have an answer for us. Nathan asks with a smirk, what do you all think David will do. You all heard him. If David chose to force Charles into overdrive, there is chance he might win. Tess says, yeah. But I don't think his overdrive will be walk in the park. In his condition, David is too weak to beat Charles. Marina says with harsh voice, okay. Now even I don't want David to fight anymore. I am more worried now that even Marina is feeling the pressure. I turn to Blake. He looks me and says, I wouldn't want David should fight Charles in his state. Fighting me is one thing. But Charles is already so powerful, his overdrive will be too much to handle for any one person.

I am finally relieved that others are on the same level as me. There is too much danger for David to continue this. I can't let his stubbornness get him killed. I turn to Derek, I know we agreed to give David chance, but you have to admit this has gone longer now. I don't know what's David's going to do, but we can't let him make Charles go into overdrive. Derek doesn't give me an answer. He looks to me and to David. He must realize we have to end the match now before David gets killed.

Derek then turns back to me, you are right. I wanted to let David fight to his content. But this too much of risk. Kafar will not be happy with this, but it's much better than David getting badly hurt or worse, dying. I become less anxious now when he too understood the risk David is putting himself in. Suddenly Charles loud roar comes through the Charm. His normal voice is already loud, the speaker so close to use made his want to cover our ears. Marina hurriedly closes her Charm. I turn back to the arena. Charles was wriggling out of the Kuret body while grunting with pain.

Catherine shouts, what the hell. Why is Charles doing that. Suddenly Charles is not going to wait around, instead he is getting out of the trap David created for him. I turn to David. My eyes twitched at what he was trying to do. The crazy guy was trying to make to create his Kuret storm. I was too shocked to be mad at him. Few seconds later Charles comes out the hole in the giants chest. Charles didn't have Kuritines or any hair made of Kuret. His entire body looked like a animal with his fur shredded off. Just a brown skin covered with few wounds. Beside him, the giant body begins to crumble and slowly turns to Kuret dust. Without waiting to heal, he begins to charge at David.

The sudden change in the pace of the battle let me dazed for a second. I ask others in a nervous tone, is Charles going to use overdrive himself now. Blake spats, no way. This can't be it. It's not as easy as it looks you know. You can't just snap your fingers and go into overdrive. I reply, then what's with the sudden change in Charles. He just tore off from the giant Kuret body to chase after David. Marina says, he's gone feral. At this point, anything is possible, I thought. I have to go inside now and stop the match.

But I momentarily stop when David changed his Kuret. Instead of using his storm, he prepares a dome around him. Derek says, I think he is trying to use his new Kuret transformation. I said, yeah. But I can tell its not same anymore. He had more Kuret around him earlier. Blake agrees with me, yeah. Its definitely weaker. Marina says, should we just stop the match now. Matt asks, but if Charles is not going to use his overdrive, then its still fine right. David might be able to continue like this.

I wish we had that luxury to think like that. And then suddenly Marina's wrist begins beeping. Marinas pull out her arm. M pops out and says. Red alert mode initialized. The same stuff that she showed us earlier was back again. I can't read what's displayed, but its definitely not good. M says, boss's heart rate is too high. He is having trouble with steady breathing now. He hasn't lost much blood, but the risk of infection and shock has become immanent. If boss doesn't stop over-exerting in the next minute, his vitals would drop considerably. Please stand by for emergency actions.

This made my chest hurt. David's finally pushed past his limit now. I turned my eyes to arena. David had already wrapped his arm with his exploding Kuret and zipping at Charles. I can't believe David is still not giving up. I can't watch this. I need to stop him. I saw Charles slowing down near David. I was too much worried about David to care about that. I pushed off the ground and ran towards the barrier. I had the Kuritine Marina gave me in my hand. I didn't even waste to stop a moment when I come near the barrier.

The Kuritine in my hand biggens to shine. My entire body gets covered with a small layer of Kuret. When I hit the barrier, the barrier didn't stop me. Instead, the Kuret layer I had on me begins to create a thin door ahead me. I pass through it without much resistance. From the corner of my eye, I saw Derek behind me also running towards the barrier. I turn my gaze back ahead. David landed a punch on Charles who blocked it with his arm. David backs away, but Charles doesn't move. Instead, there is smoke coming out of him now.

I didn’t even think to halt for a second seeing something bizarre. But then Charles real body comes out. I abruptly stop my run and let go of the hurricane I was using to propel forward. What, I ask aloud. Both of them have stopped fighting and looked like they are talking. What just happened. Charles was no longer using his Kuret. I couldn't see his properly from this far. But his clothes were torn in places. He had gotten blood on him in places. His face also looked a little weird. What's happening, why did Charles suddenly stop using his Kuret body.

I should have gone to David now they have stopped fighting. But there's a small chance that Charles is actually surrendering. If I back away now, then people might not notice that I am inside the barrier. I take less conspicuous movements and steps back to others. Derek was almost inside the barrier. He stopped one step before entering himself. The Kuritine on my hand was gone, so I can't leave now. I wasn't going to leave anyways. I turn my face to others and gesture with my hands to know what happened. Matt shook his head and spoke something in audible. I didn't realize the barrier even silences the voices from outside. Actually, now that I think about it, I don't hear the noise from the crowd too.

I gesture my fingers to my ear to tell them I don't hear anything. Blake raises his palm to me and points to Marina. She is in the middle of casting a charm. I turn my back to others and face the arena. They are definitely talking about something. David had let go of his Kuret on his arms. He wouldn't do that if it wasn't needed. Or maybe he become so tired that he can't use his Kuret anymore. Whatever's going on, they have temporarily stopped their fighting. Few seconds later, I see the barrier near me forms a small charm. Then I hear Marina's voice from it, can you hear me now. I nod, yes. I see Matt shoving Nathan aside and speaking into the charm, what's going on. They stopped fighting. Is Charles giving up.

He had the same thought as me. I turn my back to them saying, I have no idea. I can't hear them. Derek voice comes next, stay vigilant Vanessa. I don't think Charles is giving up. They are talking way too long for a simple surrender. Blake asks, Marina can you create another charm for us to hear. She replies, not if you want everyone to see a charm forming near them. The best bet would be just to have someone from the bloodline of binocular eyes and who can lip read. No one here can do that. We have no choice to wait for now. I had a hard time keeping myself still. I lost count how many times I have been stopped or decided not to intervene now. Usually it was David who makes me mad, but this one was due to Charles.

They had a long discussion. A minute gone by like this. Nathan asks, what is going on. The crowd is beginning to become more restless. Jess says, can hardly blame them. We have been seeing a high intensity battle for so long, even when they both were down earlier. Now suddenly they are chatty. Tessa asks, isn't there a rule that if both fighters are not engaged in battle for too long, they both get disqualified. Matt says, please don't tell they both are going to drop out like this. Cass smirks, you think that stupid what's his face would do that.

She had a point. Its become evident that the match can't end like this. So what are those two doing then. Another minute went by like this. The suspense has been killing me. Can't believe that them not fighting would make me worry this much. Marina asks, ah, Vanessa maybe you should go to them and ask what's the hold up. To be honest, I was thinking the same. Then Derek says in hurry, don't. I mean don't interfere when they still have time. Its almost 2 minutes now, so they have 3 more minutes before the are disqualified. At least according to the rules. They are not fighting, so lets wait for now. M's gone back to her that orange alert, so David is not in danger yet. In fact, he might be stretching this purposefully to buy time and recover some lost energy.

Yeah, that’s also true. David's not actively fighting. So its fine. But what could they be talking about so much. Others on the other side were whispering and discussing possibilities of their discussion. Were they trying just chatting each about each others skills. Could be. Then finally something changes after about another minute. David was waving his arm to us. Charles beside him faces us. David raised his hands up and gestures a T with his arm. I am a little shocked to see this. Marina shouts, what. They are asking for break. Right now. Nathan laughs, what do they think. This is not a game, they can't just ask for a break. I ask, should I go to them now.

Blake says, maybe. Looks like this finished up their talk. Derek pitches in, ah, I know that was obvious, but I don't know they are thinking. We can't just stop this match like this. Marina, open a charm near them so we can hear them. Marina asks, really. What about not wanting to interfere the match. He replies, things have changed since then. Charles is not stopping David, so he also wants the same. We can't just take a break without knowing the reason. After a short pause he continues, but I don't want to you to get into trouble. So just open a one way channel like you did last time. We will only hear them and they can't hear us.

Marina thinks for moment. She agrees and starts to prepare another charm. She says, okay, I am going to extend this charm to them, like a conference call. The charm on my side of the barrier brightens up. I turn my eyes to the two men inside the arena. A small charm begins to appear near them. It was behind Charles. Charles turns and walks to it from the side. David saw it too comes closer. Charles voice comes out, ah, what is this. Its been so long, I had forgotten his normal voice.

Then David's voice comes out, that’s Marina's work. She was using that to hear my interrogation earlier. Very much like a pepping tom. Marina scoffs, damn. I got caught. Charles chuckles a little, really. I didn't notice it. Well, it doesn't matter if they heard it. If you go with my idea everyone will know about it anyway. Charles idea. Is that what they have been discussing. David clears his throats, so here's the short version of what we talked about. Charles says he can't go into overdrive right now. And after hearing his reasons, I understand why he can't. But I can't defeat him without it. So he wants to propose something. But he can't do until he talks to Kafar about something.

Huh, I spoke aloud. That’s what they have discussing this long about. David says, oh. So this just one way channel. Nice thinking. Don't want to interfere too much. I get it. But now we want a strategic break, so to speak. Charles says next, Derek, I need you to go and get Kafar here right now. I understand its little out of the norm, but I need him here before making a decision. Everyone turn to Derek who was even more clueless now. He was thinking hard on what to do. Then David spoke, you must be confused. That’s understandable. I figured even Kafar would be reluctant. So tell him this message from me, if doesn't come here in the next 2 minutes I will knock out Charles right now. I don't like to win this way, but I'll do it. From the rules, we had about 5 minutes to resume fighting. He needs to make some sort of announcement about taking a short break in the remaining time. Tell him I said it okay.

David made this demand like a dictator. Charles asks, really. If you were okay wining like that you could have just knocked me out as soon as I let go of my Kuret body. David clicks he tongue, obviously I am not going to do that. You know that, they know it. But Kafar doesn't. In his mind if I do it, he can't spin this any other way than my clear victory. So come guys. The clocks ticking. Derek a moment later says, huh. I guess I need to go talk to Kafar. Excuse me all. He had a stern look on him, but he did what he was asked. He walks away back inside the stadium.

Charles ask, did I miss something. Why do you think Kafar will do it to stop me from losing. David chuckles, come on. You do know what's going on here right. You heard the announcement he made earlier. A moment Charles, yes. I heard him, but I don't get it. After few seconds David with a confused voice, wait. You really don't get what I am getting at. What about the time you were lying on the ground, you didn’t find it strange you weren't disqualified. Charles is still confused, what about it. I got up before the timer right. So I was safe then.

I got a little annoyed at Charles now. Doesn't he realize he got such favorable treatment in this match. Marina shouts, oh hell no. Charles doesn't know he was saved by a loophole. I am just as shocked as her. Then David says, ah. Never mind. Forget I said anything. You don't need to worry about it now. You'll know what I am talking about it later. David chose to let it lie for now. I didn't get why he didn't tell Charles about it. Charles should know that if Ned and Kafar hadn't intervened, David would already be the winner.

Charles replies, ah, okay. If you say so. I see him moving to his side and bit and sat near on a boulder on the ground, well. We don't have anything to do for now. How about I ask your friends to bring me something to drink. I am suddenly parched. I also wouldn't mind getting a some of the those tasty refreshments I saw outside today. What it called, yes, oreikitines. I almost laughed as Charles made such an outrageous ask. He knows we can't just interfere with the match. David didn't respond, but I could tell from Charles voice that he was giving Charles a look, what. I really am thirsty. Besides, what's the harm since we are asking for a break anyways.

A few seconds later David laughs, yeah. You got a point. Actually, can someone grab my bag from the room where we kept our stuff. I have a cocktail of energy drink I made for myself. I don't know how much it will help me right now, but I feel like I am about to croak again if I don't get at least some water. I looked to others and ask, are we really doing this. I mean, if they are really taking a break, it should be okay right. No one knew if they should consider their request. Then David says, oh. Right. You can get the stuff, but don't need to bring it us yet. We can wait till after Kafar makes the announcement.

Jess says, if he really would allow it. We don't know he will do it right. Nathan says, lets get them some water at least. They both sound like they really need it. Matt says, I know where David kept his bag. I'll get it then. He nods at Cass and scurries away inside the stadium. David noticed that from there, thanks Matt. And someone else can maybe get something for Charles too. This time Nathan offers unexpectedly, I usually get others to get me stuff, but I am feeling a little magnanimous right now, so I think I will get it for him.

No one stopped him as he left us to get Charles some snacks, but it is strange he would offer to be an errand boy. David chuckles, really. He offered huh. Must be on Charles side for sure. David has probably no idea about the bet made, or how true he was. Charles asks, appreciate it man. He then groans a little, Ah, my shoulder is killing me. Did you really need to use so much force. David scoffs, you must be a comedian. You will heal soon enough, I won't. Despite how we both look, I am in worse shape than you right now. At least David was aware of how messed up he was right now. Charles replies, point made. Shouldn't be complaining I guess. I do have to admit, if my mother saw me right now, she would beret me constantly on how I got wounded this badly by an outsider.

David says, your mother was the previous alpha right, did she made to Earth by any chance. Charles replies, no. Both my parents and my wife didn't make it. David says, that’s rough. Sorry. Charles says, no need to be sorry. Many of us have become orphan now. I guess I didn't think about Charles family. Looks like David knew something more about Charles than us. Maybe that’s what they were discussing earlier. David asks, but you got all your kids with you I hope. Charles says, yes. I have five children with me right now. Two of them born here on Earth. David replies, whoa. Quite a big family you got here. I don't know where you guys were hiding in Citradel, but must not be great for them to be raised in secrecy and on an alien planet.

Charles says with a stern voice, exactly. I didn't want to continue to keep them hidden, almost caged. Now that our existence is out in the open, I hope it will become better for them. For all our bloodline. David asks, speaking of bloodline maybe now you can tell me how you guys hid…he gets cut off by a microphone noise. I turn my back to them. Even though barrier muffles most of the noises, the loud voices still make it. I see Kafar coming into the podium. He began speaking to the confused masses, everyone, please may I have attention. He waits for the crowd to quite down. Then he speaks, it looks like we have some problem with the match. As you all know, we don't allow breaks in middle of the match, but seeing as we have hit one hour mark and still don't have clear victor, we decided to allow a short break. Once we know more about the fighters condition, we will let you know immediately. I will personally be heading down to check on the situation. So please remain seated for a short interval. Thank you.

He then walks back inside. I turn to others. Blake says, well. That sounded almost reasonable. Marina says with a smile, so then its official. Should we all go inside and meet them. I have few question to ask Charles and about a million for David. Tessa says, I don't think it’s a good idea for all of us to just waltz in. We don't know what going to happen, so you should be here. Marina scoffs at her. Blake says, you can listen in from here anyways. Plus I don't think we have all the time to chat. Once Kafar comes down, it will be all business.

I ask, what's the idea Charles is talking about. Catherine asks, Vanessa. You are already inside. You should go ahead. I really wanted to go, but I am still hesitant about meeting Charles a little. Another overdrive user is here. Its a little childish, but I feel uneasy now that I know about it. Blake says, yeah. You have been worried about David the most. Best you check on him now. Once Matt brings David's stuff, I will bring it to you. I face him for a while through the barrier, thanks. Blake nods and began walking away from them.

Now that things had cooled down, I didn't need to hurry up. I took my time navigating the torn arena. The holes all over the place made it not possible to walk straight towards them. Their were boulders lying everywhere. Then I crossed the place where David attacked Charles after flying up in the air. The entire arena was a giant mess. Grasses were torn away, debris everywhere and some holes were surprisingly deep. Few seconds in, I could hear them now. Charles says, well. Well. Who do we have here. He is still siting on the rock when he addressed me.

Charles looked worse up close. One side of his face had swollen and had only one eye open. His bruises were more visible now. I could see clear signs of bloodied clothes on him. How in the world is Charles still able to talk let alone laugh in such a condition. He might be healing, but its way too slow for an alpha. Guess he really is like a human when he reverts back. A trait common with David and Blake. I walk up little nervous. David turns to me with a little smile, you already know her, but let me. This is Vanessa, the omega of her bloodline Ozarek. Charles gets up on my arrival, of course. I don't need an introduction for this charming young Medrone. I have known your battles against Hives. Its my regret that I couldn't help you out.

I stuttered a little hearing his smooth and pleasing voice, no, its okay. Thanks. Nice to finally meet you in person. Its a little weird meeting you like this though. I have only heard stories about you and its so unreal to see you even fight up close. Charles chuckles, kind of you to say dear. But you don't have to sugar coat it. He turns to David, this guy here has whopped my ass. I am actually embarrassed. The first public appearance of our bloodline after centauries, and immediately I let him make a mockery out of me. I never imagined such a humble guy was that violent person all this time. In my mind I had pictured him to be something of a hard core personality.

I reply, no. No. Believe me, no one is thinking like this. If you knew how many people are cheering for you even now, you can tell they are in awe of you in every way. I can understand why Citradel has been protected so well all these years. You guys might just be the perfect warriors to protect the city. I then face David, you just had the bad luck of fighting this crazy genius. Charles laughs, is that so. I guess I am the one with bad luck. David smiles at me, I only heard you saying I am genius. He had the nerve to be amusing now. He looks like he is actually enjoying himself. I thought to hit him in the neck, but looking at his injuries, he might just get knocked out that easily.

David says, okay. Jokes aside, I do have to ask, did Kafar mention anything specifics about us. We couldn't hear him properly from his far due to the barrier. I reply, he didn't say much. Just that since you guys having been fighting for more than an hour and still no victor, he will asses the situation himself. David shakes his head slightly, okay. So that’s good. He then faces Charles, how sure are you that Kafar will give you the answer you need. Charles thinks for a moment, its not like I am expecting something from him. I just want to know his honest thoughts about it. If it works for me, I will tell you my idea. David raises an eyebrow, huh. I see. So something that you only need to know from Kafar. Best I can guess is something about the deal you had with him.

Charles smiles, bulls eye. Nothing gets past you huh. He turns to me pointing his finger at him. I chuckle a little, you can say that again. I walk over towards David and lean a little to whisper, can I talk to you a little. David turns to face me with a expression saying he expected me to ask him. He replies, sure. Charles do you mind. Charles raises his arms, not at all. Please, I am sure she must have tons of things to ask you. You bet ass I am. David waves

and we walk a little away from Charles.

Once we were earshot away from Charles. I blurt out to him, what the freak David. You said you had more to show us, you didn't say it meant you were doing breaking the laws of Kuret. You have any idea the roller coaster of emotions we gone through ever since that first stunt with pure Kuret blast. At least with your Kuret transformation was your own Kuret. So how are you able to use my Kuret. Blakes, and others. David smirks a little, I know I shouldn't be enjoying this, but I can't help it. I knew well in advance that this would create a big stir.

I honestly wanted to kick him on the knees. Suddenly he got a ego big enough the size of his head. David raises his arm up in air, whoa. Okay. Too far. Sorry. Its just I got carried away seeing you so much frustrated. It's a little funny. I rebuke, do you have any idea how close you came to be disqualified. If it weren't for others, I would have dragged you already outside. David replies, yeah. I can imagine my behaviors has changed a little. I almost yelled, at him, little. You must be out of your mind. You are almost always logical in your decisions. But you have completely thrown it away. You were ready to fight in your condition against an overdrive user. On top of that he is a Heraknus, a mythical bloodline. You must have hit your head pretty bad to decide to continue like this.

David nods, you maybe be right about hitting my head. I actually had a …he pauses suddenly. Well, that's nothing to go into right now. I am sorry though. I can't tell you all the reasons for doing this. Not because its personnel, but I am still figuring it out myself. But I appreciate your patience for not making me drop from the match. I know its no excuse, but thanks for giving me chances, even though you had no reason to. And just like that, those few words made me loose my temper. David might have changed a little, but he is still him. I reply, you are not getting off easily next time. I think when you made that promise you intentionally lied, or at least told half truths. You planned to make risky decisions from the beginning, completely ignoring my warnings.

David eyes widen at me, ah. No. His voice came out shaken. I knew it. I don't know what I wanted to do, grab his neck in anger and hug him seeing his is okay. David replies, ah, sorry. I just didn't want to you to think I was going to lose. I didn't want you to stop me. You are right, I wasn't serious about forfeiting if it became dangerous. But I was promising about winning this match. At this I urge him to answer, why. Why its important. He turns away from my eyes, I…well, I just do. Lets leave it that. You know me, I don't lie or hide without good reasons.

I would understand for most things, sure. But what could make him push so hard against Charles. I don't think David is going to open up, even if keep pestering him, he still wouldn't share it with me. Maybe no one. After a while I realize its best to leave it. Its not like I haven't kept things from others for personnel reasons. I sigh, okay. I won't ask again. But if you are going to be stubborn about it, I'll also be the same. I will drag you out of here the moment you are injured gravely.

David replies, I'll hold on to your decision then. It definitely makes me feel at ease a bit more knowing you are looking out for me. I smiled at him, you have become a pain in the ass. David shakes his head a little, oh, its nice reversal that I don't have to think that you the same way. That comment was a cheap jab at me. I lightly stab my elbow at his arm. David takes one step back, okay. Okay. Message received. Loud and clear. Seeing him so unfazed by the precarious situation he was in is insane. But somehow the ooze of confidence he is showing makes me want to believe he can actually win.

# Vanessa (Chapter 35)

Sunday, February 11, 2024 21:23

I cross my arm and ask, so. You still haven't told me how you are able to use others Kuret. David twitches his mouth trying to form words. I immediately ask, and don't say you can't tell me. You already showed us your tricks to the whole world. Its even live streaming to everywhere. I can imagine everyone coming up to you demanding an explanation on how its possible for your anti-Kuret to create so many other Kurets. David a moment later says, it's not that its something I want to keep it a secret. But its hard to explain. You said I was breaking laws of Kuret. Sadly I am not doing something so preposterous.

I get a little impatient now. He continuous before I show it in my face, the technical details of the exact way I do it is riddled with math and science. What, I shriek out hearing those unexpected words. He says, its true. I am not creating Kuret okay. That's just simply not possible. But what I am doing is capturing the ambient Kuret floating in the air with my Kuret. My Kuret works like magnet of same poles with normal Kuret. So instead of letting the Kuret run away, I entrap it within my Kuret. Like a bowl scoping up Kuret from the air. I then form a mini dome, a sphere around the captured Kuret. I use my Kuret to condense trapped Kuret inside enough that it solidifies into a small mass of pure Kuret. This is the source of all my Kuret blasts.

I couldn't believe he said all this with a straight face. I raise my palm in confusion, wait. I am confused. How is that possible. Even if you capture it with your Kuret, wouldn't it just escape. David replies, no. That's the core of this trick. I told you, I am using math and science. But its not simple. I had to use run simulation with M to use 3D geometry, spatial computational, vector in higher dimensions, thermodynamics. I could keep listing all the stuff, but I don't want to confuse you more.

He very non subtly implied I didn't understand any of those words. Worse part is he wasn't wrong. I only heard about these things in passing during the college we attended few years back. I reply, you are serious. You are saying you used Earth science to make it work. David nods, yes. It took a while to figure the mechanics behind it. It took time, effort and whole lot of patience. Honestly, at times I wasn't sure I could do it. But after several tries, I was able to do it. Even now, it only works after a painstaking amount of time.

I couldn't believe what I heard. No maybe I can. He does this sort of thing always. I can't help being impressed by him. He used Earth knowledge to make something of Medrine work. That's no easy feat. But then I realize this doesn't explain everything. I ask, okay. I guess it sort of makes sense how you managed to use pure Kuret blast. But what about turning them into other Kurets. How do you explain that. Earth knowledge can't help with that. David nods that one was a combination of Earth and Medrine knowledge. But, he looks around him, I can't tell you how I did it. At least not now. Not here. I don't know who it could be, but someone might be listening in. He walks to my side and turns towards the back of a small boulder lying nearby. There was another charm floating in that air there. What's this, it looked similar to the charm Marina casted earlier.

David leans in, and I don't mean you guys. And yes, I know you were listening on me talking. I am little disappointed Marina. I thought you were ready for it, but if you can't keep even such a simple charm hidden, you clearly are not ready for it. David then faced Marina directly. I turn along with him. I see Marina raising her arms in a fit and stomping the ground hard. She must be cursing too. David chuckles, just kidding. He straighten his back, I will keep the end of my bargain as promised. I doubt anyone else other than Blake or Nathan would have seen it.

I got curious, wait, who else do you mean. David shrugs I don't know who. But someone has been interfering with the matches. Not just mine but others too. Blake and Marina were almost poisoned. And my battle with Charles is also manipulated someway. So for the time being I am keeping this part a secret in case someone is watching me right now. Whatever I told you earlier, anyone would have eventually figured out. They would notice that whenever I use my Kuret storm, the Kuret around me disappears instead of being repelled. Reveling that piece of info doesn't change things for me.

I was surprised that he was revealing his tricks so easily. It makes sense that he doesn't want to give any more secrets. I sigh, okay. I'll need an explanation later. He nods, thanks. A moment later he asks, can we get back to Charles. I need to ask him something. I replies, yeah. I done. For now. I stress on that last part. He got the message. We both went back to Charles who looked so board sitting alone. He smiles at our return, so good chat. Got anything good from him. He asks me.

I waved my hand a little, with him its always a half way compromise. Charles replies, I see. Well, being cautious is what keeps one alive. Especially in such dangerous times. David asks, thanks, but I don't she meant it that. She probably meant it something along the line of reprimanding me later for making her worry this much. It's a little eerie to hear how easily he figured my behavior. Charles chuckles, oh I understand the sentiment. I am little nervous to face my wife right now. She must be worried about this also.

I ask him, should I ask others to get her here. He shakes his head, no. That's all right. I don't think its necessary. Besides, she knows I will be winning in the end. David retorts, now whose awfully full of themselves. You don't think she might be nervous seeing how this match has gone. Charles shifts his body a little, nah. Okay, maybe a little. Honestly, if you bring her here. She might try to stop the match too. He then stares straight at David, but obviously I can't have that. Not when a great opportunity has come at me.

Oh god. Its not just David. Both of them are raring to just go. I sigh. How can I show them enough reason to not make this a life and death match. David clears his throat, anyways. I was about to ask you a question before Kafar interrupted us. He takes a step to his side, I know you have been hiding in Medrine for so centuries, but I can't believe no one knew about you. Medrine isn't that big that you can hide this long unnoticed. Unless you practice polygamy, you need other Medrones to continue the bloodline. So you can't have been completely cut off from society. How come no one heard about you. Charles thinks for a second. He says, its not people didn't know about us. The royal family knows about us. A couple of other groups of people know. And yes, we didn't hide away in some underground or in sea for centuries.

He continues, we did however occupy mountains and valleys that were difficult to be habituated by regular people. So with some help from neighboring villages, our ancestors have found a way to keep us hidden. David presses on, okay. Are you sure people knew? Blake, Nathan and Rose are from royal bloodline. And I don't think they heard about you. And especially Blake, he is a shadow. If an organization like shadow didn't know you existed, then I can't imagine anyone else knew. Charles scratches his chin, ah. I have heard about this shadow group back on Medrine. Never had the pleasure of meeting any of them. But I assure you, the royals know about me. I have even met few people of my parents generation.

He leans back and tries to recall some memories, we even fought against a royal once when I was a kid. I ask, really. Who was it. Charles thinks a little, I don't remember his name. He had barged inside one of the village who helped us and stirred up some trouble. So my mother went to kick him out. I imagine that particular royal didn't know about us then, but he definitely learned about us. I reply shocked, wow. So you guys can just force a royal out without causing an international incident. He shrugs, honestly. It wasn't a big deal of us. And I do think he was reprimanded by his elders for doing something this reckless under our domain. He turns to David, so yes. To answer your question, a lot of people in high places knew about us.

David is silent is for some time. Is it that hard for him to believe they couldn't remain in hiding. I ask him, are you still not convinced. David turns to me, no. I understand. It's just hard for me to believe Blake didn't know such a huge secret. I got confused here, how do you know he doesn't know. He looks a little shaken at that, I mean, its pretty obvious he didn't tell you guys anything. Must be Derek who explained stuff. Right. He was right. Yet I am a little suspicious of this behavior. He is making it a bit more personnel than he should. I said, maybe Blake or Nathan were too little to be told this secret. You know. And maybe Shadows also didn't know about Heraknus, I don't see the problem.

David says, its not a problem. Just got curious that's all. Charles continuous, speaking of people who I have met, I actually fought one not from the royal bloodline. Now this guy was a pain in my ass. Let me tell you, after my mother and David, he was the toughest person I fought. Now what was his name. I forgot, but not his Kuret. Its funny actually…I raise my palm to him, sorry to interrupt. I think your snacks are here. My eyes picked up one person carrying a bag approaching the others. It was Matt, he got David's bag. From the other side of the barrier edge, I saw Nathan walking with a large paper bag on his arms. He must have brought the eatables for Charles.

Charles smiles and says, finally. I am starving. Hope he got the one I wanted to try. One thing I will say, you guys put a lot of effort in making sure people get here. I never imagined to see our Medrine culture being reawakened here. The food here looks like they were really from Medrine. Even the drinks too. And I can't believe you guys even showed that amazing opening drama of our home. It somewhat feels we got a piece of Medrine here now. David nods, of course, this is one of the biggest event in over a decade for all Medrones on Earth. I don't know how much Kafar has told you, but we got all riding on this tournament. Not just the results, but making sure people come safety arrive here. And for those who can't, they can view it without compromising our existence. A butt load of money and time went into preparation.

Charles nods, oh I know. A lot of my bloodline members were called for escorting them till here. Even when I came, I was put with special guards since I didn't have Kuret until then. I asked him a question that's been bugging me for some time, isn't it a little too unfair that you guys can't use Kuret for so long. I mean I heard on Earth it got worsened, but did you guys try to figure a way to work around this huge weakness. Charles nods, you are not the first person to ask me. Even Derek asked me. All I can say its out Kuret bloodline, nothing can be done about it. We did try various ways to overcome it, but so far nothings worked.

I ask, I ask because if you had your Kuret all the time, you would be an incredible asset to all of us. But if we are attacked at the wrong time, you would be instead be in danger yourselves. He replies, believe me. No one is frustrated more than me. I couldn't even join you guys last year in that war against Hive. And even before then, I had to rely on Derek and others to keep us safe few times. He didn't need to say it in words. His pained expression showed a clear pain and frustration over this. I can't believe someone so incredibly strong still can't be relied on so easily.

David says, I don't know if it would help, but maybe now that we are trying to pool all of us together. Maybe someone can help come up with a solution for your problem. I mean, more people means more ideas. And maybe just maybe someday you guys will figure it out. Charles replies, yes. I hope for the same. Part of the reason I agreed to enter into this tournament. David smirks, I thought you said you came to fight strong people like Blake, Marina, Nathan, Tessa and Vanessa. Charles laughs, that too obviously. But I didn't get to fight them you know. Instead I got stuck with you.

David smiles, like Vanessa said, its your bad luck. He replies, you know people usually are more scared at the prospect of fighting a Heraknus alpha. Even that royal guy who messed up earlier had to face my mother when he got her attention. After a good beating, he ran away after so fast that he left some of his valuable stuff behind. David says, oh don't worry about me being scared. I already am scared. What, he didn't look one bit. He then smiles, I am scared how popular I would go down in Medrines history by becoming first ever to beat a Heraknus alpha on overdrive.

Freak. That was so bad. But's what's so crazy about it is he didn't even show one bit of concern or fear in his voice. It was like saying such a thing was easy as saying he likes a fruit. Charles stared at him for a second, then he laughs. Chills, he says, I got the chills when you said that. Love the confidence. Even when you are so arrogant right now. Makes me believe you are correct for the only person for this. Their intense glare is making me nervous now. I turn back to others.

There has been some more movement among them. Nathan finally meets up with them. Then Blakes alone separates from the group. He carried one bag in hand and the paper bag on other. He then walks across the barrier inside. So he was one to come here. Marina would be furious not being included with us. I face back to David, how long are we going to wait before Kafar joins. Its been more than 5 minutes now. David says, he must be discussing with other admins about something. Some damage control maybe. But shouldn't be much longer now. He can't keep us waiting for long too. Charles says, and if Derek told about my request, he might know what I am going to talk to him. He might be just preparing himself for it.

I want to know what's so important he needs to know from Kafar. From ahead Blake reached us, hey. Special delivery. Sorry we didn't bring in immediately. Marina was insisting hard to meet you. Took some time to convince before she cooled down and agreed. I bet she was furious. Its not everyday you have 3 overdrive users in the same place. David says, no problem. I will make it up her, so don't worry about her. He faces Charles, I don't think I

need introductions for him too.

Charles got up from his seat and walks towards Blake. Blake hurriedly thrusts the contents on his arms to David beside him. David stumbles while struggling suddenly to keep them from falling, dude. Chill. David whispers. I help David by taking the bag from his hand. Charles says, of course. The royal prince is the most famous person who is also a dazzling true alpha. Blakes shakes his hand and looked surprised once he saw his face. He tries to put out words but it was a little stammered. Ah, thanks. I put down the bag down, not what you were expecting huh.

Blake says, ah, yeah a bit. I mean we only heard all your conversations. And now that we are up close. Ah, how do I put it. They let their hands go. Charles offers, you don't have to hide it kid. I look like hell. There is no other way to explain it. Blake nervously laughs and turns to me. I shrug gesturing just go with it. David hands over the paper bag to Charles, I noticed you gave both of them compliments. But you didn't say anything to me. You have been just complaining to me.

Charles takes the bag from him and laughs, I am not nice to people who are a pain in my ass. David says, oh yeah. I don't find you that much of a pain in my ass, you know, since I will be defeating you soon enough. David grins a little. They were proud of themselves with such ego checks. Blakes looks confused and rolls his eyes to both of them, ah, so being here is just as tense as hearing you both. Charles smirks while he takes out a plastic cup from the bag and pulls out the lid, smells good. He takes a sip from it and gulps down the content on his throat. He puts his hand down and smiles, ah, this is simply divine. I don't think we have anything like this in Citradel. He starts drinking more.

David took a knee and was scrummaging in the bag. There were dozens of bottles with some labels on them. I can't read them, but they were color coded. He finds the one he was searching for, a bottle with blue marks on it. He uncaps it and begins to drink it. Something went wrong, he turns to his side and immediately spits the liquid out. I ask, what happened. David wipes the liquid dripping from his lips, ah shit. I knew it was going to be bad, but didn't expect this. It's so bad he even coughed a little. I took the bottle from his hand took a smell from the edge. My nostril flares up with a bunch of mix of different disinfecting stuff, it smelled like a hospital & dead body at the same time in here.

I pull it away from my face a second later, shit. Are you sure you should be drinking this. David stops heaving and takes the bottle from me, this tastes so bad because of all the different mixtures of medicines and energy boosting ingredients. I couldn't make it taste better or add sweeteners without reducing its efficacy. He takes a big breath and slowly gulps down that disgusting liquid. His face turned sour when he drank, but he kept drinking despite the taste. Blake asks Charles, should you guys be so frivolous. You know you are still in the middle of the match.

Charles is now biting into one of the sandwiches. He chomps down on it while speaking with a half filled mouth, its necessary for me. Kafar mentioned we have been fighting for an hour, even if we did spend some time lying on the ground, I have spent too much of my Kuret. I am probably at a third of my original strength. I reply, really. You told David you could fight for hours. Charles nods while taking another bite, yes. But that's only if I don't suffer another Kuret blackout. Getting hit with it twice has made me vulnerable to another one. And as you already heard, my Kuret control has weakened. I thought I could replenish even some of my energy while we still have some time.

David finishes the entire bottle in ago. He pulls out another smaller bottle from the bag. This one looked like plain water. He first rinses his mouth with that water and then drinks it half way to the bottles size. He spats, guh. That was a weird experience. He puts the bottle back inside the bag. He then leans back to a boulder and lays his head back. He then closes his eyes, okay. I am going to some shut eyes for a minute. Wake me up when Kafar crosses the barrier. Blake asks, you sure. What if you accidently doze off and don't wake up. David without opening his eyes says, not going to happen. The drink I just had will soon take effect and keep me awake. I just need some time for my mind to calm down.

Blake looks at me asking my opinion. I reply, its fine I guess. Blake a little unsure. We both decided to leave David side for a bit. Charles says, so the rumors were true, he doesn't even have our stamina. I just thought it was exaugurated to make him look bad. I reply, no, its true. Most of the time he has Human limits. Charles clicks his tongue, damn. He's got just as a badly effect from Earth. Blake says, yeah. He looks at me with a suspicious look. I shook my head. Its best not to tell Charles what really effected David on Earth. I change the topic before Charles continues this line of discussion, Charles. I wanted to ask you a question ever since we heard you could overdrive.

Charles turns to me and waits for me ask, is there anyway to learn to overdrive. Others have said it just happened. Is the same for you. Or did you somehow learned to do it. Charles looks at with one curious eye. He nods, I see. You want to achieve overdrive, isn't it. My expression gave away my intent. Charles says, I didn't learn it. It's sort of just happened. My small hope got crushed hearing him. Dammit, I thought he might have triggered it differently. Charles continuous, I actually don't know if anyone in my alpha line tried to learn it. But with my own experience having used it, I am sure its not something you can figure it out. He turns to Blake, you must know it about it as well, right. Its harsh, but its probably just a luck of the draw. Some alpha's are just more predisposed than other since birth.

Blake nods slightly, yes. My father use to tell stories of those who could do it. No one knew exactly how they did it, the storis only tell what happens after they achieve it. Charles nods, yes. Same with me. I felt a brief moment of anger. I really thought I would get some clue. But even Charles didn't have any idea. Marina did say that there is no way to force it. I didn't want to wait for it, if it ever to even happen. I still am jealous that these guys are so lucky to get picked my fate. I would kill for that chance.

Charles speaks to Blake, its actually nice to talk to someone about this other than my family. We need as many people who could do it. Although, I was really surprised when you used it against Marina. Until then, she was the only I knew apart from me. Blake smiles, I accidently unlocked it few months ago. I actually wanted to keep it hidden until my match with David. But she was just too powerful to defeat without it. And that’s what got to me in the end. David figured out my overdrive. Charles nods with understanding, I was here for your match. It looked like you had trouble using your overdrive. Blakes says, yeah. Marina says it takes years to master it.

Charles replies, different people need different time to master it. You probably would have won if you had full control. Blake says, maybe. But I not so sure after what I just saw. David pulled out some crazy stuff now. Even when we all heard what he just explained how he did it to Vanessa, I still have hard time believing him. Charles asks, really. Can I ask how he did that. David himself said its not a big secret, so its fine to share. I said, he used Earth science to do it. I am not sure what that meant exactly, but obviously it works. Charles looked at me with an incredulous look, is that how. What an trendy idea. A lot of people are trying to mix Earth and Medrine science. But most of them have been for food, architecture or technology. First time I am hearing something like being used for Kuret. Kid's a genius no doubt about it.

I said, he has been like that for years. You think we would be used to it, but no. Today we got a bunch of reveals no one expected. Blake says, true. And not just from him. You being here might become even more stir amongst others after the tournament. Charles smiles, we will definitely have to deal with the repercussions of coming out of hiding after centuries. Although everyone in our bloodline is prepared. Many are still reserved, but we all collective decided its for the good. We have to actively work with others to win against Hive. And this tournament showed a good number of powerful warriors. I ask, anyone caught your eye. I mean besides us. Charles says, that’s a good question.

He starts thinking for a moment. Then he says, I don't want to speculate just because of these matches, where we can't use weapons and have rules. However, some have definitely stand out more than others. The girl who uses her Kuret to create shadow warriors. I liked how she summoned armies to battle for her. Then there is one man who was can run fast. He was also interesting. And then there's was that guy who could use multiple Kurets. He wasn't an alpha, but he used some interesting techniques. He should have learned some more close combat. I turn my gaze away hearing that. Charles had to be talking about Ned. Well, Ned is strong in his own way.

Blake says, yeah, he was a little tricky. Charles replies, David and Marina used strangely similar way of using multiple Kurets, but they both are worlds apart compared to him. I press my lips together hoping to avoid talking about Ned. Charles notices my sudden change in mood, oh, is one of your friends. I didn't mean to diminish him like that. Like I said, I didn't like to judge others based on just one match. I turn to him again and hastily replied, no. Its okay. I know what you meant. I am not angry about it. It shouldn't be a bother to let him know he is my boyfriend. But weirdly I didn't want to since we both are fighting.

Blake clears his throat, Kafar's sure taking his sweet time isn't he. How long can we keep this break to continue. I gave him a thankful look to focus on something else. He continues, the more time it takes, David will be more exhausted. I don't think his power nap will actually help with his fatigue. Charles replies, I also hope to finish it quicker. He thinks for a moment before saying, you both care a lot about David. That’s good he has good allies. Have you known him for long. We both nod in unison. I said, we have known him for years. Though Cassandra knows him the longest. They were brought up together by some Human guardians for almost a decade when they arrived on Earth. Charles replies, I see. So he was one the few lucky ones to stay in society undetected. He got any family.

Blake replies, no. None we know at least. I reply, maybe when he regains his lost memories, he might remember someone here. Charles asks after a moment, is he married. Or got any partner. Okay, this a weird line of questioning. Why does that matter right now. I shook my head, no. Charles eye widen with a little surprise, really. That’s interesting. What is, I wanted to ask him, but I kept it to myself. He continues to wonder for a moment. Then faces us, how about you both. Blake chuckles, I have been a busy with a lot of things managing the Island.

I didn't want to say anything on this matter. Charles thankfully didn't press on me and says, you young people are wasting time you know. You never know what's going to happen. Better to live your life much you can. I met my wife here on Earth few years after our arrival. If she wasn't there for me, I would have gone crazy with getting revenge. And who knows what would have happened to my kids. Our prioritize might be to fight Hive, but don't forget to live. So many people died to get us here. They would want to live your life to the fullest.

His words made me recall my parents and brother. I don't remember my parents all too well, but my brother would have wanted a different life for me. In a way, my whole life has been defined due to his death. And all others who saved me. Blake says, I understand your sentiment. Believe me, its not something I am ignoring solely because we are in war with Hive. But right now we don't have the enough luxury to indulge so easily. At least, I don't have. Maybe once we have a bit more stability in our lives. He said it like he had given some serious thoughts about it.

I reply, and no offense Charles but you guys had it easier in Citradel. I know you were the ones protecting it, but Hives didn't attack you guys all too often. Having a place to call home is something we didn't have. Most of us outside had to hidden, or be on the move constantly. Our life on Earth hasn't been easy for dating you know. Charles says, I can't deny that. I won't pretend I understand your own personnel situations outside Citradel. We have been lucky to form our community early on. Maybe I should change my statement a little bit and instead say that once our two communities join, you should look for better lives. And not just you, your friends over their too. When Charles faces them, everyone wave their arms in response. I didn't realize they are still hearing our conversation.

Blake says, well, that’s what we are hoping. I turn to David. He was still leaning against the boulder with his eyes shut. I try to imagine what would David do when he finally gets a place to live. Ever sine last home at Wisconsin was gone, he basically never stayed in one place for long. At least I stayed with Nathen in the valley for whole two years, even if it was against my will. Blake and others also stayed in Europe as a headquarter to rally others during the time. Since David became a criminal among Humans, he hasn't been able to remain in one place for too long. He had to keep moving or go into hiding to avoid capture. I don't know anyone who's life was more tumultuous than his right now on Earth. But it should change once we all start living in one city.

Maybe its because Charles asked us just now, I began to wonder if David will try to date someone. It's curious, would David be finally be open to try it. His last relationship was with that Human girl, Christina. That ended so bad, he shot her father, went spiraling and almost killed Nathan at the end. But that was years ago, would he try to find someone new. We have been working together a lot for a while. Its wired I never asked him once about it. Sometimes, I feel he avoids talking about that with me purposely. Maybe that was just my imagination.

Looking at David made me recall about his conversation with Charles earlier. I turn back to Charles and ask, I forgot to ask, what were you two discussing earlier about your overdrive. He didn't tell us any of the details.

Charles asks, oh you didn't hear that part huh. We both shook our head. He continuous, well it’s a little sore topic. I guess I can tell you now. Its about risks involved in my overdrive risks. I asks, risks. You have risks. Charles says hesitantly, yes. And not just for me. Everyone. Me and Blake look at each other confused. Blake asks, what do you mean by that. Charles is about to reply, but then he stops and tilts his head his side.

I turn to his gaze and saw some movement at the edge of the barrier. People had hurdled up near the edge of the stadium which had the gates. Once it opened fully, two people come out it. Its Derek and Kafar. Charles says, they are finally here. I'll tell you the risks as soon I talk with Kafar. Charles hurriedly finishes the rest of his food. I turn and walk to David. David resting face made me hesitate a little. The moment I wake him up, we will again be thrown into a battle mode. I don't know if I can keep seeing him act so rashly. This sudden change in attitude is something I never expected to see in him.

But on the other hand, he has never been this powerful either. Strong enough to be in the same league as alphas and omegas. Maybe if he is lucky, he might just win this and become the next crown after my brother. If there was even a chance, I want David to win. With that resolve, I put my hands on his shoulders. David, they are here. David stirs a little and then his eyes flew open. His eyes flutter for a second and then he stands back on his feet. I take my hands away and point to the two walking people now walking to our friends.

David says, thanks. He cracks his neck a little, ah. This was a much needed break. I ask, you got any rest. He replies, some. At the very least I think my nerves have settled down a bit. Don't think I can use my new Kuret though. That last attempt took everything out of me in one go. I ask, can you win with just your Kuret storm. David thinks for a moment. He then finally says, I will make it work at all cost. Even if I have to go against his overdrive, I know I will win.

I couldn't form a response to that. He still has maintained his strong confidence. I shouldn't get in his way anymore.

# Blake(Chapter 36)

Tuesday, February 13, 2024 22:10

Charles hurries up finishing the rest of his food before Kafar arrives. With this short break, his swelling had now visibly subsisted on his face. Even his bad eye is opened half way. Some of his bruises and scratches were also healed partially. Its eerie that Charles is similar like me. We are both alphas who don't heal faster in our normal state. But there is one crucial difference. Now that I am this close, I could read his Kuret aura much better. His body is a paradox. He has enormous amounts of Kuret reserve, but the output is so low right now that it's almost negligible. On the other hand, being one step above a regular alpha, I have full access to my Kuret and heal way faster than other alphas. Charles may have large Kuret to draw on, but his access is slow. It becomes a bit faster when he takes on his Kuret body. But its still relatively slower than many alphas.

That's why he takes a lot of time to form his Kuret body. Setting aside his Kuret endurance, his Kuret is fundamentally even slower than mine or Nathans. It may look like his healing ability is superior, but its not. It’s the consistent availability of Kuret. That is the reason why Charles is so incredibly powerful. Everyone has limits, we use Kuret for healing our wounds or use it for attacking. We have to thin it and choose which one to focus more on when we fight. But he doesn't need to. He can do both without any effort. I could feel that even with a third of his Kuret remaining, his Kuret body would be just as strong.

At my side, David and Vanessa walk back to us. David looked the same as few minutes back, obviously because his wounds doesn't heal like us. But his eyes had regained some spark. That short nap must have taken away a little of his mental fatigue. David asks, glad to see someone is enjoying. Charles gobbles down the last piece, it delicious. I need ask my Kids to bring me more of these later. He crumbs up the empty bag and throws it away towards the debris. He asks, did you get any rest.

David answers, if I am being honest. David shakes his shoulders back and rotates his arm slightly, I want to just go and sleep for days. And I will, once this is over. Charles nods. I turn my gaze to others at the edge. It looks like Matt is giving Kafar that Kuritine to pass through the barrier. Soon after, Derek and Kafar begin to walk towards the barrier and cross it. Vanessa asks, is it just me or Kafar looks a little angry. I reply, you are not wrong. They both are now zigzagging towards us to avoid the holes on the ground.

David asks Charles, what if Kafar doesn't answer you questions or lies about it in some way. Will you still be able to make a decision. That’s a good question. Charles still hasn't told us what he wants from Kafar. And David's right, if Kafar sees his champion in any disadvantage, he would say or do anything to change the situation. Charles replies, it doesn't matter. Whatever he says, I'll treat that as his feelings about it and make a decision. What a straightforward approach, weirdly suits his style.

Few moments later, they both arrive at our spot. As soon as they saw Charles, Derek asks first, are you all right. That wound on your face doesn't look good. Charles touches his fingers to his face. He replies, it’s sore. Its much better now. Derek nods in relief. Kafar doesn't say anything for the moment. But his expression clearly showed irritation. Derek then turns to David, what about you. David replies, nothing I can't handle. Derek was more surprised to hear this. Derek asks, I won't ask you to explain the weird powers you shown us, but advice you caution against going overboard.

David replies showing his teeth, the only person you need to be worried is Charles. I have everything in control. Not even they were expecting David to be so cocky. Kafar stares with curious gaze at David, then he turns to Charles and asks, what's going on Charles. Why did you both ask for a break. You have any idea how much others are nervous right now. We have too many unforeseen events occurring in this match. Vanessa rebukes, oh please. Don't blame them, if it weren't for you, this match would already be over. David should have won earlier, its you who keep dragging this match. She is furious, not that I blame her. She might be also directing some of the anger of Ned here.

Kafar replies with a scoff, don't start with me again. We did nothing wrong. And you all would have done the same for David. Don't go accusing others just because you don't like the rules. Vanessa got pissed at Kafar indifferent attitude. She takes a step forward, but David grabbed her arm stopping her. He says firmly, Vanessa. That’s enough. This isn't the place or time to do this. Vanessa looks for moment at him. Then clicks her tongue and nods. He lets go of her arm. He says, lets get on with this shall we.

Kafar ignores Vanessa's attitude and turns to Charles, so what is it. Charles, who was silent and thinking something, broke out of his thoughts and replies, David wants to fight me in my overdrive. Kafar eyes widened at this and turns over to David for a second. He asks, why are telling him about your overdrive. There's something I noticed from his aura, he should have been way more agitated. I ask, so you already knew that Charles can overdrive. Kafar doesn't respond to me. Derek also is surprised. Charles continuous, yes. He is one of the few outside my family who knows about it. In fact we agreed that I will not use it in the tournament. He knows the risks it would put on all the people here.

He mentioned some risks again. What is that. Before I can ask to explain, Kafar says, you can't be serious. His face was confused and scared. He asks, if you use it here then…. Charles raises his palm to him before Kafar continuous to freak out, why do you think I purposefully let all that Kuret go to waste earlier. I needed to stop him from forcing me into overdrive. Even with so many guards and other warriors here, its way to dangerous without any preparation. And that’s what I want to discuss now.

Derek asks, you said there are risks. But its not just you guys, its everyone. I don't understand. How. Charles clears his throat, I can't control my overdrive. I didn't understand why would that put everyone at risk. Hell, even I can't control my own overdrive. David chips in, its not way you are thinking Blake. Looks like his overdrive is bit more unstable than yours. David read my thoughts like a book. I ask Charles, you mean you what, go out of control.

Kafar answers me instead, yes. That’s exactly how his overdrive works right now. I have seen it for myself once before. He looses all sense of himself, attacks anyone who he sees, doesn't matter they are friend or foe. He doesn’t stop until his Kuret goes out. Whoa. That’s too much. I didn't expect Charles overdrive is this damaged. To lose control of themselves when you are overflowed with Kuret in your body, that has to be the double edge sword thing I have heard about overdrive ever. Vanessa shrieks, so if he can goes nuts and attack others, even when he is just supposed to be fighting one person. David says, yeah, that's what he told me. He will attack everyone except for his own flesh and blood it seems. That was a convenient limitation of his sense of self. It has something to do something with instincts.

Kafar asks, and you expect us to allow this. Charles replies, I am considering it. David is the only person since we left from Medrine to challenge me on equal footing. Not even against the Hive leader warranted me to use it. But against him, its different. After witnessing his absurd strength, he just might be able to handle it. Its worked out for him too since the best way of defeating me right now is to make me overdrive. He takes a moment to sigh, you see, I enormous power up with this, but I also continues to loose Kuret more consistently. So if I am trapped or restrained until the end, I will lose undoubtedly.

So that’s what's going on right now. David was thinking to use some compulsion Kuret on Charles to force him into overdrive and defeat him. But he didn't knew about these risks, so Charles took painful measures to stop him. Derek asks, you said you are considering it to use it now. Why the change of heart if you know its too risky to use it. Charles reply, I want to tell my idea. It is a little bit dangerous, sure. But I believe this is the perfect opportunity for me to use it here. David asks, I have a feeling that you want to do it more than just winning this match, given with the risks involved.

Charles nods back, yes. I told you earlier right, I have tried to learn my overdrive many times now. But never been successfully been able to gain consciousness. And I have a theory on how to overcome it. If there were no person in the vicinity, my full focus would be on that one individual. Meaning, my senses wouldn't be all over the place, but instead just locked onto that one person. If such a situation were to happen, there is a good chance that with reduced burden on my senses, I could essentially wake up from the primal instincts overloading my brain. I never met anyone who would be able to withstand my overdrive all by themselves. So this has always been just a theory. But it’s the only way I believe I can control it.

That unexpectedly made sense. It has to be frustrating not being able to control your greatest weapon. Anyone would be trying all the ways they could to overcome their weakness. I ask, so you plan to use David to wake up in your overdrive. Charles nods, I am sure he isn't the only one who might be able to keep up with me in that state. Maybe you or Marina can do it too. But since we are in a tournament, wouldn't you agree it’s the best opportunity using him. Also I need to repair the damage he caused to Heraknus alpha's reputation. He smiles at his own words.

Everyone has to be in shock to hear that Charles his putting everyone at such risks for this. But its hard to argue too at the same time. With a similar frustration of not being able to control ones greatest power, I understood what he must be feeling like. Charles must have been looking for someone to help him out. Even if its in a match. Vanessa got a little mad hearing this, so you want to use David to get stronger. You sure you and him are not related. David smirks at her. David had the gall to be so amused by this. Derek asks to David, and you are okay with this. David shrugs and chuckles, I didn't know Charles was thinking to use me. But I don't care. I am in no position to tell anyone on how to get stronger. I basically learn from others every opportunity I can get. If anything, imagine how strong our forces would become if he had 3 overdrive users. Hive won't know what hit them.

I think David is the one who should be the most bothered by these risks. He is already ready to risk his life for the small chance he wins or Charles controls his overdrive. Kafar says angrily, this is utter nonsense. Charles, you can't be actually thinking about this. Even if we clear out every single person here, we can't have David fight you alone. He will die for sure. David scoffs at Kafar but doesn't say anything. I ask, now you are worried about David. Kafar replies, of course I am. You would be too if you had seen what I witnessed those years ago. I am want Charles win, but with David dying.

Its shocking that I couldn't be a hundred percent sure about that from his aura. I want to believe he is worried about David's safely, but I also can't say for certain he just doesn't want to make Charles a murderer in front of the whole world. David says, whoa. Who said anything about dying. I will be the one to win. Okay. Do I look worried about dying. His arrogance might be the most craziest part in this discussion. Just what the hell happened to him battling Charles to change his attitude like this. Vanessa tried to say something, but David gestures her to stop. He says, I know this is dangerous. But lets first see if Charles is even going to do use it. He still hasn't made his mind about it yet. So first lets just hear him out.

Everyone's eyes abruptly fell on Charles. He takes a few seconds to prepare his words, Kafar. I want to know what are your plans for my bloodline not that we are out from hiding. Kafar says, that’s what you wanted to know from me. We already discussed what's going to change in Citradel. Charles shook his head, no. You assume that we will remain in Citradel. He turns to David, it pains me a little to say this. The way things are, I honestly don't know how the match will continue. I might loose with or without my overdrive. David grins at this. Charles continuous, and despite the way you are behaving, I know you also shaking in his boots, so to speak. You keep saying you will win. I don't doubt your resolve, but I know you don't know how you are going to beat me. At least not yet. You must to be in the same boat as me.

David's grin fades out. A small somber expression dawns on his face. A second later he says, the boots thing is debatable. But…he takes a short sigh, yeah. I agree, if. I am really unlucky it might come down to a coin flip at the end. Charles nods. He turns back to Kafar, if I loose and we move here, what's are yours plans for my bloodline. Kafar was left in silence for a bit. Then he asks, why are you asking this. You said you won't loose to anyone before your match. Even if you are backed into a corner, you always get back and strike down your opponent. Don't tell you are thinking about loosing purposely.

Charles replies, no way. I am not backing down in any way. You know me better than that. I am asking you because I am an alpha. Me winning here or losing might be important to all Medrones, but I have a responsibility to my bloodline. And top it off, I am the first alpha to have been put in such a situation where our existence has been reveled after centuries. I need to know what's going to happen to my bloodline if we move here. Kafar mauls over this for a moment. He turns to David and then back to Charles.

I think I understand Charles a little better now. He might be an alpha from a mystical bloodline, but that’s just how people told them in their stories. In all honesty, they seem like regular bloodline like any other. They just are more powerful, but also have more weaknesses. Kafar finally says, I never thought this could happen. He shook his head, I will make sure to keep our agreement as is. I got curious, what do you mean. What's your plan. Kafar didn't respond. I pursue it a little more, look. You already revealed your champion out in the open. And someone is going to lose here. So there's no point keeping it a secret. What's the different in telling us now or later.

Kafar relented and says, I will make sure that their bloodline are given preferential treatment. Their bloodline doesn't have too many fighters. Many of their people are so weakened in their normal bodies that they could die from a bullet. I promised to give them better protection. Each and every Heraknus will be able to live now without fear and the isolation from hiding. He turns to David, my plan is to give them a section of Citradel itself. A fully state of the art security and enmities to them. They have had to live in hiding all these years due to their Kuret weakened. But now, they have regained enough strength to be the most elite force. And since we are going to ask them to risk their lives even more now, they will be compensated appropriately.

So Kafar is basically going to give them a special place in the hierarchy of our community. Like the royal bloodline. I understood the importance of Heraknus warriors. But the way Kafar is wanting things, its different than how we plan to make it work here. Charles asks, can you even say that when you know what kind of society this island aspires to be. Kafar turns to me now. He says with some reluctant, you know I am right. They are too powerful of a bloodline to be not protected. I didn't think Charles had any chance of loosing, so we never discussed about this before when we were in talks about joining our communities.

I didn't respond. I wanted to say something, but I couldn't say it in front of Charles. And also, Charles said he just wanted to hear from Kafar. Charles turns to me. He asks, well. Do you believe the same. Shit, out of luck. I ask, why ask me now. I thought you only wanted to pick on Kafar's brain for this. Charles replies, but since the young prince is already here, its not too much to ask your take on this. I wasn't sure what to say here. This isn't something I can just say without knowing all the facts. We just only learned of Heraknus existence.

David interrupts my thoughts, you don't have to say anything you don't want to. But this isn't any serious discussion. You heard earlier Charles just needed to know Kafar's answer. Whether it’s the right one or not, it didn't matter. No one is going to held it against you if for anything you say. You can even choose to not say anything. He is right. I don't need to say anything right now. It might not be a formal setting, but if I say something Kafar doesn't like, he might just hold a grudge. But then again, it is still a private conversation. Even if others are listening in, whatever I say now is set in stones.

I turn to Charles, I'll be honest. Its not fair for you to be asking me so soon after you just revealed your existence. I don’t know why you stayed hidden in Medrine for centuries. I am not privy to all those facts. He then turns to Kafar, but it doesn't matter. They are on Earth now. And I know at part of the reason they hid here. I take a pause and gather my thoughts on the matter. I am definitely letting out my personnel thoughts into it. But that’s what Charles wants so I shouldn't hold back.

I turn back to Charles, the society we want right now is based on simple idea. Everyone is equal right now. It doesn't matter if your bloodline has thinned or you're omega. Everyone is suffering the same fate right now. In an ideal scenario, yeah, some bloodlines should have more priorities than others. But we are not there yet. We need to get rid of Hive before we can achieve some a society. So to answer Kafar. No, we will not give Heraknus any priority more than needed.

Kafar stammers a bit, what. Are you serious, didn't you see how powerful he is. I reply, I understand their bloodline is strong, but aren't we having this conservation because they have so many weaknesses. This is just how I am seeing, but from my view you guys aren't all that different than other bloodline. Sure, you guys have incredible perks. But I have never seen or heard more serious weakness. In the wrong place and time, there's a possibility every member of your bloodline could become helpless at the same time. That's not only dangerous for you, but also for everyone around you. And yes, I know its not something you control. But you aren't the only ones like that. So many of other bloodlines have similar problems. We can't keep giving each and everyone protection.

I didn't even see Kafar's aura to tell this is annoying him. But he asked me, so he should expect to hear my answer. I continue, it may not be fair or right. But that’s the reality we are in. We are going to protect everyone with the same resources and not just the selected ones. No matter who they are, we want to treat everyone the same way. Because if we don't, this will be a repeat of Valley. And no one wants that. I don't know if Nathan is still listening to me, but I am sure he regrets the way he handled things. Even if he doesn't regrets it, he must at least know its wrong.

I add, our entire species is at war, whether you are actively in the war or not. That means we need to let go sacrifice certain things. Like privileges or some level of safety. I am not saying that we won't do anything to protect your bloodline, but we won't do everything. We have an entire species to save, not just one bloodline. Even if it’s a one as strong as yours. I decided to stop here. I had few more things to say, but they were along the same lines. They were thoughts for if David won the match.

Kafar replies, I don't understand. We need to keep Heraknus safe. They are key to winning the war. I respond, I don't disagree. But they alone can't vanquish Hive. There are other people just as powerful as Heraknus, maybe not as powerful as Charles. There are people who are strong in their own way. Are you saying you will protecting them too differently. Kafar didn't answer. I continue, its obvious you wants to keep our most powerful weapon protected. And maybe we will. Like I said, this are just my thoughts. Who knows what people will decide. But if given me the choice, I would do it this way. Its not fair, but that’s just our reality.

Finally there was a moment of silence. David broke it by saying, nicely said. And to believe you thought you weren't ready for this. He smiles at me. He has been doing it amusingly for a while now, but this one felt genuine. I don't know if I am ready to be king. But at least I know where I stand, different from Kafar. I wonder if he had similar philosophies in Citradel. It would be interesting to know he protected certain bloodlines more closely than others or not. But that’s for a later time.

I wait for Charles who had been listening me without interruption. He then asks with a stern voice, so you believe that our bloodline is the same as others. You don't believe we are special. That’s all what he took from the whole conversation. I shook my head, I don't think like that. Yours looks special, but I think its because you guys were thought to be extinct. If I break down your powers carefully, the perks you have is balanced with an equally if not more limitations. On Medrine, bloodlines were made especial due to certain individuals. Most of the times, its their were alphas. But sometimes, anomalies are born. The bloodline become more popular or recognized due to someone other than their alpha. We could have that same trait on Earth, but sadly we don't have the numbers. So all of us on the island believe strength in individuals and groups. Not solely on the bloodline.

Charles looks at me with an intensity that begins to feel uneasy. His aura is so low due to his Kuret output, I couldn't tell if he is angry or sad or something else. Charles finally nods his head, okay. I understand. He turns to David, what do you think of all this. You must have your own opinion. Oh great, now its David's turn. David nods his head, I don't have anything to add to this. I agree with him. Charles asks again, so you don't also believe we are special bloodline. David didn't had to think long for this. Looks like he already anticipated this question.

He says, I'll ask you a question. What do you even mean by special bloodline. Does it mean you guys are so powerful we should follow you into battle always. Or does it mean you have so many weaknesses that you need to be protected always. Or is it somewhere in between. Charles doesn't say anything. David continuous, if your answer is the third one, it just means you are same as others. All the time I have been fighting you, I didn't treat you like something mythical. Its true I struggled. Like a lot. The only thing going in my mind was to find ways of winning. At least for me, that is the same way I fought against Derek and Blake. If I was so bothered by the fact that your bloodline is too special to be beaten, I would have already given up or lost. Your bloodline is strong, but so are others in this tournament.

Whoa. Me saying it from the outside is one thing. Its easy to say something like that when you are not overwhelmed and give into the fear. But he is the facing Charles. I wasn't sure how David's been feeling all this time. But I think he has been doing what he always does, treats it like problem than needs to be can solved. He must have definitely thought of giving up many times. Yet in the end, he has resolved enough to win against Charles. I see, he has been looking at him just as an alpha. Not as an alpha of a mystical line. This is something only David can do.

Kafar turns to Charles, they don't know your actual worth. One day, you will cure that weakness of Kuret blackouts. Maybe even be able to reduce the time to recover your Kuret to days instead of months. Charles replies, yes. Maybe. Charles takes a look at us. I thought maybe he wanted to hear Derek's or Vanessa's thoughts as well. But then instead of asking them, he turns to David. His stoic look finally breaks apart and makes a smile, all right. I have made a decision. You got your wish kid, get ready to face me at my full power.

# Vanessa (Chapter 37)

Friday, February 16, 2024 23:08

Things escalated so quickly, my mind is in a turmoil. I didn't realize that Charles was this concerned about his bloodline. When I think about it, he must be actually feeling very stressed by this change. Imagine being part of a secret bloodline. He had to live in secrecy while also managing his bloodline. Then not only he lost his home, but the planet too. Now stranded on Earth, they still had to hide due his Kuret effected. Suddenly bringing about a change like this will certainly shift their paradigm. Charles, being their alpha, has a duty.

Its due to that he wants the best for his people. Kafar's agreement looked enticing for sure. But like Blake said, its not fair. We don't have the luxury of keeping one bloodline above others just because people believe they are mystical. Me, Catherine the other omegas are sole survivors of our bloodline. If Kafar thought really to protect special bloodlines, he would have to do it for us too. But that's just not possible. He can't just let one particular bloodline be assigned more important than others. This sort of thing was normal in Medrine, but we are not in Medrine anymore. Things have changed drastically and become more dangerous.

When David told us his take about it, I wasn't even surprised. Its so like him to be able to handle things his way under such crazy circumstances. I had a feeling his approach had been methodical, like playing a god damn chess. He was a little under duress in the beginning of the match. Made some rash decisions and made mistakes. But that's totally normal for anyone in his position. Who wouldn't be a struggle to fight someone like Charles. But he got better, got stronger, then insanely stronger. So much so that he did reckless attacks risking sometimes his life. The difference now from the start is that he has a reason to win desperately. I still can't understand what it is, but clearly he has gotten this powerful because of it.

Charles got to hear both sides. He finally made a decision. Something unexpected. Kafar yells in confusion, what are you saying. He said he won't be treating you anything special. Charles nods back, yes. That's want I want. Blake is confused. David tried to hide it, but I can tell he also wasn't sure of this. Kafar was speechless. Charles says, I never believed we needed to be protected more than others. If we did, what's the point in us being powerful when he have Kuret. Its fine to be treated differently because we have hidden this long, but I don't want the reason to be because of our powers. They saw me fight, so I thought to ask them what they think about my bloodline. I am actually felt relieved that they both felt like me.

What is going on. Is Charles saying he believes his own bloodline is a normal one. He continuous, I agreed to this if we remain in Citradel. With the Humans more close by, I want additional protection for my bloodline. But I don't think its needed here on this Island. I want us to have a normal life as much as possible. If we are suddenly thrusted into a spotlight straight from the shadows, unreasonable expectations would be set us. You were right David. We are not an all powerful bloodline nor do we need protection. In that sense, we are just like other bloodlines. Trying to survive just like others in an foreign planet.

Kafar asks nervously, hold on. I still don't…David cuts him off, its done Kafar. Deal with it. You answered, Charles heard and now its decided. Usually I am more patient, but you'll have to forgive me because I am way to tired right now. You should just listen to Charles idea. David gave a sharp look to Kafar that said, get with the flow or beat it. Kafar tried to put his annoyance into words. Derek then suggests, look. Its their battle. And whatever discussion happened here was nothing but opinions. No one is laying down ground rules for we will have make our society yet. This was something Charles just wanted to know for his own bloodline. So for now, let it slide.

Upon Derek's suggestion, Kafar ate his words. He didn't say anything more. Just gave an look of mix of confusion and anger. Charles faces David, I asked his selfish request for a break because I had to lay out my responsibility as an alpha. My reasons to continue from this point onwards shouldn't cause problems for my family, my bloodline. Now I am sure that whether I win or nor, we will have people around us who are open to see as equals. David nods at this, its good to know that you believe in our ideals too. So lets hear your idea.

Charles says, we need to fight in remote isolation. Need people to back away few miles so that I don't go hunting them in my overdrive state. This you already figured it out. But I need to emphasize one thing, there is a real chance you will die. I am not exaggerating it enough when I say that the danger you will be facing might just be the most difficult you ever faced. The way Charles spoke was way to serious than how he was worried earlier. My eyes widen a little hearing that. I ask, you are serious, aren't you. Charles nods, yes. I am. Look, since you don't heal like us, you might suffer some injury so severe that you die before people can come get you.

I know David is trying to keep his confidence up, but even he couldn't deny this. He says, I told you, I am aware of the risks. I won't chicken out just because someone new is trying to kill me. All I have to say for that is, get in line. Hive have tried to kill me, Humans tried to kill me. Hell, even Medrones have come after me. Fear of death is the least of my problems. David must have a screw loose now. He says he understand the risks, but does he. I ask him, no way. This is too dangerous David. If Charles saying you could die, even after all the times he came close to get you, you need to know the its too serious now.

Blake backs me up firmly, there is not enough good reason to risk your life for it. David replies, if I don't do this, I may not win at all. Then we have no choice but to move to Citradel. The life of millions of Medrones hangs in the balance. Us forming a society on the island, away from Human interference, isn't that a good enough reason. I reply, but you'll live. You will have more opportunities to save lives by living. He replies with a ominous tone, one persons life isn't worth everyone. You and Blake know that the best way to keep fighting is to first get all us safe in one place. And that has to be an isolated region, here. This island.

I am mad at him right now. How can he just say his life is not important. I reply angered, are you for real. You don't know how important you are. David shakes his head, this isn't about me. We all are taking risks. Maybe some more than others. But doesn't mean I should walk away. Blake asks nervously, is what you meant Charles. Risks for David. You want us others to be away from you two, leaving David all alone. Charles nods, I will bring in some specialized gears for people to use. They have worked on me before, even at my worst, so they should work here too. But like I said, they people to be far away, otherwise I could target them instead. Something could go wrong until I get restrained.

I couldn't believe this is what's happening. David's going be locked in the barrier with Charles, with no help from the outside. This is insane. This is not going to happen. David says, enough guys. You guys have trusted me this far. So a little more faith now. I am not being suicidal. I am not going to die okay. Besides, it's not for you to decide. Its my decision. I need to decide what's best for everyone. I reply, you mean you right. For some selfish reason, you are using that as an excuse. You want to just want to win that badly.

David looks at me with sudden intensity. I might have hit the bullseye. He can try to disguise his reasons, but I am sure of the actual one. David says, you might be right. But at least my selfishness to win no matter the cost is aligned with a purpose serving others. I am not blinded so much like others. I could hear a subtle tone his voice directly at my own selfish behavior during my match. I wanted to tell him that was different. But was it really. I wanted so badly to win, I risked more than I should. If it wasn't called off, I would have continued and probably bled to death. Is the same for him. Is something driving him so bad he rather die than give up.

Blake takes over when I become too stunned to speak. He asks, this is a little crazy David. Even for you. You are willing to die for hope that the island is the best place for us. Maybe Citradel could also be better. You don't have to bet on you life like this will doom our future. David shook his head, this will. We cannot hope to win against Hive if we are still surrounded my Human interference constantly. We have already gone through this months back. You know that. That's why we even agreed to this ridiculous tournament. And don't forget in the beginning I didn't even wanted to battle here. I was sure, you, Marina or Vanessa will be strong enough to win. But then I did. My reasons were different back then from now, but I don't regret it. And it turned out to have an unexpected outcome with my new Kuret transformation.

He sighs and then says, I don't want you guys to take this wrong way. But right now, I am the one here. Not you, not Blake or Derek. But me. I didn't get till to this point in my life solely on luck or playing it safe. Every important things I have done, has always been dangerous. All the freaking time. So you need to trust me and let me decide. I have never seen such a emotional and calculative David at the same time. He is even not shying off from flaunting his own achievements to make his point. Its incredibly frustrating to hear and even more to know they were true.

But it didn't make me any less mad. Is this actually going to happen. He might actually die at the hands of someone who doesn't even want him dead. David continues before Blake or me could stop him, so Charles. How are we going to do this. Announce people to back way to the island edge. Or maybe even ship them out completely. Charles asks, are you sure then. You made up mind. Even when you are in mortal danger. David nods in response. I couldn't even say anything. David's words about selfish behavior still hung on me. I want to desperately stop this, but I can't. Not when he is doing something not so different than me.

Charles says, let me tell the entire plan at least. We won't fight today. Not even tomorrow. David arms that were in cross comes open, say what now. Charles says, we will fight in a months time. Kafar asks, what are you saying Charles. If you are already made up your mind for using your overdrive. Why do you want to delay it. Charles says, I need time to recuperate. The Kuret I have lost will need that much time to recover completely. David asks, you want to recover your entire Kuret. Why. Charles says, simple reason. I want to go into overdrive with my entire Kuret. Give me the most time I can spend in my overdrive. The more Kuret I have, the more time I would have in my overdrive and the more chance of gaining consciousness.

Its incredibly bold of Charles to ask this. Giving himself the time to prepare is nothing but even more selfishness than David. David didn't respond, instead he ponders on it. David tilts a head slightly on hearing this sudden new development. Blake shrieks, you want to postpone the match. Is that even possible. He turns to Kafar. Kafar is full on panic mode now. Way too much things must be going on his head to answer. Derek answers instead, I am not saying we should do this, but we can tell everyone that Charles is going to use his overdrive. So he needs time to use it. He turns to Charles, I assume that's what you meant when you said everyone will know about your overdrive.

Charles replies, yes. There is no point in hiding it now or later when I am going to use it. You can tell others about the risks too. I have nothing to hide or be ashamed about it. Its just how my alpha Kuret behaves. In fact, the more people are informed the better they understand the risk of being near me. Blake asks, and you need a full month do regain your lost Kuret. Charles replies, regretfully yes. The Kuret recovery is much slower for our bloodline. Blake turns to David, at the very least you will have a whole month to recover then.

I ask him, wait. So you all on board now. Blake says with annoyance, hell no. But you heard him. He isn't going to listen to us. At for the moment, we can't stop him. Short of physically restraining him ourselves all the time, I don't know what we can do. The only way we can truly stop this if we agree to move to Citradel now. But its not just David, I don't think people will agree to it. We worked hard to build this city here. Bringing people from all over the world, stealing resources we need from Humans undetected and even rebuilding our technology. Too much is at stake to change our progress by moving to Citradel. If David's going to do this, I can't deny it anymore, we need this win. I reply, so what. We should just let this happen. I turn to David, you are willing to die, when you are not even facing Hive as your enemy.

David looks at me but doesn't respond. What is going on his head right now. Charles says, you still have a out kid. I told you earlier, you can reject this idea and we can continue this match as is. I reply, that's right. Its much safer to fight Charles like this. Derek says, you might even win. You know that winning now or winning after a month don't have the same risks. You can choose for a safer option. David finally broke his silence, I don't understand one thing Charles. A months will also give me time not only to recover, but to work on my Kuret. I can't say how much, but I will become way stronger than now. Same as you. I can't believe he is ignoring us like this. Was he even listening when he heard me pleading.

Charles says, that's why it should work out well for the both of us. This gives us an equal advantage for winning and loosing. David shook his head, nope. That's were you are wrong. I am trying to weigh my options. But I don't see how this is good for the both of us. I never seen your overdrive. Meanwhile, you know all my tricks. Even if I was lying and hiding something more, you still have the edge on power. A month won't be enough time to learn my new Kuret forms. Not completely. And lets say I continue this match without making you overdrive, I would be fighting with that same disadvantage. You will not go into overdrive, but maybe you will pull out some unknown form yet again.

I am a little relieved David is still level headed even when being so stubborn. Charles nods slightly thinking at the same time. David continues, and don't get me started on how things have been not been equal for us. You had been hidden until the finals, while I had to take a long and painful route to get here. You have gotten the chance to see me fight others and now with you. A month time will give you more ways to deal with me and than I can against you. And there have been numerous violations from you. Even if there were not intentional, it shouldn't have been allowed. He turns to a nervous Kafar. David says, I am not accusing you specifically. I don't care about

it much right now anyways. But I can't ignore it too. I only bring this up to prove that fighting now or fighting after a month, we both don't have the same footing as you say.

He raises his arms up, again. It's not something I am blaming you Charles. I am just telling you what I think. I want to win against you completely, but its meaningless if I recover in a month and my chances doesn't change. I am desperate to win, not to die. I could just continue this current battle which is much safer. From my view, with these conditions, I don't see the merit in risking so much. Now if you plan to do it now instead of waiting for a month, I am game.

Charles thinks about it for a moment. Then he shakes his head, tempting. But no. I won't to do it now. I want to get the best chance and use this opportunity to recover first. David replies, yeah. Well, you see the dilemma I am here right. I gotta admit, David made sense even he is being so stubborn. His wrapped sense of danger is still somehow sensible enough to know differences of the risks involved. Charles thinks about it for a long time. It was a agonizing to wait for him to respond. Then he says, I never thought it like this. I thought you would agree to it right way if it meant getting stronger. But you are right. You were at disadvantage from the beginning. And I feel like I have been given lot more help that I should have gotten. He then turns to Kafar, so lets fix that.

Kafar asks in nervous tone, what do you mean by that. He smiles and then turns to David, I'll sweeten this proposal. If you agree to it, I am going to declare my loss. Did I hear him right. That was the most outrageous thing he has said till now. He is willing to forfeit the match to make the real fight happen later. Kafar yells, you can't. Charles says, why not. Am I also a participant here. I maybe a wild card entry, but the rules will apply to me the same. If I don't want to, I can choose to give up now. Kafar is shaken at this. So were everyone who heard this incredible turn of events.

David asks sternly with a frown, even if you give up like this. I don’t think people, specifically from Citradel, and the admins would accept the match to end like this. They might choose not to move here. I don't know if you realize just how much was risked to keep the match going. Charles nods, I think I am beginning to understand that. Earlier you asked me something about my Kuret blackout when I was lying on ground. I don't fully understand what happened, but now that I think about it, I might have been stuck like that for longer than I thought. Maybe I should I have lost then and there. Am I wrong. He looks over to us.

He did realize something was wrong. Kafar replies in haste, no. You didn't loose then. You were just lucky. That’s all. His desperate pleas looked more desperate than insincere. Charles replies, even if that’s not the case, I am still willing to give up. He turns to face David, and as for people not choosing to come here. You might be right. To make sure you actually win this match, I am also willing to bring my bloodline to this Island immediately when you agree to it. Kafar was stammering on his words, you what. You can't do that.

This is becoming too tense now. Charles says, why not. Our current deal is over now. We are not in hiding anymore, we don't need the same protection anymore. What I want is a place for my bloodline to be with other strong people. I know there are many Citradel people who are strong, but the people here are more experienced with the Hive. They have been constantly fighting Hive and even won a war without our support. We need to learn from them more than they from us. I am doing this not just for me, but for everyone.

I ask, buts that’s just your bloodline. What about others. They might still remain in Citradel. Blake replies, no, not true. Citradel didn't know their protector until now. They knew someone has been protecting them all this time, but not their identity. Now every Medrone knows about them. If they move here, then its almost certain people will also come here. They can't live in a place where the people who protected them all this time suddenly leave. Do you believe the same. He asks Derek.

Derek like us is reeling from the shift in the conversation. He then replies, yes. I do. Some people might think to stay behind, but in the end safety in numbers is what matters. It might not be pretty or smooth process. But if Charles moves here, I don't think people will remain in Citradel anymore. How unexpectedly devious of you Charles. Charles replies, thanks kid. I do sometimes get pretty good ideas now and then. So David, what do you think now. Doesn't this make us even now. You no longer have to worry about anything other than our fight anymore.

David had a bewildered expression. Even he never thought this could happen. He asks, you are serious. You are okay giving up and letting your people come here. Charles nod, yes. Once I realized that you might be the one who could handle my overdrive, I am become less concerned with this tournament. I still want to show how powerful a Heraknus alpha truly is, and now I can do it without being concerned about the consequences for my bloodline. Same as you. If when I give up now, its still only a technical victory for you. You too would not accept it as a complete victory.

I ask him, if this is want you want, you can just let someone else fight you later. Blake or Marina would be more compatible to fight you in a caged match. David doesn't need to be only one fighting you right. Charles shook his head, no. At this moment, David is the only one whose the best for this. Marina's the granddaughter of Gordan. She is the been tasked to be the architect for rebuilding our culture. She is way to important to risk herself when our society is only forming. And the young prince here also has many responsibilities now. He needs to be here to lead the new Medrine community. And unfortunately, I don't know anyone else other than the 3 of you who could have a chance of surviving my overdrive. So it has to be David. I am not saying he isn't important, but only he has shown such an adnominal will to win.

I turn my eyes to David. My face was confused visibly now. He must be trying hard to decide. This new addition had definitely thrown out all the odds stacked against David. If David agrees to it, we have effectively moved all the people to the Island. Kafar shrieks, Charles, you are making a rash decision here. You can't selfishly choose to do this. Think about others, not just your own bloodline. Charles replies, I can't take responsibility for everyone. I have made my priorities known to you from the start. And if you think about it, this will can still benefit everyone. Maybe not the way you want, but its still a possibility. Same as when people would had people move to Citradel.

Kafar shook his head, not like this. If you do this, it will make people divide even further. We can't let it happen. Charles replies, you might be right. But as said earlier, I can't take complete responsibility for others. I have to be looking out for my people first. Kafar asks pleading now, at least don't do this without discussing it other admins. With your people. Charles replies, I don't need to get approval about this from people. I can do what I want here. Unlike Medrine, we don't have a society with stringent rules. No laws to obey or repercussions when we break it. And as for my bloodline, they have already seen how strong the island people. Some may not like how I decided, but they will understand it once I talk to them later.

Blake asks, what if even after that they don't agree to come. Charles thinks for a moment before replying, I don't think that’s going to happen. I not just an alpha they follow, they trust me enough to make the right decision. But just in case if it did happen. He turns to David, I wouldn't have kept my end of the bargain and so you wouldn't need to fight me anymore. I am not sure what would happen with our two communities in that case, but at least you won't have to risk your life for this.

This is nuts. Charles is giving a lot of leeway for David accept it. With such terms, its hard not for him to take it. In his mind, he has to decide if this is worth the risk. Kafar yells, I can't believe you are willing to go this far. Charles says, I am not only one you know. With all the insane stunts this kid has been doing in this match, I don't know who is more willing to put everything on the line. Charles wasn't wrong, they both have eerily the same attitude on this matter. Kafar shifts his body and looks at us with fervor eyes. He must be angry at this situation. His worst possible outcome might become reality if Charles ends this tournament right now.

David is still thinking what to do. He says to Charles, quite the conundrum you have put me in Charles. I can chose to risk with my life a month later, but at least our future would be have better chance of surviving. On the other hand, if I continue this match, I am leaving the outcome to luck. A relatively safer way, but no guarantee of my win. He forms a smirk on his mouth and whispers, I honestly don't know what's the right way. He rolls his eyes to me. I thought he was going to ask me to help him out. But he just started straight without blinking.

He has to know how what I will say. I don't want him to fight such a freak all alone. If we are not there to intervene their match, he could very well die. I still can't believe he would rather do something irrational than continue fighting now. I wanted to let David decide this, but my mind had already made up. I told him, you already know what my thoughts are on this right. Don't do this David. Please. Getting people here is important, but not by putting your life in danger intentionally. I turn to Blake and Derek to say something. But of them didn't say anything. Rather, they couldn't. I face David back. He kept his eyes on me all the time. I couldn't keep it together and ask, what are you looking for me to say. I will never say what you want. I will never agree to this.

David says with a small chuckle, figures. That was just a wishful thinking I guess. He was really wanting me to push him and accept this deal. If I can't stop him, I am sure as hell will not going to help him decide what he really wants. Kafar suddenly yells, wait David. Blake said you all don't have all the facts of Charles and overdrive right. Maybe you need to hear some of it now. You will know how exactly ridiculous it is to face him alone with his overdrive. Charles asks, Kafar, what do you doing.

Kafar barks out, if I also can't stop you. At least I can tell David what's waiting for him next. He turns to David, I can't tell anything specific about his overdrive. I have only seen it briefly, so even if tell something about it, you won't benefit from it. But I just remembered something now. He turns to me now, you don't want to David fight too right. Then you being here is good thing. I ask, what does that mean. He says, while on Earth, no Medrone has been able to challenge him, but only some people have stood against Charles on Medrine. His mother, his uncle, a royal alpha and one more.

Blake joins in suddenly, say that now. A royal alpha. You mean my dad. Kafar shook his head, no. You and Nathan's grandfather. Back then Charles was young and wasn't even an alpha. So it isn't fair comparison. His mother and uncle on the other hand weren't a target when he goes overdrive, so its still not meaningful. But the last one, this one came in contact when Charles was an alpha and undergoing his overdrive training. Charles told me he was the only one who made him overdrive.

David asks, you said only your mother would be able to handle you in that state. Charles looks at Kafar for a second before responding, yes. That’s right. I told you about someone gave me a lot of trouble. He was too powerful for me to beat, so I made a rash decision to go into overdrive. But my mother was the one who reined me in the end. David ask, who was it that made you decide to use it. And why were you even fighting this person anyways.

Kafar cuts in before Charles could answer, the reason of their confrontation is not important. But it’s the person you should know. He turns to me again, it was Wagner. Your brother, the previous crown. My entire body shiver a little hearing his name here. I ask hesitantly, what. I turn to Charles to look for an answer. Charles takes one more look at Kafar and then to me, yes. It was him. It was years before we left Medrine, but I remember it him quite clearly. He used the same Kuret as you, but as an alpha not as an omega, I gather you had born by then. You inherited his Kuret, but he was the first alpha of your bloodline. He was in a league of his own. Next to my mother and David, he is the only person I ever wanted to use my overdrive on.
I can't believe Wagner fought him. Why did he though. Why didn't he even tell anyone about it. Told me. Charles continuous, we had a similar situation of stalemate, like David is with me now. But he chose to push further and use his own overdrive. So I had no choice but to use mine then. At that statement I froze. I blurt out, he did what. He could overdrive. Charles looked curious at me, you don't know. That's strange. I thought you knew. Blakes asks, are you sure that he did. No one knew he already achieved it. Charles looks around us. Our confused face gave him an answer, hum. This is surprising, did he keep it hidden.

I can't believe my own brother hid such a thing from me. How can he not tell me he fought a Heraknus or he could overdrive. Dammit. I know it wasn't the time to be feeling this, but I became extremely jealous of him now. He already did something I am not able to do. Kafar interrupts the sudden tense atmosphere, the important thing is that now you know that the strongest Medrone on Earth, even with his overdrive couldn't beat Charles in his own overdrive state. Wagner was defeated in no time. Maybe he didn't want to share with others that he lost and so he never spoke of this. He turns to David, you, who isn't even an alpha or omega has no chance of beating him. You will get killed.

Is that really it. I couldn't believe Wagner would be ashamed of his defeat. I turn to David who had frozen still. What happened to him. His eyes was glued to Kafar. His body is frozen, not moving even an inch. But then I noticed his fingers trembling a little. Wait. Is he scared. Is Kafar obvious plan to scare him actually working. I got concerned and ask, are you all right. He doesn't say anything. He ignores me. Blake asks, ah. You all right there. You look like you are about to throw up.

Even others notice this visible change on David. Kafar blatantly becomes rude, yes. That’s right. You must have hear how strong Wagner was. He was the strongest one in the whole planet and still couldn't defeat Charles.

Charles raised his hand to him, wait a second Kafar. This isn't…He gets cut off by David's hurried voice, is it true Charles. You met him and even fought him. For the first time I hear nervousness in his voice. Charles looks a bit uneasy at this. He nods, yes. I did. I am not lying. But you need to know…David interrupts his again, prove it. I won't take just your word for it. Tell me something about him only people who fought him would know.

This is a strange ask. What's going on with David. Charles asks, did you knew him on Medrine. But I thought you don't remember your past. David yells with a certain force that shocked everyone of us, just tell me. How I know doesn’t matter right now. Charles was taken aback from this sudden outburst from him. Does he remember my brother. Why didn't he ever mention that. Now that I think about it. Whenever I bring my brother, he evades the entire topic with some reason. What's going on David. How do you know about him, I ask him. David doesn't respond to me. He was focused completely on Charles. Charles looks over to us. Even Kafar was not certain what's going on now.

Charles scratches his forehead for a moment, I am not sure what to tell you. Lets see. He closes his eyes for a second to think and then says, yeah. I found something very peculiar about him. I remember he ditched his weapon early on when he figured it wasn't going to work on me. He did said something aloud to me, about it being not strong enough to break my body and mind. That was wired thing to say. No one would throw away any weapon.

David Kuret immediately erupts in flame beside me. I instinctively take a few step back away from him. I shriek, David. What are you doing. Everyone expect Charles takes a step away from his Kuret that was enveloping him. The moment I saw his face, I couldn't believe it. He looked pissed. His mouth was turned hard from gritting his teeth. His eyes had such anger and madness I never seen it before. Blake shouts, whoa. What happened. Derek asks, somethings wrong. Kafar nervously laughs, yes. Looks like he is realizing just how fruitless this endeavor is.

David begins walking slowly between us. His Kuret roared wildly around him. He comes closer to Charles and then a moment later quells down his Kuret. He says, I accept your conditions. Lets do it. A month later we will duke it out.

# David (Chapter 38)

Saturday, September 6, 2025 12:45

I can't think, maybe can't even breathe. My heart is beating so loud that I can't hear anything else. This is the opportunity I thought that was never going to get. When Kafar revealed about that guy fighting Charles, my thoughts became a singularly focused on finding the authenticity and not a plot by Kafar to make me back off. Charles answer was proof enough that Kafar was telling the truth. I can't believe that there is someone alive who fought that psychopath. What's more, he couldn't beat Charles. If could beat Charles, it would mean I beat him.

It didn't make me a second longer to make my decision after this revelation. My Kuret was leaking from me, partly excited and anxious, as I walked towards Charles. Other were trying speaking to me, but I couldn't hear them. My breathing had tuned everything out. Finally I told him, I accept your conditions. Lets do it. A month later we will duke it out. Charles was visibly taken aback by my sudden change in demeanor. I kept waiting for him to reply back as he gather back his composure. He hesitantly asks, are you all right, kid. I don't know why you are acting like this, but maybe you should take a moment.

I replied, I am fine. I gritted my teeth and the corner of my mouth formed into a big smile involuntary. I continued, no. I am actually great. I have a chance to beat down someone that the previous crown couldn't beat. I am not letting this opportunity go to waste. No way in hell. Charles eyes focused on me, then he looked to others. None were speaking, just waiting. Charles broke the silence after a sigh, look, that’s not the whole story. Kafar left out somethings. I cut him off, I don't care. The other unnecessary details are a little interest to me. I only care about our fight now. So lets agree to the conditions you laid out.

Charles silent breathing is heavy and long. He was clearly wary of me. Blake and others were also stunned by my attitude. But I cared not. Even with my brain getting hotter by the second, I was aware that I was having an episode. Soon I will be getting a panic attack. I need to get this out of the way out better my breakdown. Kafar cuts in with a nervous and anxious voice, are you absolutely sure you want to do this. He turns to Charles once he realized I wasn't going to respond to him, Charles, you do this and you expose everything. After keeping it a secrete for so long, are you really ready to reveal it now?

Charles looks to him but doesn’t respond. He is still contemplating his decision. He turns to me and lightly shook his head, all right. I don't understand what's going on with you. Its got nothing to do me anyways. Fine David. You got yourself a deal. He raised his arm. Others around were shocked by this development. My smile become even wider, probably becoming menacing. I took his arm and shook it. Kafar was the most vocal about opposing this. Others were silently witnessing and someone was even cussing.

A moment later I take back my hand and say, I can't wait for our rematch. Charles lightly nodded with a little nervousness. He turns towards the building with admins and raised his hand in air. He then gestures that he is giving up. I saw glimmers of confusion coming in the air from the crowd. I bet the entire stadium is in an uproar. The admins are the ones who are most shocked to have seen this conclusion to the match.

I could feel my veins popping in my head, my breathing erratic. I was definitely going towards a breakdown. With all the exhaustion, I may even pass out soon. My legs suddenly felt weak. Actually I have been struggling to stand now. My left leg stung a little and out of no where my knee gave out. Beside me Blake caught me with this hands on my arms before I fell down. He shrieks, whoa. What happened.

My Kuret was receding back in. I was able to clam myself a little now that the Charles had given up. I could hear others now. I look up to Blake who had a serious face on him. I murmur, get me out of here. Hurry. I pleaded. Blake was stunned and then a moment later nodded sternly. Vanessa and Derek looked over to me in stupor. Kafar was angrily watching Charles and was ignoring me. Blake looks over to others, I am talking him to infirmary. He is finally hitting his limit. He turns to Kafar, David is the winner after this. You can't stop this now. Kafar ignored him and had his eyes focused solely on Charles. Charles and Kafar were now in heated argument a moment later.

I could feel my hands shaking. Shit. I can't let others know about me. Not right now. With Blake's support, we both turned and start to walk away. Blake could definitely tell something was wrong with me. Thankfully, he didn't ask me. Even if he did, I wouldn't tell him when others are listening in. I couldn't tell what Vanessa and Derek were doing. One thing was certain though, Vanessa was no doubt mad at me. But there was no sign of her following us. I was thankful for that. I am in no state to handle it right now.

We came close to the barrier. On the other side, our friends were waiting. Since the barrier was still eructed, we couldn't cross it yet. I wanted to hurry the hell out of here. My chest started to ache now. My legs were almost giving up as I lost strength. Blake grabbed hold of me firmly, shit, he muffles. He turns to others and signals Marina to remove the barrier. I looked up with my twitching eyes. Marina had raised her shoulders asking what's going on. Blake mouths hurry up to her. Marina was bamboozled. She looked over to Blake and then finally to me.

She took a few seconds to understand and nods panicking seeing my state. She turns to others and signs them to back away from her. She uses her Kuret and starts to create a charm. I don't know what exactly her plan was. This barrier is extremely tough. I don't think it can't be taken down fast, especially without her overdrive. At this point, both my legs had lost strength. Blake felt a sudden tug of weight from my slumped body. I brings his own Kuret to support with one arm, dammit. Try to hold on a little longer. I understand you want to leave before anyone sees you like this. I'll help as much as I can.

All I could muster was a slight node. Blake pretty much caught on to my plight now. Ahead of us, Marina was continuing with her casting. I could vaguely make out circuits of Kuret coming out of her hands. I had even started to sweat excessively and fogging my eyes. Shit. This might be the biggest breakdown I ever experienced. This cannot be happening at a worst timing, for all of Medrines to see. I have kept this weakness hidden all the tournament. I might let it being slide if it got exposed later, but I still have a final showdown.

Fortunately, I had a good excuse of exhaustion. People seeing me would just assume I am tired and had to be carried out. I had little room to think about it though. My mind was becoming jumbled and thoughts incoherent. I am running out of time. Marinas charm was finally completed. She walked towards the barrier wall. The invisible kuret begins twist and funnel out towards Marina. A moment later a hole opened up through which we could pass though.

Though, something was odd. The cornucopia of glimmers coming off were not disappearing, instead it was just being scooped into sheet of kuret enveloping Marina. Blake and I didn't waste time and crossed the barrier. The sudden change in surrounding made my body jerk. The loud noise which was earlier dulled down was now completely deafening. Crowd of people were shouting with such zeal it was unclear whether they were mad or congratulating me. I tried best not to look up and instead just focused on going inside.

Others scrammed around us. Nathan asks, what the hell just happened to you? Cass asks, David, what's happening. Her voice filled with concern. Matt and others still kept their distance, due to Marina shouting, don't come near me. It was as though she was making the barrier kuret curled up in her charm. Why was she still holding it. She looks at others, I can't let go of this. If I do, they both will just be pulled back in by this. I can't disperse this Kuret yet. A little of the barrier kuret left her charm and form a thin sheet of wall Infront of the two us as we walked.

I could feel a slight tug from the front trying to push me and Blake back inside. Blake says, you are slipping a little Marina. Marina curses a little and says, I know, I know. She starts to walk behind us. She continuous, guys, don't follow us. I need some space. I will follow them inside to make sure the barrier doesn't pull them back. Tell the others inside to wait for a little while until I come back. Tessa speaks, understood. Just do whatever you can for them right now. David doesn't looks too good.

I bet, I grumbled. Others watched us in confusion as the three of us pass the corridor door I used to enter inside. The noise slowly begins to fade down. The familiar noise of my breathing and heart beats begins to rise up. At this point Blake is completely dragging my lifeless body though the hallway. Marina walks in close behind us with the Kuret barrier in tow, what happened. Is he okay. Away from others she finally asks. Blake replies, I have no freaking clue. One minute he was okay, then the next second he was not. His kuret leaked out and he started to shake badly. I can't believe his injury worsened so suddenly without M warning. I thought she mentioned he was okay.

Marina waves her wrist a little, M wake up. What's going on. I thought he wasn't in danger. The watch glows up and M comes out, boss's stats are crashing. Diagnosis confirm its not physical injury, but a psychological. Preparing countermeasures with sedatives. Blakes immediately speaks up, what. How can this be. M didn't respond, but only showed my heart rate and other stats. Marina asks, oh come on. Just tell us. Your boss is looking pale now. M response didn't change, causing Marina to snap with a irritated sigh.

The three of us pass though the inside of the building now. There were some staffs now visible. They tried to approach us, some confused and others clapping. Blake waved his free arm around them, sorry people. The winner is too exhausted to talk right now. Thankfully, due to my sudden departure, the people inside had not mobilized completely. Only the essential people were inside. Majority of them would be either outside or gathering to move inside.

A group of people came and began gathering around us. They were the security for the participants. The head person Jackson came up and takes a quick look at us. He nods then instructs others to form around the three of us. Give us some space, he shouts to the oncoming people. He turns to Blake, what happened. Blake responds, we need to go to the infirmary quickly. It might not look like it, but his injuries are worse than they appear. He needs to get inside his personal suspension tank.

Jackson replies, I see. Okay. Lets cut through the stair case from the left end of the building instead of using this one. I saw few people from the stadium beginning to come inside. It will be a longer route, but we can avoid people for now. Blake says, lead the way. Using the five security guys, the three of us make way from the slowing buzzing staff in a tight formation. Blakes turns back to Marina and asks, how long will you have to keep this up? Marina replies, a minute more. I don't have those stones from before to create doors in the barrier, so next best thing is to take a piece out of it and let it slowly disintegrate.

Blake asks, okay. As soon as this done, you can head back to take down the entire thing. Marina clicks her tongue, after all that effort to make it. She turns to face me and hold back whatever she was about to say more, well, whatever. At the very least it was a good opportunity to test it out. She turns to Jackson, how much farther. He points to the straight ahead on the turn on the hallway. We were able to pace up from here out since there were very less people now.

My head started to hurt now. Vision was blurry to tell what direction we were going. I was completely at the mercy of others now. I grabbed my left chest. It felt like my chest was about to burst open. This is just a panic attack. I kept reminding myself. The rational part of me knew this was my PTSD, yet my body was crashing out. I don't know how long I could hold it together now.

After what felt like eternity, I saw the glimmers of medicines. We were close. We came to a halt near the entrance. I heard Blake saying beside me, thanks everyone. I will help David inside. Don't let anyone inside. Jackson waves his hand to others guard the door, understood. You do what you need to. Marina says, its done. She dispels the Kuret as the door open for us. She says, I think I better stick with you until David stabilizes. Since I got M with me.

Blake takes a moment to consider, good thinking. We might need M. As we cross the minimal staffs inside, Blake murmurs to her to avoid people hearing us, I don't know how, but I think David's having a heart attack. He is panicking more visibly now. Marina didn't hold back her shout, what. That can't be. She looks to M, the hologram didn't mention anything. She replies, its not possible. M is not showing anything. Just a high hear rate. Blake replies, but look, he is grabbing his chest like this.

We rushed to my private room that was dedicated for me. All the equipment here were carefully calibrated for me. I only ever needed for rest and bandages before. But this time, the suspension tank was already up and running. Now that we were completely away from others, I spoke up, its not a heart attack. By voice was basically trembling at this point. Even I could barely hear my own voice. The two of them turn to me. Blake was near me and heard the most, what was that.

He leaned to my neck to hear more clearly. But at that moment, I couldn't keep my nausea down anymore. I could feel the gag reflex coming on. Marina saw me and immediately understood. Shit. She conjured up a charm to pull the dustbin from the corner to her. Blake saw this and let goes of me. My body slump down like a rock. I already couldn't feel my legs, so with one free arm keeping me steady on the floor, I threw up into the bin Infront. The glimmers and smell of my own stomach contents hit me with force.

Blake and Marina take a step back. My mouth filled with the familiar yet disgusting taste. I emptied out my stomach after several seconds. Spit comes out from the corner of my mouth. Shit. I began shaking now uncountably, my left hand still clutching my chest. I push the bin away and slump down face first. Marina calls out, David no. Blake grabs me by my shoulders, pulling me up and shouts, what's going on M. Their voices were now filled with terror. M didn't respond.

Once Blake helps me out straighten up, I try to speak up again, panic attack. It was all I could muster. This time Blake heard me, are you serious. You know what's happening to you. I gave a slight now. Or maybe not. My whole body was shutting down, it was hard to tell anything. Blake pulls me up towards the suspension device. Marina opens the lid and warm air gushes out from the inside. Blake uses his Kuret to push me up and place me inside. M finally speaks up, confirmed boss inside. Starting up the process.

After finally resting inside my tank, my body finally gave out. My hands and legs begin to shake. My heart is pounding like crazy. A nanobot wire comes out floating on the water with a needle to inject me in my left arm. I could hardly tell the needle inside my vein. Blake lets goes of my body as he paces me inside. The water begins to fill inside from the bottom. All I could feel was it was warm and getting splashed around from all my shaking. Marina was about to close the lid. With my available arm, I lift it up and wave at her to stop.

She askes concerned, what, something wrong. I tried to speak, but my throat was in no mood to listen. Blake asks, something you need us do. I think I nodded. I couldn't tell. I didn't want others to know about me like this, but I didn't have much choice. M can't diagnosis my PTSD properly, only manage the symptoms. I need help from Dr Drew here. With a shaking hand, I point to Marina's wrist. Marina confused brought her arm near my palm. I don't know if M will even register this gesture with all this tremors, but I had little options.

I begin slowly making air gestures with my fingers. Both of them realized a moment later that I was motioning something to M. The sedative was finally taking effect. For the first time since letting go of Charles hand, I felt my breathing calming down. But that also meant I was going to be unconscious soon. With every bit of focus I could manage, I complete the unlock sequence. M speaks out, confirmed raised authority. Boss's PTSD and medication history is now available.

Marina freaks out, PTSD. What the hell. Blake turns to me and asks, what does this mean. He leans closer to me thinking I would respond. But no voice would come from me. Marina shouts, ah. Freak it. We will ask him later. Let M work on him first. Blake pulls away, yeah right. He grabs my arm hanging out at the edge and pulls in inside placing on my stomach. Marina closes the lid with the water now filling up my neck. I could feel the nanobots surfing in the water around me.

My mind finally begins to drift off to slumber.